

QUALCOMM INC/DE

FORM 10-K (Annual Report)

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**UNITED STATES
SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE COMMISSION
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20549**

FORM 10-K

(Mark one)

☒ **ANNUAL REPORT PURSUANT TO SECTION 13 OR 15(d) OF THE SECURITIES EXCHANGE ACT OF 1934**

For the fiscal year ended September 24, 2017

OR

☐ **TRANSITION REPORT PURSUANT TO SECTION 13 OR 15(d) OF THE SECURITIES EXCHANGE ACT OF 1934**

For the transition period from _____ to _____.

Commission File Number 0-19528

QUALCOMM Incorporated

(Exact name of registrant as specified in its charter)

Delaware
(State or Other Jurisdiction of
Incorporation or Organization)

95-3685934
(I.R.S. Employer
Identification No.)

5775 Morehouse Dr.
San Diego, California
(Address of Principal Executive Offices)

92121-1714
(Zip Code)

(858) 587-1121
(Registrant's telephone number, including area code)

Securities registered pursuant to section 12(b) of the Act:

Title of Each Class	Name of Each Exchange on Which Registered
Common stock, \$0.0001 par value	NASDAQ Stock Market LLC

Securities registered pursuant to Section 12(g) of the Act:

None

Indicate by check mark if the registrant is a well-known seasoned issuer, as defined in Rule 405 of the Securities Act.

Yes ☒ No ☐

Indicate by check mark if the registrant is not required to file reports pursuant to Section 13 or Section 15(d) of the Act. Yes ☐ No ☒

Indicate by check mark whether the registrant (1) has filed all reports required to be filed by Section 13 or 15(d) of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934 during the preceding 12 months (or for such shorter period that the registrant was required to file such reports), and (2) has been subject to such filing requirements for the past 90 days. Yes ☒ No ☐

Indicate by check mark whether the registrant has submitted electronically and posted on its corporate Web site, if any, every Interactive Data File required to be submitted and posted pursuant to Rule 405 of Regulation S-T (§232.405 of this chapter) during the preceding 12 months (or for such shorter period that the registrant was required to submit and post such files). Yes ☒ No ☐

Indicate by check mark if disclosure of delinquent filers pursuant to Item 405 of Regulation S-K (§229.405 of this chapter) is not contained herein, and will not be contained, to the best of registrant's knowledge, in definitive proxy or information statements incorporated by reference in Part III of this Form 10-K or any amendment to this Form 10-K. ☐

Indicate by check mark whether the registrant is a large accelerated filer, an accelerated filer, a non-accelerated filer, smaller reporting company or an emerging growth company. See the definitions of "large accelerated filer," "accelerated filer," "smaller reporting company," and "emerging growth company" in Rule 12b-2 of the Exchange Act. (Check one):

Large accelerated filer ☒ Accelerated filer ☐ Non-accelerated filer ☐
(Do not check if a smaller reporting company) Smaller reporting company ☐ Emerging growth company ☐

If an emerging growth company, indicate by check mark if the registrant has elected not to use the extended transition period for complying with any new or revised financial accounting standards provided pursuant to Section 13(a) of the Exchange Act. ☐

Indicate by check mark whether the registrant is a shell company (as defined in Rule 12b-2 of the Exchange Act). Yes ☐ No ☒

The aggregate market value of the voting and non-voting common equity held by non-affiliates of the registrant at March 26, 2017 (the last business day of the registrant's most recently completed second fiscal quarter) was \$83,990,231,661 , based upon the closing price of the registrant's common stock on that date as reported on the NASDAQ Global Select Market.

The number of shares outstanding of the registrant's common stock was 1,474,164,639 at October 30, 2017 .

DOCUMENTS INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE

Portions of the registrant's Definitive Proxy Statement in connection with the registrant's 2018 Annual Meeting of Stockholders, to be filed with the Commission subsequent to the date hereof pursuant to Regulation 14A, are incorporated by reference into Part III of this Report.

QUALCOMM INCORPORATED
Form 10-K
For the Fiscal Year Ended September 24, 2017
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TRADEMARKS

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Other products and brand names may be trademarks or registered trademarks of their respective owners.

In this document, the words “Qualcomm,” “we,” “our,” “ours” and “us” refer only to QUALCOMM Incorporated and its subsidiaries and not any other person or entity. This Annual Report (including, but not limited to, the section regarding Management’s Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations) contains forward-looking statements regarding our business, investments, financial condition, results of operations and prospects. Words such as “expects,” “anticipates,” “intends,” “plans,” “believes,” “seeks,” “estimates” and similar expressions or variations of such words are intended to identify forward-looking statements, but are not the exclusive means of identifying forward-looking statements in this Annual Report. Additionally, statements concerning future matters such as the development of new products, enhancements or technologies, industry and market trends, sales levels, expense levels and other statements regarding matters that are not historical are forward-looking statements, but are not the exclusive means of identifying forward-looking statements in this Annual Report.

Although forward-looking statements in this Annual Report reflect our good faith judgment, such statements can only be based on facts and factors currently known by us. Consequently, forward-looking statements are inherently subject to risks and uncertainties and actual results and outcomes may differ materially from the results and outcomes discussed in or anticipated by the forward-looking statements. Factors that could cause or contribute to such differences in results and outcomes include without limitation those discussed under “Part I, Item 1A. Risk Factors” below, as well as those discussed elsewhere in this Annual Report. Readers are urged not to place undue reliance on these forward-looking statements, which speak only as of the date of this Annual Report. We undertake no obligation to revise or update any forward-looking statements in order to reflect any event or circumstance that may arise after the date of this Annual Report. Readers are urged to carefully review and consider the various disclosures made in this Annual Report, which attempt to advise interested parties of the risks and factors that may affect our business, financial condition, results of operations and prospects.

PART I

Item 1. Business

We incorporated in California in 1985 and reincorporated in Delaware in 1991. We operate and report using a 52-53 week fiscal year ending on the last Sunday in September. Our 52-week fiscal years consist of four equal fiscal quarters of 13 weeks each, and our 53-week fiscal years consist of three 13-week fiscal quarters and one 14-week fiscal quarter. The financial results for our 53-week fiscal years and our 14-week fiscal quarters will not be exactly comparable to our 52-week fiscal years and our 13-week fiscal quarters. The fiscal years ended September 24, 2017, September 25, 2016 and September 27, 2015 included 52 weeks.

Overview

We are a global leader in the development and commercialization of foundational technologies and products used in mobile devices and other wireless products, including network equipment, broadband gateway equipment and consumer electronic devices. Our inventions helped power the growth in smartphones, which have connected billions of people. We are a pioneer in 3G (third generation) and 4G (fourth generation) wireless technologies, and are now a leader in 5G (fifth generation) wireless technologies to empower a new era of intelligent, connected devices. Our technologies and products are also used in industry segments beyond mobile, including automotive, IoT (Internet of Things), data center, networking, computing and machine learning, and allow millions of devices to connect with each other in new ways. We derive revenues principally from sales of integrated circuit products and licensing our intellectual property, including patents, software and other rights.

The foundational technologies we invent help power the modern mobile experience. We share these inventions broadly through our licensing program, ensuring wide ecosystem access to technologies at the core of mobile innovation, and through the sale of our wireless chipset platforms and other products, which accelerates consumer adoption of experiences empowered by these inventions. As a company, we collaborate across the ecosystem, including manufacturers, operators, developers, governments and industry standards organizations, to create a global environment that drives continued progress and growth.

We have a long history of driving innovation. We played a leading role in developing the inventions that serve as the foundation for 3G and 4G wireless technologies, which are expected to serve as the basis for 5G wireless technologies. This includes the CDMA (Code Division Multiple Access) and OFDMA (Orthogonal Frequency Division Multiple Access) families of technologies, with the latter encompassing LTE (Long Term Evolution), which, along with TDMA (Time Division Multiple Access), are the primary digital technologies currently used to transmit a wireless device user’s voice or data over radio waves using a public cellular wireless network. We own significant intellectual property applicable to products that implement any version of CDMA and OFDMA, including patents, patent applications and trade secrets. Companies in the mobile communications industry generally recognize that any company seeking to develop, manufacture and/or sell

subscriber units or infrastructure equipment that use CDMA-based and/or OFDMA-based technologies will require a license or other rights to use our patents.

We also develop and commercialize numerous other key technologies used in handsets and other wireless devices that contribute to end-user demand, and we own substantial intellectual property related to these technologies. Some of these inventions were contributed to and are being commercialized as industry standards, such as certain video and audio codec, wireless LAN (local area network), GPS (global positioning system) and positioning and Bluetooth. Other technologies widely used by wireless devices that we have developed are not related to any industry standards, such as operating systems, user interfaces, graphics and camera processing functionality, RF (radio frequency) and antenna design and application processor architectures. Our patents cover a wide range of technologies across the entire wireless system (including wireless devices and infrastructure equipment) and not just what is embodied in chipsets.

We are organized on the basis of products and services and have three reportable segments. We conduct business primarily through our QCT (Qualcomm CDMA Technologies) semiconductor business and our QTL (Qualcomm Technology Licensing) licensing business. QCT develops and supplies integrated circuits (also known as chips or chipsets) and system software based on CDMA, OFDMA and other technologies for use in mobile devices, wireless networks, devices used in the Internet of Things (IoT), broadband gateway equipment, consumer electronic devices and automotive telematics and infotainment systems. QTL grants licenses to use portions of our intellectual property portfolio, which includes certain patent rights essential to and/or useful in the manufacture and sale of certain wireless products. Our QSI (Qualcomm Strategic Initiatives) reportable segment makes strategic investments. We also have nonreportable segments, including our mobile health, data center, small cell and other wireless technology and service initiatives.

Industry Trends

The mobile industry has experienced tremendous growth for more than 20 years, growing from less than 60 million global connections in 1994 (WCIS+, October 2017) to approximately 7.8 billion global connections as of September 30, 2017 (GSMA Intelligence, October 2017). As the largest technology platform in the world, mobile has changed the way we work, the way we live and the way we connect with each other. The scale and pace of innovation in mobile, especially around connectivity and computing capabilities, is also impacting industries beyond wireless. Our business model and inventions have been integral to the mobile evolution, providing foundational technologies for this continued innovation and growth.

Extending connectivity. 3G/4G multimode mobile broadband technology has been a key growth driver of mobile, providing users with fast, reliable, always-on connectivity. As of September 30, 2017, there were approximately 4.7 billion 3G/4G connections globally (CDMA-based, OFDMA-based and CDMA/OFDMA multimode) representing nearly 60% of total mobile connections (GSMA Intelligence, October 2017). By 2020, global 3G/4G connections are projected to reach 6.3 billion, with approximately 83% of these connections coming from emerging regions (GSMA Intelligence, October 2017).

3G/4G multimode mobile broadband has also emerged as an important platform for extending the reach and potential of the Internet. In 2010, the number of broadband connections using mobile technology surpassed those using fixed technologies (GSMA Intelligence, October 2017), making mobile networks the primary method of access to the Internet for many people around the world. This is further amplified in emerging regions, where, as of September 30, 2017, 3G/4G connections are approximately six times the number of fixed Internet connections (GSMA Intelligence and WBIS, October 2017). In China, 3G/4G LTE multimode services have experienced strong adoption since being launched in the fourth quarter of calendar 2013, with more than 939 million connections reported as of September 30, 2017 (GSMA Intelligence, October 2017). In India, mobile operators continue to expand their 4G multimode services, providing consumers with the benefits of advanced mobile broadband connectivity while creating new opportunities for device manufacturers and other members of the mobile ecosystem. 3G/4G mobile broadband may be the first and, in many cases, the only way that people in these regions access the Internet.

Looking ahead, Qualcomm and the wireless industry are actively developing and standardizing 5G technology, which is the next generation of wireless technology, expected to be commercially deployed starting in 2019. While the 5G New Radio (NR) standard is still being defined, it is expected to provide a unified connectivity network for all spectrum and service types based on OFDM technology. 5G is being designed to support faster data rates, lower network latency and wider bandwidths of spectrum. Incorporating many of the innovations developed for 4G, 5G is also expected to be scalable and adaptable across a variety of use cases, which include, among others: empowering new industries and services, such as autonomous vehicles and industrial applications, through ultra-reliable, ultra-low latency communication links; and connecting a significant number of “things” (also known as the Internet of Things or IoT, including the connected home, smart cities devices, wearables and voice and music devices), with connectivity designed to meet ultra-low power, complexity and cost requirements. 5G is also expected to enhance mobile broadband services, including ultra-high definition (4K) video streaming and augmented and virtual reality, with multi-gigabit speeds.

Most 5G devices are expected to include multimode support for 3G, 4G and Wi-Fi, enabling service continuity where 5G has yet to be deployed and simultaneous connectivity across 4G and Wi-Fi technologies, while also allowing mobile operators to utilize current network deployments. At the same time, 4G is expected to continue to evolve in parallel with the development of 5G and become fundamental to many of the key 5G technologies, such as support for unlicensed spectrum, gigabit LTE user data rates and LTE IoT to meet the needs of ultra-low power, complexity and cost applications. The first phase of 5G networks are expected to support mobile broadband services for the smartphone form factor both in lower spectrum bands below 6 GHz as well as higher bands above 6 GHz, including millimeter wave (mmWave).

We continue to work closely with mobile operators and infrastructure companies around the world on 5G demonstrations and trials in preparation for commercial network launches.

Growth in smartphones. Smartphone adoption continues to expand globally, fueled by fast 3G/4G LTE multimode connectivity advanced multimedia features and enhanced location awareness capabilities, among others. In 2016, approximately 1.5 billion smartphones shipped globally, representing a year-over-year increase of approximately 5%, with cumulative smartphone shipments between 2017 and 2021 projected to reach approximately 8.6 billion (Gartner, September 2017). Most of this growth is happening in emerging regions, where smartphones accounted for approximately 75% of handset shipments in 2016 and are expected to reach approximately 92% in 2021 (Gartner, September 2017). Growth in smartphones has not only been driven by the success of premium-tier devices, but also by the number of affordable handsets that are fueling shipments in emerging regions and the variety of flexible and affordable data plans being offered by mobile operators.

Consumer demand for new types of experiences empowered by 3G/4G LTE connectivity, combined with the needs of mobile operators and device manufacturers to provide differentiated features and services, is driving continued innovation within the smartphone. We have been a leading contributor to this innovation that is happening across multiple technology dimensions, including connectivity, intelligence, camera, audio, video, sensors and security. As a result, the smartphone has become the go-to device for social networking, music, gaming, email and web browsing, among others. It is also replacing many traditional consumer electronics devices due to advanced capabilities, including digital cameras, video cameras, Global Positioning System (GPS) units and music players, combined with an always on and connected mobile platform.

Transforming other industries. With its significant scale, rapid development cycles and highly integrated solutions, a number of industries beyond mobile are leveraging technology innovations found in smartphones. Our inventions that contribute to the formation of advanced cellular technologies, such as 3G/4G LTE connectivity, are helping transform industry segments outside of the traditional cellular industry, including automotive and IoT, among others, and empowering companies to create new products and services.

The proliferation of intelligent, connected things is also enabling new types of user experiences, as smartphones are able to interact with and control more of the objects around us. Through the addition of embedded sensors and on-device artificial intelligence processing, connected things are able to collect data and learn about their environment, providing users with contextually relevant information and further increasing the device's utility and value.

Wireless Technologies Overview

The growth in the use of wireless devices worldwide and the demand for data services and applications requires continuous innovation to further improve the user experience, support new services, increase network capacity, make use of different frequency bands and allow for dense network deployments. To meet these requirements, different wireless communications technologies continue to evolve. For nearly three decades, we have invested heavily in research and development to drive the evolution of wireless technologies, including CDMA and OFDMA. As a result, we have developed and acquired (and continue to develop and acquire) significant related intellectual property. This intellectual property has been incorporated into the most widely accepted and deployed cellular wireless communications technology standards, and we have licensed it to several hundred licensees, including leading wireless device and infrastructure manufacturers.

Cellular wireless technologies. Relevant cellular wireless technologies can be grouped into the following categories.

TDMA-based. TDMA (Time Division Multiple Access)-based technologies are characterized by their access method allowing several users to share the same frequency channel by dividing the signal into different time slots. Most of these systems are classified as 2G (second generation) technology. The main examples of TDMA-based technologies are GSM (deployed worldwide), IS-136 (deployed in the Americas) and Personal Digital Cellular (PDC) (deployed in Japan).

Since CDMA technologies are the basis for all 3G wireless systems, GSM connections are declining. According to GSMA Intelligence estimates as of September 30, 2017, there were approximately 3.1 billion GSM connections worldwide, representing approximately 39% of total cellular connections, down from 46% as of September 30, 2016. The transition of

wireless devices from 2G to 3G/4G technologies continued around the world with 3G/4G connections up 16% year-over-year (GSMA Intelligence, October 2017).

CDMA-based. CDMA-based technologies are characterized by their access method allowing several users to share the same frequency and time by allocating different orthogonal codes to individual users. Most of the CDMA-based technologies are classified as 3G technology.

There are a number of variants of CDMA-based technologies deployed around the world, in particular CDMA2000, EV-DO (Evolution Data Optimized), WCDMA (Wideband CDMA) and TD-SCDMA (Time Division-Synchronous CDMA) (deployed exclusively in China). CDMA-based technologies provide vastly improved capacity for voice and low-rate data services as compared to analog technologies and significant improvements over TDMA-based technologies such as GSM. To date, these technologies have seen many revisions, and they continue to evolve. New features continue to be defined in the 3rd Generation Partnership Project (3GPP), an industry standards development organization.

CDMA technologies ushered in a significant increase in broadband data services that continue to grow globally. According to GSMA Intelligence estimates as of September 30, 2017, there were approximately 2.4 billion CDMA-based connections worldwide, representing approximately 30% of total cellular connections.

OFDMA-based. OFDMA-based technologies are characterized by their access method allowing several users to share the same frequency band and time by allocating different subcarriers to individual users. Most of the OFDMA-based technologies to be deployed through 2017 are classified as 4G technology. It is expected that 5G will heavily leverage OFDM-based technologies. We continue to play a significant role in the development of LTE and LTE Advanced, which are the predominant 4G technologies currently in use, and their evolution to LTE Advanced Pro.

LTE is incorporated in 3GPP specifications starting from release 8 and uses OFDMA in the downlink and single carrier FDMA (SC-FDMA) in the uplink. LTE has two modes, FDD (frequency division duplex) and TDD (time division duplex), to support paired and unpaired spectrum, respectively, and is being developed by 3GPP. The principal benefit of LTE is its ability to leverage a wide range of spectrum (bandwidths of up to 20 MHz or more through aggregation). LTE is designed to seamlessly interwork with 3G through 3G/4G multimode devices. Most LTE devices rely on 3G for voice services across the network, as well as for ubiquitous data services outside the LTE coverage area, and on 4G for data services inside the LTE coverage area. LTE's voice solution, VoLTE (voice over LTE), is being commercially deployed in a growing number of networks.

Carrier aggregation, one of the significant improvements of LTE Advanced, was commercially launched in June 2013 and continues to evolve to aggregate additional carriers in the uplink as well as the downlink. Along with carrier aggregation, LTE Advanced brings many more enhancements, including advanced antenna techniques and optimization for small cells. Apart from improving the performance of existing networks, these releases also bring new enhancements under the umbrella of LTE Advanced Pro to which we have been a significant contributor, including, LTE Direct for proximity-based device-to-device discovery, cellular vehicle-to-everything (C-V2X) communication, improved LTE broadcast, optimizations of narrowband communications designed for IoT (known as eMTC and NB-IoT) and the ability to use LTE Advanced in unlicensed spectrum (LTE Unlicensed) as well as in emerging shared spectrum bands in various regions (such as the Citizens Broadband Radio Service or CBRS in the United States). There will be multiple options for deploying LTE Unlicensed for different deployment scenarios.

- LTE-U, which relies on an LTE control carrier based on 3GPP Release 12, uses carrier aggregation to combine unlicensed and licensed spectrum in the downlink and has been introduced in early mobile operator deployments in the United States and evolves to Licensed Assisted Access (LAA).
- LAA, introduced as part of 3GPP Release 13, also aggregates unlicensed and licensed spectrum in both up and downlink and is being deployed globally by mobile operators. LAA is a key technology for many operators with limited licensed spectrum to deliver Gigabit LTE speeds.
- MulteFire can operate in unlicensed spectrum without a licensed anchor control channel.

There also have been ongoing efforts to make the interworking between LTE and Wi-Fi more seamless and completely transparent to the users. Further integration is achieved with LTE Wi-Fi Link Aggregation (LWA), which will utilize existing and new carrier Wi-Fi deployments.

According to GSMA Intelligence estimates as of September 30, 2017, there were approximately 2.3 billion global LTE connections worldwide, representing approximately 30% of total cellular connections.

According to the Global mobile Suppliers Association (GSA), as of September 30, 2017, more than 810 wireless operators have commercially deployed or started testing LTE with 644 commercially launched in 200 countries. In addition, LTE Advanced standards featuring carrier aggregation have begun to be deployed, with 212 operators having commercially launched LTE Advanced networks in 105 countries (GSA, October 2017).

As we look forward, the wireless industry is actively building the next generation of cellular technologies under the name 5G in 3GPP. While 5G is still being defined, our inventions that serve as foundational technologies for 3G and 4G are expected to serve as the basis for 5G wireless technologies. 5G is expected to transform the role of wireless technologies and incorporate advancements on 3G/4G features available today, including further enhanced mobile broadband services, device-to-device capabilities, use of all different types of spectrum (including licensed, unlicensed and shared spectrum) and connectivity of a significant number of things. 5G is also expected to include operation in emerging higher frequency bands, such as those in the millimeter wave range to significantly increase the data rate offered to users. Furthermore, 5G is expected to offer techniques that will allow cellular networks to expand into new vertical product segments, such as enabling automation-based platforms for industrial companies (known as Industrial IoT), and define a radio link with much higher levels of reliability for control of vehicles and machines. This development, which builds on the various 3G and 4G features addressing IoT, will further sustain the trend of enabling cellular connectivity to non-handset categories of devices. We continue to play a significant role in driving 5G from standardization to commercialization, including contributing to 3GPP standardization activities to define the 5G New Radio (NR) and Next Generation Core (NGC) standard and collaborating with industry participants on 5G demonstrations and trials to prepare for commercial network launches. We continue to enhance and track the 3GPP standard in our 5G NR prototypes for spectrum below 6GHz and mmWave spectrum, as well as for shared and unlicensed spectrum. These prototypes will be used for interoperability device testing starting in late 2017 with infrastructure partners as well as for early trial activities with mobile operators.

Other (non-cellular) wireless technologies. There are other, non-cellular wireless technologies that have also been broadly adopted.

Wireless Local Area Networks. Wireless local area networks (WLAN), such as Wi-Fi, link two or more nearby devices wirelessly and usually provide connectivity through an access point. Wi-Fi systems are based on standards developed by the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) in the 802.11 family of standards. 802.11ax, the latest standard, adds advanced features such as downlink and uplink OFDMA and uplink multiple user multiple in/multiple out (UL MU MIMO) to the 802.11 baseline standard. This technology primarily targets broadband connectivity for mobile devices, tablets, laptops and other consumer electronics devices using 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz spectrum. For 60GHz mmWave technology, 802.11ay adds wider channel bandwidth and the use of MIMO to the existing 802.11ad (also known as Gigabit Wi-Fi or WiGig) standard. 802.11ah was finalized in early 2017 and targets sub-1 GHz spectrum and is expected to be a solution for “connected home” applications that require long battery life. We played a leading role in the development of 802.11ac, 802.11ax, 802.11ay, 802.11ah and 802.11p, and we are actively involved in innovative programs developed in the context of the Wi-Fi Alliance.

Bluetooth. Bluetooth is a wireless personal area network that provides wireless connectivity between devices over short distances ranging from a few centimeters to a few hundred meters. Bluetooth technology provides wireless connectivity to a wide range of fixed or mobile consumer electronics devices. Bluetooth functionalities are standardized by the Bluetooth Special Interest Group in various versions of the specification (from 1.0 to 5.0), which include different functionalities, such as enhanced data rate, low energy and mesh technologies. In August 2015, we acquired CSR plc, a leading contributor to Bluetooth evolution in the areas of mobile devices, HID (human interface device), A/V (audio/video) and mesh technologies.

Location Positioning Technologies. Location positioning technologies have evolved rapidly in the industry over the past few years in order to deliver an enhanced location experience. We were a key developer of the Assisted-GPS (A-GPS) positioning technology used in most cellular handsets today. For uses requiring the best accuracy for E911 services and navigational based services, A-GPS provided a leading-edge solution.

The industry has now evolved to support additional inputs for improving the location experience. Our products and intellectual property now support multiple constellations, including: GPS, GLONASS, Galileo and BeiDou; terrestrial-based positioning using WWAN (Wireless Wide Area Network) and Wi-Fi-based inputs; Wi-Fi RSSI (received signal strength indication) and RTT (round-trip time) signals for indoor location; and third-party sensors combined with GNSS (Global Navigation Satellite System) measurements to provide interim support for location-based services in rural areas and indoors where other signal inputs may not be available.

Other Significant Technologies used in Cellular and Certain Consumer Electronic Devices and Networks

We have played a leading role in developing and/or acquired many of the other technologies used across the wireless system, such as cellular and certain consumer electronic devices and not just what is embodied in the chipsets, and networks, including:

- graphics and display processing functionality;
- video coding based on the HEVC (high efficiency video codec) standard, which is being deployed to support 4K video and immersive media content;
- audio coding, including EVS (enhanced voice services) and MPEG-H 3D Audio;

- the latest version of 3GPP's codec for multimedia use and for voice/speech use, which is being deployed commercially;
- multimedia transport, including MPEG-DASH (Dynamic Adaptive Streaming over HTTP) enabling advanced multimedia experiences;
- camera and camcorder functions;
- operating system and user interface features;
- machine learning platforms;
- augmented reality (AR) and virtual reality (VR) features enabling new types of user experiences;
- security and content protection systems for enhanced device security without compromising the user experience;
- volatile (LP-DDR2, 3, 4) and non-volatile (eMMC) memory and related controllers;
- power management systems for improved battery life and device charging; and
- RFFE (radio frequency front-end) system products for improved signal performance and reduced power consumption, while simplifying the design for manufacturers to develop LTE multimode, multiband devices.

Acquisitions

RF360 Holdings. On February 3, 2017, we completed the formation of a joint venture with TDK Corporation (TDK), under the name RF360 Holdings Singapore Pte. Ltd. (RF360 Holdings), to enable delivery of radio frequency front-end (RFFE) modules and radio frequency (RF) filters into fully integrated products for mobile devices and Internet of Things (IoT) applications, among others. The joint venture is owned 51% by Qualcomm Global Trading Pte. Ltd. (Qualcomm Global Trading), a Singapore corporation and wholly-owned subsidiary of ours, and 49% by EPCOS AG (EPCOS), a German wholly-owned subsidiary of TDK. Certain intellectual property, patents and filter and module design and manufacturing assets were carved out of existing TDK businesses and are owned by the joint venture, and certain assets were acquired directly by affiliates of ours. Qualcomm Global Trading has the option to acquire (and EPCOS has an option to sell) EPCOS's interest in the joint venture for \$1.15 billion 30 months after the Closing Date. The total purchase price was \$3.1 billion. RF360 Holdings, which is included in our QCT segment, is a Singapore corporation with research and development and manufacturing and/or sales locations in the United States, Europe and Asia and its headquarters in Munich, Germany.

NXP Semiconductors N.V. On October 27, 2016, we announced a definitive agreement under which Qualcomm River Holdings, B.V. (Qualcomm River Holdings), an indirect, wholly owned subsidiary of QUALCOMM Incorporated, will acquire NXP Semiconductors N.V. (NXP). Pursuant to the definitive agreement, Qualcomm River Holdings has commenced a tender offer to acquire all of the issued and outstanding common shares of NXP for \$110 per share in cash, for estimated total cash consideration to be paid to NXP's shareholders of \$38 billion. NXP is a leader in high-performance, mixed-signal semiconductor electronics in automotive, broad-based microcontrollers, secure identification, network processing and RF power products.

The transaction is subject to receipt of regulatory approvals in various jurisdictions and other closing conditions, including the tender of at least 80% of the issued and outstanding common shares of NXP in the offer (provided that the minimum tender threshold may be reduced to a percentage not less than 70% with the prior written consent of NXP). While we continue to work to close by the end of calendar 2017, the transaction may close in early 2018. At an Extraordinary General Meeting of NXP's shareholders held on January 27, 2017, NXP's shareholders approved certain matters relating to the transaction, including the appointment of designees of Qualcomm River Holdings to NXP's board of directors (effective upon the closing of the transaction) and certain transactions that are intended to be consummated after the completion of the tender offer.

In May 2017, we issued an aggregate principal amount of \$11.0 billion of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes with varying maturities, of which a portion will be used to fund the purchase price and other related transactions. In addition, we have secured \$4.0 billion in committed financing through a Term Loan Facility, which is expected to be drawn on at the close of the NXP transaction (See "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 6. Debt."). The remaining amount will be funded with cash held by our foreign entities.

Qualcomm River Holdings and NXP may terminate the definitive agreement under certain circumstances. If the definitive agreement is terminated by NXP in certain circumstances, NXP will be required to pay Qualcomm River Holdings a termination fee of \$1.25 billion. If the definitive agreement is terminated by Qualcomm River Holdings under certain circumstances involving the failure to obtain the required regulatory approvals or the failure of NXP to complete certain pre-closing reorganization steps in all material respects, Qualcomm River Holdings will be required to pay NXP a termination fee of \$2.0 billion.

Operating Segments

We have three reportable segments. We conduct business primarily through QCT (Qualcomm CDMA Technologies) and QTL (Qualcomm Technology Licensing), and QSI (Qualcomm Strategic Initiatives) makes strategic investments. Revenues in fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 for our reportable segments were as follows (in millions, except percentage data):

	2017	2016	2015
QCT	\$ 16,479	\$ 15,409	\$ 17,154
<i>As a percent of total</i>	74%	65%	68%
QTL	\$ 6,445	\$ 7,664	\$ 7,947
<i>As a percent of total</i>	29%	33%	31%
QSI	\$ 113	\$ 47	\$ 4
<i>As a percent of total</i>	1%	—	—

QCT Segment. QCT is a leading developer and supplier of integrated circuits and system software based on CDMA, OFDMA and other technologies for use in wireless voice and data communications, networking, application processing, multimedia and global positioning system products. QCT's integrated circuit products are sold and its system software is licensed to manufacturers that use our products in mobile devices, tablets, laptops, data modules, handheld wireless computers and gaming devices, access points and routers, broadband gateway equipment, data cards and infrastructure equipment, other consumer electronics and automotive telematics and infotainment systems. Our Mobile Station Modem (MSM) integrated circuits, which include the Mobile Data Modem, Qualcomm® Single Chip and Qualcomm® Snapdragon™ mobile platforms and processors and LTE modems, perform the core baseband modem functionality in wireless devices providing voice and data communications, as well as multimedia applications and global positioning functions. In addition, our Snapdragon mobile platforms and processors provide advanced application and graphics processing capabilities. Because of our experience in designing and developing CDMA- and OFDMA-based products, we design both the baseband integrated circuit and the supporting system, including the RF (Radio Frequency), PM (Power Management) and wireless connectivity integrated circuits. This approach enables us to optimize the performance of the wireless device with improved product features and integration with the network system. QCT's system software helps enable the other device components to interface with the integrated circuit products and is the foundation software enabling manufacturers to develop devices utilizing the functionality within the integrated circuits. We also provide support, including reference designs and tools, to assist our customers in reducing the time required to design their products and bring their products to market.

QCT offers a broad portfolio of products, including both wireless device and infrastructure integrated circuits, in support of CDMA2000 1X and 1xEV-DO, as well as the EV-DO Revision A/B evolutions of CDMA 2000 technology. Leveraging our expertise in CDMA, we also develop and offer integrated circuits supporting the WCDMA version of 3G for manufacturers of wireless devices. Device manufacturers have widely adopted our WCDMA products that support GSM/GPRS, WCDMA, HSDPA (High-Speed Downlink Packet Access), HSUPA (High-Speed Uplink Packet Access) and HSPA+ for their devices. QCT also sells multimode products for the LTE standard, which are designed to support seamless backward compatibility to existing 3G technologies. Our integrated circuit products are included in a broad range of devices, from low-tier, entry-level devices for emerging regions, which may use our Qualcomm Reference Design (QRD) products, to premium-tier devices. In fiscal 2017, QCT shipped approximately 804 million MSM™ integrated circuits for wireless devices worldwide, compared to approximately 842 million and 932 million in fiscal 2016 and 2015, respectively.

Our modems are built to work with increasingly complex networks. They support the latest communication technologies and adapt to network conditions and user needs in real time to enable delivery of faster, smoother data and voice connections. Our 3G/4G modem roadmap delivers the latest network technologies across multiple product tiers and devices. This roadmap is the result of our years of research into emerging network standards and the development of chipsets that take advantage of these new standards, while maintaining backward compatibility with existing standards.

Each Snapdragon mobile platform and processor is a highly integrated, mobile optimized system on a chip incorporating our advanced technologies, including a Snapdragon modem for fast reliable mobile broadband connectivity, a high performance central processing unit (CPU), digital signal processor (DSP), graphics processing unit (GPU), image signal processor, multimedia subsystems, including high fidelity audio, high-definition video and advanced imaging capabilities, our mobile security technology, and accurate location positioning engines. Our CPU cores are designed to deliver high levels of compute performance at low power, allowing manufacturers to design powerful, slim and power-efficient devices. Our Qualcomm® Adreno™ GPUs are also designed to deliver high quality graphics performance for visually rich 3D gaming and

user interfaces. The heterogeneous compute architecture of our Snapdragon mobile platforms and processors is designed to help ensure that the CPU, DSP and GPU work efficiently together, each being utilized only when needed, which enhances the processing capacity, speed and efficiency of our Snapdragon mobile platforms and processors and the battery life of devices using our processors.

Our portfolio of RF products includes QFE (Qualcomm Front End) radio frequency front-end (RFFE) components that are designed to simplify the RF design for LTE multimode, multiband mobile devices, reduce power consumption and improve radio performance. Through our RF360 Holdings joint venture, QCT offers an expanded portfolio of RFFE products for mobile devices and IoT applications. Our technologies provide comprehensive RFFE product offerings with system level performance from the modem and transceiver to the antenna tuner that include power tracking, tuning systems, switching, multimode-multiband power amplification, low noise amplifiers, complex transmit and receive modules, in addition to discrete filtering applications across cellular, infrastructure and automotive markets.

Our wireless products also consist of integrated circuits and system software for WLAN, Bluetooth, Bluetooth Smart, frequency modulation (FM) and near field communications, as well as technologies that support location data and services, including GPS, GLONASS and BeiDou. Our WLAN, Bluetooth and FM products have been integrated with the Snapdragon mobile platforms and processors to provide additional connectivity for mobile devices, tablets, laptops, consumer electronics and automotive telematics and infotainment systems. QCT also offers standalone WLAN, Bluetooth, Bluetooth Smart, applications processor and Ethernet products for mobile devices, consumer electronics, computers, IoT applications, other connected devices and automotive telematics and infotainment systems. Our networking products include WLAN, Powerline and Ethernet chips, network processors and software. These products help enable home and business networks to support the growing number of connected devices, digital media, data services and other smart home applications.

QCT primarily utilizes a fabless production model, which means that we do not own or operate foundries for the production of silicon wafers from which our integrated circuits are made. Integrated circuits are die cut from silicon wafers that have completed the package assembly and test manufacturing processes. The semiconductor package supports the electrical contacts that connect the integrated circuit to a circuit board. Die cut from silicon wafers are the essential components of all of our integrated circuits and a significant portion of the total integrated circuit cost. We employ both turnkey and two-stage manufacturing models to purchase our integrated circuits. Under the turnkey model, our foundry suppliers are responsible for delivering fully assembled and tested integrated circuits. Under the two-stage manufacturing model, we purchase die in singular or wafer form from semiconductor manufacturing foundries and contract with separate third-party suppliers for manufacturing services such as wafer bump, probe, assembly and the majority of our final test requirements. RF360 Holdings uses certain internal fabrication facilities to manufacture RFFE modules and RF filter acoustic products, and its manufacturing operations consist of front-end and back-end processes. The front-end processes primarily take place at manufacturing facilities located in Germany and Singapore and involve the imprinting of substrate silicon wafers with the circuitry required for semiconductors to function (also known as wafer fabrication). The back-end processes involve the assembly, packaging and test of semiconductors to prepare RFFE modules and RF filter acoustic products for distribution. The back-end manufacturing facilities are located in China, Germany and Singapore.

Other than RF360 Holdings, we primarily rely on independent third-party suppliers to perform the manufacturing and assembly, and most of the testing, of our integrated circuits based primarily on our proprietary designs and test programs. Our suppliers also are responsible for the procurement of most of the raw materials used in the production of our integrated circuits. The primary foundry suppliers for our various digital, analog/mixed-signal, RF and PM integrated circuits are Global Foundries Inc., Samsung Electronics Co. Ltd., Semiconductor Manufacturing International Corporation, Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Company and United Microelectronics Corporation. The primary semiconductor assembly and test suppliers are Advanced Semiconductor Engineering, Amkor Technology, Siliconware Precision Industries and STATSChipPAC. The majority of our foundry and semiconductor assembly and test suppliers are located in the Asia-Pacific region.

QCT's sales are primarily made through standard purchase orders for delivery of products. QCT generally allows customers to reschedule delivery dates within a defined time frame and to cancel orders prior to shipment with or without payment of a penalty, depending on when the order is canceled. The industry in which QCT operates is intensely competitive. QCT competes worldwide with a number of United States and international designers and manufacturers of semiconductors. As a result of global expansion by foreign and domestic competitors, technological changes, device manufacturer concentrations and the potential for further industry consolidation, we anticipate the industry to remain very competitive. We believe that the principal competitive factors for our products include performance, level of integration, quality, compliance with industry standards, price, time-to-market, system cost, design and engineering capabilities, new product innovation and customer support. QCT also competes in both single- and multi-mode environments against alternative communications technologies including, but not limited to, GSM/GPRS/EDGE and TDMA. Further, QCT is expanding its product offerings to

adjacent industry segments outside traditional cellular industries, including automotive, which is subject to long design-in time frames, long product life cycles and a high degree of regulatory and safety requirements, necessitating suppliers to the industry to comply with stringent qualification processes, very low defect rates and high reliability standards, all of which results in a significant barrier to entry and may result in increased costs.

QCT's current competitors include, but are not limited to, companies such as Broadcom Limited, Cirrus Logic, Cypress Semiconductor Corporation, HiSilicon Technologies, Intel, Marvell Technology, Maxim Integrated Products, MediaTek, Microchip Technology Inc., Murata Manufacturing Co., Ltd., Nordic Semiconductor, Nvidia, Qorvo Inc., Realtek Semiconductor, Renesas Electronics Corporation, Samsung Electronics, Sequans Communications S.A., Skyworks Solutions Inc., Sony Corporation and Spreadtrum Communications (which is controlled by Tsinghua Unigroup). QCT also faces competition from products internally developed by our customers, including some of our largest customers, and from some early-stage companies. Our competitors devote significant amounts of their financial, technical and other resources to develop and market competitive products and, in some cases, to develop and adopt competitive digital communication or signal processing technologies, and those efforts may materially and adversely affect us. Although we have attained a significant position in the industry, many of our current and potential competitors may have advantages over us that include, among others: motivation by our customers in certain circumstances to utilize their own internally-developed integrated circuit products, to use our competitors' integrated circuit products and/or sell such products to others, including by bundling with other products, or to choose alternative technologies; lower cost structures and/or a willingness and ability to accept lower prices and lower or negative margins for their products, particularly in China; foreign government support of other technologies or competitors; better known brand names; ownership and control of manufacturing facilities and greater expertise in manufacturing processes; more extensive relationships with local distribution companies and original equipment manufacturers in certain geographic regions (such as China) and/or experience in adjacent industry segments outside traditional cellular industries (such as automotive and IoT); and/or a more established presence in certain regions.

QTL Segment . QTL grants licenses or otherwise provides rights to use portions of our intellectual property portfolio, which, among other rights, includes certain patent rights essential to and/or useful in the manufacture and sale of certain wireless products, including, without limitation, products implementing CDMA2000, WCDMA, CDMA TDD and/or LTE standards and their derivatives. We have historically licensed our cellular standard-essential patents together with other Qualcomm patents that may be useful to such licensed products because licensees typically have desired to obtain the commercial benefits of receiving such broad patent rights from us. However, we also have licensed only our cellular standard-essential patents to certain licensees who have requested such licenses. In addition, our practice in China since 2015 is to offer licenses to our 3G and 4G standard-essential Chinese patents for devices sold for use in China separately from licenses to our other patents. Our licensees manufacture wireless products including mobile devices (also known as subscriber units, which include handsets), other consumer devices (e.g., tablets and laptops), machine-to-machine devices (e.g., telematics devices, meter reading devices), plug-in end user data modem cards, certain embedded modules for incorporation into end user products, infrastructure equipment required to establish and operate a network and equipment to test networks and subscriber units.

Since our founding in 1985, we have focused heavily on technology development and innovation. These efforts have resulted in a leading intellectual property portfolio related to, among other things, wireless technology. We have an extensive portfolio of United States and foreign patents, and we continue to pursue patent applications around the world. Our patents have broad coverage in many countries, including Brazil, China, India, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the United States and countries in Europe and elsewhere. A substantial portion of our patents and patent applications relate to digital wireless communications technologies, including patents that are essential or may be important to the commercial implementation of CDMA2000, WCDMA (UMTS), TD-SCDMA, TD-CDMA (Time Division CDMA) and OFDMA/LTE products. Our patent portfolio is the most widely and extensively licensed in the industry, with several hundred licensees. Additionally, we have a substantial patent portfolio related to key technologies used in communications and other devices and/or related services, some of which were developed in industry standards development bodies. These include certain video codec, audio codec, WLAN, memory interfaces, wireless power, GPS and positioning, broadcast and streaming protocols, and short range communication functionalities, including NFC and Bluetooth. Our patents cover a wide range of technologies across the entire wireless system, including the device (handsets and other wireless devices) and not just what is embodied in the chipsets. Over the years, a number of companies have challenged our patent position, but companies in the mobile communications industry generally recognize that any company seeking to develop, manufacture and/or sell subscriber units or infrastructure equipment that use CDMA-based and/or OFDMA-based technologies will require a license or other rights to use our patents.

We have licensed or otherwise provided rights to use our patents to hundreds of companies on industry-accepted terms. Unlike some other companies in our industry that hold back certain key technologies, we offer companies substantially our entire patent portfolio for use in cellular subscriber devices and cell site infrastructure equipment. Our strategy to make our

patented technologies broadly available has been a catalyst for industry growth, helping to enable a wide range of companies offering a broad array of wireless products and features while increasing the capabilities of and/or driving down average and low-end selling prices for 3G handsets and other wireless devices. By licensing or otherwise providing rights to use our patents to a wide range of equipment manufacturers, encouraging innovative applications, supporting equipment manufacturers with integrated chipset and software products and focusing on improving the efficiency of the airlink for wireless operators, we have helped 3G CDMA evolve and grow and reduced device pricing, all at a faster pace than the 2G (second generation) technologies such as GSM that preceded it.

Upon the initial deployment of OFDMA-based networks, the products implementing such technologies generally have been multimode and implement CDMA-based technologies. The licenses granted under our existing CDMA license agreements generally cover multimode CDMA/OFDMA (3G/4G) devices, and our licensees are obligated to pay royalties under their CDMA license agreements for such devices. Further, the majority of the leading handset and other wireless device companies (including Huawei, LG, Microsoft, Oppo, Samsung, Sony, vivo, Xiaomi and ZTE) have royalty-bearing licenses under our patent portfolio for use in LTE or other OFDMA-based products that do not implement any CDMA-based standards.

Standards bodies have been informed that we hold patents that might be essential for all 3G standards that are based on CDMA. We have committed to such standards bodies that we will offer to license our essential patents for these CDMA standards consistent with our commitments to those bodies. We have also informed standards bodies that we hold patents and pending patent applications that are potentially essential for certain standards that are based on OFDM/OFDMA technology (e.g., LTE, including FDD and TDD versions) and have committed to offer to license our essential patents for these OFDMA standards consistent with our commitments to those bodies. We have made similar commitments with respect to certain other technologies implemented in industry standards.

QTL licensing revenues include license fees and royalties based on sales by licensees of products incorporating or using our intellectual property. License fees are fixed amounts paid in one or more installments. License fees are recognized over the estimated period of benefit of the license to the licensee, typically 5 to 15 years. Royalties are generally based upon a percentage of the wholesale (i.e., licensee's) selling price of complete licensed products, net of certain permissible deductions (including transportation, insurance, packing costs and other items). We broadly provide per unit running royalty caps that apply to certain categories of complete wireless devices, namely smartphones, tablets and laptops, which effectively provide for a maximum running royalty amount per device (i.e., the royalty caps limit the running royalties due on a per unit basis). QTL recognizes royalty revenues based on royalties reported by licensees and when other revenue recognition criteria are met. Licensees, however, do not report and pay royalties owed for sales in any given quarter until after the conclusion of that quarter, which is generally the following quarter. Revenues generated from royalties are subject to quarterly and annual fluctuations. The vast majority of QTL revenues have been generated through our licensees' sales of CDMA2000-based, WCDMA-based and LTE-based products (including 3G and 4G multi-mode devices), such as feature phones and smartphones. We have invested and continue to invest in both the acquisition and development of OFDMA technology and intellectual property and have generated the industry leading patent portfolio applicable to LTE, LTE Advanced and LTE Advanced Pro. Additionally, we have invested and continue to invest in the development of 5G, which while still being defined, is expected to heavily leverage OFDMA-based technologies. Nevertheless, we face competition in the development of intellectual property for future generations of digital wireless communications technologies and services.

Separate and apart from licensing manufacturers of wireless devices and network equipment, we have entered into certain arrangements with competitors of our QCT segment, such as Broadcom Limited. A principal purpose of these arrangements is to provide our QCT segment and the counterparties certain freedom of operation with respect to each party's integrated circuits business. In every case, these agreements expressly reserve the right for QTL to seek royalties from the customers of such integrated circuit suppliers with respect to such suppliers' customers' sales of CDMA-, WCDMA- and OFDMA-based wireless devices into which such suppliers' integrated circuits are incorporated.

Our license agreements also may provide us with rights to use certain of our licensees' technology and intellectual property to manufacture and sell certain components (e.g., Application-Specific Integrated Circuits) and related software, subscriber units and/or infrastructure equipment.

We are currently subject to various governmental investigations and private legal proceedings challenging our patent licensing practices, which may require us to change our patent licensing practices as described more fully in this Annual Report in "Part I, Item 1A. Risk Factors" under the heading "If we are required to change our patent licensing practices due to governmental investigations and/or private legal proceedings challenging those practices, our business and results of operations could be adversely impacted" and in "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies."

QSI Segment. QSI makes strategic investments that are focused on opening new or expanding opportunities for our technologies and supporting the design and introduction of new products and services (or enhancing existing products or services) for voice and data communications and new industry segments. Many of these strategic investments are in early-stage companies in a variety of industries, including, but not limited to, automotive, IoT, mobile, data center and healthcare. Investments primarily include non-marketable equity instruments, which generally are recorded using the cost method or the equity method, and convertible debt instruments, which are recorded at fair value. In addition, QSI segment results include revenues and related costs associated with license and development contracts with one of our equity method investees. As part of our strategic investment activities, we intend to pursue various exit strategies for each of our QSI investments in the foreseeable future.

Other Businesses. Nonreportable segments include our mobile health, data center, small cell and other wireless technology and service initiatives. Our nonreportable segments develop and sell products and services that include, but are not limited to: products and services for mobile health; license of chipset technology and products and services for use in data centers; products designed for implementation of small cells to address the challenge of meeting the increased demand for data; development, other services and related products to U.S. government agencies and their contractors; and software products and content and push-to-talk enablement services to wireless operators.

Additional information regarding our operating segments is provided in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 8. Segment Information.” Information regarding seasonality is provided in this Annual Report in “Part II, Item 7. Management’s Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations” in the “Our Business and Operating Segments” section under the heading “Seasonality.”

Strategic Realignment Plan

In the fourth quarter of fiscal 2015, we announced a Strategic Realignment Plan designed to improve execution, enhance financial performance and drive profitable growth as we worked to create sustainable long-term value for stockholders. As part of this Strategic Realignment Plan, among other actions, we implemented a cost reduction plan, which included a series of targeted reductions across our businesses, particularly in QCT, and a reduction to annual share-based compensation grants. The cost reduction initiatives were achieved by the end of fiscal 2016 and other activities under the plan were completed by the end of fiscal 2017. Additional information regarding our Strategic Realignment Plan is provided in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 10. Strategic Realignment Plan.”

Corporate Structure

We operate our businesses through our parent company, QUALCOMM Incorporated, and multiple direct and indirect subsidiaries. We have developed our corporate structure in order to address various legal, regulatory, tax, contractual compliance, operations and other matters. Substantially all of our products and services businesses, including QCT, and substantially all of our engineering, research and development functions, are operated by QUALCOMM Technologies, Inc. (QTI), a wholly-owned subsidiary of QUALCOMM Incorporated, and QTI’s subsidiaries. QTL is operated by QUALCOMM Incorporated, which owns the vast majority of our patent portfolio. Neither QTI nor any of its subsidiaries has any right, power or authority to grant any licenses or other rights under or to any patents owned by QUALCOMM Incorporated.

Revenue Concentrations, Significant Customers and Geographical Information

Revenues in fiscal 2017 were negatively impacted by the actions of Apple Inc. and Hon Hai Precision Industry Co., Ltd./Foxconn, its affiliates and other suppliers to Apple, as well as the previously disclosed dispute with another licensee, who underpaid royalties due in the second quarter of fiscal 2017 and did not report or pay royalties due in the third or fourth quarter of fiscal 2017. A small number of customers/licensees historically have accounted for a significant portion of our consolidated revenues.

In fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, revenues from suppliers to Apple Inc. and from Samsung Electronics each comprised more than 10% of consolidated revenues. Combined revenues from GuangDong OPPO Mobile Telecommunications Corp. Ltd. and vivo Communication Technology Co., Ltd., and their respective affiliates, also comprised more than 10% of consolidated revenues in fiscal 2017.

Consolidated revenues from international customers and licensees as a percentage of total revenues were 98%, 98% and 99% in fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, respectively. During fiscal 2017, 65% and 16% of our revenues were from customers and licensees based in China (including Hong Kong) and South Korea, respectively, compared to 57% and 17% during fiscal 2016, respectively, and 53% and 16% during fiscal 2015, respectively. We report revenues from external customers by country based on the location to which our products or services are delivered, which for QCT is generally the country in which our customers manufacture their products, or for licensing revenues, the invoiced addresses of our licensees. As a result, the revenues by country presented herein are not necessarily indicative of either the country in which the devices

containing our products and/or intellectual property are ultimately sold to consumers or the country in which the companies that sell the devices are headquartered. For example, China revenues could include revenues related to shipments of integrated circuits to a company that is headquartered in South Korea but that manufactures devices in China, which devices are then sold to consumers in Europe and/or the United States. Additional geographic information is provided in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 8. Segment Information.”

Research and Development

The communications industry is characterized by rapid technological change, evolving industry standards and frequent new product introductions, requiring a continuous effort to enhance existing products and technologies and to develop new products and technologies. We have significant engineering resources, including engineers with substantial expertise in CDMA, OFDMA and a broad range of other technologies. Using these engineering resources, we expect to continue to invest in research and development in a variety of ways in an effort to extend the demand for our products, including continuing the development of CDMA, OFDMA and other technologies, developing alternative technologies for certain specialized applications, participating in the formulation of new voice and data communication standards and technologies, assisting in deploying digital voice and data communications networks around the world and leveraging our existing technology in new and expanded product areas, such as RFFE, and adjacent industry segments outside of traditional cellular industries, such as automotive, IoT and networking. Our research and development team has a demonstrated track record of innovation in voice and data communication technologies and application processor technology, among others. Our research and development expenditures in fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 totaled approximately \$5.5 billion, \$5.2 billion and \$5.5 billion, respectively.

We continue to invest significant resources towards advancements in 4G OFDMA-based technologies (including LTE) and 5G-based technologies. We also engage in acquisitions and other transactions, such as joint ventures, to meet certain technology needs, to obtain development resources or open or expand opportunities for our technologies and supporting the design and introduction of new products and services (or enhancing existing products and services) for voice and data communications and new industry segments outside of the traditional cellular industry. Recent transactions include our acquisition of CSR plc, our RF360 Holdings joint venture with TDK Corporation and our proposed acquisition of NXP.

We make investments to provide our integrated circuit customers with chipsets designed on leading-edge technology nodes that combine multiple technologies for use in consumer devices (e.g., smartphones, tablets and laptops), consumer electronics and other products (e.g., access points and routers, data cards and infrastructure equipment). In addition to 3G and 4G LTE technologies, our chipsets support other wireless and wired connectivity technologies, including WLAN, Bluetooth, Ethernet, GPS, GLONASS, BeiDou and Powerline communication. Our integrated chipsets often include multiple technologies, including advanced multimode modems, application processors and graphics engines, as well as the tools to connect these diverse technologies. We continue to support Android, Windows and other mobile client software environments in our chipsets.

We develop on our own, and with our partners, innovations that are integrated into our product portfolio to further expand the opportunity for wireless communications and enhance the value of our products and services. These innovations are expected to enable our customers to improve the performance or value of their existing services, offer these services more affordably and introduce revenue-generating broadband data services ahead of their competition.

We have research and development centers in various locations throughout the world that support our global development activities and ongoing efforts to develop and/or advance 4G OFDMA, 5G and a broad range of other technologies. We continue to use our substantial engineering resources and expertise to develop new technologies, applications and services and make them available to licensees to help grow the communications industry and generate new or expanded licensing opportunities.

We also make investments in opportunities that leverage our existing technical and business expertise to deploy new and expanded product areas, such as RFFE, and enter into adjacent industry segments, such as products for automotive, IoT (including the connected home, smart cities, wearables, voice and music and robotics), data center, networking, computing and machine learning, among others.

Sales and Marketing

Sales and marketing activities of our operating segments are discussed under Operating Segments. Other marketing activities include public relations, advertising, digital marketing and social media, participation in technical conferences and trade shows, development of business cases and white papers, competitive analyses, industry intelligence and other marketing programs, such as marketing development funds with our customers. Our Corporate Marketing department provides company information on our Internet site and through other channels regarding our products, strategies and technology to industry analysts and media.

Competition

Competition faced by our operating segments is discussed under Operating Segments. Competition in the communications industry throughout the world continues to increase at a rapid pace as consumers, businesses and governments realize the potential of wireless communications products and services. We have facilitated competition in the wireless communications industry by licensing our technologies to a large number of manufacturers. Although we have attained a significant position in the traditional cellular industry, many of our current and potential competitors may have advantages over us that include, among others: motivation by our customers in certain circumstances to utilize their own internally-developed integrated circuit products, to use our competitors' integrated circuit products and/or sell such products to others, including by bundling with other products, or to choose alternative technologies; lower cost structures and/or a willingness and ability to accept lower prices and lower or negative margins for their products, particularly in China; foreign government support of other technologies or competitors; better known brand names; ownership and control of manufacturing facilities and greater expertise in manufacturing processes; more extensive relationships with local distribution companies and original equipment manufacturers in certain geographic regions (such as China) and/or experience in adjacent industry segments outside traditional cellular industries (such as automotive and IoT); and/or a more established presence in certain regions. These relationships may affect customers' decisions to purchase products or license technology from us. Accordingly, new competitors or alliances among competitors could emerge and rapidly acquire significant market positions to our detriment.

We expect competition to increase as our current competitors expand their product offerings and introduce new technologies and services in the future and as additional companies compete with our products or services based on 3G, 4G or other technologies. Although we intend to continue to make substantial investments in developing new products and technologies and improving existing products and technologies, our competitors may introduce alternative products, services or technologies that threaten our business. It is also possible that the prices we charge for our products and services may continue to decline as competition continues to intensify. See also the Risk Factor entitled “ *Our industry is subject to competition in an environment of rapid technological change that could result in decreased demand and/or declining average selling prices for our products and/or those of our customers and/or licensees.* ”

Corporate Responsibility and Sustainability

We strive to better our local and global communities through ethical business practices, socially empowering technology applications, educational and environmental programs and employee diversity and volunteerism.

- *Our Governance.* We aim to demonstrate accountability, transparency, integrity and ethical business practices throughout our operations and interactions with our stakeholders.
- *Our Products.* We strive to meet or exceed industry standards for product responsibility and supplier management.
- *Our Workplace.* We endeavor to provide a safe and healthy work environment where diversity is embraced and various opportunities for training, growth and advancement are encouraged for all employees.
- *Our Community.* We have strategic relationships with a wide range of local organizations and programs that develop and strengthen communities worldwide.
- *Our Environment.* We aim to expand our operations while minimizing our carbon footprint, conserving water and reducing waste.
- *Qualcomm® Wireless Reach™.* We invest in strategic programs that foster entrepreneurship, aid in public safety, enhance delivery of health care, enrich teaching and learning and improve environmental sustainability through the use of advanced wireless technologies.

Employees

At September 24, 2017, we employed approximately 33,800 full-time, part-time and temporary employees. During fiscal 2017, the number of employees increased by approximately 3,300 primarily due to increases in engineering resources and the formation of our consolidated RF360 Holdings joint venture with TDK.

Available Information

Our Internet address is www.qualcomm.com. There we make available, free of charge, our annual report on Form 10-K, quarterly reports on Form 10-Q, current reports on Form 8-K and any amendments to those reports, as soon as reasonably practicable after we electronically file such material with, or furnish it to, the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC). We also make available on our Internet site public financial information for which a report is not required to be filed with or furnished to the SEC. Our SEC reports and other financial information can be accessed through the investor relations section

of our Internet site. The information found on our Internet site is not part of this or any other report we file with or furnish to the SEC.

Executive Officers

Our executive officers (and their ages at September 24, 2017) are as follows:

Paul E. Jacobs, age 54, has served as Executive Chairman since March 2014, as Chairman of the Board of Directors since March 2009 and as a director since June 2005. He served as Chief Executive Officer from July 2005 to March 2014. In addition, he served as an Executive Vice President from February 2000 to June 2005. Dr. Jacobs joined Qualcomm as an intern in 1986 and full-time in 1990 as an engineer and throughout his tenure at Qualcomm has held several other leadership positions. Dr. Jacobs holds a B.S. degree in Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, an M.S. degree in Electrical Engineering and a Ph.D. degree in Electrical Engineering and Computer Science from the University of California, Berkeley.

Steve Mollenkopf, age 48, has served as Chief Executive Officer since March 2014 and as a director since December 2013. He served as Chief Executive Officer-elect and President from December 2013 to March 2014 and as President and Chief Operating Officer from November 2011 to December 2013. In addition, he served as Executive Vice President and Group President from September 2010 to November 2011 and as Executive Vice President and President, QCT from August 2008 to September 2010. Mr. Mollenkopf joined Qualcomm in 1994 as an engineer and throughout his tenure at Qualcomm has held several other technical and leadership positions. Mr. Mollenkopf has been a director of General Electric Company since November 2016. Mr. Mollenkopf holds a B.S. degree in Electrical Engineering from Virginia Tech and an M.S. degree in Electrical Engineering from the University of Michigan.

Derek K. Aberle, age 47, has served as President since March 2014. He served as Executive Vice President and Group President from November 2011 to March 2014 and as Executive Vice President and President, QTL from September 2008 to November 2011. Mr. Aberle joined Qualcomm in December 2000 as an attorney and throughout his tenure at Qualcomm has held several other legal and leadership positions. Mr. Aberle holds a B.A. degree in Business Economics from the University of California, Santa Barbara and a J.D. degree from the University of San Diego. Mr. Aberle will be leaving Qualcomm effective January 4, 2018.

Cristiano R. Amon, age 47, has served as Executive Vice President, Qualcomm Technologies, Inc. (QTI, a subsidiary of Qualcomm Incorporated) and President, Qualcomm CDMA Technologies (QCT) since November 2015. He served as Executive Vice President, QTI and Co-President, QCT from October 2012 to November 2015, Senior Vice President, Qualcomm Incorporated and Co-President, QCT from June 2012 to October 2012 and as Senior Vice President, QCT Product Management from October 2007 to June 2012. Mr. Amon joined Qualcomm in 1995 as an engineer and throughout his tenure at Qualcomm held several other technical and leadership positions. Mr. Amon holds a B.S. degree in Electrical Engineering from UNICAMP, the State University of Campinas, Brazil.

George S. Davis, age 59, has served as Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer since March 2013. Mr. Davis is responsible for leading Finance, Information Technology and Investor Relations. Prior to joining Qualcomm, Mr. Davis was Chief Financial Officer of Applied Materials, Inc., a provider of manufacturing equipment, services and software to the semiconductor, flat panel display, solar photovoltaic and related industries, from November 2006 to March 2013. Mr. Davis held several other leadership positions at Applied Materials from November 1999 to November 2006. Prior to joining Applied Materials, Mr. Davis served 19 years with Atlantic Richfield Company in a number of finance and other corporate positions. Mr. Davis holds a B.A. degree in Economics and Political Science from Claremont McKenna College and an M.B.A. degree from the University of California, Los Angeles.

Matthew S. Grob, age 51, has served as Executive Vice President, Qualcomm Technologies, Inc. (QTI) since March 2017. He served as Executive Vice President, QTI and Chief Technology Officer from October 2012 to March 2017. He served as Executive Vice President, Qualcomm Incorporated and Chief Technology Officer from July 2011 to October 2012. Mr. Grob joined Qualcomm in August 1991 as an engineer and throughout his tenure at Qualcomm held several other technical and leadership positions. Mr. Grob holds a B.S. degree in Electrical Engineering from Bradley University and an M.S. degree in Electrical Engineering from Stanford University.

Brian T. Modoff, age 58, has served as Executive Vice President, Strategy and Mergers & Acquisitions since October 2015. Prior to joining Qualcomm, Mr. Modoff was a Managing Director in Equity Research at Deutsche Bank Securities Inc. (Deutsche Bank), a provider of financial services, from March 1999 to October 2015. Prior to joining Deutsche Bank, Mr. Modoff was a research analyst at several financial institutions from November 1993 to March 1999. Mr. Modoff holds a B.A. degree in Economics from California State University, Fullerton and a Master of International Management from the Thunderbird School of Global Management.

Alexander H. Rogers, age 60, has served as Executive Vice President and President, QTL since October 2016. He served as Senior Vice President and President, QTL from September 2016 to October 2016, Senior Vice President, Deputy General Counsel and General Manager, QTL from March 2016 to September 2016, Senior Vice President and Deputy General Counsel from October 2015 to March 2016 and Senior Vice President and Legal Counsel from April 2007 to October 2015. Mr. Rogers joined Qualcomm in January 2001 as an attorney and throughout his tenure at Qualcomm held several other leadership positions in the legal department. Prior to joining Qualcomm, Mr. Rogers was a partner at the law firm of Gray, Cary, Ware & Friedenrich (now DLA Piper). Mr. Rogers holds B.A. and M.A. degrees in English Literature from Georgetown University and a J.D. degree from Georgetown University Law Center.

Donald J. Rosenberg, age 66, has served as Executive Vice President, General Counsel and Corporate Secretary since October 2007. He served as Senior Vice President, General Counsel and Corporate Secretary of Apple Inc. from December 2006 to October 2007. From May 1975 to November 2006, Mr. Rosenberg held numerous positions at IBM Corporation, including Senior Vice President and General Counsel. Mr. Rosenberg has served as a member of the board of directors of NuVasive, Inc. since February 2016. Mr. Rosenberg holds a B.S. degree in Mathematics from the State University of New York at Stony Brook and a J.D. degree from St. John's University School of Law.

Michelle Sterling, age 50, has served as Executive Vice President, Human Resources since May 2015. She served as Senior Vice President, Human Resources from October 2007 to April 2015. Ms. Sterling joined Qualcomm in 1994 and throughout her tenure at Qualcomm has held several other human resources and leadership positions. Ms. Sterling holds a B.S. degree in Business Management from the University of Redlands.

James H. Thompson, age 53, has served as Executive Vice President, Engineering, Qualcomm Technologies, Inc. and Chief Technology Officer since March 2017. He served as Executive Vice President, Engineering, Qualcomm Technologies, Inc. from October 2012 to March 2017 and as Senior Vice President, Engineering, Qualcomm Incorporated from July 1998 to October 2012. Dr. Thompson joined Qualcomm in 1992 as a senior engineer and throughout his tenure at Qualcomm held several other technical and leadership positions. Dr. Thompson holds B.S., M.S. and Ph.D. degrees in Electrical Engineering from the University of Wisconsin.

Item 1A. Risk Factors

You should consider each of the following factors in evaluating our business and our prospects. The risks and uncertainties described below are not the only ones we face. Additional risks and uncertainties not presently known to us or that we currently consider immaterial may also negatively impact our business and results of operations, and require significant management time and attention. In that case, the trading price of our common stock could decline. You should also consider the other information set forth in this Annual Report in evaluating our business and our prospects, including but not limited to our financial statements and the related notes, and "Part II, Item 7. Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations."

Risks Related to Our Businesses

Our proposed acquisition of NXP Semiconductors N.V. involves a number of risks, including, among others, the risk that we fail to complete the acquisition, in a timely manner or at all, regulatory risks, risks associated with our use of a significant portion of our cash and our taking on significant indebtedness, other financial risks, integration risks, and risk associated with the reactions of customers, suppliers and employees.

Our and NXP's obligations to consummate the proposed transaction are subject to the satisfaction or waiver of certain conditions, including, among others: (i) the tender of a minimum number of NXP's outstanding common shares in the tender offer commenced by a subsidiary of QUALCOMM Incorporated; (ii) the receipt of regulatory clearance under European Union and certain other foreign antitrust laws; (iii) the absence of any law or order prohibiting the proposed transaction; (iv) there being no event that would have a material adverse effect on NXP; (v) the accuracy of the representations and warranties of NXP, subject to certain exceptions, and NXP's material compliance with its covenants, in the definitive agreement; and (vi) the completion of certain internal reorganization steps with respect to NXP and the disposition of certain non-core assets of NXP. We cannot provide assurance that the conditions to the completion of the proposed transaction will be satisfied in a timely manner or at all, and if the proposed transaction is not completed, we would not realize any of the expected benefits.

The regulatory approvals required in connection with the proposed transaction may not be obtained or may contain materially burdensome conditions. If any conditions or changes to the structure of the proposed transaction are required to obtain these regulatory approvals, they may have the effect of jeopardizing or delaying completion of the proposed transaction or reducing our anticipated benefits. If we agree to any material conditions in order to obtain any approvals required to complete the proposed transaction, our business and results of operations may be adversely affected.

In addition, the use of a significant portion of our cash and the incurrence of substantial indebtedness in connection with the financing of the proposed transaction will reduce our liquidity, and may limit our flexibility in responding to other business opportunities and increase our vulnerability to adverse economic and industry conditions. See the Risk Factor entitled “ *There are risks associated with our indebtedness* .”

If the proposed transaction is not completed, our stock price could fall to the extent that our current price reflects an assumption that we will complete it. Furthermore, if the proposed transaction is not completed and the purchase agreement is terminated, we would not realize any of the expected benefits of the proposed transaction, and we may suffer other consequences that could adversely affect our business, results of operations and stock price, including, among others:

- we could be required to pay a termination fee to NXP of \$2.0 billion ;
- we will have incurred and may continue to incur costs relating to the proposed transaction, many of which are payable by us whether or not the proposed transaction is completed;
- matters relating to the proposed transaction (including integration planning) require substantial commitments of time and resources by our management team and numerous others throughout our organization, which could otherwise have been devoted to other opportunities;
- we may be subject to legal proceedings related to the proposed transaction or the failure to complete the proposed transaction;
- the failure to consummate the proposed transaction may result in negative publicity and a negative perception of us in the investment community; and
- any disruptions to our business resulting from the announcement and pendency of the proposed transaction, including any adverse changes in our relationships with our customers, suppliers, partners or employees, may continue or intensify in the event the proposed transaction is not consummated.

The proposed transaction will be our largest acquisition to date, by a significant margin. The benefits we expect to realize from the proposed transaction will depend, in part, on our ability to integrate the businesses successfully and efficiently. See the Risk Factor entitled “ *We may engage in strategic acquisitions, transactions or make investments that could adversely affect our results of operations or fail to enhance stockholder value* .”

Furthermore, uncertainties about the proposed transaction may cause our and/or NXP’s current and prospective employees to experience uncertainty about their futures. These uncertainties may impair our and/or NXP’s ability to retain, recruit or motivate key management, engineering, technical and other personnel. Similarly, our and/or NXP’s existing or prospective customers, licensees, suppliers and/or partners may delay, defer or cease purchasing products or services from or providing products or services to us or NXP; delay or defer other decisions concerning us or NXP; or otherwise seek to change the terms on which they do business with us or NXP. Any of the above could harm us and/or NXP, and thus decrease the benefits we expect to receive from the proposed transaction.

The proposed transaction may also result in significant charges or other liabilities that could adversely affect our results of operations, such as cash expenses and non-cash accounting charges incurred in connection with our acquisition and/or integration of the business and operations of NXP. Further, our failure to identify or accurately assess the magnitude of certain liabilities we are assuming in the proposed transaction could result in unexpected litigation or regulatory exposure, unfavorable accounting charges, unexpected increases in taxes due, a loss of anticipated tax benefits or other adverse effects on our business, results of operations, financial condition or cash flows.

Our revenues depend on commercial network deployments, expansions and upgrades of CDMA, OFDMA and other communications technologies; our customers’ and licensees’ sales of products and services based on these technologies; and customers’ demand for our products and services.

We develop, patent and commercialize technology and products based on CDMA, OFDMA and other communications technologies, which are primarily wireless. We depend on operators of wireless networks and our customers and licensees to adopt and/or implement the latest generation of these technologies for use in their networks, devices and services. We also depend on our customers and licensees to develop devices and services based on these technologies with value-added features to drive consumer demand for new 3G, 3G/4G multimode and 4G devices, and in the future 5G devices, as well as establishing the selling prices for such devices. Further, we depend on the timing of our customers’ and licensees’ deployments of new devices and services based on these technologies. Increasingly, we also depend on operators of wireless networks, our customers and licensees and other third parties to incorporate these technologies into new device types and into industries beyond traditional cellular communications, such as automotive, the internet of things (IoT) (including the connected home, smart cities, wearables, voice and music and robotics), data center, networking, computing, and machine

learning, among others. We are also impacted by consumers' rates of replacement of smartphones and other computing devices.

Our revenues and/or growth in revenues could be negatively impacted, our business may be harmed and our substantial investments in these technologies may not provide us an adequate return, if:

- wireless operators and industries beyond traditional cellular communications deploy alternative technologies;
- wireless operators delay next-generation network deployments, expansions or upgrades and/or delay moving 2G customers to 3G, 3G/4G multimode or 4G wireless devices;
- LTE, an OFDMA-based 4G wireless technology, is not more widely deployed or further commercial deployment is delayed;
- government regulators delay making sufficient spectrum available for 3G, 4G, new unlicensed technologies that we are developing in conjunction with 3G and 4G, as well as for 5G, thereby restricting the ability of wireless operators to deploy or expand the use of these technologies;
- wireless operators delay or do not drive improvements in 3G, 4G or 3G/4G multimode network performance and/or capacity;
- our customers' and licensees' revenues and sales of products, particularly premium-tier products, and services using these technologies do not grow or do not grow as quickly as anticipated due to, for example, the maturity of smartphone penetration in developed regions;
- our intellectual property and technical leadership included in the 5G standardization effort is different than in 3G and 4G standards;
- the standardization and/or deployment of 5G technology is delayed; and/or
- we are unable to drive the adoption of our products and services into networks and devices, including devices beyond traditional cellular applications, based on CDMA, OFDMA and other communications technologies.

Our industry is subject to competition in an environment of rapid technological change that could result in decreased demand and/or declining average selling prices for our products and/or those of our customers and/or licensees.

Our products, services and technologies face significant competition. We expect competition to increase as our current competitors expand their product offerings or reduce the prices of their products as part of a strategy to attract new business and/or customers, as new opportunities develop and as new competitors enter the industry. Competition in wireless communications is affected by various factors that include, among others: device manufacturer concentrations and vertical integration; growth in demand, consumption and competition in certain geographic regions; government intervention and/or support of national industries and/or competitors; evolving industry standards and business models; evolving methods of transmission of voice and data communications; increasing data traffic and densification of wireless networks; convergence and aggregation of connectivity technologies (including Wi-Fi and LTE) in both devices and access points; consolidation of wireless technologies and infrastructure at the network edge; networking and connectivity trends (including cloud services); use of both licensed and unlicensed spectrum; the evolving nature of computing (including demand for always on, always connected capabilities); the speed of technological change (including the transition to smaller geometry process technologies); value-added features that drive selling prices as well as consumer demand for new 3G, 3G/4G multimode and 4G devices; turnkey, integrated products that incorporate hardware, software, user interface, applications and reference designs; scalability; and the ability of the system technology to meet customers' immediate and future network requirements. We anticipate that additional competitors will introduce products as a result of growth opportunities in wireless communications, the trend toward global expansion by foreign and domestic competitors, technological and public policy changes and relatively low barriers to entry in certain segments of the industry. Additionally, the semiconductor industry has experienced and may continue to experience consolidation, which could result in significant changes to the competitive landscape.

We expect that our future success will depend on, among other factors, our ability to:

- differentiate our integrated circuit products with innovative technologies across multiple products and features (e.g., modem, radio frequency front-end (RFFE), graphics and/or other processors, camera and connectivity) and with smaller geometry process technologies that drive performance;
- develop and offer integrated circuit products at competitive cost and price points to effectively cover both emerging and developed geographic regions and all device tiers;

- continue to drive the adoption of our integrated circuit products into the most popular device models and across a broad spectrum of devices, such as smartphones, tablets, laptops, other computing devices, automobiles, wearables and voice and music and other connected devices and infrastructure products;
- maintain and/or accelerate demand for our integrated circuit products at the premium device tier, while increasing the adoption of our products in mid- and low-tier devices, in part by strengthening our integrated circuit product roadmap for, and developing channel relationships in, emerging geographic regions, such as China and India, and by providing turnkey products, which incorporate our integrated circuits, for low- and mid-tier smartphones, tablets and laptops;
- continue to be a leader in 4G technology evolution, including expansion of our LTE-based single mode licensing program in areas where single-mode products are commercialized, and continue to innovate and introduce 4G turnkey, integrated products and services that differentiate us from our competition;
- be a leader serving original equipment manufacturers, high level operating systems (HLOS) providers, operators, cloud providers and other industry participants as competitors, new industry entrants and other factors continue to affect the industry landscape;
- be a preferred partner (and sustain preferred relationships) providing integrated circuit products that support multiple operating system and infrastructure platforms to industry participants that effectively commercialize new devices using these platforms;
- increase and/or accelerate demand for our semiconductor component products, including RFFE, and our wired and wireless connectivity products, including networking products for consumers, carriers and enterprise equipment and connected devices;
- identify potential acquisition targets that will grow or sustain our business or address strategic needs, reach agreement on terms acceptable to us and effectively integrate these new businesses and/or technologies;
- create standalone value and/or contribute to the success of our existing businesses through acquisitions, joint ventures and other transactions (and/or by developing customer, licensee and/or vendor relationships) in new industry segments and/or disruptive technologies, products and/or services (such as products for automotive, IoT (including the connected home, smart cities, wearables, voice and music and robotics), data center, networking, computing, and machine learning, among others);
- become a leading supplier of RFFE products, which are designed to address cellular radio frequency band fragmentation while improving radio frequency performance and assist original equipment manufacturers in developing multiband, multimode mobile devices;
- be a leader in 5G technology development, standardization, intellectual property creation and licensing and develop and commercialize 5G integrated circuit products and services; and/or
- continue to develop brand recognition to effectively compete against better known companies in computing and other consumer driven segments and to deepen our presence in significant emerging geographic regions.

Competition in any or all product tiers may result in the loss of certain business or customers, which would negatively impact our revenues, results of operations and cash flows. Such competition may also reduce average selling prices for our chipset products and/or the products of our customers and licensees. Certain of these dynamics are particularly pronounced in emerging geographic regions where competitors may have lower cost structures and/or may have a willingness and ability to accept lower prices and/or lower or negative margins on their products (particularly in China). Reductions in the average selling prices of our chipset products, without a corresponding increase in volumes, would negatively impact our revenues, and without corresponding decreases in average unit costs, would negatively impact our margins. In addition, reductions in the average selling prices of our licensees' products, unless offset by an increase in volumes, would generally decrease total royalties payable to us, negatively impacting our licensing revenues.

Companies that promote standards that are neither CDMA- nor OFDMA-based (e.g., GSM) as well as companies that design integrated circuits based on CDMA, OFDMA, Wi-Fi or their derivatives are generally competitors or potential competitors. Examples (some of which are strategic partners of ours in other areas) include Broadcom Limited, Cirrus Logic, Cypress Semiconductor Corporation, HiSilicon Technologies, Intel, Marvell Technology, Maxim Integrated Products, MediaTek, Microchip Technology Inc., Murata Manufacturing Co., Ltd., Nordic Semiconductor, Nvidia, Qorvo Inc., Realtek Semiconductor, Renesas Electronics Corporation, Samsung Electronics, Sequans Communications S.A., Skyworks Solutions Inc., Sony Corporation and Spreadtrum Communications (which is controlled by Tsinghua Unigroup). Some of these current and potential competitors may have advantages over us that include, among others: motivation by our customers in certain

circumstances to utilize their own internally-developed integrated circuit products, to use our competitors' integrated circuit products and/or sell such products to others, including by bundling with other products, or to choose alternative technologies; lower cost structures and/or a willingness and ability to accept lower prices and lower or negative margins for their products, particularly in China; foreign government support of other technologies or competitors; better known brand names; ownership and control of manufacturing facilities and greater expertise in manufacturing processes; more extensive relationships with local distribution companies and original equipment manufacturers in certain geographic regions (such as China) and/or experience in adjacent industry segments outside traditional cellular industries (such as automotive and IoT); and/or a more established presence in certain regions.

We derive a significant portion of our consolidated revenues from a small number of customers and licensees. If revenues derived from these customers or licensees decrease or the timing of such revenues fluctuates, our business and results of operations could be negatively affected.

Our QCT segment derives a significant portion of its revenues from a small number of customers, and we expect this trend to continue in the foreseeable future. Our industry is experiencing and may continue to experience concentration of device share among a few companies, particularly at the premium tier, contributing to this trend. In addition, certain of our largest integrated circuit customers develop their own integrated circuit products, which they have in the past chosen, and may in the future choose, to utilize in certain of their devices rather than our integrated circuit products (and/or sell their integrated circuit products to third parties in competition with us). Also, one of our largest integrated circuit customers has utilized products of one of our competitors in certain of their devices rather than our products.

The loss of any one of our significant customers, a reduction in the purchases of our products by such customers or the cancelation of significant purchases by any of these customers, whether due to the use of their own integrated circuit products, our competitors' integrated circuit products or otherwise, would reduce our revenues and could harm our ability to achieve or sustain expected results of operations, and a delay of significant purchases, even if only temporary, would reduce our revenues in the period of the delay. Any such reduction in revenues would also impact our cash resources available for other purposes, such as research and development. Further, the concentration of device share among a few companies, and the corresponding purchasing power of these companies, may result in lower prices for our products which, if not accompanied by a sufficient increase in the volume of purchases of our products, could have an adverse effect on our revenues and margins. In addition, the timing and size of purchases by our significant customers may be impacted by the timing of such customers' new or next generation product introductions, over which we have no control, and the timing of such introductions may cause our revenues and results of operations to fluctuate. Accordingly, if current industry dynamics and concentrations continue, our QCT segment's revenues will continue to depend largely upon, and be impacted by, future purchases, and the timing and size of any such future purchases, by these significant customers.

One of our largest customers purchases our Mobile Data Modem (MDM) products, which do not include our integrated application processor technology and which have lower revenue and margin contributions than our combined modem and application processor products. To the extent such customer takes device share from our other customers who purchase our integrated modem and application processor products, our revenues and margins may be negatively impacted.

Further, companies that develop HLOS for devices, including leading technology companies, now sell their own devices. If we fail to effectively partner or continue partnering with these companies, or with their partners or customers, they may decide not to purchase (either directly or through their contract manufacturers), or to reduce or discontinue their purchases of, our integrated circuit products.

In addition, there has been and continues to be litigation among certain of our customers and other industry participants, and the potential outcomes of such litigation, including but not limited to injunctions against devices that incorporate our products and/or intellectual property, or rulings on certain patent law or patent licensing issues that create new legal precedent, could impact our business, particularly if such action impacts one of our larger customers.

Although we have several hundred licensees, our QTL segment derives a significant portion of its licensing revenues from a limited number of licensees. In the event that one or more of our significant licensees fail to meet their reporting and/or payment obligations, or we are unable to renew or modify one or more of such license agreements under similar terms, our revenues, results of operations and cash flows would be adversely impacted. Moreover, the future growth and success of our core licensing business will depend in part on the ability of our licensees to develop, introduce and deliver high-volume products that achieve and sustain customer acceptance. We have no control over the product development, sales efforts or pricing of products by our licensees, and our licensees might not be successful. Reductions in the average selling prices of wireless devices sold by our significant licensees, without a sufficient increase in the volumes of such devices sold, would generally have an adverse effect on our licensing revenues.

We derive a significant portion of our consolidated revenues from the premium-tier device segment. If sales of premium-tier devices decrease, and/or sales of our premium-tier integrated circuit products decrease, our results of operations could be negatively affected.

We derive a significant portion of our revenues from the premium-tier device segment, and we expect this trend to continue in the foreseeable future. We have experienced, and expect to continue to experience, slowing growth in the premium-tier device segment due to, among other factors, lengthening replacement cycles in developed regions, where premium-tier smartphones are common; increasing consumer demand in emerging regions, particularly China and India, where premium-tier smartphones are less common and replacement cycles are on average longer than in developed regions; and/or a maturing premium-tier smartphone industry in which demand is increasingly driven by new product launches and/or innovation cycles.

In addition, as discussed in the prior risk factor, our industry is experiencing concentration of device share among a few companies at the premium tier, which gives them significant supply chain leverage. Further, those companies may utilize their own internally-developed integrated circuit products, or our competitors' integrated circuit products, rather than our products in a portion of their devices. These dynamics may result in lower prices for and/or reduced sales of our premium-tier integrated circuit products.

A reduction in sales of premium-tier devices, or a reduction in sales of our premium-tier integrated circuit products (which have a higher revenue and margin contribution than our lower-tier integrated circuit products), may reduce our revenues and margins and may harm our ability to achieve or sustain expected financial results. Any such reduction in revenues would also impact our cash resources available for other purposes, such as research and development.

Efforts by some communications equipment manufacturers or their customers to avoid paying fair and reasonable royalties for the use of our intellectual property may require the investment of substantial management time and financial resources and may result in legal decisions and/or actions by governments, courts, regulators or agencies, Standards Development Organizations (SDOs) or other industry organizations that harm our business.

From time to time, companies initiate various strategies to attempt to renegotiate, mitigate and/or eliminate their need to pay royalties to us for the use of our intellectual property. These strategies have included: (i) litigation, often alleging infringement of patents held by such companies, patent misuse, patent exhaustion, patent invalidity and/or unenforceability of our patents and/or licenses, that we do not license our patents on fair, reasonable and nondiscriminatory (FRAND) terms, or some form of unfair competition or competition law violation; (ii) taking positions contrary to our understanding of their contracts with us; (iii) appeals to governmental authorities; (iv) collective action, including working with wireless operators, standards bodies, other like-minded companies and other organizations, on both formal and informal bases, to adopt intellectual property policies and practices that could have the effect of limiting returns on intellectual property innovations; (v) lobbying governmental regulators and elected officials for the purpose of seeking the reduction of royalty rates or the base on which royalties are calculated, the imposition of some form of compulsory licensing and/or to weaken a patent holder's ability to enforce its rights or obtain a fair return for such rights; and (vi) licensees using various strategies to attempt to shift their royalty obligation to their suppliers that results in lowering the wholesale (i.e., licensee's) selling price on which the royalty is calculated.

In addition, certain licensees have disputed, underreported, underpaid, not reported and/or not paid royalties owed to us under their license agreements or reported to us in a manner that is not in compliance with their contractual obligations, and certain companies have yet to enter into or delayed entering into or renewing license agreements with us for their use of our intellectual property, and licensees and/or companies may continue to do so in the future. The fact that one or more licensees dispute, underreport, underpay, do not report and/or do not pay royalties owed to us may encourage other licensees to take similar actions and may encourage other licensees or unlicensed companies to delay entering into, or not enter into, new license agreements. Further, to the extent such licensees and/or companies increase their device share, the negative impact of their underreporting, underpayment, non-payment and/or non-reporting on our business, revenues, results of operations, financial condition and/or cash flows will be exacerbated.

We are currently subject to various litigation and governmental investigations and/or proceedings, some of which have arisen and may continue to arise out of the strategies described above. Certain legal matters are described more fully in this Annual Report in "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies." The unfavorable resolution of one or more of these matters could have a material adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and/or cash flows. Depending on the type of matter, various remedies that could result from an unfavorable resolution include, among others, injunctions, monetary damages or fines or other orders to pay money and the issuance of orders to cease certain conduct and/or modify our business practices. Further, a governmental body in a particular country or region may assert, and may be successful in imposing, remedies with effects that extend beyond the borders of that

country or region. See also the Risk Factor entitled “If we are required to change our patent licensing practices due to governmental investigations and/or private legal proceedings challenging those practices, our business and results of operations could be adversely impacted.”

In addition, in connection with our participation in SDOs, we, like other patent owners, generally have made contractual commitments to such organizations to license those of our patents that would necessarily be infringed by standard-compliant products as set forth in those commitments. Some manufacturers and users of standard-compliant products advance interpretations of these commitments that are adverse to our licensing business, including interpretations that would limit the amount of royalties that we could collect on the licensing of our patent portfolio.

Further, some companies or entities have proposed significant changes to existing intellectual property policies for implementation by SDOs and other industry organizations with the goal of significantly devaluing standard-essential patents. For example, some have put forth proposals which would require a maximum aggregate intellectual property royalty rate for the use of all standard-essential patents owned by all of the member companies to be applied to the selling price of any product implementing the relevant standard. They have further proposed that such maximum aggregate royalty rate be apportioned to each member company with standard-essential patents based upon the number of standard-essential patents held by such company. Others have proposed that injunctions not be an available remedy for infringement of standard-essential patents and/or have made proposals that could severely limit damage awards and other remedies by courts for patent infringement (e.g., by severely limiting the base upon which the royalty percentage may be applied). A number of these strategies are purportedly based on interpretations of the policies of certain SDOs concerning the licensing of patents that are or may be essential to industry standards and on our (and/or other companies’) alleged failure to abide by these policies.

Some SDOs, courts and governmental agencies have adopted and may in the future adopt some or all of these interpretations or proposals in a manner adverse to our interests, including in litigation to which we may not be a party.

We expect that such proposals, interpretations and strategies will continue in the future, and if successful, our business model would be harmed, either by limiting or eliminating our ability to collect royalties (or by reducing the royalties we can collect) on all or a portion of our patent portfolio, limiting our return on investment with respect to new technologies, limiting our ability to seek injunctions against infringers of our standard-essential patents, constraining our ability to make licensing commitments when submitting our technology for inclusion in future standards (which could make our technology less likely to be included in such standards) or forcing us to work outside of SDOs or other industry groups to promote our new technologies, and our revenues, results of operations and/or cash flows could be negatively impacted. In addition, the legal and other costs associated with asserting or defending our positions have been and continue to be significant. We assume that such challenges, regardless of their merits, will continue into the foreseeable future and may require the investment of substantial management time and financial resources.

Our business, particularly our licensing business, may suffer as a result of adverse rulings in government investigations or proceedings.

We are currently subject to various governmental investigations and/or proceedings, particularly with respect to our licensing business, and certain such matters are described more fully in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies.” Key allegations in those matters include, among others, that we do not license our cellular standard-essential patents separately from our other patents, that we violate FRAND licensing commitments by refusing to grant licenses to chipset makers, that our royalty rates are too high and/or that the base on which our royalties are calculated should be something less than the wholesale (i.e., licensee’s) selling price of the applicable device (minus certain permitted deductions). The unfavorable resolution of one or more of these matters could have a material adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and/or cash flows. Depending on the type of matter, various remedies that could result from an unfavorable resolution include, among others, injunctions, monetary damages or fines or other orders to pay money, and the issuance of orders to cease certain conduct and/or modify our business practices. Further, a governmental body in a particular country or region may assert, and may be successful in imposing, remedies with effects that extend beyond the borders of that country or region. See also the Risk Factor entitled “If we are required to change our patent licensing practices due to governmental investigations and/or private legal proceedings challenging those practices, our business and results of operations could be adversely impacted.”

If we are required to change our patent licensing practices due to governmental investigations and/or private legal proceedings challenging those practices, our business and results of operations could be adversely impacted.

We are currently subject to various governmental investigations and private legal proceedings challenging our patent licensing practices as described more fully in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies.” Key allegations in those matters include, among others, that we do not license our cellular standard-essential patents separately from our other patents, that we violate FRAND licensing commitments by refusing to

grant licenses to chipset makers, that our royalty rates are too high and/or that the base on which our royalties are calculated should be something less than the wholesale (i.e., licensee's) selling price of the applicable device (minus certain permitted deductions). We believe that the ultimate intent of these investigations and legal proceedings is to reduce the amount of royalties that licensees are required to pay to us for their use of our intellectual property.

We have historically licensed our cellular standard-essential patents together with our other patents that may be useful to licensed products because licensees typically have desired to obtain the commercial benefits of receiving such broad patent rights from us. However, we also have licensed only our cellular standard-essential patents to certain licensees who have requested such licenses. In addition, in connection with our resolution with the China National Development and Reform Commission (NDRC) in China, our standard practice in China since 2015 is to offer licenses for our 3G and 4G standard-essential Chinese patents for branded devices sold for use in China separately from licenses to our other patents. If we were required to separately license our cellular standard-essential patents to all of our licensees worldwide, and more licensees chose such a license instead of a portfolio license than has historically been the case, our licensing revenues and earnings would be negatively impacted unless we were able to license our other patents at rates that offset all or a portion of any difference between the royalties previously received for licenses of substantially all of our patent portfolio as compared to licenses of only our cellular standard-essential patents and/or there was a sufficient increase in the overall volume of sales of devices upon which royalties are paid.

If we were required to grant patent licenses to chipset manufacturers (i.e., to implement a more complex, tiered licensing structure in which we license certain portions of our patent portfolio to chipset manufacturers and other portions to device manufacturers), we would incur additional transaction costs, which may be significant, and we may incur delays in recognizing revenues until license negotiations were completed. In addition, our licensing revenues and earnings would be negatively impacted if we were not able to obtain, in the aggregate, equivalent revenues under such a multi-level licensing structure.

If we were required to reduce the royalty rates we charge under our patent license agreements, our revenues and earnings would be negatively impacted absent a sufficient increase in the volume of sales of devices upon which royalties are paid. Similarly, if we were required to reduce the base on which our royalties are calculated, our revenues, results of operations and/or cash flows would be negatively impacted unless there was a sufficient increase in the volume of sales of devices upon which royalties are paid and/or we were able to increase our royalty rates to offset the decrease in revenues resulting from such lower royalty base (assuming the absolute royalty dollars were below any relevant royalty caps).

To the extent that we were required to implement any of these new licensing practices by modifying or renegotiating our existing license agreements, we would incur additional transaction costs, which may be significant, and we may incur delays in recognizing revenues until license negotiations were completed. The impact of any such changes to our licensing practices could vary widely and by jurisdiction, depending on the specific outcomes and the geographic scope of such outcomes. In addition, if we were required to make modifications to our licensing practices in one jurisdiction, licensees and/or governmental agencies in other jurisdictions may attempt to obtain similar outcomes for themselves and/or for such other jurisdictions, as applicable.

The enforcement and protection of our intellectual property rights may be expensive, could fail to prevent misappropriation or unauthorized use of our intellectual property rights, could result in the loss of our ability to enforce one or more patents, and/or could be adversely affected by changes in patent laws, by laws in certain foreign jurisdictions that may not effectively protect our intellectual property rights and/or by ineffective enforcement of laws in such jurisdictions.

We rely primarily on patent, copyright, trademark and trade secret laws, as well as nondisclosure and confidentiality agreements, international treaties and other methods, to protect our proprietary information, technologies and processes, including our patent portfolio. Policing unauthorized use of our products, technologies and proprietary information is difficult and time consuming. The steps we have taken have not always prevented, and we cannot be certain the steps we will take in the future will prevent, the misappropriation or unauthorized use of our proprietary information and technologies, particularly in foreign countries where the laws may not protect our proprietary intellectual property rights as fully or as readily as United States laws or where the enforcement of such laws may be lacking or ineffective. Some industry participants who have a vested interest in devaluing patents in general, or standard-essential patents in particular, have mounted attacks on certain patent systems, increasing the likelihood of changes to established patent laws. In the United States, there is continued discussion regarding potential patent law changes and current and potential future litigation regarding patents, the outcomes of which could be detrimental to our licensing business. The laws in certain foreign countries in which our products are or may be manufactured or sold, including certain countries in Asia, may not protect our intellectual property rights to the same extent as the laws in the United States. We expect that the European Union will adopt a unitary patent system in the next few years that may broadly impact that region's patent regime. We cannot predict with certainty the long-term effects of any

potential changes. In addition, we cannot be certain that the laws and policies of any country or the practices of any standards bodies, foreign or domestic, with respect to intellectual property enforcement or licensing or the adoption of standards, will not be changed in the future in a way detrimental to our licensing program or to the sale or use of our products or technologies.

We have had and may in the future have difficulty in certain circumstances in protecting or enforcing our intellectual property rights and/or contracts, including collecting royalties for use of our patent portfolio due to, among others: refusal by certain licensees to report and/or pay all or a portion of the royalties they owe to us; policies of foreign governments; challenges to our licensing practices under competition laws; adoption of mandatory licensing provisions by foreign jurisdictions (either with controlled/regulated royalties or royalty free); failure of foreign courts to recognize and enforce judgments of contract breach and damages issued by courts in the United States; and/or challenges before competition agencies to our licensing business and/or the pricing and integration of additional features and functionality into our chipset products. Certain licensees have disputed, underreported, underpaid, not reported and/or not paid royalties owed to us under their license agreements with us or reported to us in a manner that is not in compliance with their contractual obligations, and certain companies have yet to enter into or delayed entering into or renewing license agreements for their use of our intellectual property, and such licensees and/or companies may continue to do so in the future. The fact that one or more licensees dispute, underreport, underpay, do not report and/or do not pay royalties owed to us may encourage other licensees to take similar actions and may encourage other licensees or unlicensed companies to delay entering into, or not enter into, new license agreements. Additionally, although our license agreements provide us with the right to audit the books and records of licensees, audits can be expensive, time consuming, incomplete and subject to dispute. Further, certain licensees may not comply with the obligation to provide full access to their books and records. To the extent we do not aggressively enforce our rights under our license agreements, licensees may not comply with their existing license agreements, and to the extent we do not aggressively pursue unlicensed companies to enter into license agreements with us for their use of our intellectual property, other unlicensed companies may not enter into license agreements.

We have entered into litigation in the past and may need to further litigate in the future to enforce our contract and/or intellectual property rights, protect our trade secrets or determine the validity and scope of proprietary rights of others. We are currently engaged in litigation matters related to protecting or enforcing our contract and/or intellectual property rights, and certain such matters are described more fully in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies.” As a result of any such litigation, we could lose our ability to enforce one or more patents, portions of our license agreements could be determined to be invalid or unenforceable (which may in turn result in other licensees either not complying with their existing license agreements and/or initiating litigation) and/or we could incur substantial costs. Any action we take to enforce our contract or intellectual property rights could be costly and could absorb significant management time and attention, which, in turn, could negatively impact our results of operations and/or cash flows. Further, even a positive resolution to our enforcement efforts may take time to conclude, which may reduce our revenues and cash resources available for other purposes, such as research and development, in the periods prior to conclusion. See also the Risk Factor entitled “If we are required to change our patent licensing practices due to governmental investigations and/or private legal proceedings challenging those practices, our business and results of operations could be adversely impacted.”

Our growth increasingly depends on our ability to extend our technologies, products and services into new and expanded product areas, such as RFFE, and adjacent industry segments outside of traditional cellular industries, such as automotive, IoT and networking, among others. Our research, development and other investments in these new and expanded product areas and industry segments, and related technologies, products and services, as well as in our existing technologies, products and services and new technologies, such as 5G, may not generate operating income or contribute to future results of operations that meet our expectations.

Our industry is subject to rapid technological change, evolving industry standards and frequent new product introductions, and we must make substantial research, development and other investments, such as acquisitions, in new products, services and technologies to compete successfully. Technological innovations generally require significant research and development efforts before they are commercially viable. While we continue to invest significant resources toward advancements primarily in support of 4G OFDMA- and 5G-based technologies, we also innovate across a broad spectrum of opportunities to deploy new and expanded products and enter into adjacent industry segments by leveraging our existing technical and business expertise and/or through acquisitions.

In particular, our future growth significantly depends on new and expanded product areas, such as RFFE, and adjacent industry segments, such as automotive, IoT (including the connected home, smart cities, wearables, voice and music and robotics) data center, networking, computing, and machine learning, among others; our ability to develop leading and cost-effective technologies, products and services for new and expanded product areas and adjacent industry segments; and third

parties incorporating our technology, products and services into devices used in these product areas and industry segments. Accordingly, we intend to continue to make substantial investments in these new and expanded product areas and adjacent industry segments, and in developing new products, services and technologies for these product areas and industry segments.

However, our research, development and other investments in these new and expanded product areas and adjacent industry segments, and corresponding technologies, products and services, as well as in our existing, technologies, products and services and new technologies, such as 5G, use of both licensed and unlicensed spectrum, and convergence of cellular and Wi-Fi, may not succeed due to, among others: new industry segments and/or consumer demand may not grow as anticipated; our strategies and/or the strategies of our customers, licensees or partners may not be successful; improvements in alternate technologies in ways that reduce the advantages we anticipate from our investments; competitors' products or services being more cost effective, having more capabilities or fewer limitations or being brought to market faster than our new products and services; and competitors having longer operating histories in industry segments that are new to us. We may also underestimate the costs of or overestimate the future revenues and/or margins that could result from these investments, and these investments may not, or may take many years to, generate material returns. Further, the automotive industry is subject to long design-in time frames, long product life cycles and a high degree of regulatory and safety requirements, necessitating suppliers to the industry to comply with stringent qualification processes, very low defect rates and high reliability standards, all of which results in a significant barrier to entry and increased costs.

If our new technologies, products and/or services are not successful, or are not successful in the time frame we anticipate, we may incur significant costs and/or asset impairments, our business may not grow as anticipated, our revenues and/or margins may be negatively impacted and/or our reputation may be harmed.

There are numerous risks associated with our operation and control of manufacturing facilities we acquired through the formation of our joint venture with TDK, RF360 Holdings, including a higher portion of fixed costs relative to a fabless model, environmental compliance and liability, exposure to natural disasters, timely supply of equipment and materials and manufacturing difficulties.

Manufacturing facilities are characterized by a higher portion of fixed costs relative to a fabless model. In less favorable industry environments, in particular, we may be faced with a decline in the utilization rates of our manufacturing facilities due to decreases in demand for our products. During such periods, our manufacturing facilities could operate at lower capacity levels, while the fixed costs associated with full capacity continue to be incurred, resulting in lower gross profit.

We are subject to many environmental, health and safety laws and regulations in each jurisdiction in which we operate our manufacturing facilities, which govern, among other things, emissions of pollutants into the air, wastewater discharges, the use and handling of hazardous substances, waste disposal, the investigation and remediation of soil and ground water contamination and the health and safety of our employees. We are also required to obtain and maintain environmental permits from governmental authorities for certain of our operations. We cannot make assurances that we will be at all times in compliance with such laws, regulations and permits. Certain environmental laws impose strict, and in certain circumstances, joint and several, liability on current or previous owners or operators of real property for the cost of investigation, removal or remediation of hazardous substances. Certain of these laws also assess liability on persons who arrange for hazardous substances to be sent to disposal or treatment facilities when such facilities are found to be contaminated. In addition, we could also be held liable for consequences arising out of human exposure to hazardous substances or other environmental damage.

We have manufacturing facilities in Asia and Europe. If tsunamis, flooding, earthquakes, volcanic eruptions or other natural disasters or geopolitical conflicts were to damage, destroy or disrupt our manufacturing facilities, it could disrupt our operations, delay new production and shipments of inventory or result in costly repairs, replacements or other costs. In addition, natural disasters or geopolitical conflicts may result in disruptions in transportation, distribution channels or supply chains, or significant increases in the prices of raw materials.

Our manufacturing operations depend on securing raw materials and other supplies in adequate quality and quantity in a timely manner from multiple suppliers, and in some cases we rely on a limited number of suppliers, particularly in Asia. Accordingly, there may be cases where supplies of raw materials and other products are interrupted by disaster, accident or some other event at a supplier, supply is suspended due to quality or other issues, or there is a shortage of supply due to a rapid increase in demand, which could impact production and prevent us from supplying products to our customers. If the supply-demand balance is disrupted, it may considerably increase costs of manufacturing due to increased prices we pay for raw materials or fuel. From time to time, suppliers may extend lead times, limit the amounts supplied to us or increase prices due to capacity constraints or other factors. Further, it may be difficult or impossible to substitute one piece of equipment for another or replace one type of material with another. A failure by our suppliers to deliver our requirements could result in disruptions to our manufacturing operations.

Our manufacturing processes are highly complex, require advanced and costly equipment and must be continuously modified to improve yields and performance. Difficulties in the production process can reduce yields or interrupt production, and as a result we may not be able to deliver products or do so in a timely, cost-effective or competitive manner. Further, to remain competitive and/or meet customer demand, we may be required to improve our facilities and process technologies and carry out extensive research and development, each of which may require investment of significant amounts of capital, and may have a material adverse effect on our results of operations, financial condition and/or cash flows.

The continued and future success of our licensing programs can be impacted by the deployment of other technologies in place of technologies based on CDMA, OFDMA and their derivatives; the success of our licensing programs for 4G single mode products and emerging industry segments; and the need to extend license agreements that are expiring and/or to cover additional future patents.

Although we own a very strong portfolio of issued and pending patents related to OFDM, OFDMA, WLAN and other technologies, our patent portfolio licensing program in some of these areas may be less established and might not be as successful in generating licensing revenues as our CDMA licensing program has been. Many wireless operators have selected or have deployed OFDMA-based LTE as their next-generation 4G technology in existing (or future if not yet deployed) wireless spectrum bands as complementary to their existing CDMA-based networks. While 3G/4G multimode products are generally covered by our existing 3G licensing agreements, products that implement 4G but do not also implement 3G are generally not covered by these agreements. We believe that our patented technologies are essential and useful to implementation of the LTE industry standards and have granted royalty-bearing 4G single-mode licenses to the majority of the leading handset and other wireless device companies (including Huawei, LG, Microsoft, Oppo, Samsung, Sony Mobile, vivo, Xiaomi and ZTE) as they recognize that they need a license to our patents to make and sell products implementing 4G standards but not implementing 3G standards. The royalty rates for single mode 4G products are lower than our royalty rates for 3G and 3G/4G multimode products. Accordingly, without a corresponding increase in volumes and/or device ASP, we will not achieve the same licensing revenues on such LTE products as on 3G and 3G/4G multimode products. In addition, new connectivity and other services are emerging that rely on devices that may or may not be used on traditional cellular networks, such as devices used in the IoT and automotive industry segments. We also seek to diversify and broaden our technology licensing programs to new industry segments in which we can utilize our technology leadership, such as wireless charging and other technologies. Standards, even de facto standards, that develop as these technologies mature, in particular those that do not include a base level of interoperability, may impact our ability to obtain royalties at all or that are equivalent to those that we receive for 3G and 3G/4G multimode products used in cellular communications. Although we believe that our patented technologies are essential and useful to the commercialization of such services, any royalties we receive may be lower than those we receive from our current licensing program.

Over the long-term, we need to continue to evolve our patent portfolio, particularly in 5G. If we do not maintain a strong portfolio that is applicable to current and/or future standards (such as 5G), products and/or services, our future licensing revenues could be negatively impacted.

The licenses granted to and from us under a number of our license agreements include only patents that are either filed or issued prior to a certain date. As a result, there are agreements with some licensees where later patents are not licensed by or to us. Additionally, certain of our license agreements (including essentially all of our recent agreements in China) are effective for a specified term. In order to license or to obtain a license to such later patents or after the expiration of a specified term, or to receive royalties after the specified time period, we will need to extend or modify such license agreements or enter into new license agreements with such licensees. Accordingly, to the extent not renewed on their terms or by election for an additional (generally multi-year) period, if applicable, we will need to extend or modify such license agreements or enter into new license agreements with such licensees more frequently than we have done historically. We might not be able to renew those license agreements, or enter into new license agreements, in the future without affecting the material terms and conditions of our license agreements with such licensees, and such modifications or new agreements may negatively impact our revenues. If there is a delay in renewing a license agreement prior to its expiration, there would be a delay in our ability to recognize revenues related to that licensee's product sales. Further, if we are unable to reach agreement on such modifications or new agreements, it could result in patent infringement litigation with such companies.

We depend on a limited number of third-party suppliers for the procurement, manufacture and testing of our products manufactured in a fabless production model. If we fail to execute supply strategies that provide technology leadership, supply assurance and low cost, our business and results of operations may be harmed. We are also subject to order and shipment uncertainties that could negatively impact our results of operations.

Our QCT segment primarily utilizes a fabless production model, which means that we do not own or operate foundries for the production of silicon wafers from which our integrated circuits are made. Other than the manufacturing facilities we now operate through our recently formed RF360 Holdings joint venture, we rely on independent third-party suppliers to

perform the manufacturing and assembly, and most of the testing, of our integrated circuits. Our suppliers are also responsible for the procurement of most of the raw materials used in the production of our integrated circuits. We employ both turnkey and two-stage manufacturing models to purchase our integrated circuits. Under the turnkey model, our foundry suppliers are responsible for delivering fully assembled and tested integrated circuits. Under the two-stage manufacturing model, we purchase die in singular or wafer form from semiconductor manufacturing foundries and contract with separate third-party suppliers for manufacturing services such as wafer bump, probe, assembly and the majority of our final test requirements. The semiconductor manufacturing foundries that supply products to our QCT segment are primarily located in Asia, as are our primary warehouses where we store finished goods for fulfillment of customer orders. The following could have an adverse effect on our ability to meet customer demands and/or negatively impact our revenues, business operations, profitability and/or cash flows:

- a reduction, interruption, delay or limitation in our product supply sources;
- a failure by our suppliers to procure raw materials or to provide or allocate adequate manufacturing or test capacity for our products;
- our suppliers' inability to react to shifts in product demand or an increase in raw material or component prices;
- our suppliers' delay in developing leading process technologies, or inability to develop or maintain leading process technologies, including transitions to smaller geometry process technologies;
- the loss of a supplier or the inability of a supplier to meet performance, quality or yield specifications or delivery schedules;
- additional expense and/or production delays as a result of qualifying a new supplier and commencing volume production or testing in the event of a loss of or a decision to add or change a supplier; and/or
- natural disasters or geopolitical conflicts, particularly in Asia, impacting our suppliers.

While we have established alternate suppliers for certain technologies, we rely on sole- or limited-source suppliers for certain products, subjecting us to significant risks, including: possible shortages of raw materials or manufacturing capacity; poor product performance; and reduced control over delivery schedules, manufacturing capability and yields, quality assurance, quantity and costs. To the extent we have established alternate suppliers, these suppliers may require significant levels of support to bring complex technologies to production. As a result, we may invest a significant amount of effort and resources and incur higher costs to support and maintain such alternate suppliers. Further, any future consolidation of foundry suppliers could increase our vulnerability to sole- or limited-source arrangements and reduce our suppliers' willingness to negotiate pricing, which could negatively impact our ability to achieve cost reductions and/or increase our manufacturing costs. Our arrangements with our suppliers may obligate us to incur costs to manufacture and test our products that do not decrease at the same rate as decreases in pricing to our customers. Our ability, and that of our suppliers, to develop or maintain leading process technologies, including transitions to smaller geometry process technologies, and to effectively compete with the manufacturing processes and performance of our competitors, could impact our ability to introduce new products and meet customer demand, could increase our costs (possibly decreasing our margins) and could subject us to the risk of excess inventories. Our inability to meet customer demand due to sole- or limited-sourcing and/or the additional costs that we incur because of these or other supply constraints or because of the need to support alternate suppliers could negatively impact our business, our results of operations and/or cash flows.

Although we have long-term contracts with our suppliers, many of these contracts do not provide for long-term capacity commitments. To the extent we do not have firm commitments from our suppliers over a specific time period or for any specific quantity, our suppliers may allocate, and in the past have allocated, capacity to the production and testing of products for their other customers while reducing or limiting capacity to manufacture or test our products. Accordingly, capacity for our products may not be available when we need it or at reasonable prices. To the extent we do obtain long-term capacity commitments, we may incur additional costs related to those commitments and/or make non-refundable payments for capacity commitments that are not used.

One or more of our suppliers or potential alternate suppliers may manufacture CDMA- or OFDMA-based integrated circuits that compete with our products. Such suppliers could elect to allocate raw materials and manufacturing capacity to their own products and reduce or limit deliveries to us to our detriment.

In addition, we may not receive reasonable pricing, manufacturing or delivery terms from our suppliers. We cannot guarantee that the actions of our suppliers will not cause disruptions in our operations that could harm our ability to meet our delivery obligations to our customers or increase our cost of sales.

Additionally, we place orders with our suppliers using our forecasts of customer demand, which are based on a number of assumptions and estimates, and are generally only partially covered by commitments from our customers. If we overestimate customer demand, we may experience increased excess and/or obsolete inventory, which would negatively impact our results of operations.

Claims by other companies that we infringe their intellectual property could adversely affect our business.

From time to time, companies have asserted, and may again assert, patent, copyright and other intellectual property rights against our products or products using our technologies or other technologies used in our industry. These claims have resulted and may again result in our involvement in litigation. We may not prevail in such litigation given, among other factors, the complex technical issues and inherent uncertainties in intellectual property litigation. If any of our products or services were found to infringe another company's intellectual property rights, we could be subject to an injunction or be required to redesign our products or services, which could be costly, or to license such rights and/or pay damages or other compensation to such other company. If we are unable to redesign our products or services, license such intellectual property rights used in our products or services or otherwise distribute our products (e.g., through a licensed supplier), we could be prohibited from making and selling such products or providing such services. In any potential dispute involving other companies' patents or other intellectual property, our chipset foundries, semiconductor assembly and test providers and customers could also become the targets of litigation. We are contingently liable under certain product sales, services, license and other agreements to indemnify certain customers, chipset foundries and semiconductor assembly and test service providers against certain types of liability and/or damages arising from qualifying claims of patent infringement by products or services sold or provided by us, or by intellectual property provided by us to our chipset foundries and semiconductor assembly and test service providers. Reimbursements under indemnification arrangements could have an adverse effect on our results of operations and/or cash flows. Furthermore, any such litigation could severely disrupt the supply of our products and the businesses of our chipset customers and their customers, which in turn could hurt our relationships with them and could result in a decline in our chipset sales and/or reductions in our licensees' sales, causing a corresponding decline in our chipset and/or licensing revenues. Any claims, regardless of their merit, could be time consuming to address, result in costly litigation, divert the efforts of our technical and management personnel or cause product release or shipment delays, any of which could have an adverse effect on our results of operations and cash flows.

We expect that we may continue to be involved in litigation and may have to appear in front of administrative bodies (such as the United States International Trade Commission) to defend against patent assertions against our products by companies, some of whom are attempting to gain competitive advantage or leverage in licensing negotiations. We may not be successful in such proceedings, and if we are not, the range of possible outcomes is very broad and may include, for example, monetary damages or fines or other orders to pay money, royalty payments, injunctions on the sale of certain of our integrated circuit products (and/or on the sale of our customers' devices using such products) and/or the issuance of orders to cease certain conduct and/or modify our business practices. Further, a governmental body in a particular country or region may assert, and may be successful in imposing, remedies with effects that extend beyond the borders of that country or region. In addition, a negative outcome in any such proceeding could severely disrupt the business of our chipset customers and their wireless operator customers, which in turn could harm our relationships with them and could result in a decline in our worldwide chipset sales and/or a reduction in our licensees' sales to wireless operators, causing corresponding declines in our chipset and/or licensing revenues.

Certain legal matters, including certain claims by other companies that we infringe their intellectual property, are described more fully in this Annual Report in "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies."

We may engage in strategic acquisitions, transactions or make investments that could adversely affect our results of operations or fail to enhance stockholder value.

We engage in strategic acquisitions and other transactions, including joint ventures, and make investments, which we believe are important to the future of our business, with the goal of maximizing stockholder value. We acquire businesses and other assets, including patents, technology, wireless spectrum and other intangible assets, enter into joint ventures or other strategic transactions and purchase minority equity interests in or make loans to companies that may be private and early-stage. Our strategic activities are generally focused on opening or expanding opportunities for our technologies and supporting the design and introduction of new products and services (or enhancing existing products or services) for voice and data communications and new industry segments. Recent material transactions include our acquisition of CSR plc, our RF360 Holdings joint venture with TDK Corporation and our proposed acquisition of NXP. Many of our strategic activities entail a high degree of risk and require the use of domestic and/or foreign capital, and investments may not become liquid for several years after the date of the investment, if at all. Our strategic activities may not generate financial returns or result in increased adoption or continued use of our technologies, products or services. We may underestimate the costs and/or

overestimate the benefits, including product, revenue, cost and other synergies and growth opportunities that we expect to realize, and we may not achieve those benefits. In some cases, we may be required to consolidate or record our share of the earnings or losses of companies in which we have acquired ownership interests. In addition, we may record impairment charges related to our strategic activities. Any losses or impairment charges that we incur related to strategic activities will have a negative impact on our financial condition and results of operations, and we may continue to incur new or additional losses related to strategic assets or investments that we have not fully impaired or exited.

Achieving the anticipated benefits of business acquisitions, including joint ventures and other strategic investments in which we have management and operational control, depends in part upon our ability to integrate the businesses in an efficient and effective manner and achieve anticipated synergies, and we may not be successful in these efforts. Such integration is complex and time consuming and involves significant challenges, including, among others: retaining key employees; successfully integrating new employees, technology, products, processes, operations (including manufacturing operations), sales and distribution channels, business models and business systems; retaining customers and suppliers of the businesses; consolidating research and development and/or supply operations; minimizing the diversion of management's attention from ongoing business matters; consolidating corporate and administrative infrastructures; and managing the increased scale, complexity and globalization of our business, operations and employee base. We may not derive any commercial value from associated technologies or products or from future technologies or products based on these technologies, and we may be subject to liabilities that are not covered by indemnification protection that we may obtain, and we may become subject to litigation. Additionally, we may not be successful in entering or expanding into new sales or distribution channels, business or operational models (including manufacturing), geographic regions, industry segments and/or categories of products served by or adjacent to the associated businesses or in addressing potential new opportunities that may arise out of the combination.

If we do not achieve the anticipated benefits of business acquisitions or other strategic activities, our business and results of operations may be adversely affected, and we may not enhance stockholder value by engaging in these transactions.

We are subject to various laws, regulations, policies and standards. Our business may suffer as a result of existing, or new or amended, laws, regulations, policies or standards and/or our failure or inability to comply with laws, regulations, policies or standards.

Our business, products and services, and those of our customers and licensees, are subject to various laws and regulations globally, as well as government policies and the specifications of international, national and regional communications standards bodies. Compliance with existing laws, regulations, policies and standards, the adoption of new laws, regulations, policies or standards, changes in the interpretation of existing laws, regulations, policies or standards, changes in the regulation of our activities by a government or standards body and/or rulings in court, regulatory, administrative or other proceedings relating to such laws, regulations, policies or standards, including, among others, those affecting licensing practices, competitive business practices, the use of our technology or products, protection of intellectual property, trade, foreign currency, investments or loans, spectrum availability and license issuance, adoption of standards, the provision of device subsidies by wireless operators to their customers, taxation, export control, privacy and data protection, environmental protection, health and safety, labor and employment, human rights, corporate governance, public disclosure or business conduct could have an adverse effect on our business and results of operations.

Government policies, particularly in China, that restrict the timing of funds that may flow out of a country may impact the timing of our receipt of payments from our customers and/or licensees in such country, which may negatively impact our cash flows.

Delays in government approvals or other governmental activities that could result from, among others, a decrease in or a lack of funding for certain agencies or branches of the government and/or political changes, could result in our incurring higher costs, could negatively impact our ability to timely consummate strategic transactions and/or could have other negative impacts on our business and the businesses of our customers and licensees.

National, state and local environmental laws and regulations affect our operations around the world. These laws may make it more expensive to manufacture, have manufactured and sell products, and our costs could increase if our vendors (e.g., suppliers, third-party manufacturers or utility companies) pass on their costs to us. We are also subject to laws and regulations impacting the manufacturing operations we acquired through our RF360 Holdings joint venture. See the Risk Factor entitled "There are numerous risks associated with our operation and control of manufacturing facilities we acquired through the formation of our joint venture with TDK, RF360 Holdings, including high fixed costs, environmental compliance and liability, exposure to natural disasters, timely supply of equipment and materials and manufacturing difficulties."

Regulations in the United States require that we determine whether certain materials used in our products, referred to as conflict minerals, originated in the Democratic Republic of the Congo or an adjoining country (collectively, the Covered

Countries), or were from recycled or scrap sources. Other countries or regions may impose similar requirements in the future. The verification and reporting requirements, in addition to customer demands for conflict free sourcing, impose additional costs on us and on our suppliers and may limit the sources or increase the prices of materials used in our products. Further, if we are unable to determine that the conflict minerals used in our products do not directly or indirectly finance or benefit armed groups in the Covered Countries, we may face challenges with our customers that place us at a competitive disadvantage, and our reputation may be harmed. Similarly, other laws and regulations have been adopted or proposed that require additional transparency regarding the employment practices of our suppliers, and any failure to maintain responsible sourcing practices could also adversely affect our relationships with customers and our reputation.

Laws, regulations, policies and standards are complex and changing and may create uncertainty regarding compliance. Laws, regulations, policies and standards are subject to varying interpretations in many cases, and their application in practice may evolve over time. As a result, our efforts to comply may fail, particularly if there is ambiguity as to how they should be applied in practice. Failure to comply with any law, regulation, policy or standard may adversely affect our business, results of operations and/or cash flows. New laws, regulations, policies and standards or evolving interpretations of legal requirements may cause us to incur higher costs as we revise current practices, policies and/or procedures and may divert management time and attention to compliance activities.

Our use of open source software may harm our business.

Certain of our software and our suppliers' software may contain or may be derived from "open source" software, and we have seen, and believe we will continue to see, an increase in customers requesting that we develop products, including software associated with our integrated circuit products, that incorporate open source software elements and operate in an open source environment, which, under certain open source licenses, may offer accessibility to a portion of a product's source code and may expose related intellectual property to adverse licensing conditions. Licensing of such software may impose certain obligations on us if we were to distribute derivative works of the open source software. For example, these obligations may require us to make source code for the derivative works available to our customers in a manner that allows them to make such source code available to their customers or license such derivative works under a particular type of license that is different than what we customarily use to license our software. Developing open source products, while adequately protecting the intellectual property rights upon which our licensing business depends, may prove burdensome and time-consuming under certain circumstances, thereby placing us at a competitive disadvantage, and we may not adequately protect our intellectual property rights. Also, our use and our customers' use of open source software may subject our products and our customers' products to governmental scrutiny and delays in product certification, which could cause customers to view our products as less desirable than our competitors' products. While we believe we have taken appropriate steps and employ adequate controls to protect our intellectual property rights, our use of open source software presents risks that could have an adverse effect on these rights and on our business.

Our stock price, earnings and the fair value of our investments are subject to substantial quarterly and annual fluctuations and to market downturns.

Our stock price and earnings have fluctuated in the past and are likely to fluctuate in the future. Factors that may have a significant impact on the market price of our stock and/or earnings include those identified throughout this Risk Factors section, volatility of the stock market in general and technology-based companies in particular, announcements concerning us, our suppliers, our competitors or our customers or licensees and variations between our actual financial results or guidance and expectations of securities analysts or investors, among others. Further, increased volatility in the financial markets and/or overall economic conditions may reduce the amounts that we realize in the future on our cash equivalents and/or marketable securities and may reduce our earnings as a result of any impairment charges that we record to reduce recorded values of marketable securities to their fair values.

In the past, securities class action litigation has been brought against a company following periods of volatility in the market price of its securities. Due to changes in our stock price, we are and may in the future be the target of securities litigation. Securities litigation could result in substantial uninsured costs and divert management's attention and our resources. Certain legal matters, including certain securities litigation brought against us, are described more fully in this Annual Report in "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies."

We maintain an extensive investment portfolio of varied holdings, which are generally classified as available-for-sale and are therefore recorded on our consolidated balance sheet at fair value, with unrealized gains or losses reported as a component of accumulated other comprehensive income. The fair values of our investments are subject to fluctuation based primarily on market price volatility, as well as the underlying operations of the associated investment, among other things. If the fair value of such investments decreases below their cost basis, as some of our previous investments have, we may be required in certain circumstances to recognize a loss in our results of operations. The sensitivity of and risks associated with

the market value of our investment portfolio are described more fully in this Annual Report in “Part II, Item 7A. Quantitative and Qualitative Disclosures About Market Risk.”

There are risks associated with our indebtedness.

Our outstanding indebtedness and any additional indebtedness we incur, including in connection with our proposed acquisition of NXP, may have negative consequences on our business, including, among others:

- requiring us to use cash to pay the principal of and interest on our indebtedness, thereby reducing the amount of cash available for other purposes;
- limiting our ability to obtain additional financing for working capital, capital expenditures, acquisitions, stock repurchases, dividends or other general corporate and other purposes;
- limiting our flexibility in planning for, or reacting to, changes in our business and our industry; and/or
- increasing our vulnerability to interest rate fluctuations to the extent a portion of our debt has variable interest rates.

Our ability to make payments of principal and interest on our indebtedness depends upon our future performance, which is subject to general economic conditions, industry cycles and financial, business and other factors, including factors which negatively impact our cash flows, such as licensees withholding some or all of the royalty payments they owe to us or paying fines in connection with regulatory investigations, many of which are beyond our control. If we are unable to generate sufficient cash flow from operations in the future to service our debt, we may be required to, among other things: repatriate funds to the United States at substantial tax cost; refinance or restructure all or a portion of our indebtedness; reduce or delay planned capital or operating expenditures; or sell selected assets. Such measures might not be sufficient to enable us to service our debt. In addition, any such refinancing, restructuring or sale of assets might not be available on economically favorable terms or at all, and if prevailing interest rates at the time of any such refinancing and/or restructuring are higher than our current rates, interest expense related to such refinancing and/or restructuring would increase. If there are adverse changes in the ratings assigned to our debt securities by credit rating agencies, our borrowing costs, our ability to access debt in the future and/or the terms of such debt could be adversely affected.

Our business and operations could suffer in the event of security breaches or other misappropriation of our intellectual property or proprietary or confidential information.

Attempts by others to gain unauthorized access to our information technology systems are increasingly more sophisticated. These attempts, which might be related to industrial or other espionage, include covertly introducing malware to our computers and networks, including those in our manufacturing operations, and impersonating authorized users, among others. In addition, employees and former employees, in particular former employees who become employees of our competitors, customers or licensees, may misappropriate, use, publish or provide to our competitors, customers or licensees our intellectual property and/or proprietary or confidential business information. We seek to detect and investigate all security incidents and to prevent their recurrence, but in some cases, we might be unaware of an incident or its magnitude and effects. The theft, unauthorized use or publication of our intellectual property and/or proprietary or confidential business information could harm our competitive position, reduce the value of our investment in research and development and other strategic initiatives and/or otherwise adversely affect our business. To the extent any security breach results in inappropriate disclosure of our customers’ or licensees’ proprietary or confidential information, we may incur liability. We expect to continue to devote significant resources to the security of our information technology systems.

Potential tax liabilities could adversely affect our results of operations.

We are subject to income taxes in the United States and numerous foreign jurisdictions, including Singapore where our QCT segment’s non-United States headquarters is located. Significant judgment is required in determining our provision for income taxes. We regularly are subject to examination of our tax returns and reports by taxing authorities in the United States federal jurisdiction and various state and foreign jurisdictions, most notably in countries where we earn a routine return and the tax authorities believe substantial value-add activities are performed. Our current examinations are at various stages with respect to assessments, claims, deficiencies and refunds. We continually assess the likelihood and amount of potential adjustments and adjust the income tax provision, income taxes payable and deferred taxes in the period in which the facts give rise to a revision become known. Although we believe that our tax estimates are reasonable at September 24, 2017, the final determination of tax audits and any related legal proceedings could materially differ from amounts reflected in our historical income tax provisions and accruals. In such case, our income tax provision, results of operations and/or cash flows in the period or periods in which that determination is made could be negatively affected.

We have tax incentives in Singapore provided that we meet specified employment and other criteria, and as a result of the expiration of these incentives, our Singapore tax rate increased in fiscal 2017 and is expected to increase again in fiscal

2027. If we do not meet the criteria required to retain such incentives, our Singapore tax rate could increase prior to fiscal 2027, and our results of operations and cash flows could be adversely affected.

Tax rules may change in a manner that adversely affects our future reported results of operations or the way we conduct our business. For example, we consider the operating earnings of certain non-United States subsidiaries to be indefinitely reinvested outside the United States based on our current needs for those earnings to be reinvested offshore as well as estimates that future domestic cash generated from operations and/or borrowings will be sufficient to meet future domestic cash needs for the foreseeable future. No provision has been made for United States federal, state or foreign taxes that may result from future remittances of the undistributed earnings of these foreign subsidiaries. Our future results of operations and liquidity may be adversely affected if tax rules regarding unrepatriated earnings change, if domestic cash needs require us to repatriate foreign earnings, if the shares of these foreign subsidiaries were sold or otherwise transferred or if the United States international tax rules change as part of comprehensive tax reform or other tax legislation.

Further changes in the tax laws of foreign jurisdictions could arise as a result of the base erosion and profit shifting (BEPS) project that was undertaken by the Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD). The OECD, which represents a coalition of member countries, recommended changes to numerous long-standing tax principles related to transfer pricing. These changes, if adopted by countries, could increase tax uncertainty and may adversely affect our provision for income taxes, results of operations and/or cash flow. We have not yet determined what changes, if any, may be needed to our operations or structure to address BEPS. If our effective tax rates were to increase, particularly in the United States or Singapore, our results of operations, cash flows and/or financial condition could be adversely affected.

Global, regional or local economic conditions that impact the mobile communications industry or the other industries in which we operate could negatively affect the demand for our products and services and our customers' or licensees' products and services, which may negatively affect our revenues.

A decline in global, regional or local economic conditions or a slow-down in economic growth, particularly in geographic regions with high concentrations of wireless voice and data users or high concentrations of our customers or licensees, could have adverse, wide-ranging effects on demand for our products and for the products and services of our customers or licensees, particularly equipment manufacturers or others in the wireless communications industry who buy their products, such as wireless operators. Any prolonged economic downturn may result in a decrease in demand for our products or technologies; the insolvency of key suppliers, customers or licensees; delays in reporting and/or payments from our licensees and/or customers; failures by counterparties; and negative effects on wireless device inventories. In addition, our customers' ability to purchase or pay for our products and services and network operators' ability to upgrade their wireless networks could be adversely affected by economic conditions, leading to a reduction, cancelation or delay of orders for our products or services.

We may not be able to attract and retain qualified employees.

Our future success depends largely upon the continued service of our executive officers and other key management and technical personnel, and on our ability to continue to identify, attract, retain and motivate them. Implementing our business strategy requires specialized engineering and other talent, as our revenues are highly dependent on technological and product innovations. The market for employees in our industry is extremely competitive. Further, existing immigration laws make it more difficult for us to recruit and retain highly skilled foreign national graduates of universities in the United States, making the pool of available talent even smaller. If we are unable to attract and retain qualified employees, our business may be harmed.

Currency fluctuations could negatively affect future product sales or royalty revenues, harm our ability to collect receivables or increase the U.S. dollar cost of our products.

Our customers sell their products throughout the world in various currencies. Our consolidated revenues from international customers and licensees as a percentage of our total revenues were greater than 90% in each of the last three fiscal years. Adverse movements in currency exchange rates may negatively affect our business, revenues, results of operations and/or cash flows due to a number of factors, including, among others:

- Our products and those of our customers and licensees that are sold outside the United States may become less price-competitive, which may result in reduced demand for those products and/or downward pressure on average selling prices;
- Certain of our revenues, such as royalties, that are derived from licensee or customer sales denominated in foreign currencies could decrease;

- Our foreign suppliers may raise their prices if they are impacted by currency fluctuations, resulting in higher than expected costs and lower margins;
- Certain of our costs that are derived from supply contracts denominated in foreign currencies could increase; and/or
- Foreign exchange hedging transactions that we engage in to reduce the impact of currency fluctuations may require the payment of structuring fees, limit the U.S. dollar value of royalties from licensees' sales that are denominated in foreign currencies, cause earnings volatility if the hedges do not qualify for hedge accounting and expose us to counterparty risk if the counterparty fails to perform.

Failures in our products or services or in the products or services of our customers or licensees, including those resulting from security vulnerabilities, defects or errors, could harm our business.

The use of devices containing our products to access untrusted content creates a risk of exposing the system software in those devices to viral or malicious attacks. While we continue to focus on this issue and are taking measures to safeguard our products from cybersecurity threats, device capabilities continue to evolve, enabling more data and processes, such as computing, and increasing the risk of security failures. Further, our products are inherently complex and may contain defects or errors that are detected only when the products are in use. The design process interface in new domains of technology and the migration to integrated circuit technologies with smaller geometric feature sizes are complex and add risk to manufacturing yields and reliability. Further, manufacturing, testing, marketing and use of our products and those of our customers and licensees entail the risk of product liability. Because our products and services are responsible for critical functions in our customers' products and/or networks, security failures, defects or errors in our products or services could have an adverse impact on us, on our customers and/or on the end users of our customers' products. Such adverse impact could include product liability claims or recalls, write-offs of our inventories, property, plant and equipment and/or intangible assets; unfavorable purchase commitments; a shift of business to our competitors; a decrease in demand for connected devices and wireless services; damage to our reputation and to our customer relationships; and other financial liability or harm to our business. Further, security failures, defects or errors in the products of our customers or licensees could have an adverse impact on our results of operations and/or cash flows due to a delay or decrease in demand for our products or services generally, and our premium-tier products in particular, among other factors.

Item 1B. Unresolved Staff Comments

None.

Item 2. Properties

At September 24, 2017, we occupied the following facilities (square footage in millions):

	United States	Other Countries	Total
Owned facilities	4.6	0.2	4.8
Leased facilities	1.6	4.6	6.2
Total	6.2	4.8	11.0

Our headquarters as well as certain research and development, manufacturing and network management hub operations are located in San Diego, California. Additionally, our QCT segment's non-United States headquarters is located in Singapore. Our consolidated RF360 Holdings joint venture with TDK leases manufacturing facilities in Germany, China and Singapore. We also own and lease properties around the world for use as sales and administrative offices and research and development centers, primarily in the United States and India. Our facility leases expire at varying dates through 2025, not including renewals that would be at our option. Several other owned and leased facilities are under construction totaling approximately 128,000 additional square feet.

We believe that our facilities are suitable and adequate for our present purposes and that the productive capacity in facilities that are not under construction is substantially utilized. We do not identify or allocate facilities by operating segment. Additional information on net property, plant and equipment by geography is provided in this Annual Report in "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 8. Segment Information." In the future, we may need to purchase, build or lease additional facilities to meet the requirements projected in our long-term business plan.

Item 3. Legal and Regulatory Proceedings

Information regarding legal and regulatory proceedings is provided in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies.” We are also engaged in numerous other legal actions arising in the ordinary course of our business and, while there can be no assurance, we believe that the ultimate outcome of these other legal actions will not have a material adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition or cash flows.

Item 4. Mine Safety Disclosures

Not applicable.

Part II

Item 5. Market for Registrant's Common Equity, Related Stockholder Matters and Issuer Purchases of Equity Securities

Market Information and Dividends

Our common stock is traded on the NASDAQ Global Select Market (NASDAQ) under the symbol "QCOM." The following table sets forth the range of high and low sales prices of our common stock as reported by NASDAQ and cash dividends announced per share of common stock, for the fiscal periods presented. Quotations of our stock price represent inter-dealer prices without retail markup, markdown or commission and may not necessarily represent actual transactions.

	High (\$)	Low (\$)	Dividends (\$)
2017			
First quarter	71.62	61.86	0.53
Second quarter	67.58	52.37	0.53
Third quarter	59.89	51.05	0.57
Fourth quarter	57.69	48.92	0.57
2016			
First quarter	61.19	45.93	0.48
Second quarter	53.52	42.24	0.48
Third quarter	56.27	49.67	0.53
Fourth quarter	64.00	50.84	0.53

At October 30, 2017, there were 7,310 holders of record of our common stock. On October 30, 2017, the last sale price reported on the NASDAQ for our common stock was \$54.66 per share. On October 10, 2017, we announced a cash dividend of \$0.57 per share on our common stock, payable on December 15, 2017 to stockholders of record as of the close of business on November 29, 2017. We intend to continue to pay quarterly dividends, subject to capital availability and our view that cash dividends are in the best interests of our stockholders. Future dividends may be affected by, among other items, our views on potential future capital requirements, including those relating to research and development, creation and expansion of sales distribution channels, investments and acquisitions, legal risks, withholding of payments by one or more of our significant licensees and/or customers, fines by government agencies and/or adverse rulings by a court or arbitrator in a legal matter, stock repurchase programs, debt issuance, changes in federal and state income tax law and changes to our business model.

Share-Based Compensation

We primarily issue restricted stock units under our equity compensation plans, which are part of a broad-based, long-term retention program that is intended to attract and retain talented employees and directors and align stockholder and employee interests.

Our 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan (2016 Plan) provides for the grant of both incentive and nonstatutory stock options, stock appreciation rights, restricted stock, unrestricted stock, restricted stock units, performance units, performance shares, deferred compensation awards and other stock-based awards. Restricted stock units generally vest over periods of three years from the date of grant. Stock options vest over periods not exceeding five years and are exercisable for up to ten years from the grant date. The Board of Directors may amend or terminate the 2016 Plan at any time, with certain amendments also requiring stockholder approval.

Additional information regarding our share-based compensation plans and plan activity for fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 is provided in this Annual Report in "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 5. Employee Benefit Plans" and additional information regarding our share-based compensation plans for fiscal 2017 will be provided in our 2018 Proxy Statement under the heading "Equity Compensation Plan Information."

Issuer Purchases of Equity Securities

Issuer purchases of equity securities during the fourth quarter of fiscal 2017 were:

	Total Number of Shares Purchased	Average Price Paid Per Share (1)	Total Number of Shares Purchased as Part of Publicly Announced Plans or Programs	Approximate Dollar Value of Shares that May Yet Be Purchased Under the Plans or Programs (2)
	(In thousands)		(In thousands)	(In millions)
June 26, 2017 to July 23, 2017	—	\$ —	—	\$ 1,959
July 24, 2017 to August 20, 2017	2,854	52.54	2,854	1,809
August 21, 2017 to September 24, 2017	3,268	50.47	3,268	1,644
Total	<u>6,122</u>		<u>6,122</u>	

(1) Average Price Paid Per Share excludes cash paid for commissions.

(2) On March 9, 2015 , we announced a repurchase program authorizing us to repurchase up to \$15 billion of our common stock. At September 24, 2017 , \$1.6 billion remained authorized for repurchase. The stock repurchase program has no expiration date.

Item 6. Selected Financial Data

The following data should be read in conjunction with the annual consolidated financial statements, related notes and other financial information appearing elsewhere herein.

	Years Ended (1)				
	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016	September 27, 2015	September 28, 2014	September 29, 2013
(In millions, except per share data)					
Statement of Operations Data:					
Revenues	\$ 22,291	\$ 23,554	\$ 25,281	\$ 26,487	\$ 24,866
Operating income	2,614	6,495	5,776	7,550	7,230
Income from continuing operations (2)	2,465	5,702	5,268	7,534	6,845
Discontinued operations, net of income taxes	—	—	—	430	—
Net income attributable to Qualcomm	2,466	5,705	5,271	7,967	6,853

Per Share Data:

Basic earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm:

Continuing operations	\$ 1.67	\$ 3.84	\$ 3.26	\$ 4.48	\$ 3.99
Discontinued operations	—	—	—	0.25	—
Net income	1.67	3.84	3.26	4.73	3.99

Diluted earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm:

Continuing operations	1.65	3.81	3.22	4.40	3.91
Discontinued operations	—	—	—	0.25	—
Net income	1.65	3.81	3.22	4.65	3.91

Dividends per share announced	2.20	2.02	1.80	1.54	1.20
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Balance Sheet Data:

Cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities	\$ 38,578	\$ 32,350	\$ 30,947	\$ 32,022	\$ 29,406
Total assets	65,486	52,359	50,796	48,574	45,516
Short-term debt (3)	2,495	1,749	1,000	—	—
Long-term debt (4)	19,398	10,008	9,969	—	—
Other long-term liabilities (5)	2,432	895	817	428	550
Total stockholders' equity	30,746	31,768	31,414	39,166	36,087

- (1) Our fiscal year ends on the last Sunday in September. The fiscal years ended September 24, 2017 , September 25, 2016 , September 27, 2015 , September 28, 2014 and September 29, 2013 each included 52 weeks.
- (2) Revenues in fiscal 2017 were negatively impacted by actions taken by Apple and its contract manufacturers as well as the previously disclosed dispute with another licensee, who did not fully report or fully pay royalties due in the last three quarters of fiscal 2017, as well as the \$940 million reduction to revenues recorded related to the BlackBerry arbitration. Operating income was further negatively impacted by \$927 million and \$778 million in charges related to the fines imposed by the KFTC and the TFTC, respectively.
- (3) Short-term debt was comprised of outstanding commercial paper and, in fiscal 2017, the current portion of long-term debt.
- (4) Long-term debt was comprised of floating- and fixed-rate notes.
- (5) Other long-term liabilities in this balance sheet data exclude unearned revenues.

Item 7. Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations

In addition to historical information, the following discussion contains forward-looking statements that are subject to risks and uncertainties. Actual results may differ materially from those referred to herein due to a number of factors, including but not limited to risks described in "Part I, Item 1A. Risk Factors" and elsewhere in this Annual Report.

The following discussion and analysis of our financial condition and results of operations should be read in conjunction with our consolidated financial statements and related notes included in "Part II, Item 8. Financial Statements and Supplementary Data" of this Annual Report.

Fiscal 2017 Overview

Revenues were \$22.3 billion with net income attributable to Qualcomm of \$2.5 billion, a decrease of 5% and 57% from fiscal 2016, respectively. Highlights and other events from fiscal 2017 included:

- The transition of wireless networks and devices to 3G/4G (CDMA-single mode, OFDMA-single mode and CDMA/OFDMA multi-mode) continued around the world. 3G/4G connections increased to approximately 4.7 billion, up 16% year-over-year, and represent approximately 60% of total mobile connections at the end of fiscal 2017, up from 54% at the end of fiscal 2016. ⁽¹⁾
- We continue to invest significant resources toward advancements primarily in support of 4G OFDMA- and 5G-based technologies as well as other technologies to extend the demand for our products and generate new or expanded licensing opportunities, including within adjacent industry segments outside traditional cellular industries, such as automotive, the Internet of Things (IoT) and networking.
- QCT results were positively impacted by growth in revenues related to adjacent industry segments outside traditional cellular industries, results from our recently formed RF360 Holdings joint venture and cost reduction initiatives achieved under the Strategic Realignment Plan, partially offset by a decline in share at Apple.
- QTL results were negatively impacted by actions taken by Apple and its contract manufacturers, as well as the previously disclosed dispute with another licensee, who underpaid royalties due in the second quarter of fiscal 2017 and did not report or pay royalties due in the third or fourth quarter of fiscal 2017.
- In January 2017, we received a formal written decision from the Korea Fair Trade Commission (KFTC) in connection with its investigation of us, which ordered certain remedial actions and imposed a fine of approximately 1.03 trillion Korean Won (approximately \$927 million). The fine was paid in March 2017.
- On October 11, 2017, the Taiwan Fair Trade Commission (TFTC) announced that it had reached a decision in its investigation of us and found us to be in violation of the Taiwan Fair Trade Act. On October 23, 2017, we received the TFTC's written decision, which prohibits certain conduct, allows for certain competing chip companies and handset manufacturers to request to amend or enter into patent license and other relevant agreements, and imposes a fine of approximately 23.4 billion Taiwan Dollars (approximately \$778 million based on the exchange rate at September 24, 2017), which was recorded as a charge to other expense in the fourth quarter of fiscal 2017.
- In May 2017, in connection with the arbitration decision, we entered into a Joint Stipulation Regarding Final Award Agreement with BlackBerry Limited (BlackBerry) and paid to BlackBerry \$940 million to cover the award amount, prejudgment interest and attorney's fees. This amount, which was recorded as a reduction to revenues, also reflected certain amounts that were owed to us by BlackBerry.
- On October 27, 2016, we announced a definitive agreement under which Qualcomm River Holdings, B.V. (Qualcomm River Holdings), an indirect, wholly owned subsidiary of QUALCOMM Incorporated, will acquire NXP Semiconductors N.V. (NXP). Pursuant to the definitive agreement, Qualcomm River Holdings has commenced a tender offer to acquire all of the issued and outstanding common shares of NXP for \$110 per share in cash, for estimated total cash consideration to be paid to NXP's shareholders of \$38 billion. NXP is a leader in high-performance, mixed-signal semiconductor electronics in automotive, broad-based microcontrollers, secure identification, network processing and RF power products. The transaction is subject to receipt of regulatory approvals in various jurisdictions and other closing conditions. While we continue to work to close by the end of calendar 2017, the transaction may close in early 2018.
- In May 2017, we issued an aggregate principal amount of \$11.0 billion in nine tranches of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes, with maturity dates starting in 2019 through 2047 and effective interest rates between 1.80% and 4.47%. The proceeds are intended to be used to finance, in part, our proposed acquisition of NXP and other related transactions and for general corporate purposes.

(1) According to GSMA Intelligence estimates as of October 30, 2017 (estimates excluded Wireless Local Loop).

Our Business and Operating Segments

We develop and commercialize foundational technologies and products used in mobile devices and other wireless products, including network equipment, broadband gateway equipment and consumer electronics devices. We derive revenues principally from sales of integrated circuit products and licensing our intellectual property, including patents, software and other rights.

We are organized on the basis of products and services and have three reportable segments. We conduct business primarily through our QCT (Qualcomm CDMA Technologies) semiconductor business and our QTL (Qualcomm Technology Licensing) licensing business. QCT develops and supplies integrated circuits and system software based on CDMA, OFDMA and other technologies for use in mobile devices, wireless networks, devices used in IoT, broadband gateway equipment, consumer electronic devices and automotive telematics and infotainment systems. QTL grants licenses to use portions of its intellectual property portfolio, which includes certain patent rights essential to and/or useful in the manufacture and sale of certain wireless products. Our QSI (Qualcomm Strategic Initiatives) reportable segment makes strategic investments. We also have nonreportable segments, including our mobile health, data center, small cell and other wireless technology and service initiatives.

Our reportable segments are operated by QUALCOMM Incorporated and its direct and indirect subsidiaries. Substantially all of our products and services businesses, including QCT, and substantially all of our engineering, research and development functions, are operated by Qualcomm Technologies, Inc. (QTI), a wholly-owned subsidiary of QUALCOMM Incorporated, and QTI's subsidiaries. QTL is operated by QUALCOMM Incorporated, which owns the vast majority of our patent portfolio. Neither QTI nor any of its subsidiaries has any right, power or authority to grant any licenses or other rights under or to any patents owned by QUALCOMM Incorporated.

Further information regarding our business and operating segments is provided in "Part I, Item 1. Business" of this Annual Report.

Seasonality. Many of our products and/or intellectual property are incorporated into consumer wireless devices, which are subject to seasonality and other fluctuations in demand. As a result, QCT has tended historically to have stronger sales toward the end of the calendar year as manufacturers prepare for major holiday selling seasons; and because QTL recognizes royalty revenues when royalties are reported by licensees, QTL has tended to record higher royalty revenues in the first calendar quarter when licensees report their sales made in the fourth calendar quarter. We have also experienced fluctuations in revenues due to the timing of conversions and expansions of 3G and 4G networks by wireless operators and the timing of launches of flagship wireless devices that incorporate our products and/or intellectual property. These trends may or may not continue in the future. These seasonal trends for QTL may be impacted by disputes and/or resolutions with licensees.

Results of Operations

Revenues (in millions)

	2017	2016	2015	2017 vs. 2016 Change	2016 vs. 2015 Change
Equipment and services	\$ 16,647	\$ 15,467	\$ 17,079	\$ 1,180	\$ (1,612)
Licensing	5,644	8,087	8,202	(2,443)	(115)
	<u>\$ 22,291</u>	<u>\$ 23,554</u>	<u>\$ 25,281</u>	<u>\$ (1,263)</u>	<u>\$ (1,727)</u>

The increase in equipment and services revenues in fiscal 2017 is primarily due to an increase in QCT revenues of \$1.13 billion and an increase in QSI revenues of \$66 million. The decrease in equipment and services revenues in fiscal 2016 was primarily due to a decrease in QCT revenues of \$1.76 billion, partially offset by increases in revenues of one of our nonreportable segments and our QSI segment of \$56 million and \$43 million, respectively. The decrease in licensing revenues in fiscal 2017 was primarily due to the decrease in QTL revenues, the reduction to licensing revenues of \$962 million related to the BlackBerry arbitration and a \$103 million decrease in revenues of one of our nonreportable segments. The decrease in licensing revenues in fiscal 2016 was primarily due to the decrease in QTL revenues, partially offset by a \$143 million increase in revenues of one of our nonreportable segments.

In fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, revenues from suppliers to Apple Inc. and from Samsung Electronics each comprised more than 10% of consolidated revenues. Combined revenues from GuangDong OPPO Mobile Telecommunications Corp. Ltd. and vivo Communication Technology Co., Ltd., and their respective affiliates, also comprised more than 10% of consolidated revenues in fiscal 2017. QCT and QTL segment revenues related to the products of these customers/licensees comprised 51%, 49% and 47% of total consolidated revenues in fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, respectively.

Revenues from customers in China (including Hong Kong) and South Korea comprised 65% and 16% , respectively, of total consolidated revenues for fiscal 2017 , compared to 57% and 17% , respectively, for fiscal 2016 , and 53% and 16% , respectively, for fiscal 2015 . We report revenues from external customers by country based on the location to which our products or services are delivered, which for QCT is generally the country in which our customers manufacture their products, or for licensing revenues, the invoiced addresses of our licensees. As a result, the revenues by country presented herein are not necessarily indicative of either the country in which the devices containing our products and/or intellectual property are ultimately sold to consumers or the country in which the companies that sell the devices are headquartered. For example, China revenues would include revenues related to shipments of integrated circuits to a company that is headquartered in South Korea but that manufactures devices in China, which devices are then sold to consumers in Europe and/or the United States.

Costs and Expenses (in millions)

	2017	2016	2015	2017 vs. 2016 Change	2016 vs. 2015 Change
Cost of revenues	\$ 9,792	\$ 9,749	\$ 10,378	\$ 43	\$ (629)
Gross margin	56%	59%	59%		

The margin percentage decreased in fiscal 2017 primarily due to the decrease in higher margin QTL licensing revenues as a proportion of total revenues, partially offset by an increase in QCT margin percentage. The margin percentage in fiscal 2017 was also negatively impacted by the reduction to licensing revenues related to the BlackBerry arbitration. The margin percentage in fiscal 2016 remained flat primarily due to the effect of \$163 million in additional charges related to the amortization of intangible assets and the recognition of the step-up of inventories to fair value primarily related to the acquisition of CSR plc in the fourth quarter of fiscal 2015 , offset by the impact of higher-margin segment mix primarily related to QTL. Our margin percentage may continue to fluctuate in future periods depending on the mix of segment results as well as products sold, competitive pricing, new product introduction costs and other factors, including disputes and/or resolutions with licensees.

	2017	2016	2015	2017 vs. 2016 Change	2016 vs. 2015 Change
Research and development	\$ 5,485	\$ 5,151	\$ 5,490	\$ 334	\$ (339)
% of revenues	25%	22%	22%		
Selling, general, and administrative	\$ 2,658	\$ 2,385	\$ 2,344	\$ 273	\$ 41
% of revenues	12%	10%	9%		
Other	\$ 1,742	\$ (226)	\$ 1,293	\$ 1,968	\$ (1,519)

The dollar increase in research and development expenses in fiscal 2017 was primarily attributable to an increase of \$372 million in costs related to the development of integrated circuit technologies, including 5G technology and RFFE technologies from our recently formed RF360 Holdings joint venture, and related software products, partially offset by cost decreases driven by actions initiated under our Strategic Realignment Plan, which was substantially completed by the end of fiscal 2016 . The dollar decrease in research and development expenses in fiscal 2016 was primarily attributable to a decrease of \$228 million in cost related to the development of integrated circuit technologies and related software products. Such decrease was primarily driven by actions initiated under the Strategic Realignment Plan, partially offset by increased research and development costs resulting from acquisitions. The decrease in research and development expenses in fiscal 2016 also included decreases of \$67 million in development costs of display technologies and \$45 million in share-based compensation expense.

The dollar increase in selling, general and administrative expenses in fiscal 2017 was primarily attributable to increases of \$136 million in professional services fees, primarily related to third-party acquisition and integration services resulting from the proposed acquisition of NXP, \$70 million in costs related to litigation and other legal matters and \$33 million in employee-related expenses, primarily related to our recently formed RF360 Holdings joint venture, which closed in February 2017. The dollar increase in selling, general and administrative expenses in fiscal 2016 was primarily attributable to increases of \$65 million in costs related to litigation and other legal matters, \$39 million in employee-related expenses and \$27 million in depreciation and amortization expense, partially offset by decreases of \$36 million in share-based compensation expense, \$21 million in selling and marketing expenses, \$19 million in professional services and \$17 million in patent-related costs.

Other expenses in fiscal 2017 consisted of a \$927 million charge related to the KFTC fine, including related foreign currency losses, a \$778 million charge related to the TFTC fine and \$37 million in restructuring and restructuring-related charges related to our Strategic Realignment Plan. Other income in fiscal 2016 was attributable to a \$380 million gain on the sale of wireless spectrum, partially offset by net charges related to our Strategic Realignment Plan, which included \$202 million in restructuring and restructuring-related charges, partially offset by a \$48 million gain on the sale of our business that provided augmented reality applications. Other expenses in fiscal 2015 were attributable to a \$975 million charge resulting from the resolution reached with the NDRC, charges of \$255 million and \$11 million for impairment of goodwill and intangible assets, respectively, related to our content and push-to-talk services and display businesses and \$190 million in restructuring and restructuring-related charges related to our Strategic Realignment Plan, partially offset by \$138 million in gains on sales of certain property plant and equipment.

Interest Expense and Investment and Other Income, Net (in millions)

	2017	2016	2015	2017 vs. 2016 Change	2016 vs. 2015 Change
Interest expense	\$ 494	\$ 297	\$ 104	\$ 197	\$ 193
Investment and other income, net					
Interest and dividend income	\$ 619	\$ 611	\$ 527	\$ 8	\$ 84
Net realized gains on marketable securities	456	239	451	217	(212)
Net realized gains on other investments	74	49	49	25	—
Impairment losses on marketable securities and other investments	(177)	(172)	(200)	(5)	28
Equity in net losses of investees	(74)	(84)	(32)	10	(52)
Net losses on foreign currency transactions	(30)	—	—	(30)	—
Net gains (losses) on derivative instruments	32	(8)	17	40	(25)
Net gains on deconsolidation of subsidiaries	—	—	3	—	(3)
	\$ 900	\$ 635	\$ 815	\$ 265	\$ (180)

The increase in interest expense in fiscal 2017 was primarily due to the issuance of an aggregate principal amount of \$11.0 billion of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes in May 2017 and fees related to the Bridge and Term Loan Facilities entered into during the first quarter of fiscal 2017. The increase in net realized gains on marketable securities in fiscal 2017 was primarily attributable to certain marketable securities that we sold to fund, in part, our proposed acquisition of NXP. The net losses on foreign currency transactions in fiscal 2017 were primarily attributable to the impact of currency exchange rate movements on certain monetary assets and liabilities of our recently formed RF360 Holdings joint venture.

The increase in interest expense in fiscal 2016 was primarily due to the issuance of an aggregate principal amount of \$10.0 billion of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes in May 2015.

Income Tax Expense (in millions)

	2017	2016	2015	2017 vs. 2016 Change	2016 vs. 2015 Change
Income tax expense	\$ 555	\$ 1,131	\$ 1,219	\$ (576)	\$ (88)
Effective tax rate	18%	17%	19%	1%	(2%)

The following table summarizes the primary factors that caused our annual effective tax rates to be less than the United States federal statutory rate:

	2017	2016	2015
Expected income tax provision at federal statutory tax rate	35%	35%	35%
Benefits from foreign income taxed at other than U.S. rates	(32%)	(16%)	(14%)
Benefits related to the research and development tax credits	(3%)	(2%)	(2%)
Worthless stock deduction of domestic subsidiary	—	(1%)	—
Nondeductible charges related to the KFTC and TFTC investigations	12%	—	—
Impact of changes in tax reserves and audit settlements for prior year tax positions	4%	—	(1%)
Other	2%	1%	1%
Effective tax rate	18%	17%	19%

In fiscal 2017, we recorded charges of \$927 million and \$778 million related to the fines imposed by the KFTC and the TFTC, respectively, which are not deductible for tax purposes and are each attributable to both the United States and a foreign jurisdiction. Additionally, the effective tax rate of 18% for fiscal 2017 was impacted by lower United States revenues primarily related to decreased royalty revenues from Apple's contract manufacturers and the BlackBerry arbitration. The effective tax rate of 18% for fiscal 2017 also reflected the increase in our Singapore tax rate as a result of the expiration of certain of our tax incentives in March 2017, which was substantially offset by tax benefits resulting from the increase in our Singapore tax rate that will be in effect when certain deferred tax assets are scheduled to reverse. The effective tax rate for our state income tax provision, net of federal benefit, was negligible for all years presented.

The effective tax rate of 17% for fiscal 2016 reflected a \$101 million tax benefit recorded discretely in the third quarter of fiscal 2016 resulting from a worthless stock deduction on a domestic subsidiary of one of our former display businesses and a \$79 million benefit recorded discretely in the first quarter of fiscal 2016 related to fiscal 2015 resulting from the retroactive and permanent reinstatement of the United States federal research and development tax credit.

During fiscal 2015, the NDRC imposed a fine of \$975 million, which was not deductible for tax purposes and was substantially attributable to a foreign jurisdiction. Additionally, during fiscal 2015, we recorded a tax benefit of \$101 million related to fiscal 2014 resulting from the retroactive reinstatement of the United States federal research and development tax credit to January 1, 2014 through December 31, 2014. The effective tax rate for fiscal 2015 also reflected the United States federal research and development tax credit generated through December 31, 2014, the date on which the credit expired and a \$61 million tax benefit as a result of a favorable tax audit settlement with the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) related to Qualcomm Atheros, Inc.'s pre-acquisition 2010 and 2011 tax returns.

The effective tax rate for fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 also reflected tax benefits for certain tax incentives obtained in Singapore that commenced in March 2012, including a tax exemption for the first five years, provided that we meet specified employment and other criteria. Our Singapore tax rate increased in fiscal 2017 as a result of the expiration of certain of these incentives and will increase again in fiscal 2027 upon the expiration of the remaining incentives.

Unrecognized tax benefits were \$372 million and \$271 million at September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016, respectively. The increase in unrecognized tax benefits in fiscal 2017 was primarily due to tax positions related to transfer pricing. We believe that it is reasonably possible that the total amounts of unrecognized tax benefits at September 24, 2017 may increase or decrease in the next 12 months.

We are subject to income taxes in the United States and numerous foreign jurisdictions and are currently under examination by various tax authorities worldwide, most notably in countries where we earn a routine return and tax authorities believe substantial value-add activities are performed. These examinations are at various stages with respect to assessments, claims, deficiencies and refunds. We continually assess the likelihood and amount of potential adjustments and adjusts the income tax provision, income taxes payable and deferred taxes in the period in which the facts give rise to a revision become known. As of September 24, 2017, we believe that adequate amounts have been reserved for based on facts known. However, the final determination of tax audits and any related legal proceedings could materially differ from amounts reflected in our income tax provision and the related accruals.

Our Segment Results

The following should be read in conjunction with the fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 results of operations for each reportable segment included in this Annual Report in "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 8. Segment Information."

<i>(in millions)</i>	2017	2016	2015
Revenues			
QCT	\$ 16,479	\$ 15,409	\$ 17,154
QTL	6,445	7,664	7,947
QSI	113	47	4
EBT (1)			
QCT	\$ 2,747	\$ 1,812	\$ 2,465
QTL	5,175	6,528	6,882
QSI	65	386	(74)
EBT as a % of revenues			
QCT	17%	12%	14%
QTL	80%	85%	87%

(1) Earnings (loss) before taxes.

QCT Segment. QCT revenues increased in fiscal 2017 and decreased in fiscal 2016 due to corresponding fluctuations in equipment and services revenues. Equipment and services revenues, mostly related to sales of MSM and accompanying RF, Power Management (PM) and wireless connectivity integrated circuits, were \$16.31 billion , \$15.18 billion and \$16.95 billion in fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 , respectively. Approximately 804 million , 842 million and 932 million MSM integrated circuits were sold during fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 , respectively.

Equipment and services revenues increased in fiscal 2017 primarily due to an increase in revenues related to RFFE products, including \$676 million from the formation of our RF360 Holdings joint venture, a \$492 million increase resulting from higher shipments of connectivity products primarily related to adjacent industry segments outside of traditional cellular industries and a \$469 million increase resulting from the net impact of higher-priced product mix and lower average selling prices. These increases were partially offset by a decrease of \$553 million primarily related to lower MSM and accompanying RF and PM unit shipments driven primarily by a decline in share at Apple, partially offset by higher demand from OEMs in China. The decrease in equipment and services revenues in fiscal 2016 resulted primarily from decreases of \$1.35 billion related to lower MSM and accompanying RF and PM unit shipments and \$1.14 billion from lower average selling prices and lower-priced product mix, partially offset by a net increase of \$753 million in revenues related to other products, primarily related to higher connectivity shipments resulting from the acquisition of CSR in the fourth quarter of fiscal 2015.

QCT EBT as a percentage of revenues increased in fiscal 2017 primarily due to an increase in gross margin percentage, partially offset by a combined increase of 1% in research and development and selling, general and administrative expenses primarily from our RF360 Holdings joint venture. QCT gross margin percentage increased in fiscal 2017 primarily as a result of higher-margin product mix and lower average unit costs, partially offset by lower average selling prices and higher excess inventory charges. QCT EBT as a percentage of revenues decreased in fiscal 2016 primarily due to the impact of lower revenues relative to operating expenses. QCT gross margin percentage remained flat in fiscal 2016 primarily as a result of lower average selling prices and lower-margin product mix, offset by lower average unit costs and lower excess inventory charges.

QCT accounts receivable increased by 24% in fiscal 2017 from \$1.46 billion to \$1.81 billion, primarily due to the accounts receivable related to our RF360 Holdings joint venture and increased revenues related to integrated circuits. QCT inventories increased by 31% in fiscal 2017 from \$1.54 billion to \$2.02 billion due to inventories relating to our RF360 Holdings joint venture and an increase in the overall quantity of units on hand, partially offset by lower average unit costs.

QTL Segment. QTL results were negatively impacted by actions taken by Apple and its contract manufacturers as well as the previously disclosed dispute with another licensee, who did not report or pay royalties due in the third or fourth quarter of fiscal 2017. Revenues related to the products of Apple's contract manufacturers and the other licensee in dispute comprised a total of approximately \$1.35 billion in the third and fourth quarters of fiscal 2016. Additionally, QTL revenues were negatively impacted by an estimated amount in excess of \$150 million related to the dispute with the other licensee who

underpaid royalties due in the second quarter of fiscal 2017. In addition to the above, the decrease in QTL revenues during fiscal 2017 was also attributable to the recognition of revenues in fiscal 2016 relating to the termination of an infrastructure license agreement resulting from the merger of two licensees and decreased recognition of unearned license fees, partially offset by an increase in revenues per unit and higher royalty revenues recognized related to devices sold in prior periods. QTL EBT as a percentage of revenues decreased in fiscal 2017 as compared to fiscal 2016 primarily due to the decrease in QTL revenues. QTL revenues and EBT in fiscal 2016 and 2017 also continued to be impacted negatively by units that we believe are not being reported by certain other licensees and sales of certain unlicensed products. While we have reached agreements with many licensees, negotiations with certain other licensees and unlicensed companies are ongoing, particularly in emerging regions, including China, and additional litigation may become necessary if negotiations fail to resolve the relevant issues.

The decrease in QTL revenues in fiscal 2016 of \$283 million was primarily attributable to decreases in revenues per reported unit and recognition of unearned license fees, partially offset by an increase in reported sales of CDMA-based products (including multimode products that also implement OFDMA) and \$266 million in licensing revenues recorded in the second quarter of fiscal 2016 due to the termination of an infrastructure license agreement resulting from the merger of two licensees.

QTL accounts receivable increased by more than 100% in fiscal 2017 from \$644 million to \$1.74 billion, primarily due to the short payment of royalties reported in the second quarter of fiscal 2017 by, and deemed collectible from, Apple's contract manufacturers and the timing of the collection of payments from certain of our other licensees.

QSI Segment . The decrease in QSI EBT in fiscal 2017 of \$321 million was primarily due to the effect of a \$380 million gain on the sale of wireless spectrum recorded in fiscal 2016, partially offset by the net impact of \$41 million resulting from higher revenues and costs associated with certain development contracts with one of our equity method investees. The increase in QSI EBT in fiscal 2016 of \$460 million was primarily due to a \$380 million gain on the sale of wireless spectrum, an increase of \$47 million in net realized gains on investments and a decrease of \$21 million in impairment losses on investments.

Looking Forward

We expect continued growth in the coming years in consumer demand for 3G, 3G/4G multimode and 4G products and services around the world, driven primarily by smartphones. We also expect growth in new device categories and industries, driven by the expanding adoption of certain technologies that are already commonly used in smartphones by industry segments outside traditional cellular industries, such as automotive, IoT and networking. As we look forward to the next several months and beyond, we expect our business to be impacted by the following key items:

- On October 27, 2016, we announced a definitive agreement under which Qualcomm River Holdings, an indirect, wholly owned subsidiary of QUALCOMM Incorporated, will acquire NXP. Pursuant to the definitive agreement, Qualcomm River Holdings has commenced a tender offer to acquire all of the issued and outstanding common shares of NXP for \$110 per share in cash, for estimated total cash consideration to be paid to NXP's shareholders of \$38 billion . NXP is a leader in high-performance, mixed-signal semiconductor electronics in automotive, broad-based microcontrollers, secure identification, network processing and RF power products. The transaction is subject to receipt of regulatory approvals in various jurisdictions and other closing conditions, including the tender of at least 80% of the issued and outstanding common shares of NXP in the offer (provided that the minimum tender threshold may be reduced to a percentage not less than 70% with the prior written consent of NXP). While we continue to work to close by the end of calendar 2017, the transaction may close in early 2018. We intend to fund the transaction with cash generated from our recent debt offering as well as cash held by our foreign entities and use of a Term Loan, which we expect to draw on at close. We expect that this acquisition will continue to require us to devote significant resources and management time and attention and utilize a substantial portion of our cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities.
- Regulatory authorities in certain jurisdictions continue to investigate our business practices, and other regulatory authorities may do so in the future. Unfavorable resolutions of one or more of these matters have had and could in the future have a material adverse effect on our business with remedies that include, among others, injunctions, monetary damages or fines or other orders to pay money, and the issuance of orders to cease certain conduct and/or modify our business practices. Additionally, certain of our direct and indirect customers and licensees, including BlackBerry Limited and Apple Inc., have pursued, and others may in the future pursue, litigation or arbitration against us related to our business. Unfavorable resolutions of one or more of these matters have had and could in the future have a material adverse effect on our business, including monetary damages. These activities have required and we expect that they will continue to require the investment of significant management time and attention, and

have resulted and we expect that they will continue to result in increased legal costs. See “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies” included in this Annual Report.

- We are currently in dispute with Apple surrounding what we believe is an attempt by Apple to reduce the amount of royalties that its contract manufacturers are required to pay to us for use of our intellectual property. QTL revenues and EBT in fiscal 2017 were negatively impacted as a result of actions taken by Apple and its contract manufacturers. Such contract manufacturers did not fully report and did not pay royalties due on sales of Apple products for a portion of the fiscal year. We have taken action against Apple’s contract manufacturers to compel such licensees to pay the required royalties, and against Apple. Additionally, QTL revenues and EBT in fiscal 2017 were negatively impacted by the previously disclosed dispute with another licensee, who did not fully report or fully pay royalties due in the last three quarters of fiscal 2017. We expect these companies will continue to take such actions in the future, resulting in increased legal costs and negatively impacting our future revenues, as well as our financial condition, results of operations and cash flows until the respective disputes are resolved.
- We continue to believe that certain licensees, particularly in China, are not fully complying with their contractual obligations to report their sales of licensed products to us, and certain companies, including unlicensed companies, particularly in emerging regions, including China, are delaying execution of new license agreements. We have made substantial progress in reaching agreements with many companies, primarily in China. However, negotiations with certain licensees and unlicensed companies are ongoing. We believe that the conclusion of new agreements with these companies will result in improved reporting by these licensees, including with respect to sales of three-mode devices (i.e., devices that implement GSM, TD-SCDMA and LTE-TDD) sold in China. Additionally, we believe our increased efforts in the areas of compliance will improve reporting, but will also result in increased costs to the business. Litigation and/or other actions, such as those recently taken against Apple and its contract manufacturers, may be necessary to compel licensees to report and pay the required royalties for sales they have not previously reported and/or to compel unlicensed companies to execute licenses. Such litigation or other actions would result in increased legal costs.
- We expect our business, particularly QCT, to continue to be impacted by industry dynamics, including:
 - Concentration of device share among a few companies within the premium tier, resulting in significant supply chain leverage for those companies;
 - Decisions by companies to utilize their own internally-developed integrated circuit products and/or sell such products to others, including by bundling with other products, increasing competition;
 - Decisions by certain companies to utilize our competitors’ integrated circuit products in all or a portion of their devices. For example, commencing with the iPhone 7 (which was released in September 2016), we are no longer the sole supplier of modems for new iPhone product launches, as Apple utilizes modems from one of our competitors in a portion of such devices. We expect that in the future Apple will utilize our competitors’ modems in a portion of (or potentially all) iPhones. Accordingly, QCT revenues from modem sales for iPhones declined in fiscal 2017 and may continue to decline in the future, in part depending on the extent of Apple’s utilization of competitors’ modems and the mix of the various versions that are sold. Overall QCT revenues, as well as profitability, may similarly decline unless offset by sales of integrated circuit products to other customers, including those outside of traditional cellular industries, such as automotive, IoT and networking. Apple’s dual sourcing does not impact our licensing revenues since our licensing revenues from Apple products are not dependent upon whether such products include our chipsets;
 - Intense competition, particularly in China, as our competitors expand their product offerings and/or reduce the prices of their products as part of a strategy to attract new and/or retain existing customers; and
 - Lengthening replacement cycles in developed regions, where the smartphone industry is mature, premium-tier smartphones are common and consumer demand is increasingly driven by new product launches and/or innovation cycles, and from increasing consumer demand in emerging regions where premium-tier smartphones are less common and replacement cycles are on average longer than in developed regions.
- Consumer demand for 3G/4G smartphone products is increasing in emerging regions driven by availability of lower-tier 3G/4G devices. We expect the ongoing rollout of 4G services in emerging regions will encourage competition and growth, bringing the benefits of 3G/4G LTE multimode to consumers.
- We continue to invest significant resources toward advancements in 4G LTE and 5G technologies, OFDM-based WLAN technologies, wireless baseband chips, our converged computing/communications (Snapdragon) chips, radio

RFFE, connectivity, power management, graphics, audio and video codecs, multimedia products and software, which contribute to the expansion of our intellectual property portfolio. We are also investing in targeted opportunities that leverage our existing technical and business expertise to deploy new business models and enter and/or expand into new industry segments, such as products for automotive, IoT (including the connected home, smart cities, wearables, voice and music and robotics), data center, networking, computing and machine learning, among others.

In addition to the foregoing business and market-based matters, we continue to devote resources to working with and educating participants in the wireless value chain and governments as to the benefits of our business model and our extensive technology investments in promoting a highly competitive and innovative wireless industry. However, we expect that certain companies may continue to be dissatisfied with the need to pay reasonable royalties for the use of our technology and not welcome the success of our business model in enabling new, highly cost-effective competitors to their products. We expect that such companies, and/or governments or regulators, will continue to challenge our business model in various forums throughout the world.

Further discussion of risks related to our business is presented in “Part I, Item 1A. Risk Factors” included in this Annual Report.

Liquidity and Capital Resources

On October 27, 2016, we announced a definitive agreement under which Qualcomm River Holdings will acquire NXP. Pursuant to the definitive agreement, Qualcomm River Holdings has commenced a tender offer to acquire all of the issued and outstanding common shares of NXP for \$110 per share in cash, for estimated total cash consideration to be paid to NXP’s shareholders of \$38 billion. The transaction is subject to receipt of regulatory approvals in various jurisdictions and other closing conditions. While we continue to work to close by the end of calendar 2017, the transaction may close in early 2018. In May 2017, we issued an aggregate principal amount of \$11.0 billion of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes with varying maturities, of which a portion will be used to fund the purchase price and other related transactions. In addition, we have secured \$4.0 billion in committed financing through a Term Loan Facility, which is expected to be drawn on at the close of the NXP transaction. The remaining amount will be funded with cash held by our foreign entities, which will result in the use of a substantial portion of our cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities.

Qualcomm River Holdings and NXP may terminate the definitive agreement under certain circumstances. If the definitive agreement is terminated by NXP in certain circumstances, NXP will be required to pay Qualcomm River Holdings a termination fee of \$1.25 billion. If the definitive agreement is terminated by Qualcomm River Holdings under certain circumstances involving the failure to obtain the required regulatory approvals or the failure of NXP to complete certain pre-closing reorganization steps in all material respects, Qualcomm River Holdings will be required to pay NXP a termination fee of \$2.0 billion. In November 2016, as required by the definitive agreement, we entered into four letters of credit for an aggregate amount of \$2.0 billion pursuant to which NXP will have the right to draw amounts to fund the potential termination fee payable to NXP. Each letter of credit is required to be fully cash collateralized in an amount equal to 100% of its face value through deposits with the issuers of the letters of credit. We are restricted from using the funds deposited as collateral while the letters of credit are outstanding. At September 24, 2017, the letters of credit were fully collateralized through bank time deposits and money market funds.

Our principal sources of liquidity are our existing cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities, cash generated from operations, cash provided by our debt programs and proceeds from the issuance of common stock under our stock option and employee stock purchase plans. The following table presents selected financial information related to our liquidity as of and for the years ended September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016 (in millions):

	2017	2016	\$ Change	% Change
Cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities	\$ 38,578	\$ 32,350	\$ 6,228	19%
Accounts receivable, net	3,632	2,219	1,413	64%
Inventories	2,035	1,556	479	31%
Short-term debt	2,495	1,749	746	43%
Long-term debt	19,398	10,008	9,390	94%
Net cash provided by operating activities	4,693	7,400	(2,707)	(37%)
Net cash provided (used) by investing activities	18,463	(3,488)	21,951	N/M
Net cash provided (used) by financing activities	5,879	(5,522)	11,401	N/M

N/M = Not meaningful

The net increase in cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities was primarily due to the proceeds from the issuance of unsecured floating-rate and fixed-rate notes in May 2017 of approximately \$10.95 billion, net of underwriting discounts and offering expenses, and net cash provided by operating activities, partially offset by \$3.3 billion in cash dividends paid, the deposit of \$2.0 billion that was used to collateralize the letters of credit related to our proposed acquisition of NXP, \$1.5 billion in payments to fund acquisitions and other investments, primarily related to our recently formed RF360 Holdings joint venture, \$1.3 billion in payments to repurchase shares of our common stock and \$751 million of net repayments of our outstanding commercial paper debt. Total cash provided by operating activities decreased primarily due to the \$940 million payment in connection with the BlackBerry arbitration and the \$927 million payment of the fine imposed by the KFTC, as well as changes in working capital related to an increase in accounts receivable and inventories and the timing of related payments. Total cash provided by operating activities was also impacted by actions taken by Apple and its contract manufacturers, as well as the previously disclosed dispute with another licensee, who did not report or pay royalties due in the third or fourth quarter of fiscal 2017.

Our days sales outstanding, on a consolidated basis, increased to 56 days at September 24, 2017 compared to 33 days at September 25, 2016. The increase in accounts receivable and the related days sales outstanding were primarily due to the short payment in the second quarter of fiscal 2017 of royalties reported by and deemed collectible from Apple's contract manufacturers. We expect these receivables to remain outstanding until we resolve our dispute with Apple. The increase in accounts receivable also resulted from the accounts receivable relating to our RF360 Holdings joint venture, increased revenues related to integrated circuits and the timing of the collection of payments from certain of our other licensees. The increase in inventories was primarily due to inventories relating to our RF360 Holdings joint venture and an increase in the overall quantity of units on hand, partially offset by lower average unit costs.

Our cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities at September 24, 2017 consisted of \$9.2 billion held by our United States-based entities and \$29.4 billion held by our foreign entities. Most of our cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities held by our foreign entities are indefinitely reinvested and would be subject to material tax effects if repatriated. However, we believe that our United States sources of cash and liquidity are sufficient to meet our business needs in the United States and do not expect that we will need to repatriate the funds.

We believe our current cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities, our expected cash flow generated from operations and our expected financing activities will satisfy our working and other capital requirements for at least the next 12 months based on our current business plans. Recent and expected working and other capital requirements, in addition to our proposed acquisition of NXP, also include the items described below.

- Our purchase obligations at September 24, 2017, some of which relate to research and development activities and capital expenditures, totaled \$4.3 billion and \$1.0 billion for fiscal 2018 and 2019, respectively, and \$0.5 billion thereafter.
- Our research and development expenditures were \$5.5 billion and \$5.2 billion during fiscal 2017 and 2016, respectively, and we expect to continue to invest heavily in research and development for new technologies, applications and services for voice and data communications.
- Cash outflows for capital expenditures were \$690 million and \$539 million during fiscal 2017 and 2016, respectively. We anticipate that capital expenditures will be higher in fiscal 2018 as compared to fiscal 2017, primarily due to an increase in estimated capital expenditures of approximately \$150 million for the full year impact of capital expenditures related to the manufacturing operations of our RF360 Holdings joint venture. We expect to

continue to incur capital expenditures in the future to support our business, including research and development activities. Future capital expenditures may be impacted by transactions that are currently not forecasted.

- The TFTC imposed a fine on us of approximately 23.4 billion Taiwan Dollars (approximately \$778 million based on exchange rates at September 24, 2017), which is due on or before November 7, 2017.
- We expect to continue making strategic investments and acquisitions, the amounts of which could vary significantly, to open new opportunities for our technologies, obtain development resources, grow our patent portfolio or pursue new businesses.

Debt. In November 2016, we amended and restated our existing Revolving Credit Facility that provides for unsecured revolving facility loans, swing line loans and letters of credit to increase the aggregate amount available to \$5.0 billion, of which \$530 million and \$4.47 billion will expire in February 2020 and November 2021, respectively. At September 24, 2017, no amounts were outstanding under the Amended and Restated Revolving Credit Facility.

We have an unsecured commercial paper program, which provides for the issuance of up to \$5.0 billion of commercial paper. Net proceeds from this program are used for general corporate purposes. At September 24, 2017, we had \$999 million of commercial paper outstanding with weighted-average net interest rates of 1.19% and weighted-average remaining days to maturity of 45 days.

In May 2017, we issued an aggregate principal amount of \$11.0 billion in nine tranches of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes, with maturity dates starting in 2019 through 2047 and effective interest rates between 1.80% and 4.47%. Net proceeds from the issuance of the notes of \$10.95 billion are intended to be used to fund a portion of the purchase price of our planned acquisition of NXP and other related transactions and also for general corporate purposes. Our 2019 floating-rate notes, 2020 floating-rate notes, 2019 fixed-rate notes and 2020 fixed-rate notes issued in May 2017 for an aggregate principal amount of \$4.0 billion are subject to a special mandatory redemption at a price equal to 101% of the aggregate principal amount, plus accrued and unpaid interest to, but excluding, the date of such mandatory redemption. The redemption is required on the first to occur of (i) the termination of the NXP purchase agreement or (ii) January 25, 2018 (which reflects the automatic extension of the original expiration date of October 27, 2017 in accordance with the NXP purchase agreement, and as such date may be further extended in accordance with the NXP purchase agreement to a date on or prior to June 1, 2018).

In May 2015, we issued an aggregate principal amount of \$10.0 billion in eight tranches of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes, with maturity dates in 2018 through 2045 and effective interest rates between 1.65% and 4.74%. Interest is payable in arrears quarterly for the floating-rate notes and semi-annually for the fixed-rate notes.

In November 2016, we entered into a Term Loan Facility that provides for senior unsecured delayed-draw term facility loans in an aggregate amount of \$4.0 billion. Proceeds from the Term Loan Facility, if drawn, will be used to finance, in part, the proposed acquisition of NXP. At September 24, 2017, no amounts were outstanding under the Term Loan Facility.

We may issue additional debt in the future. The amount and timing of such additional borrowings will be subject to a number of factors, including the cash flow generated by United States-based entities, acquisitions and strategic investments, acceptable interest rates and changes in corporate income tax law, among other factors. Additional information regarding our outstanding debt at September 24, 2017 is provided in this Annual Report in "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 6. Debt."

Capital Return Program. The following table summarizes stock repurchases and dividends paid during fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 (in millions, except per-share amounts):

	Stock Repurchase Program			Dividends		Total
	Shares	Average Price Paid Per Share	Amount	Per Share	Amount	Amount
2017	22.8	\$ 58.87	\$ 1,342	\$ 2.20	\$ 3,252	\$ 4,594
2016	73.8	53.16	3,922	2.02	2,990	6,912
2015	172.4	65.21	11,245	1.80	2,880	14,125

On March 9, 2015, we announced that we had been authorized to repurchase up to \$15 billion of our common stock. At September 24, 2017, \$1.6 billion remained authorized for repurchase under our stock repurchase program. As a result of our proposed acquisition of NXP and the pending use of a substantial portion of our cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities, we currently expect to repurchase shares in the next few years to offset dilution from the issuance of common stock under our employee benefit plans. We periodically evaluate repurchases as a means of returning capital to stockholders to determine when and if repurchases are in the best interests of our stockholders.

On October 10, 2017, we announced a cash dividend of \$0.57 per share on our common stock, payable on December 15, 2017 to stockholders of record as of the close of business on November 29, 2017. We intend to continue to use cash dividends as a means of returning capital to stockholders, subject to capital availability and our view that cash dividends are in the best interests of our stockholders, among other factors.

Contractual Obligations/Off-Balance Sheet Arrangements

We have no significant contractual obligations not fully recorded on our consolidated balance sheets or fully disclosed in the notes to our consolidated financial statements. We have no material off-balance sheet arrangements as defined in Regulation S-K 303(a)(4)(ii).

The following table summarizes the payments due by fiscal period for our outstanding contractual obligations at September 24, 2017 (in millions):

	Total	2018	2019-2020	2021-2022	Beyond 2022	No Expiration Date
Purchase obligations (1)	\$ 5,874	\$ 4,348	\$ 1,379	\$ 147	\$ —	\$ —
Operating lease obligations	445	98	184	108	55	—
Capital lease obligations (2)	44	14	27	3	—	—
Equity funding and financing commitments (3)	514	69	—	69	—	376
Long-term debt (4)	21,000	1,500	6,000	2,000	11,500	—
Other long-term liabilities (5)(6)	1,957	308	1,448	62	15	124
Total contractual obligations	\$ 29,834	\$ 6,337	\$ 9,038	\$ 2,389	\$ 11,570	\$ 500

- (1) Total purchase obligations included commitments to purchase integrated circuit product inventories of \$3.5 billion, \$846 million, \$286 million, \$72 million and \$27 million for each of the subsequent five years from fiscal 2018 through 2022, respectively; there were no such purchase commitments thereafter. Integrated circuit product inventory obligations represent purchase commitments for raw materials, semiconductor die, finished goods and manufacturing services, such as wafer bump, probe, assembly and final test. Under our manufacturing relationships with our foundry suppliers and assembly and test service providers, cancellation of outstanding purchase orders is generally allowed but requires payment of all costs incurred through the date of cancellation, and in some cases, incremental fees related to capacity underutilization.
- (2) Amounts represent future minimum lease payments including interest payments. Capital lease obligations are included in other liabilities in the consolidated balance sheet at September 24, 2017.
- (3) Certain of these commitments do not have fixed funding dates and are subject to certain conditions and have, therefore, been presented as having no expiration date. Commitments represent the maximum amounts to be funded under these arrangements; actual funding may be in lesser amounts or not at all.
- (4) The amounts noted herein represent contractual payments of principal only.
- (5) Certain long-term liabilities reflected on our balance sheet, such as unearned revenues, are not presented in this table because they do not require cash settlement in the future. Other long-term liabilities as presented in this table include the related current portions, as applicable.
- (6) Our consolidated balance sheet at September 24, 2017 included \$138 million in noncurrent liabilities for uncertain tax positions, some of which may result in cash payment. The future payments related to uncertain tax positions recorded as noncurrent liabilities have not been presented in the table above due to the uncertainty of the amounts and timing of cash settlement with the taxing authorities.

Additional information regarding our financial commitments at September 24, 2017 is provided in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 3. Income Taxes,” “Note 6. Debt” and “Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies.”

Critical Accounting Estimates

The preparation of our consolidated financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States requires us to make estimates and judgments that affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses, and disclosure of contingent assets and liabilities. We base our estimates on historical and anticipated results and trends and on various other assumptions that we believe are reasonable under the circumstances, including assumptions as to future events. By their nature, estimates are subject to an inherent degree of uncertainty. Although we believe that our estimates and the assumptions supporting our assessments are reasonable, actual results that differ from our estimates could be material to our consolidated financial statements. A summary of our significant accounting policies is included in this

Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 1. The Company and Its Significant Accounting Policies.” We consider the following accounting estimates to be critical in the preparation of our consolidated financial statements.

Impairment of Marketable Securities and Other Investments. We hold investments in marketable securities, with increases and decreases in fair value generally recorded through stockholders’ equity as other comprehensive income or loss. We record impairment losses in earnings when we believe an investment has experienced a decline that is other than temporary. During fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, we recorded \$131 million, \$112 million and \$163 million, respectively, in impairment losses on our investments in marketable securities. In connection with the proposed NXP transaction, during fiscal 2017, we divested a substantial portion of our marketable securities portfolio in order to finance, in part, that transaction. Given the change in our intention to sell certain marketable securities, we recognized other-than-temporary impairment losses in fiscal 2017 for such marketable securities and may recognize additional losses prior to the sale of such marketable securities still held at September 24, 2017. For the available-for-sale securities that are not expected to be sold to finance the NXP transaction, we concluded that the gross unrealized losses of \$1 million were temporary at September 24, 2017.

We also hold investments in non-marketable equity instruments in privately held companies that are accounted for using either the cost or the equity method. Many of these investments are in early-stage companies, which are inherently risky because the markets for the technologies or products of these companies are uncertain and may never develop. We monitor our investments for events or circumstances that could indicate the investments are impaired, such as a deterioration in the investee’s financial condition and business forecasts and lower valuations in recently completed or proposed financings, and we record impairment losses in earnings when we believe an investment has experienced a decline in value that is other than temporary.

Valuation of Inventories. Inventories are valued at the lower of cost or market (replacement cost, not to exceed net realizable value) using the first-in, first-out method. Recoverability of inventories is assessed based on review of future customer demand that considers multiple factors, including committed purchase orders from customers as well as purchase commitment projections provided by customers, among other things. This valuation also requires us to make judgments and assumptions based on information currently available about market conditions, including competition, product pricing, product life cycle and development plans. If we overestimate demand for our products, the amount of our loss will be impacted by our contractual ability to reduce inventory purchases from our suppliers. Our assumptions of future product demand are inherently uncertain, and changes in our estimates and assumptions may cause us to realize material write-downs in the future.

Valuation of Goodwill and Other Indefinite-Lived and Long-Lived Assets. Our business combinations typically result in the recording of goodwill, other intangible assets and property, plant and equipment, and the recorded values of those assets may become impaired in the future. We also acquire intangible assets and property, plant and equipment in other types of transactions. The determination of the recorded value of intangible assets acquired in a business combination requires management to make estimates and assumptions that affect our consolidated financial statements. For intangible assets acquired in a non-monetary exchange, the estimated fair values of the assets transferred (or the estimated fair values of the assets received, if more clearly evident) are used to establish their recorded values, unless the values of neither the assets received nor the assets transferred are determinable within reasonable limits, in which case the assets received are measured based on the carrying values of the assets transferred. Valuation techniques consistent with the market approach, income approach and/or cost approach are used to measure fair value. An estimate of fair value can be affected by many assumptions that require significant judgment. For example, the income approach generally requires us to use assumptions to estimate future cash flows including those related to total addressable market, pricing and share forecasts, competition, technology obsolescence, future tax rates and discount rates. Our estimate of the fair value of certain assets may differ materially from that determined by others who use different assumptions or utilize different business models and from the future cash flows actually realized.

Goodwill and other indefinite-lived intangible assets are tested annually for impairment and in interim periods if certain events occur indicating that the carrying amounts may be impaired. Long-lived assets, such as property, plant and equipment and intangible assets subject to amortization, are reviewed for impairment when there is evidence that events or changes in circumstances indicate that the carrying amount of an asset or asset group may not be recoverable. Our judgments regarding the existence of impairment indicators and future cash flows related to goodwill and other indefinite-lived intangible assets and long-lived assets may be based on operational performance of our businesses, market conditions, expected selling price and/or other factors. Although there are inherent uncertainties in this assessment process, the estimates and assumptions we use, including estimates of future cash flows and discount rates, are consistent with our internal planning, when appropriate. If these estimates or their related assumptions change in the future, we may be required to record an impairment charge on a

portion or all of our goodwill, other indefinite-lived intangible assets and/or long-lived assets. Furthermore, we cannot predict the occurrence of future impairment-triggering events nor the impact such events might have on our reported asset values. Future events could cause us to conclude that impairment indicators exist and that goodwill or other intangible assets associated with our acquired businesses are impaired. Any resulting impairment loss could have an adverse impact on our financial condition and results of operations. During fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, we recorded \$76 million, \$107 million and \$317 million, respectively, in impairment charges for goodwill, other indefinite-lived intangible assets and long-lived assets. The estimated fair values of our QCT and QTL reporting units were substantially in excess of their respective carrying values at September 24, 2017.

Legal and Regulatory Proceedings. We are currently involved in certain legal and regulatory proceedings, and we intend to continue to vigorously defend ourselves. However, the unfavorable resolution of one or more of these proceedings could have a material adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and/or cash flows. A broad range of remedies with respect to our business practices that are deemed to violate applicable laws are potentially available. These remedies may include, among others, injunctions, monetary damages or fines or other orders to pay money and the issuance of orders to cease certain conduct and/or to modify our business practices. We disclose a loss contingency if there is at least a reasonable possibility that a material loss has been incurred. We record our best estimate of a loss related to pending legal or regulatory proceedings when the loss is considered probable and the amount can be reasonably estimated. Where a range of loss can be reasonably estimated with no best estimate in the range, we record the minimum estimated liability. As additional information becomes available, we assess the potential liability, including the probability of loss related to pending legal or regulatory proceedings, and revise our estimates and update our disclosures accordingly. Significant judgment is required in both the determination of probability and the determination as to whether a loss is reasonably estimable. Revisions in our estimates of the potential liability could materially impact our results of operations.

Income Taxes. We are subject to income taxes in the United States and numerous foreign jurisdictions, and the assessment of our income tax positions involves dealing with uncertainties in the application of complex tax laws and regulations in various taxing jurisdictions. In addition, the application of tax laws and regulations is subject to legal and factual interpretation, judgment and uncertainty. Tax laws and regulations themselves are subject to change as a result of changes in fiscal policy, changes in legislation, the evolution of regulations and court rulings. Significant judgments and estimates are required in determining our provision for income taxes, including those related to tax incentives, intercompany research and development cost-sharing arrangements, transfer pricing and tax credits. While we believe we have appropriate support for the positions taken on our tax returns, we regularly assess the potential outcomes of examinations by taxing authorities in determining the adequacy of our provision for income taxes. Therefore, the actual liability for United States or foreign taxes may be materially different from our estimates, which could result in the need to record additional tax liabilities or potentially reverse previously recorded tax liabilities. We are participating in the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) Compliance Assurance Process program whereby we endeavor to agree with the IRS on the treatment of all issues prior to filing our federal return. A benefit of participation in this program is that post-filing adjustments by the IRS are less likely to occur.

Our QCT segment's non-United States headquarters is located in Singapore. We obtained tax incentives in Singapore that commenced in March 2012, including a tax exemption for the first five years, provided that we meet specified employment and incentive criteria, and as a result of the expiration of certain of these incentives, our Singapore tax rate increased in fiscal 2017 and will increase again in fiscal 2027 upon the expiration of the remaining incentives. Our failure to meet these criteria could adversely impact our provision for income taxes.

We consider the operating earnings of certain non-United States subsidiaries to be indefinitely reinvested outside the United States based on our plans for use and/or investment outside of the United States and our belief that our sources of cash and liquidity in the United States will be sufficient to meet future domestic cash needs. On a regular basis, we consider projected cash needs for, among other things, potential acquisitions, such as our proposed acquisition of NXP, investments in our existing businesses, future research and development and capital transactions, including repurchases of our common stock, dividends and debt repayments. We estimate the amount of cash or other liquidity that is available or needed in the jurisdictions where these investments are expected as well as our ability to generate cash in those jurisdictions and our access to capital markets. This analysis enables us to conclude whether or not we will indefinitely reinvest the current period's foreign earnings. We have not recorded a deferred tax liability of approximately \$13.7 billion related to the United States federal and state income taxes and foreign withholding taxes on approximately \$39.0 billion of undistributed earnings of certain non-United States subsidiaries indefinitely reinvested outside the United States. Should we decide to no longer indefinitely reinvest such earnings outside the United States, for example, if we determine that such earnings are needed to fund future domestic operations or there is not a sufficient need for such earnings outside of the United States, we would have to adjust the income tax provision in the period we make such determination.

Recent Accounting Pronouncements

Information regarding recent accounting pronouncements and the impact of those pronouncements, if any, on our consolidated financial statements is provided in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 1. The Company and Its Significant Accounting Policies.”

Item 7A. Quantitative and Qualitative Disclosures about Market Risk

Marketable Securities

We have made investments in marketable equity securities of companies of varying size, style, industry and geography and changes in investment allocations may affect the price volatility of our investments. On October 27, 2016, we announced a definitive agreement under which Qualcomm River Holdings will acquire NXP for estimated total cash consideration to be paid to NXP’s shareholders of \$38 billion. We intend to fund the transaction with cash held by our foreign entities as well as funds raised in connection with our May 2017 debt issuance, which will result in the use of a substantial portion of our cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities, as well as committed financing through a Term Loan Facility, which is expected to be drawn on at the close of the NXP transaction. As a result, during fiscal 2017, we divested a substantial portion of our marketable securities portfolio, including our equity securities and fund shares.

Equity Price Risk. The recorded values of our marketable equity securities and fund shares decreased to \$36 million at September 24, 2017 from \$1.7 billion at September 25, 2016. A 10% decrease in the market price of our marketable equity securities and fund shares at September 24, 2017 would have caused a negligible decrease in the carrying amounts of these securities. A 10% decrease in the market price of our marketable equity securities and fund shares at September 25, 2016 would have caused a decrease in the carrying amounts of these securities of \$175 million. At September 24, 2017, there were no gross unrealized losses of our marketable equity securities and fund shares.

Interest Rate Risk. We invest a portion of our cash in a number of diversified fixed- and floating-rate securities consisting of cash equivalents, marketable debt securities, debt funds and time deposits that are subject to interest rate risk. Changes in the general level of interest rates can affect the fair value of our investment portfolio. If interest rates in the general economy were to rise, our holdings could lose value. As a result of divesting a substantial portion of our marketable securities portfolio and changes in portfolio allocation, the fair value of our investment portfolio is subject to lower interest rate risk. At September 24, 2017, a hypothetical increase in interest rates of 100 basis points across the entire yield curve on our holdings would have resulted in a decrease of \$26 million in the fair value of our holdings. At September 25, 2016, a hypothetical increase in interest rates of 100 basis points across the entire yield curve on our holdings would have resulted in a decrease of \$501 million in the fair value of our holdings.

Other Investments

Equity Price Risk. We hold investments in non-marketable equity instruments in privately held companies that may be impacted by equity price risks. Volatility in the equity markets could negatively affect our investees’ ability to raise additional capital as well as our ability to realize value from our investments through initial public offerings, mergers and private sales. Consequently, we could incur other-than-temporary impairment losses or realized losses on all or a part of the values of our non-marketable equity investments. At September 24, 2017, the aggregate carrying value of our non-marketable equity investments was \$982 million and was included in other noncurrent assets. At September 25, 2016, the aggregate carrying value of our non-marketable equity investments was \$855 million and was included in other noncurrent assets.

Debt and Interest Rate Swap Agreements

Interest Rate Risk. In May 2017, we issued an aggregate principal amount of \$11.0 billion of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes with varying maturity dates. In 2015, we issued an aggregate principal amount of \$10.0 billion of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes with varying maturity dates and entered into interest rate swaps with an aggregate notional amount of \$3.0 billion to effectively convert certain fixed-rate interest payments into floating-rate payments. The interest rates on our floating-rate notes and interest rate swaps are based on LIBOR. By issuing additional floating-rate notes in fiscal 2017, our assumed risks associated with variable interest rates based on LIBOR have increased. At September 24, 2017, a hypothetical increase in LIBOR-based interest rates of 100 basis points would cause our interest expense to increase by \$46 million on an annualized basis as it relates to our floating-rate notes and interest rate swap agreements. At September 25, 2016, a hypothetical increase in LIBOR-based interest rates of 100 basis points would have caused our interest expense to increase by \$30 million on an annualized basis as it relates to our floating-rate notes and interest rate swap agreements.

Additionally, we have a commercial paper program that provides for the issuance of up to \$5.0 billion of commercial paper. At September 24, 2017, we had \$999 million of commercial paper outstanding, with original maturities of less than

three months. Changes in interest rates could affect the amounts of interest that we pay if we refinance the current outstanding commercial paper with new debt.

Additional information regarding our notes and related interest rate swap agreements and commercial paper program is provided in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 1. The Company and Its Significant Accounting Policies” and “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 6. Debt.”

Foreign Exchange Risk

We manage our exposure to foreign exchange market risks, when deemed appropriate, through the use of derivative financial instruments, including foreign currency forward and option contracts with financial counterparties. We utilize such derivative financial instruments for hedging or risk management purposes rather than for speculative purposes. Counterparties to our derivative contracts are all major banking institutions. In the event of the financial insolvency or distress of a counterparty to our derivative financial instruments, we may be unable to settle transactions if the counterparty does not provide us with sufficient collateral to secure its net settlement obligations to us, which could have a negative impact on our results. A description of our foreign currency accounting policies is provided in this Annual Report in “Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements, Note 1. The Company and Its Significant Accounting Policies.”

At September 24, 2017, our net liability related to foreign currency options designated as hedges of foreign currency risk on royalties earned from certain licensees was \$15 million. If our forecasted royalty revenues for currencies in which we hedge were to decline by 20% and foreign exchange rates were to change unfavorably by 20% in our hedged foreign currency, we would not incur a loss as our hedge positions would continue to be fully effective.

At September 24, 2017, our net asset related to foreign currency option and forward contracts designated as hedges of foreign currency risk on certain operating expenditure transactions was negligible. If our forecasted operating expenditures for currencies in which we hedge were to decline by 20% and foreign exchange rates were to change unfavorably by 20% in our hedged foreign currency, we would incur a negligible loss.

Financial assets and liabilities held by consolidated subsidiaries that are not denominated in the functional currency of those entities are subject to the effects of currency fluctuations and may affect reported earnings. As a global company, we face exposure to adverse movements in foreign currency exchange rates. We may hedge currency exposures associated with certain assets and liabilities denominated in nonfunctional currencies and certain anticipated nonfunctional currency transactions. As a result, we could experience unanticipated gains or losses on anticipated foreign currency cash flows, as well as economic loss with respect to the recoverability of investments. While we may hedge certain transactions with non-United States customers, declines in currency values in certain regions may, if not reversed, adversely affect future product sales because our products may become more expensive to purchase in the countries of the affected currencies.

At September 24, 2017, our net liability related to foreign currency option and forward contracts not designated as hedging instruments used to manage foreign currency risk on certain receivables and payables was negligible. If the foreign exchange rates were to change unfavorably by 20% in our hedged foreign currency, we would not incur a loss as the change in the fair value of the foreign currency option and forward contracts would be offset by the change in fair value of the related receivables and payables being economically hedged.

Our analysis methods used to assess and mitigate the risks discussed above should not be considered projections of future risks.

Item 8. Financial Statements and Supplementary Data

Our consolidated financial statements at September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016 and for each of the three years in the period ended September 24, 2017 and the Report of PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP, Independent Registered Public Accounting Firm, are included in this Annual Report on pages F-1 through F-44.

Item 9. Changes in and Disagreements with Accountants on Accounting and Financial Disclosure

None.

Item 9A. Controls and Procedures

Conclusion Regarding the Effectiveness of Disclosure Controls and Procedures

Under the supervision and with the participation of our management, including our principal executive officer and principal financial officer, we conducted an evaluation of our disclosure controls and procedures, as such terms are defined under Rule 13a-15(e) promulgated under the Securities Exchange Act of 1934, as amended (the Exchange Act). Based on this

evaluation, our principal executive officer and our principal financial officer concluded that our disclosure controls and procedures were effective as of the end of the period covered by this Annual Report.

Management's Report on Internal Control over Financial Reporting

Our management is responsible for establishing and maintaining adequate internal control over financial reporting, as such term is defined in Exchange Act Rule 13a-15(f). Under the supervision and with the participation of our management, including our principal executive officer and principal financial officer, we conducted an evaluation of the effectiveness of our internal control over financial reporting based on the framework in *Internal Control — Integrated Framework (2013)* issued by the Committee of Sponsoring Organizations of the Treadway Commission. Based on our evaluation under this framework, our management concluded that our internal control over financial reporting was effective as of September 24, 2017 .

PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP, the independent registered public accounting firm that audited the consolidated financial statements included in this Annual Report, has also audited the effectiveness of our internal control over financial reporting as of September 24, 2017 , as stated in its report which appears on page F-1.

Inherent Limitations over Internal Controls

Our internal control over financial reporting is designed to provide reasonable assurance regarding the reliability of financial reporting and the preparation of consolidated financial statements for external purposes in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles. Our internal control over financial reporting includes those policies and procedures that:

- i. pertain to the maintenance of records that, in reasonable detail, accurately and fairly reflect the transactions and dispositions of our assets;
- ii. provide reasonable assurance that transactions are recorded as necessary to permit preparation of consolidated financial statements in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles, and that our receipts and expenditures are being made only in accordance with authorizations of our management and directors; and
- iii. provide reasonable assurance regarding prevention or timely detection of unauthorized acquisition, use or disposition of our assets that could have a material effect on the consolidated financial statements.

Internal control over financial reporting cannot provide absolute assurance of achieving financial reporting objectives because of its inherent limitations, including the possibility of human error and circumvention by collusion or overriding of controls. Accordingly, even an effective internal control system may not prevent or detect material misstatements on a timely basis. Also, projections of any evaluation of effectiveness to future periods are subject to the risk that controls may become inadequate because of changes in conditions or that the degree of compliance with the policies or procedures may deteriorate.

Changes in Internal Control over Financial Reporting

There were no changes in our internal control over financial reporting during the fourth quarter of fiscal 2017 that have materially affected, or are reasonably likely to materially affect, our internal control over financial reporting.

Item 9B. Other Information

None.

Part III

Item 10. Directors, Executive Officers and Corporate Governance

The information required by this item regarding directors is incorporated by reference to our Definitive Proxy Statement to be filed with the Securities and Exchange Commission in connection with our 2018 Annual Meeting of Stockholders (the 2018 Proxy Statement) under the headings "Nominees for Election" and "Section 16(a) Beneficial Ownership Reporting Compliance." Certain information required by this item regarding executive officers is set forth in Item 1 of Part I of this Report under the caption "Executive Officers," and certain information is incorporated by reference to the 2018 Proxy Statement under the heading "Section 16(a) Beneficial Ownership Reporting Compliance." The information required by this item regarding corporate governance is incorporated by reference to the 2018 Proxy Statement under the headings "Code of Ethics and Corporate Governance Principles and Practices," "Director Nominations" and "Board Meetings, Committees and Attendance."

Item 11. Executive Compensation

The information required by this item is incorporated by reference to the 2018 Proxy Statement under the headings “Executive Compensation and Related Information,” “Compensation Tables and Narrative Disclosures,” “Director Compensation,” “Compensation Committee Interlocks and Insider Participation in Compensation Decisions” and “Compensation Committee Report.”

Item 12. Security Ownership of Certain Beneficial Owners and Management and Related Stockholder Matters

The information required by this item is incorporated by reference to the 2018 Proxy Statement under the headings “Equity Compensation Plan Information” and “Stock Ownership of Certain Beneficial Owners and Management.”

Item 13. Certain Relationships and Related Transactions, and Director Independence

The information required by this item is incorporated by reference to the 2018 Proxy Statement under the headings “Certain Relationships and Related-Person Transactions” and “Director Independence.”

Item 14. Principal Accounting Fees and Services

The information required by this item is incorporated by reference to the 2018 Proxy Statement under the heading “Fees for Professional Services” and “Policy on Audit Committee Pre-Approval of Audit and Non-Audit Services of Independent Public Accountants.”

PART IV

Item 15. Exhibits and Financial Statement Schedules

The following documents are filed as part of this report:

(a) Financial Statements:

	Page Number
(1) Report of Independent Registered Public Accounting Firm	F-1
Consolidated Balance Sheets at September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016	F-2
Consolidated Statements of Operations for Fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015	F-3
Consolidated Statements of Comprehensive Income for Fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015	F-4
Consolidated Statements of Cash Flows for Fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015	F-5
Consolidated Statements of Stockholders’ Equity for Fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015	F-6
Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements	F-7
(2) Schedule II - Valuation and Qualifying Accounts	S-1

Financial statement schedules other than those listed above have been omitted because they are either not required, not applicable or the information is otherwise included in the notes to the consolidated financial statements.

(b) Exhibits

Exhibit Number	Exhibit Description	Form	File No./ Film No.	Date of First Filing	Exhibit Number	Filed Herewith
2.1	Rule 2.7 Announcement, Recommended Cash Acquisition of CSR plc by Qualcomm Global Trading Pte. Ltd.	8-K	000-19528/ 141156425	10/15/2014	2.1	
2.2	Master Transaction Agreement, dated January 13, 2016, by and among Qualcomm Global Trading Pte. Ltd., each other Purchaser Group member, TDK Japan, each other Seller Group member, and, solely for purposes of Section 10.9 thereof, QUALCOMM Incorporated. (1)	8-K	000-19528/ 161339867	1/13/2016	2.1	

Exhibit Number	Exhibit Description	Form	File No./ Film No.	Date of First Filing	Exhibit Number	Filed Herewith
2.3	Amendment #1, dated December 20, 2016, to Master Transaction Agreement, dated January 13, 2016, by and among Qualcomm Global Trading Pte. Ltd., each other Purchaser Group member, TDK Japan, each other Seller Group member, and, solely for purposes of Section 10.9 thereof, QUALCOMM Incorporated. (1)	10-Q	000-19528/ 17546539	1/25/2017	2.3	
2.4	Amendment #2, dated January 19, 2017, to Master Transaction Agreement, dated January 13, 2016, by and among Qualcomm Global Trading Pte. Ltd., each other Purchaser Group member, TDK Japan, each other Seller Group member, and, solely for purposes of Section 10.9 thereof, QUALCOMM Incorporated. (1)	10-Q	000-19528/ 17546539	1/25/2017	2.4	
2.5	Amendment #3, dated February 3, 2017, to Master Transaction Agreement, dated January 13, 2016, by and among Qualcomm Global Trading Pte. Ltd., each other Purchaser Group member, TDK Japan, each other Seller Group member, and, solely for purposes of Section 10.9 thereof, QUALCOMM Incorporated. (1)	10-Q	000-19528/ 17770305	4/19/2017	2.6	
2.6	Purchase Agreement dated as of October 27, 2016 by and between Qualcomm River Holdings, B.V. and NXP Semiconductors N.V. (1)	8-K	000-19528/ 161956228	10/27/2016	2.1	
3.1	Restated Certificate of Incorporation, as amended.	10-Q	000-19528/ 161775595	7/20/2016	3.1	
3.2	Amended and Restated Bylaws.	8-K	000-19528/ 161769723	7/15/2016	3.2	
4.1	Indenture, dated May 20, 2015, between the Company and U.S. Bank National Association, as trustee.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.1	
4.2	Officers' Certificate, dated May 20, 2015, for the Floating Rate Notes due 2018, the Floating Rate Notes due 2020, the 1.400% Notes due 2018, the 2.250% Notes due 2020, the 3.000% Notes due 2022, the 3.450% Notes due 2025, the 4.650% Notes due 2035 and the 4.800% Notes due 2045.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.2	
4.3	Form of Floating Rate Notes due 2018.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.3	
4.4	Form of Floating Rate Notes due 2020.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.4	
4.5	Form of 1.400% Notes due 2018.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.5	
4.6	Form of 2.250% Notes due 2020.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.6	
4.7	Form of 3.000% Notes due 2022.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.7	
4.8	Form of 3.450% Notes due 2025.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.8	
4.9	Form of 4.650% Notes due 2035.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.9	
4.10	Form of 4.800% Notes due 2045.	8-K	000-19528/ 15880967	5/21/2015	4.10	
4.11	Officers' Certificate, dated May 26, 2017, for the Floating Rate Notes due 2019, the Floating Rate Notes due 2020, the Floating Rate Notes due 2023, the 1.850% Notes due 2019, the 2.100% Notes due 2020, the 2.600% Notes due 2023, the 2.900% Notes due 2024, the 3.250% Notes due 2027 and the 4.300% Notes due 2047.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.2	
4.12	Form of Floating Rate Notes due 2019.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.3	
4.13	Form of Floating Rate Notes due 2020.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.4	
4.14	Form of Floating Rate Notes due 2023.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.5	

Exhibit Number	Exhibit Description	Form	File No./ Film No.	Date of First Filing	Exhibit Number	Filed Herewith
4.15	Form of 1.850% Notes due 2019.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.6	
4.16	Form of 2.100% Notes due 2020.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.7	
4.17	Form of 2.600% Notes due 2023.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.8	
4.18	Form of 2.900% Notes due 2024.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.9	
4.19	Form of 3.250% Notes due 2027.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.10	
4.20	Form of 4.300% Notes due 2047.	8-K	000-19528/ 17882336	5/31/2017	4.11	
10.1	Form of Indemnity Agreement between the Company and its directors and officers. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 151197257	11/4/2015	10.1	
10.2	Form of Grant Notice and Stock Option Agreement under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 091159213	11/5/2009	10.84	
10.3	Atheros Communications, Inc. 2004 Stock Incentive Plan, as amended. (2)	S-8	333-174649/ 11886141	6/1/2011	99.1	
10.4	Resolutions Amending Atheros Communications, Inc. Equity Plans. (2)	S-8	333-174649/ 11886141	6/1/2011	99.6	
10.5	Form of Grant Notices and Global Employee Stock Option Agreement under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 121186937	11/7/2012	10.104	
10.6	Form of Grant Notices and Global Employee Restricted Stock Unit Agreement under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 121186937	11/7/2012	10.105	
10.7	2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan, as amended and restated. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 13779468	4/24/2013	10.112	
10.8	Form of Aircraft Time Sharing Agreement. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 13983769	7/24/2013	10.114	
10.9	Form of Grant Notices and Non-Employee Director Restricted Stock Unit Agreements under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan for non-employee directors residing in the United Kingdom and Hong Kong. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 131196747	11/6/2013	10.117	
10.10	Form of Grant Notices and Non-Employee Director Deferred Stock Unit Agreements under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan for non-employee directors residing in the United States and Spain. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 131196747	11/6/2013	10.119	
10.11	Form of Non-Employee Director Deferred Stock Unit Grant Notices and Deferred Stock Unit Agreement under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan for non-employee directors residing in Singapore. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 14988939	7/23/2014	10.122	
10.12	Form of Executive Restricted Stock Unit Grant Notice and Executive Restricted Stock Unit Agreements under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan, which includes a September 29, 2014 to March 29, 2015 performance period. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 14988939	7/23/2014	10.123	
10.13	Non-Qualified Deferred Compensation Plan, as amended, effective January 1, 2016. (2)	8-K	000-19528/ 151134109	9/30/2015	10.1	
10.14	Amendment to 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan, as amended and restated. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 15555092	1/28/2015	10.126	
10.15	Amended and Restated QUALCOMM Incorporated 2001 Employee Stock Purchase Plan, as amended. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 151000141	7/22/2015	10.128	
10.16	Revolving Credit Agreement among Qualcomm Incorporated, the lenders party thereto and Bank of America, N.A., as Administrative Agent, Swing Line Lender and Letter of Credit Issuer, dated as of February 18, 2015.	8-K	000-19528/ 15628813	2/18/2015	10.1	
10.17	Form of Executive Performance Stock Unit Grant Notice and Executive Performance Stock Unit agreement under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan, which includes a September 29, 2014 to September 24, 2017 performance period. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 151197257	11/4/2015	10.27	

Exhibit Number	Exhibit Description	Form	File No./ Film No.	Date of First Filing	Exhibit Number	Filed Herewith
<u>10.18</u>	Form of Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Grant Notice and Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Grant Agreement under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan, which includes a September 28, 2015 to September 28, 2018 performance period. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 151197257	11/4/2015	10.28	
<u>10.19</u>	Form of 2016 Annual Cash Incentive Plan Performance Unit Agreement. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 161365251	1/27/2016	10.29	
<u>10.20</u>	2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan. (2)	DEF 14A	000-19528/ 161353677	1/21/2016	Appendix 5	
<u>10.21</u>	Form of Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Grant Notice under the 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan, which includes a March 28, 2016 to March 28, 2019 performance period. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 161581558	4/20/2016	10.31	
<u>10.22</u>	Form of Non-Employee Director Deferred Stock Unit Grant Notices and Non-Employee Director Deferred Stock Unit Agreements under the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan for non-employee directors residing in the United States. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 161581558	4/20/2016	10.32	
<u>10.23</u>	Form of Non-Employee Director Deferred Stock Unit Grant Notices and Non-Employee Director Deferred Stock Unit Agreements under the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan for non-employee directors residing in Spain. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 161581558	4/20/2016	10.33	
<u>10.24</u>	Form of Non-Employee Director Deferred Stock Unit Grant Notices and Non-Employee Director Deferred Stock Unit Agreements under the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan for non-employee directors residing in Singapore. (2)	10-Q	000-19528/ 161581558	4/20/2016	10.34	
<u>10.25</u>	Qualcomm Incorporated 2017 Director Compensation Plan. (2)	8-K	000-19528/ 161931217	10/11/2016	99.1	
<u>10.26</u>	Form of Executive Restricted Stock Unit Grant Notice and Executive Restricted Stock Unit Agreement under the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 161967933	11/2/2016	10.36	
<u>10.27</u>	Form of Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Grant Notice and Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Agreement under the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan. (2)	10-K	000-19528/ 161967933	11/2/2016	10.37	
<u>10.28</u>	Executive Performance Unit Award Grant Notice and Executive Performance Unit Award Agreement under the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan for Derek K. Aberle. (2) (3)	10-K	000-19528/ 161967933	11/2/2016	10.38	
<u>10.29</u>	Letter Agreement, dated as of October 27, 2016, by and between QUALCOMM Incorporated and Qualcomm River Holdings B.V.	8-K	000-19528/ 161956228	10/27/2016	10.1	
<u>10.30</u>	Credit Agreement among QUALCOMM Incorporated, the lenders party thereto and Goldman Sachs Bank USA, as Administrative Agent, dated as of November 8, 2016.	8-K	000-19528/ 161985209	11/9/2016	10.1	
<u>10.31</u>	Amended and Restated Credit Agreement among QUALCOMM Incorporated, the lenders party thereto and Bank of America, N.A., as Administrative Agent, dated as of November 8, 2016.	8-K	000-19528/ 161985209	11/9/2016	10.2	
<u>10.32</u>	Letter of Credit and Reimbursement Agreement between Qualcomm River Holdings B.V. and Mizuho Bank, Ltd., dated as of November 22, 2016.	8-K	000-19528/ 162023573	11/29/2016	10.1	
<u>10.33</u>	First Amendment to Letter of Credit and Reimbursement Agreement between Qualcomm River Holdings B.V. and Mizuho Bank, Ltd., dated as of November 23, 2016.	8-K	000-19528/ 162023573	11/29/2016	10.2	
<u>10.34</u>	Continuing Agreement for Standby Letters of Credit between Qualcomm River Holdings B.V. and The Bank of Tokyo-Mitsubishi UFJ, Ltd., dated as of November 22, 2016.	8-K	000-19528/ 162023573	11/29/2016	10.3	
<u>10.35</u>	Reimbursement and Security Agreement between Qualcomm River Holdings B.V. and Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation, dated as of November 22, 2016.	8-K	000-19528/ 162023573	11/29/2016	10.4	

Exhibit Number	Exhibit Description	Form	File No./ Film No.	Date of First Filing	Exhibit Number	Filed Herewith
<u>10.36</u>	Letter of Credit Application by QUALCOMM Incorporated to Bank of America, N.A., dated as of November 23, 2016.	8-K	000-19528/162023573	11/29/2016	10.5	
<u>10.37</u>	Form of 2017 Annual Cash Incentive Plan Performance Unit Agreement (2)	10-Q	000-19528/17546539	1/25/2017	10.47	
<u>10.38</u>	Qualcomm Incorporated 2018 Director Compensation Plan. (2)					X
<u>10.39</u>	Form of Executive Restricted Stock Unit Grant Notice and Executive Restricted Stock Unit Agreement under the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan, which includes a September 25, 2017 to March 25, 2018 performance period. (2)					X
<u>10.40</u>	Form of Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Grant Notice and Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Agreement under the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan, which includes a September 25, 2017 to September 27, 2020 performance period. (2)					X
<u>12.1</u>	Computation of Ratio of Earnings to Fixed Charges.					X
<u>21</u>	Subsidiaries of the Registrant.					X
<u>23.1</u>	Consent of Independent Registered Public Accounting Firm.					X
<u>31.1</u>	Certification pursuant to Section 302 of the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002 for Steve Mollenkopf.					X
<u>31.2</u>	Certification pursuant to Section 302 of the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002 for George S. Davis.					X
<u>32.1</u>	Certification pursuant to 18 U.S.C. Section 1350, as adopted pursuant to Section 906 of the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002, for Steve Mollenkopf.					X
<u>32.2</u>	Certification pursuant to 18 U.S.C. Section 1350, as adopted pursuant to Section 906 of the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002, for George S. Davis.					X
101.INS	XBRL Instance Document.					X
101.SCH	XBRL Taxonomy Extension Schema.					X
101.CAL	XBRL Taxonomy Extension Calculation Linkbase.					X
101.LAB	XBRL Taxonomy Extension Labels Linkbase.					X
101.PRE	XBRL Taxonomy Extension Presentation Linkbase.					X
101.DEF	XBRL Taxonomy Extension Definition Linkbase.					X

- (1) The Company shall furnish supplementally a copy of any omitted schedule to the Commission upon request.
- (2) Indicates management contract or compensatory plan or arrangement required to be identified pursuant to Item 15(a).
- (3) Confidential treatment has been requested with respect to certain portions of this exhibit.

Item 16. Form 10-K Summary

None.

SIGNATURES

Pursuant to the requirements of Section 13 or 15(d) of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934, the registrant has duly caused this report to be signed on its behalf by the undersigned, thereunto duly authorized.

November 1, 2017

QUALCOMM Incorporated

By /s/ Steve Mollenkopf
Steve Mollenkopf
Chief Executive Officer

Pursuant to the requirements of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934, this Report has been signed below by the following persons on behalf of the registrant and in the capacities and on the dates indicated:

Signature	Title	Date
<u>/s/ Steve Mollenkopf</u> Steve Mollenkopf	Chief Executive Officer and Director (Principal Executive Officer)	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ George S. Davis</u> George S. Davis	Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer (Principal Financial and Accounting Officer)	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Barbara T. Alexander</u> Barbara T. Alexander	Director	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Jeffrey W. Henderson</u> Jeffrey W. Henderson	Director	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Thomas W. Horton</u> Thomas W. Horton	Director	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Paul E. Jacobs</u> Paul E. Jacobs	Chairman	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Ann M. Livermore</u> Ann M. Livermore	Director	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Harish Manwani</u> Harish Manwani	Director	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Mark D. McLaughlin</u> Mark D. McLaughlin	Director	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Clark T. Randt, Jr.</u> Clark T. Randt, Jr.	Director	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Francisco Ros</u> Francisco Ros	Director	November 1, 2017
<u>/s/ Anthony J. Vinciguerra</u> Anthony J. Vinciguerra	Director	November 1, 2017

Report of Independent Registered Public Accounting Firm

To the Board of Directors and Stockholders of QUALCOMM Incorporated:

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements listed in the index appearing under Item 15(a)(1) present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of QUALCOMM Incorporated and its subsidiaries as of September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016, and the results of their operations and their cash flows for each of the three years in the period ended September 24, 2017 in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. In addition, in our opinion, the financial statement schedule listed in the index appearing under Item 15(a)(2) presents fairly, in all material respects, the information set forth therein when read in conjunction with the related consolidated financial statements. Also in our opinion, the Company maintained, in all material respects, effective internal control over financial reporting as of September 24, 2017, based on criteria established in *Internal Control - Integrated Framework (2013)* issued by the Committee of Sponsoring Organizations of the Treadway Commission (COSO). The Company's management is responsible for these financial statements and financial statement schedule, for maintaining effective internal control over financial reporting and for its assessment of the effectiveness of internal control over financial reporting, included in the accompanying Management's Report on Internal Control over Financial Reporting. Our responsibility is to express opinions on these financial statements, on the financial statement schedule and on the Company's internal control over financial reporting based on our integrated audits. We conducted our audits in accordance with the standards of the Public Company Accounting Oversight Board (United States). Those standards require that we plan and perform the audits to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement and whether effective internal control over financial reporting was maintained in all material respects. Our audits of the financial statements included examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements, assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, and evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. Our audit of internal control over financial reporting included obtaining an understanding of internal control over financial reporting, assessing the risk that a material weakness exists, and testing and evaluating the design and operating effectiveness of internal control based on the assessed risk. Our audits also included performing such other procedures as we considered necessary in the circumstances. We believe that our audits provide a reasonable basis for our opinions.

A company's internal control over financial reporting is a process designed to provide reasonable assurance regarding the reliability of financial reporting and the preparation of financial statements for external purposes in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles. A company's internal control over financial reporting includes those policies and procedures that (i) pertain to the maintenance of records that, in reasonable detail, accurately and fairly reflect the transactions and dispositions of the assets of the company; (ii) provide reasonable assurance that transactions are recorded as necessary to permit preparation of financial statements in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles, and that receipts and expenditures of the company are being made only in accordance with authorizations of management and directors of the company; and (iii) provide reasonable assurance regarding prevention or timely detection of unauthorized acquisition, use, or disposition of the company's assets that could have a material effect on the financial statements.

Because of its inherent limitations, internal control over financial reporting may not prevent or detect misstatements. Also, projections of any evaluation of effectiveness to future periods are subject to the risk that controls may become inadequate because of changes in conditions, or that the degree of compliance with the policies or procedures may deteriorate.

/s/ PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP

San Diego, California

November 1, 2017

QUALCOMM Incorporated
CONSOLIDATED BALANCE SHEETS
(In millions, except per share data)

	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
ASSETS		
Current assets:		
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 35,029	\$ 5,946
Marketable securities	2,279	12,702
Accounts receivable, net	3,632	2,219
Inventories	2,035	1,556
Other current assets	618	558
Total current assets	43,593	22,981
Marketable securities	1,270	13,702
Deferred tax assets	2,900	2,030
Property, plant and equipment, net	3,216	2,306
Goodwill	6,623	5,679
Other intangible assets, net	3,737	3,500
Other assets	4,147	2,161
Total assets	\$ 65,486	\$ 52,359
LIABILITIES AND STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY		
Current liabilities:		
Trade accounts payable	\$ 1,971	\$ 1,858
Payroll and other benefits related liabilities	1,183	934
Unearned revenues	502	509
Short-term debt	2,495	1,749
Other current liabilities	4,756	2,261
Total current liabilities	10,907	7,311
Unearned revenues	2,003	2,377
Long-term debt	19,398	10,008
Other liabilities	2,432	895
Total liabilities	34,740	20,591
Commitments and contingencies (Note 7)		
Stockholders' equity:		
Qualcomm stockholders' equity:		
Preferred stock, \$0.0001 par value; 8 shares authorized; none outstanding	—	—
Common stock and paid-in capital, \$0.0001 par value; 6,000 shares authorized; 1,474 and 1,476 shares issued and outstanding, respectively	274	414
Retained earnings	30,088	30,936
Accumulated other comprehensive income	384	428
Total Qualcomm stockholders' equity	30,746	31,778
Noncontrolling interests	—	(10)
Total stockholders' equity	30,746	31,768
Total liabilities and stockholders' equity	\$ 65,486	\$ 52,359

See accompanying notes.

QUALCOMM Incorporated
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENTS OF OPERATIONS
(In millions, except per share data)

	Year Ended		
	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016	September 27, 2015
Revenues:			
Equipment and services	\$ 16,647	\$ 15,467	\$ 17,079
Licensing	5,644	8,087	8,202
Total revenues	22,291	23,554	25,281
Costs and expenses:			
Cost of revenues	9,792	9,749	10,378
Research and development	5,485	5,151	5,490
Selling, general and administrative	2,658	2,385	2,344
Other (Note 2)	1,742	(226)	1,293
Total costs and expenses	19,677	17,059	19,505
Operating income	2,614	6,495	5,776
Interest expense	(494)	(297)	(104)
Investment and other income, net (Note 2)	900	635	815
Income before income taxes	3,020	6,833	6,487
Income tax expense	(555)	(1,131)	(1,219)
Net income	2,465	5,702	5,268
Net loss attributable to noncontrolling interests	1	3	3
Net income attributable to Qualcomm	\$ 2,466	\$ 5,705	\$ 5,271
Basic earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm	\$ 1.67	\$ 3.84	\$ 3.26
Diluted earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm	\$ 1.65	\$ 3.81	\$ 3.22
Shares used in per share calculations:			
Basic	1,477	1,484	1,618
Diluted	1,490	1,498	1,639
Dividends per share announced	\$ 2.20	\$ 2.02	\$ 1.80

See accompanying notes.

QUALCOMM Incorporated
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENTS OF COMPREHENSIVE INCOME
(In millions)

	Year Ended		
	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016	September 27, 2015
Net income	\$ 2,465	\$ 5,702	\$ 5,268
Other comprehensive (loss) income, net of income taxes:			
Foreign currency translation gains (losses)	309	(22)	(47)
Reclassification of foreign currency translation (gains) losses included in net income	(1)	21	—
Noncredit other-than-temporary impairment losses and subsequent changes in fair value related to certain available-for-sale debt securities, net of tax (expense) benefit of (\$3), \$23 and \$19, respectively	6	(43)	(35)
Reclassification of net other-than-temporary losses on available-for-sale securities included in net income, net of tax benefit of \$46, \$71 and \$66, respectively	85	130	121
Net unrealized (losses) gains on other available-for-sale securities, net of tax benefit (expense) of \$59, (\$166) and \$114, respectively	(102)	306	(215)
Reclassification of net realized gains on available-for-sale securities included in net income, net of tax expense of \$156, \$85 and \$173, respectively	(286)	(156)	(317)
Net unrealized (losses) gains on derivative instruments, net of tax benefit of \$0, \$2 and \$0, respectively	(49)	(4)	54
Reclassification of net realized (gains) losses on derivative instruments included in net income, net of tax expense (benefit) of \$4, (\$2) and \$0, respectively	(10)	1	—
Other gains	4	—	—
Total other comprehensive (loss) income	(44)	233	(439)
Total comprehensive income	2,421	5,935	4,829
Comprehensive loss attributable to noncontrolling interests	1	3	3
Comprehensive income attributable to Qualcomm	\$ 2,422	\$ 5,938	\$ 4,832

See accompanying notes.

QUALCOMM Incorporated
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENTS OF CASH FLOWS
(In millions)

	Year Ended		
	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016	September 27, 2015
Operating Activities:			
Net income	\$ 2,465	\$ 5,702	\$ 5,268
Adjustments to reconcile net income to net cash provided by operating activities:			
Depreciation and amortization expense	1,461	1,428	1,214
Indefinite and long-lived asset impairment charges	76	107	317
Income tax provision (less than) in excess of income tax payments	(400)	(200)	47
Gain on sale of wireless spectrum	—	(380)	—
Non-cash portion of share-based compensation expense	914	943	1,026
Incremental tax benefits from share-based compensation	(40)	(8)	(103)
Net realized gains on marketable securities and other investments	(530)	(288)	(500)
Impairment losses on marketable securities and other investments	177	172	200
Other items, net	146	77	(16)
Changes in assets and liabilities:			
Accounts receivable, net	(1,104)	(232)	550
Inventories	(200)	(49)	93
Other assets	169	246	(793)
Trade accounts payable	(45)	541	(908)
Payroll, benefits and other liabilities	1,835	(352)	(328)
Unearned revenues	(231)	(307)	(561)
Net cash provided by operating activities	4,693	7,400	5,506
Investing Activities:			
Capital expenditures	(690)	(539)	(994)
Purchases of available-for-sale securities	(19,062)	(18,015)	(15,400)
Proceeds from sales and maturities of available-for-sale securities	41,715	14,386	15,080
Purchases of trading securities	—	(177)	(1,160)
Proceeds from sales and maturities of trading securities	—	779	1,658
Purchases of other marketable securities	(710)	—	—
Proceeds from sales and maturities of other marketable securities	706	450	—
Deposits of investments designated as collateral	(2,000)	—	—
Acquisitions and other investments, net of cash acquired	(1,544)	(812)	(3,019)
Proceeds from sale of wireless spectrum	—	232	—
Proceeds from sales of property, plant and equipment	28	16	266
Other items, net	20	192	(3)
Net cash provided (used) by investing activities	18,463	(3,488)	(3,572)
Financing Activities:			
Proceeds from short-term debt	8,558	8,949	4,083
Repayment of short-term debt	(9,309)	(8,200)	(3,083)
Proceeds from long-term debt	10,953	—	9,937
Proceeds from issuance of common stock	497	668	787
Repurchases and retirements of common stock	(1,342)	(3,923)	(11,246)
Dividends paid	(3,252)	(2,990)	(2,880)
Incremental tax benefits from share-based compensation	40	8	103
Other items, net	(266)	(34)	38
Net cash provided (used) by financing activities	5,879	(5,522)	(2,261)
Effect of exchange rate changes on cash and cash equivalents	48	(4)	(20)
Net increase (decrease) in cash and cash equivalents	29,083	(1,614)	(347)
Cash and cash equivalents at beginning of period	5,946	7,560	7,907
Cash and cash equivalents at end of period	\$ 35,029	\$ 5,946	\$ 7,560

See accompanying notes.

QUALCOMM Incorporated
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENTS OF STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY
(In millions)

	Common Stock Shares	Common Stock and Paid-In Capital	Retained Earnings	Accumulated Other Comprehensive Income	Total Qualcomm Stockholders' Equity	Noncontrolling Interests	Total Stockholders' Equity
Balance at September 28, 2014	1,669	\$ 7,736	\$ 30,799	\$ 634	\$ 39,169	\$ (3)	\$ 39,166
Total comprehensive income	—	—	5,271	(439)	4,832	(3)	4,829
Common stock issued under employee benefit plans and the related tax benefits	32	871	—	—	871	—	871
Repurchases and retirements of common stock	(172)	(9,334)	(1,912)	—	(11,246)	—	(11,246)
Share-based compensation	—	1,078	—	—	1,078	—	1,078
Tax withholdings related to vesting of share-based payments	(5)	(351)	—	—	(351)	—	(351)
Dividends	—	—	(2,932)	—	(2,932)	—	(2,932)
Other	—	—	—	—	—	(1)	(1)
Balance at September 27, 2015	1,524	—	31,226	195	31,421	(7)	31,414
Total comprehensive income	—	—	5,705	233	5,938	(3)	5,935
Common stock issued under employee benefit plans and the related tax benefits	30	615	—	—	615	—	615
Repurchases and retirements of common stock	(73)	(974)	(2,949)	—	(3,923)	—	(3,923)
Share-based compensation	—	997	—	—	997	—	997
Tax withholdings related to vesting of share-based payments	(5)	(224)	—	—	(224)	—	(224)
Dividends	—	—	(3,046)	—	(3,046)	—	(3,046)
Balance at September 25, 2016	1,476	414	30,936	428	31,778	(10)	31,768
Total comprehensive income	—	—	2,466	(44)	2,422	(1)	2,421
Common stock issued under employee benefit plans and the related tax benefits	25	499	—	—	499	—	499
Repurchases and retirements of common stock	(23)	(1,342)	—	—	(1,342)	—	(1,342)
Share-based compensation	—	975	—	—	975	—	975
Tax withholdings related to vesting of share-based payments	(4)	(268)	—	—	(268)	—	(268)
Dividends	—	—	(3,314)	—	(3,314)	—	(3,314)
Other	—	(4)	—	—	(4)	11	7
Balance at September 24, 2017	<u>1,474</u>	<u>\$ 274</u>	<u>\$ 30,088</u>	<u>\$ 384</u>	<u>\$ 30,746</u>	<u>\$ —</u>	<u>\$ 30,746</u>

See accompanying notes.

QUALCOMM Incorporated
NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

Note 1. The Company and Its Significant Accounting Policies

The Company. QUALCOMM Incorporated, a Delaware corporation, and its subsidiaries (collectively the Company or Qualcomm) develop, design, manufacture, have manufactured on its behalf and market digital communications products, which principally consist of integrated circuits and system software based on CDMA, OFDMA and other technologies, for use in mobile devices, wireless networks, devices used in the Internet of Things (IoT), broadband gateway equipment, consumer electronic devices and automotive telematics and infotainment systems. The Company also grants licenses to use portions of its intellectual property portfolio, which includes certain patent rights essential to and/or useful in the manufacture and sale of certain wireless products and receives fixed license fees (payable in one or more installments) as well as ongoing royalties based on sales by licensees of wireless products incorporating its patented technologies.

Principles of Consolidation. The Company's consolidated financial statements include the assets, liabilities and operating results of majority-owned subsidiaries, including its joint venture RF360 Holdings Singapore Pte. Ltd (RF360 Holdings) (Note 9). In addition, the Company consolidated its investment in an immaterial less than majority-owned variable interest entity as the Company was the primary beneficiary until the end of fiscal 2017. The ownership of the other interest holders of consolidated subsidiaries and the immaterial less than majority-owned variable interest entity is presented separately in the consolidated balance sheets and statements of operations. All significant intercompany accounts and transactions have been eliminated.

Financial Statement Preparation. The preparation of financial statements in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America (GAAP) requires management to make estimates and assumptions that affect the reported amounts and the disclosure of contingent amounts in the Company's consolidated financial statements and the accompanying notes. Examples of the Company's significant accounting estimates that may involve a higher degree of judgment and complexity than others include: the determination of other-than-temporary impairments of marketable securities and other investments; the valuation of inventories; the valuation and assessment of the recoverability of goodwill and other indefinite-lived and long-lived assets; the recognition, measurement and disclosure of loss contingencies related to legal and regulatory proceedings; and the calculation of tax liabilities, including the recognition and measurement of uncertain tax positions. Actual results could differ from those estimates. Certain prior year amounts have been reclassified to conform to the current year presentation.

Fiscal Year. The Company operates and reports using a 52-53 week fiscal year ending on the last Sunday in September. The fiscal years ended September 24, 2017, September 25, 2016 and September 27, 2015 included 52 weeks.

Cash Equivalents. The Company considers all highly liquid investments with original maturities of 90 days or less to be cash equivalents. Cash equivalents are comprised of money market funds, certificates of deposit, commercial paper, government agencies' securities, corporate bonds and notes, certain bank time deposits and repurchase agreements fully collateralized by government agencies' securities. The carrying amounts approximate fair value due to the short maturities of these instruments.

Marketable Securities. Marketable securities include available-for-sale securities and certain time deposits for which classification is determined at the time of purchase and reevaluated at each balance sheet date. The Company also held trading securities and securities for which the Company had elected the fair value option that would have otherwise been recorded using the equity method. These investments were exited during fiscal 2016, and the related changes in fair value associated with these investments were recognized in investment and other income, net and were negligible in fiscal 2016 and 2015. The Company classifies marketable securities as current or noncurrent based on the nature of the securities and their availability for use in current operations. Marketable securities are stated at fair value. The net unrealized gains or losses on available-for-sale securities are recorded as a component of accumulated other comprehensive income, net of income taxes. The realized gains and losses on marketable securities are determined using the specific identification method.

At each balance sheet date, the Company assesses available-for-sale securities in an unrealized loss position to determine whether the unrealized loss is other than temporary. The Company considers factors including: the significance of the decline in value as compared to the cost basis; underlying factors contributing to a decline in the prices of securities in a single asset class; how long the market value of the security has been less than its cost basis; the security's relative performance versus its peers, sector or asset class; expected market volatility; the market and economy in general; analyst recommendations and price targets; views of external investment managers; news or financial information that has been released specific to the investee; and the outlook for the overall industry in which the investee operates.

If a debt security's market value is below amortized cost and the Company either intends to sell the security or it is more likely than not that the Company will be required to sell the security before its anticipated recovery, the Company records an other-than-temporary impairment charge to investment and other income, net for the entire amount of the impairment. For the

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remaining debt securities, if an other-than-temporary impairment exists, the Company separates the other-than-temporary impairment into the portion of the loss related to credit factors, or the credit loss portion, which is recorded as a charge to investment and other income, net, and the portion of the loss that is not related to credit factors, or the noncredit loss portion, which is recorded as a component of other accumulated comprehensive income, net of income taxes.

For equity securities, the Company considers the loss relative to the expected volatility and the likelihood of recovery over a reasonable period of time. If events and circumstances indicate that a decline in the value of an equity security has occurred and is other than temporary, the Company records a charge to investment and other income, net for the difference between fair value and cost at the balance sheet date. Additionally, if the Company has either the intent to sell the equity security or does not have both the intent and the ability to hold the equity security until its anticipated recovery, the Company records a charge to investment and other income, net for the difference between fair value and cost at the balance sheet date.

Equity and Cost Method Investments. The Company generally accounts for non-marketable equity investments either under the equity or the cost method. Equity investments over which the Company has significant influence, but not control over the investee and is not the primary beneficiary of the investee's activities are accounted for under the equity method. Other non-marketable equity investments are accounted for under the cost method. The Company's share of gains and losses in equity method investments are recorded in investment and other income, net. The Company monitors non-marketable equity investments for events or circumstances that could indicate the investments are impaired, such as a deterioration in the investee's financial condition and business forecasts and lower valuations in recently completed or proposed financings, and records a charge to investment and other income, net for the difference between the estimated fair value and the carrying value.

The carrying values of the Company's non-marketable equity investments are recorded in other noncurrent assets and were as follows (in millions):

	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
Equity method investments	\$ 379	\$ 324
Cost method investments	603	531
	<u>\$ 982</u>	<u>\$ 855</u>

Transactions with equity method investees are considered related party transactions. Revenues from certain licensing and services contracts with two of the Company's equity method investees were \$165 million, \$196 million and negligible in fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, respectively. The Company eliminates unrealized profit or loss related to such transactions in relation to its ownership interest in the investee, which is recorded as a component of equity in net losses in investees in investment and other income, net. Aggregate accounts receivable from these equity method investees were \$29 million and \$73 million at September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016, respectively.

Derivatives. The Company's primary objectives for holding derivative instruments are to manage interest rate risk on its long-term debt and to manage foreign exchange risk for certain foreign currency revenues, operating expenses, receivables and payables. Derivative instruments are recorded at fair value and included in other current or noncurrent assets or other current or noncurrent liabilities based on their maturity dates. Counterparties to the Company's derivative instruments are all major banking institutions.

Interest Rate Swaps: The Company manages its exposure to certain interest rate risks related to its long-term debt through the use of interest rate swaps. Such swaps allow the Company to effectively convert fixed-rate payments into floating-rate payments based on LIBOR. These transactions are designated as fair value hedges, and the gains and losses related to changes in the fair value of the interest rate swaps substantially offset changes in the fair value of the hedged portion of the underlying debt that are attributable to changes in the market interest rates. The net gains and losses on the interest rate swaps, as well as the offsetting gains or losses on the related fixed-rate debt attributable to the hedged risks, are recognized in earnings as interest expense in the current period. The interest settlement payments associated with the interest rate swap agreements are classified as cash flows from operating activities in the consolidated statements of cash flows.

At September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016, the aggregate fair value of the Company's interest rate swaps related to its long-term debt issued in May 2015 was negligible and \$65 million, respectively. The fair values of the swaps were recorded in noncurrent assets, other current liabilities and other noncurrent liabilities at September 24, 2017 and in noncurrent assets at September 25, 2016. The swaps had an aggregate notional amount of \$3.0 billion, which effectively converted all of the fixed-rate debt due in 2018 and approximately 43% and 50% of the fixed-rate debt due in 2020 and 2022,

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respectively, into floating-rate debt. The maturities of the swaps match the Company's fixed-rate debt due in 2018, 2020 and 2022.

Foreign Currency Hedges: The Company manages its exposure to foreign exchange market risks, when deemed appropriate, through the use of derivative instruments, including foreign currency forward and option contracts with financial counterparties, that may or may not be designated as hedging instruments. These derivative instruments mature between one and twelve months. Gains and losses arising from the effective portion of such contracts that are designated as cash flow hedging instruments are recorded as a component of accumulated other comprehensive income as gains and losses on derivative instruments, net of income taxes. The hedging gains and losses in accumulated other comprehensive income are subsequently reclassified to revenues or costs and expenses, as applicable, in the consolidated statements of operations in the same period in which the underlying transactions affect the Company's earnings. Gains and losses arising from the ineffective portion of such contracts are recorded in investment and other income, net as gains and losses on derivative instruments. The cash flows associated with derivative instruments designated as cash flow hedging instruments are classified as cash flows from operating activities in the consolidated statements of cash flows, which is the same category as the hedged transaction. The cash flows associated with the ineffective portion of such derivative instruments are classified as cash flows from investing activities in the consolidated statements of cash flows. The fair values of the Company's foreign currency forward and option contracts used to hedge foreign currency risk designated as cash flow hedges recorded in total assets and in total liabilities were \$10 million and \$22 million, respectively, at September 24, 2017 and negligible at September 25, 2016.

For foreign currency forward and option contracts not designated as hedging instruments, the changes in fair value are recorded in investment and other income, net in the period of change. The cash flows associated with derivative instruments not designated as hedging instruments are classified as cash flows from operating activities in the consolidated statements of cash flows, which is the same category as the hedged transaction. The fair value of the Company's foreign currency forward and option contracts not designated as hedging instruments was negligible at September 24, 2017. There were no foreign currency forward and option contracts not designated as hedging instruments at September 25, 2016.

Gross Notional Amounts: The gross notional amounts of the Company's interest rate and foreign currency derivatives by instrument type were as follows (in millions):

	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
Forwards	\$ 163	\$ 108
Options	2,333	929
Swaps	3,000	3,061
	<u>\$ 5,496</u>	<u>\$ 4,098</u>

The gross notional amounts by currency were as follows (in millions):

	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
Chinese renminbi	\$ 1,460	\$ 325
Euro	146	31
Indian rupee	772	433
Japanese yen	68	97
Korean won	50	85
United States dollar	3,000	3,045
Other	—	82
	<u>\$ 5,496</u>	<u>\$ 4,098</u>

Fair Value Measurements. Fair value is defined as the exchange price that would be received for an asset or paid to transfer a liability (an exit price) in the principal or most advantageous market for the asset or liability in an orderly transaction between market participants as of the measurement date. Applicable accounting guidance provides an established hierarchy for inputs used in measuring fair value that maximizes the use of observable inputs and minimizes the use of unobservable inputs by requiring that the most observable inputs be used when available. Observable inputs are inputs that market participants would use in valuing the asset or liability and are developed based on market data obtained from sources independent of the Company. Unobservable inputs are inputs that reflect the Company's assumptions about the factors that

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market participants would use in valuing the asset or liability. There are three levels of inputs that may be used to measure fair value:

- Level 1 includes financial instruments for which quoted market prices for identical instruments are available in active markets.
- Level 2 includes financial instruments for which there are inputs other than quoted prices included within Level 1 that are observable for the instrument.
- Level 3 includes financial instruments for which fair value is derived from valuation techniques in which one or more significant inputs are unobservable, including the Company's own assumptions.

Assets and liabilities are classified based on the lowest level of input that is significant to the fair value measurements. The Company reviews the fair value hierarchy classification on a quarterly basis. Changes in the observability of valuation inputs may result in a reclassification of levels for certain securities within the fair value hierarchy.

Cash Equivalents and Marketable Securities: With the exception of auction rate securities, the Company obtains pricing information from quoted market prices, pricing vendors or quotes from brokers/dealers. The Company conducts reviews of its primary pricing vendors to determine whether the inputs used in the vendor's pricing processes are deemed to be observable. The fair value for interest-bearing securities includes accrued interest.

The fair value of U.S. Treasury securities and government-related securities, corporate bonds and notes and common and preferred stock is generally determined using standard observable inputs, including reported trades, quoted market prices, matrix pricing, benchmark yields, broker/dealer quotes, issuer spreads, two-sided markets and/or benchmark securities.

The fair value of debt and equity funds is reported at published net asset values. The Company assesses the daily frequency and size of transactions at published net asset values and/or the funds' underlying holdings to determine whether fair value is based on observable or unobservable inputs.

The fair value of mortgage- and asset-backed securities is derived from the use of matrix pricing (prices for similar securities) or, in some cases, cash flow pricing models with observable inputs, such as contractual terms, maturity, credit rating and/or securitization structure to determine the timing and amount of future cash flows. Certain mortgage- and asset-backed securities may require the use of significant unobservable inputs to estimate fair value, such as default likelihood, recovery rates and prepayment speed.

The fair value of auction rate securities is estimated by the Company using a discounted cash flow model that incorporates transaction details, such as contractual terms, maturity and timing and amount of future cash flows, as well as assumptions related to liquidity, default likelihood and recovery, the future state of the auction rate market and credit valuation adjustments of market participants. Though most of the securities held by the Company are pools of student loans guaranteed by the U.S. government, prepayment speeds and illiquidity discounts are considered significant unobservable inputs. These additional inputs are generally unobservable, and therefore, auction rate securities are included in Level 3.

Derivative Instruments: Derivative instruments that are traded on an exchange are valued using quoted market prices and are included in Level 1. Derivative instruments that are not traded on an exchange are valued using conventional calculations/models that are primarily based on observable inputs, such as foreign currency exchange rates, volatilities and interest rates, and therefore, such derivative instruments are included in Level 2.

Other Investments and Other Liabilities: Other investments and other liabilities included in Level 1 are comprised of the Company's deferred compensation plan liability and related assets, which consist of mutual funds classified as trading securities, and are included in other assets. Other investments and other liabilities included in Level 3 are comprised of convertible debt instruments issued by private companies and contingent consideration related to business combinations, respectively. The fair value of convertible debt instruments is estimated by the Company based on the estimated timing and amount of future cash flows, as well as assumptions related to liquidity, default likelihood and recovery. The fair value of contingent consideration related to business combinations is estimated by the Company using a real options approach, which includes inputs, such as projected financial information, market volatility, discount rates and timing of contractual payments. The inputs used by the Company to estimate the fair values of the convertible debt instruments and contingent consideration are generally unobservable, and therefore, they are included in Level 3.

Allowances for Doubtful Accounts. The Company maintains allowances for doubtful accounts for estimated losses resulting from the inability of the Company's customers to make required payments. The Company considers the following factors when determining if collection of required payments is reasonably assured: customer credit-worthiness; past

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transaction history with the customer; current economic industry trends; changes in customer payment terms; and bank credit-worthiness for letters of credit. If the Company has no previous experience with the customer, the Company may request financial information, including financial statements or other documents, to determine that the customer has the means of making payment. The Company may also obtain reports from various credit organizations to determine that the customer has a history of paying its creditors. If these factors do not indicate collection is reasonably assured, revenue is deferred as a reduction to accounts receivable until collection becomes reasonably assured, which is generally upon receipt of cash. If the financial condition of the Company's customers was to deteriorate, adversely affecting their ability to make payments, additional allowances would be required.

Inventories. Inventories are valued at the lower of cost or market (replacement cost, not to exceed net realizable value) using the first-in, first-out method. Recoverability of inventories is assessed based on review of future customer demand that considers multiple factors, including committed purchase orders from customers as well as purchase commitment projections provided by customers, among other things.

Property, Plant and Equipment. Property, plant and equipment are recorded at cost and depreciated or amortized using the straight-line method over their estimated useful lives. Upon the retirement or disposition of property, plant and equipment, the related cost and accumulated depreciation or amortization are removed, and a gain or loss is recorded, when appropriate. Buildings on owned land are depreciated over 30 years, and building improvements are depreciated over their useful lives ranging from 7 to 15 years. Leasehold improvements are amortized over the shorter of their estimated useful lives, not to exceed 15 years, or the remaining term of the related lease. Other property, plant and equipment have useful lives ranging from 2 to 25 years. Leased property meeting certain capital lease criteria is capitalized, and the net present value of the related lease payments is recorded as a liability. Amortization of assets under capital leases is recorded using the straight-line method over the shorter of the estimated useful lives or the lease terms. Maintenance, repairs and minor renewals or betterments are charged to expense as incurred.

Goodwill and Other Intangible Assets. Goodwill represents the excess of purchase price over the value assigned to the net tangible and identifiable intangible assets of businesses acquired. Acquired intangible assets other than goodwill are amortized over their useful lives unless the lives are determined to be indefinite. For intangible assets purchased in a business combination, the estimated fair values of the assets received are used to establish their recorded values. For intangible assets acquired in a non-monetary exchange, the estimated fair values of the assets transferred (or the estimated fair values of the assets received, if more clearly evident) are used to establish their recorded values, unless the values of neither the assets received nor the assets transferred are determinable within reasonable limits, in which case the assets received are measured based on the carrying values of the assets transferred. Valuation techniques consistent with the market approach, income approach and/or cost approach are used to measure fair value.

Impairment of Goodwill, Other Indefinite-Lived Assets and Long-Lived Assets. Goodwill and other indefinite-lived intangible assets are tested annually for impairment in the fourth fiscal quarter and in interim periods if certain events occur indicating that the carrying amounts may be impaired. If a qualitative assessment is used and the Company determines that the fair value of a reporting unit or indefinite-lived intangible asset is more likely than not (i.e., a likelihood of more than 50%) less than its carrying amount, a quantitative impairment test will be performed. If goodwill is quantitatively assessed for impairment, a two-step approach is applied. First, the Company compares the estimated fair value of the reporting unit in which the goodwill resides to its carrying value. The second step, if necessary, measures the amount of impairment, if any, by comparing the implied fair value of goodwill to its carrying value. Other indefinite-lived intangible assets are quantitatively assessed for impairment, if necessary, by comparing their estimated fair values to their carrying values. If the carrying value exceeds the fair value, the difference is recorded as an impairment.

Long-lived assets, such as property, plant and equipment and intangible assets subject to amortization, are reviewed for impairment when there is evidence that events or changes in circumstances indicate that the carrying amount of an asset or asset group may not be recoverable. Recoverability of assets to be held and used is measured by comparing the carrying amount of an asset or asset group to estimated undiscounted future cash flows expected to be generated by the asset or asset group. If the carrying amount of an asset or asset group exceeds its estimated future cash flows, an impairment charge is recognized for the amount by which the carrying amount of the asset or asset group exceeds the estimated fair value of the asset or asset group. Long-lived assets to be disposed of by sale are reported at the lower of their carrying amounts or their estimated fair values less costs to sell and are not depreciated.

Revenue Recognition. The Company derives revenues principally from sales of integrated circuit products and licensing of its intellectual property and also generates revenues through sales of products that connect medical devices and by performing software hosting, software development and other services. The timing of revenue recognition and the amount of

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revenue actually recognized in each case depends upon a variety of factors, including the specific terms of each arrangement and the nature of the Company's deliverables and obligations. Unearned revenues consist primarily of license fees for intellectual property with continuing performance obligations.

Revenues from sales of the Company's products are recognized at the time of shipment, or when title and risk of loss pass to the customer and all other criteria for revenue recognition are met, if later. Revenues from providing services are recognized when earned. Revenues from providing services were less than 10% of total revenues for all periods presented.

The Company grants licenses or otherwise provides rights to use portions of its intellectual property portfolio, which, among other rights, includes certain patent rights essential to and/or useful in the manufacture and sale of certain wireless products. Licensees typically pay a fixed license fee in one or more installments and royalties based on their sales of products incorporating or using the Company's licensed intellectual property. License fees are recognized over the estimated period of benefit of the license to the licensee, typically 5 to 15 years. Royalties are generally based upon a percentage of the wholesale (i.e., licensee's) selling price of complete licensed products, net of certain permissible deductions (including transportation, insurance, packing costs and other items). The Company broadly provides per unit running royalty caps that apply to certain categories of complete wireless devices, namely smartphones, tablets and laptops, which in general, effectively provide for a maximum running royalty amount per device (i.e., the royalty caps limit the running royalties due on a per unit basis). The Company earns royalties on such licensed products sold worldwide by its licensees at the time that the licensees' sales occur. The Company's licensees, however, do not report and pay royalties owed for sales in any given quarter until after the conclusion of that quarter, which is generally the following quarter. The Company recognizes royalty revenues based on royalties reported by licensees during the quarter and when all other revenue recognition criteria are met.

The Company records reductions to revenues for customer incentive arrangements, including volume-related and other pricing rebates and cost reimbursements for marketing and other activities involving certain of the Company's products and technologies. The charges for such arrangements are recorded as a reduction to accounts receivable or as other current liabilities based on whether the Company has the contractual right of offset. The Company recognizes the liability based on the estimated amount of the incentive, or if not reasonably estimated, the maximum potential liability, at the later of the date at which the Company records the related revenues or the date at which the Company offers the incentive or, if payment is contingent, when the contingency is resolved. In certain arrangements, the liabilities are based on customer forecasts. The Company reverses accruals for unclaimed incentive amounts to revenues when the unclaimed amounts are no longer subject to payment.

Concentrations. Revenues in fiscal 2017 were negatively impacted by the actions of Apple Inc. and Hon Hai Precision Industry Co., Ltd./Foxconn, its affiliates and other suppliers to Apple as well as the dispute with another licensee, who did not report or pay royalties due in the third or fourth quarter of fiscal 2017. Apple's contract manufacturers did not fully report and did not pay royalties due on sales of Apple products for a portion of the fiscal year, which resulted in higher accounts receivable from those suppliers (Note 2). A significant portion of the Company's revenues is concentrated with a small number of customers/licensees of the Company's QCT and QTL segments. Revenues related to the products of two customers/licensees comprised 18% and 17% of total consolidated revenues in fiscal 2017, compared to 24% and 16% in fiscal 2016 and 25% and 20% in fiscal 2015. Excluding the unpaid royalty receivables due from suppliers to Apple (Note 2), aggregate accounts receivable from one customer/licensee comprised 10% and 14% of accounts receivable at September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016, respectively.

The Company relies on sole- or limited-source suppliers for some products, particularly products in the QCT segment, subjecting the Company to possible shortages of raw materials or manufacturing capacity. While the Company has established alternate suppliers for certain technologies that the Company considers critical, the loss of a supplier or the inability of a supplier to meet performance or quality specifications or delivery schedules could harm the Company's ability to meet its delivery obligations and/or negatively impact the Company's revenues, business operations and ability to compete for future business.

Shipping and Handling Costs. Costs incurred for shipping and handling are included in cost of revenues. Amounts billed to a customer for shipping and handling are reported as revenues.

Share-Based Compensation. Share-based compensation expense for equity-classified awards, principally related to restricted stock units (RSUs), is measured at the grant date, or at the acquisition date for awards assumed in business combinations, based on the estimated fair value of the award and is recognized over the employee's requisite service period. Share-based compensation expense is adjusted to exclude amounts related to share-based awards that are expected to be forfeited.

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The fair values of RSUs are estimated based on the fair market values of the underlying stock on the dates of grant or dates the RSUs are assumed. If RSUs do not have the right to participate in dividends, the fair values are discounted by the dividend yield. The weighted-average estimated fair values of employee RSUs granted during fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 were \$66.54, \$53.56 and \$68.77 per share, respectively. Upon vesting, the Company issues new shares of common stock. For the majority of RSUs, shares are issued on the vesting dates net of the amount of shares needed to satisfy statutory tax withholding requirements to be paid by the Company on behalf of the employees. As a result, the actual number of shares issued will be fewer than the number of RSUs outstanding. The annual pre-vest forfeiture rate for RSUs was estimated to be approximately 5%, 4% and 3% in fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, respectively.

Total share-based compensation expense, related to all of the Company's share-based awards, was comprised as follows (in millions):

	2017	2016	2015
Cost of revenues	\$ 38	\$ 40	\$ 42
Research and development	588	614	659
Selling, general and administrative	288	289	325
Share-based compensation expense before income taxes	914	943	1,026
Related income tax benefit	(161)	(190)	(190)
	<u>\$ 753</u>	<u>\$ 753</u>	<u>\$ 836</u>

Legal and Regulatory Proceedings. The Company is currently involved in certain legal and regulatory proceedings. The Company discloses a loss contingency if there is at least a reasonable possibility that a material loss has been incurred. The Company records its best estimate of a loss related to pending legal and regulatory proceedings when the loss is considered probable and the amount can be reasonably estimated. Where a range of loss can be reasonably estimated with no best estimate in the range, the Company records the minimum estimated liability. As additional information becomes available, the Company assesses the potential liability related to pending legal and regulatory proceedings and revises its estimates and updates its disclosures accordingly. The Company's legal costs associated with defending itself are recorded to expense as incurred.

Foreign Currency. Certain foreign subsidiaries use a local currency as the functional currency. Resulting translation gains or losses are recognized as a component of accumulated other comprehensive income. Transaction gains or losses related to balances denominated in a currency other than the functional currency are recognized in the consolidated statements of operations.

Income Taxes. The asset and liability approach is used to recognize deferred tax assets and liabilities for the expected future tax consequences of temporary differences between the carrying amounts and the tax bases of assets and liabilities. Tax law and rate changes are reflected in income in the period such changes are enacted. The Company records a valuation allowance to reduce deferred tax assets to the amount that is more likely than not to be realized. The Company includes interest and penalties related to income taxes, including unrecognized tax benefits, within income tax expense. The Company classifies all deferred tax assets and liabilities as noncurrent in the consolidated balance sheets.

The Company's income tax returns are based on calculations and assumptions that are subject to examination by the Internal Revenue Service and other tax authorities. In addition, the calculation of the Company's tax liabilities involves dealing with uncertainties in the application of complex tax regulations. The Company recognizes liabilities for uncertain tax positions based on a two-step process. The first step is to evaluate the tax position for recognition by determining if the weight of available evidence indicates that it is more likely than not that the position will be sustained on audit, including resolution of related appeals or litigation processes, if any. The second step is to measure the tax benefit as the largest amount that is more than 50% likely of being realized upon settlement. While the Company believes it has appropriate support for the positions taken on its tax returns, the Company regularly assesses the potential outcomes of examinations by tax authorities in determining the adequacy of its provision for income taxes. The Company continually assesses the likelihood and amount of potential adjustments and adjusts the income tax provision, income taxes payable and deferred taxes in the period in which the facts that give rise to a revision become known.

The Company recognizes windfall tax benefits associated with share-based awards directly to stockholders' equity when realized. A windfall tax benefit occurs when the actual tax benefit realized by the Company upon an employee's disposition of a share-based award exceeds the deferred tax asset, if any, associated with the award that the Company had recorded. The Company records windfall tax benefits to stockholders' equity. A shortfall occurs when the actual tax benefit realized by the

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Company upon an employee's disposition of a share-based award is less than the deferred tax asset, if any, associated with the award that the Company has recorded. The Company records shortfall tax detriments when realized to stockholders' equity to the extent that previous windfall tax benefits exist (referred to as the APIC windfall pool), with any remainder recognized in income tax expense. The Company had a sufficient APIC windfall pool to absorb all shortfalls that occurred in fiscal 2017. When assessing whether a tax benefit relating to share-based compensation has been realized, the Company follows the tax law ordering method, under which current year share-based compensation deductions are assumed to be utilized before net operating loss carryforwards and other tax attributes.

Earnings Per Common Share. Basic earnings per common share are computed by dividing net income attributable to Qualcomm by the weighted-average number of common shares outstanding during the reporting period. Diluted earnings per common share are computed by dividing net income attributable to Qualcomm by the combination of dilutive common share equivalents, comprised of shares issuable under the Company's share-based compensation plans and shares subject to written put options and/or accelerated share repurchase agreements, if any, and the weighted-average number of common shares outstanding during the reporting period. Dilutive common share equivalents include the dilutive effect of in-the-money share equivalents, which are calculated based on the average share price for each period using the treasury stock method. Under the treasury stock method, the exercise price of an award, if any, the amount of compensation cost for future service that the Company has not yet recognized, if any, and the estimated tax benefits that would be recorded in paid-in capital when an award is settled, if any, are assumed to be used to repurchase shares in the current period. The dilutive common share equivalents, calculated using the treasury stock method, for fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 were 12,989,000, 13,864,000 and 20,724,000, respectively. Shares of common stock equivalents outstanding that were not included in the computation of diluted earnings per common share because the effect would be anti-dilutive or certain performance conditions were not satisfied at the end of the period were 2,955,000, 2,435,000 and 4,652,000 during fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, respectively.

Recent Accounting Pronouncements. In May 2014, the FASB issued new guidance related to revenue recognition, which outlines a comprehensive revenue recognition model and supersedes most current revenue recognition guidance. The new guidance requires a company to recognize revenue as control of goods or services transfers to a customer at an amount that reflects the expected consideration to be received in exchange for those goods or services. It defines a five-step approach for recognizing revenue, which may require a company to use more judgment and make more estimates than under the current guidance. The Company will adopt the new guidance in the first quarter of fiscal 2019 and currently expects to apply the modified retrospective approach, which means that the cumulative effect of applying the new guidance is recognized as an adjustment to the opening retained earnings balance. Given the scope of work required to implement the recognition and disclosure requirements under the new guidance, the Company has made progress in the identification of changes to policy, processes, systems and controls, and the Company continues to assess data availability and presentation necessary to meet the additional disclosure requirements of the guidance in the notes to the consolidated financial statements.

The Company currently expects the adoption of this new guidance to most significantly impact its licensing business. Specifically, the Company expects a change in the timing of revenues recognized from sales-based royalties. The Company currently recognizes sales-based royalties as revenues in the period in which such royalties are reported by licensees, which is after the conclusion of the quarter in which the licensees' sales occur and when all other revenue recognition criteria are met. Under the new guidance, the Company will be required to estimate and recognize sales-based royalties in the period in which the associated sales occur, resulting in an acceleration of revenue recognition compared to the current method. Upon adoption of the new guidance, licenses to use portions of the Company's intellectual property portfolio will be considered one performance obligation, and license fees will be recognized as revenues on a straight-line basis over the term of the license agreement, which is similar to the recognition of license revenues under the current guidance. The Company currently accounts for customer incentive arrangements in its licensing and semiconductor businesses, including volume-related and other pricing rebates or cost reimbursements for marketing and other activities involving certain of the Company's products and technologies in part based on the maximum potential liability. Under the new guidance, the Company expects to estimate the amount of all customer incentives. The Company does not otherwise expect the adoption of the new guidance will have a material impact on its businesses.

In January 2016, the FASB issued new guidance on classifying and measuring financial instruments, which requires that (i) all equity investments, other than equity-method investments, in unconsolidated entities generally be measured at fair value through earnings and (ii) when the fair value option has been elected for financial liabilities, changes in fair value due to instrument-specific credit risk be recognized separately in other comprehensive income. Additionally, it changes the disclosure requirements for financial instruments. The new guidance will be effective for the Company starting in the first quarter of fiscal 2019. Early adoption is permitted for certain provisions. The Company does not intend adopt any of the

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provisions early and is in the process of determining the effects the adoption will have on its consolidated financial statements.

In February 2016, the FASB issued new guidance related to leases that outlines a comprehensive lease accounting model and supersedes the current lease guidance. The new guidance requires lessees to recognize lease liabilities and corresponding right-of-use assets for all leases with lease terms of greater than 12 months. It also changes the definition of a lease and expands the disclosure requirements of lease arrangements. The new guidance must be adopted using the modified retrospective approach. The Company will adopt the new guidance in the first quarter of fiscal 2020 and is in the process of determining the effects the adoption will have on its consolidated financial statements.

In March 2016, the FASB issued new guidance that changes the accounting for share-based payments, including income taxes, classification of awards and classification in the statement of cash flows. The new guidance will increase the number of shares an employer can withhold to cover income taxes on share-based payment awards and still qualify for the exemption to liability classification. In addition, under the new guidance, excess tax benefits or deficiencies associated with share-based payment awards will be recognized through earnings when the awards vest or settle, rather than in stockholders' equity. As a result, subsequent to adoption, the Company's income tax expense and associated effective tax rate will be impacted by fluctuations in stock price between the grant dates and vesting dates of equity awards. The new guidance will be effective for the Company starting in the first quarter of fiscal 2018.

In June 2016, the FASB issued new guidance that changes the accounting for recognizing impairments of financial assets. Under the new guidance, credit losses for certain types of financial instruments will be estimated based on expected losses. The new guidance also modifies the impairment models for available-for-sale debt securities and for purchased financial assets with credit deterioration since their origination. The new guidance will be effective for the Company starting in the first quarter of fiscal 2021. Early adoption is permitted starting in the first quarter of fiscal 2020. The Company is in the process of determining the effects the adoption will have on its consolidated financial statements as well as whether to adopt the new guidance early.

In August 2016, the FASB issued new guidance related to the classification of certain cash receipts and cash payments on the statement of cash flows. The new guidance will be effective for the Company beginning in the first quarter of fiscal 2019 on a retrospective basis, and early adoption is permitted. The Company does not intend to adopt the new guidance early and is currently evaluating the impact of this accounting standard update on its consolidated financial statements.

In October 2016, the FASB issued new guidance that changes the accounting for income tax effects of intra-entity transfers of assets other than inventory. Under the new guidance, the selling (transferring) entity is required to recognize a current tax expense or benefit upon transfer of the asset. Similarly, the purchasing (receiving) entity is required to recognize a deferred tax asset or deferred tax liability, as well as the related deferred tax benefit or expense, upon receipt of the asset. The new guidance will be effective for the Company starting in the first quarter of fiscal 2019 on a modified retrospective basis, and early adoption is permitted. The Company does not intend to adopt the new guidance early and is currently evaluating the impact of this accounting standard update on its consolidated financial statements.

In August 2017, the FASB issued new guidance that expands and refines hedge accounting for both financial and non-financial risks, aligns the recognition and presentation of the effects of hedging instruments and hedged items in the financial statements, and includes targeted improvements related to the assessment of hedge effectiveness. The new guidance also modifies disclosure requirements for hedging activities. The new guidance will be effective for the Company starting in the first quarter of fiscal 2020, and early adoption is permitted in any interim period. The Company is currently evaluating the impact of the new guidance on its consolidated financial statements as well as whether to adopt the new guidance early.

Note 2. Composition of Certain Financial Statement Items

Accounts Receivable (in millions)

	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
Trade, net of allowances for doubtful accounts of \$11 and \$1, respectively	\$ 3,576	\$ 2,194
Long-term contracts	40	20
Other	16	5
	<u>\$ 3,632</u>	<u>\$ 2,219</u>

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Approximately 70% of the increase in accounts receivable was due to the short payment in the second quarter of fiscal 2017 of royalties reported by and deemed collectible from Apple's contract manufacturers. This same amount is recorded in customer-related liabilities for Apple, since the Company does not have the contractual right to offset these amounts. The remaining increase in accounts receivable resulted from the accounts receivable relating to the Company's recently formed RF360 Holdings joint venture (Note 9), increased revenues related to integrated circuits and the timing of the collection of payments from certain of the Company's other licensees.

Inventories (in millions)

	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
Raw materials	\$ 103	\$ 1
Work-in-process	799	847
Finished goods	1,133	708
	<u>\$ 2,035</u>	<u>\$ 1,556</u>

Property, Plant and Equipment (in millions)

	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
Land	\$ 195	\$ 192
Buildings and improvements	1,595	1,545
Computer equipment and software	1,609	1,426
Machinery and equipment	3,528	2,454
Furniture and office equipment	109	77
Leasehold improvements	310	254
Construction in progress	73	92
	<u>7,419</u>	<u>6,040</u>
Less accumulated depreciation and amortization	<u>(4,203)</u>	<u>(3,734)</u>
	<u>\$ 3,216</u>	<u>\$ 2,306</u>

Depreciation and amortization expense related to property, plant and equipment for fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 was \$684 million, \$624 million and \$625 million, respectively. The gross book values of property under capital leases included in buildings and improvements were negligible at September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016.

Goodwill and Other Intangible Assets. The Company allocates goodwill to its reporting units for annual impairment testing purposes. The following table presents the goodwill allocated to the Company's reportable and nonreportable segments, as described in Note 8, as well as the changes in the carrying amounts of goodwill during fiscal 2017 and 2016 (in millions):

	QCT	QTL	Nonreportable Segments	Total
Balance at September 27, 2015	\$ 4,461	\$ 718	\$ 300	\$ 5,479
Acquisitions	172	—	—	172
Impairments	—	—	(17)	(17)
Other (1)	41	—	4	45
Balance at September 25, 2016 (2)	<u>4,674</u>	<u>718</u>	<u>287</u>	<u>5,679</u>
Acquisitions	841	23	11	875
Impairments	—	—	—	—
Other (1)	66	—	3	69
Balance at September 24, 2017 (2)	<u>\$ 5,581</u>	<u>\$ 741</u>	<u>\$ 301</u>	<u>\$ 6,623</u>

(1) Includes changes in goodwill amounts resulting from foreign currency translation, purchase accounting adjustments and, in fiscal 2016, the sale of the Company's business that provided augmented reality applications.

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(2) Cumulative goodwill impairments were \$537 million at both September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016 .

The components of other intangible assets, net were as follows (in millions):

	September 24, 2017			September 25, 2016		
	Gross Carrying Amount	Accumulated Amortization	Weighted-average amortization period (years)	Gross Carrying Amount	Accumulated Amortization	Weighted-average amortization period (years)
Wireless spectrum	\$ 1	\$ —	20	\$ 2	\$ (2)	5
Marketing-related	77	(52)	4	119	(77)	8
Technology-based	6,413	(2,818)	10	5,900	(2,459)	10
Customer-related	149	(33)	9	21	(4)	7
	<u>\$ 6,640</u>	<u>\$ (2,903)</u>	<u>10</u>	<u>\$ 6,042</u>	<u>\$ (2,542)</u>	<u>10</u>

All of these intangible assets are subject to amortization, other than acquired in-process research and development with carrying values of \$74 million and \$83 million at September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016 , respectively. Amortization expense related to these intangible assets was \$777 million , \$804 million and \$ 591 million for fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 , respectively. Amortization expense related to these intangible assets and acquired in-process research and development, beginning upon the expected completion of the underlying projects, is expected to be \$780 million , \$734 million , \$622 million , \$507 million and \$415 million for each of the subsequent five years from fiscal 2018 through 2022, respectively, and \$679 million thereafter.

Other Current Liabilities (in millions)

	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
Customer incentives and other customer-related liabilities	\$ 2,804	\$ 1,710
Accrual for TFTC fine (Note 7)	778	—
Other	1,174	551
	<u>\$ 4,756</u>	<u>\$ 2,261</u>

Customer incentives and other customer-related liabilities substantially consist of amounts payable to customers for incentive and other arrangements, including volume-related and other pricing rebates and cost reimbursements for marketing and other activities involving certain of the Company's products and technologies. The corresponding charges for such arrangements were recorded as a reduction to revenues.

Accumulated Other Comprehensive Income. Changes in the components of accumulated other comprehensive income, net of income taxes, in Qualcomm stockholders' equity during fiscal 2017 were as follows (in millions):

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	Foreign Currency Translation Adjustment	Noncredit Other-than- Temporary Impairment Losses and Subsequent Changes in Fair Value for Certain Available- for-Sale Debt Securities	Net Unrealized Gain (Loss) on Other Available-for- Sale Securities	Net Unrealized Gain (Loss) on Derivative Instruments	Other Gains	Total Accumulated Other Comprehensive Income
Balance at September 25, 2016	\$ (161)	\$ 6	\$ 532	\$ 51	\$ —	\$ 428
Other comprehensive (loss) income before reclassifications	309	6	(102)	(49)	4	168
Reclassifications from accumulated other comprehensive income	(1)	11	(212)	(10)	—	(212)
Other comprehensive (loss) income	308	17	(314)	(59)	4	(44)
Balance at September 24, 2017	\$ 147	\$ 23	\$ 218	\$ (8)	\$ 4	\$ 384

Reclassifications from accumulated other comprehensive income related to net gains on available-for-sale securities of \$201 million, \$83 million and \$212 million during fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, respectively, were recorded in investment and other income, net (Note 2). Reclassifications from accumulated other comprehensive income related to foreign currency translation losses of \$21 million during fiscal 2016 were recorded in selling, general and administrative expenses and other operating expenses. Reclassifications from accumulated other comprehensive income related to foreign currency translation adjustments during fiscal 2017 and 2015 were negligible. Reclassifications from accumulated other comprehensive income related to derivative instruments of \$10 million for fiscal 2017 were recorded in revenues, cost of revenues, research and development expenses and selling, general and administrative expenses. Reclassifications from accumulated other comprehensive income related to derivative instruments during fiscal 2016 and 2015 were negligible.

Other Income, Costs and Expenses. Other expenses in fiscal 2017 consisted of a \$927 million charge related to the KFTC fine (Note 7), including related foreign currency losses, a \$778 million charge related to the TFTC fine (Note 7) and \$37 million in restructuring and restructuring-related charges related to the Company's Strategic Realignment Plan (Note 10).

Other income for fiscal 2016 included a gain of \$380 million on the sale of wireless spectrum in the United Kingdom that was held by the QSI (Qualcomm Strategic Initiatives) segment in the first quarter of fiscal 2016 for \$232 million in cash and \$275 million in deferred payments due in 2020 to 2023, which were recorded at their present values in other assets. Other income for fiscal 2016 also included \$202 million in restructuring and restructuring-related charges, which were partially offset by a \$48 million gain on the sale of the Company's business that provided augmented reality applications, all of which related to the Company's Strategic Realignment Plan.

On February 9, 2015, the Company announced that it had reached a resolution with the China National Development and Reform Commission (NDRC) regarding its investigation of the Company relating to China's Anti-Monopoly Law (AML) and the Company's licensing business and certain interactions between the Company's licensing business and its semiconductor business. The NDRC issued an Administrative Sanction Decision finding that the Company had violated the AML, and the Company agreed to implement a rectification plan that modified certain of its business practices in China. In addition, the NDRC imposed a fine on the Company of 6.088 billion Chinese renminbi (approximately \$975 million), which the Company paid. The Company recorded the amount of the fine in the second quarter of fiscal 2015 in other expenses. Other expenses in fiscal 2015 also included \$255 million and \$11 million in impairment charges on goodwill and intangible assets, respectively, related to the Company's content and push-to-talk services and display businesses and \$190 million in restructuring and restructuring-related charges related to the Company's Strategic Realignment Plan, partially offset by \$138 million in gains on sales of certain property, plant and equipment.

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Investment and Other Income, Net (in millions)

	2017	2016	2015
Interest and dividend income	\$ 619	\$ 611	\$ 527
Net realized gains on marketable securities	456	239	451
Net realized gains on other investments	74	49	49
Impairment losses on marketable securities	(131)	(112)	(163)
Impairment losses on other investments	(46)	(60)	(37)
Net gains (losses) on derivative instruments	32	(8)	17
Equity in net losses of investees	(74)	(84)	(32)
Net losses on foreign currency transactions	(30)	—	—
Net gains on deconsolidation of subsidiaries	—	—	3
	<u>\$ 900</u>	<u>\$ 635</u>	<u>\$ 815</u>

There were no net impairment losses on marketable securities related to the noncredit portion of losses on debt securities recognized in other comprehensive income in fiscal 2017, and such losses were \$ 37 million and \$ 23 million in fiscal 2016 and 2015, respectively. The ending balance of the credit loss portion of other-than-temporary impairments on debt securities held by the Company was negligible and \$55 million at September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016, respectively.

Note 3. Income Taxes

The components of the income tax provision were as follows (in millions):

	2017	2016	2015
Current provision (benefit):			
Federal	\$ 72	\$ 4	\$ (67)
State	3	4	4
Foreign	1,256	1,411	1,307
	<u>1,331</u>	<u>1,419</u>	<u>1,244</u>
Deferred (benefit) provision:			
Federal	(586)	(184)	(9)
State	4	6	1
Foreign	(194)	(110)	(17)
	<u>(776)</u>	<u>(288)</u>	<u>(25)</u>
	<u>\$ 555</u>	<u>\$ 1,131</u>	<u>\$ 1,219</u>

The foreign component of the income tax provision consisted primarily of foreign withholding taxes on royalty fees included in United States earnings.

The components of income before income taxes by United States and foreign jurisdictions were as follows (in millions):

	2017	2016	2015
United States	\$ (762)	\$ 3,032	\$ 2,993
Foreign	3,782	3,801	3,494
	<u>\$ 3,020</u>	<u>\$ 6,833</u>	<u>\$ 6,487</u>

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The foreign component of income before income taxes in foreign jurisdictions consists primarily of income earned in Singapore.

The following is a reconciliation of the expected statutory federal income tax provision to the Company's actual income tax provision (in millions):

	2017	2016	2015
Expected income tax provision at federal statutory tax rate	\$ 1,057	\$ 2,392	\$ 2,270
State income tax provision, net of federal benefit	8	19	18
Foreign income taxed at other than U.S. rates	(963)	(1,068)	(937)
Research and development tax credits	(81)	(143)	(148)
Worthless stock deduction of domestic subsidiary	—	(101)	—
Nondeductible charges related to the KFTC and TFTC investigations	363	—	—
Impact of changes in tax reserves and audit settlements for prior year tax positions	111	—	(61)
Other	60	32	77
	<u>\$ 555</u>	<u>\$ 1,131</u>	<u>\$ 1,219</u>

During fiscal 2017, the Company recorded charges of \$927 million and \$778 million related to the fines imposed by the KFTC and the TFTC, respectively (Note 7), which are not deductible for tax purposes and are attributable to both the United States and a foreign jurisdiction.

During fiscal 2016, the Company recorded a tax benefit of \$101 million from a worthless stock deduction on a domestic subsidiary of one of the Company's former display businesses. Also, during fiscal 2016, the United States government permanently reinstated the federal research and development tax credit retroactively to January 1, 2015. As a result of the reinstatement, the Company recorded a tax benefit of \$79 million in fiscal 2016 related to fiscal 2015. During fiscal 2015, the NDRC imposed a fine of \$975 million (Note 2), which was not deductible for tax purposes and was substantially attributable to a foreign jurisdiction. Additionally, during fiscal 2015, the Company recorded a tax benefit of \$101 million related to fiscal 2014 resulting from the United States government reinstating the federal research and development tax credit retroactively to January 1, 2014 through December 31, 2014. The effective tax rate for fiscal 2015 also reflected the United States federal research and development tax credit generated through December 31, 2014, the date on which the credit expired, and a \$61 million tax benefit as a result of a favorable tax audit settlement with the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) related to Qualcomm Atheros, Inc.'s pre-acquisition 2010 and 2011 tax returns.

The Company's QCT segment's non-United States headquarters is located in Singapore. The Company has obtained tax incentives in Singapore that commenced in March 2012, which are effective through March 2027, that result in a tax exemption for the first five years provided that the Company meets specified employment and investment criteria. As a result of the expiration of certain of these incentives, the Company's Singapore tax rate increased in fiscal 2017 and will increase again in fiscal 2027 upon the expiration of the remaining incentives. Had the Company established QCT's non-United States headquarters in Singapore without these tax incentives, the Company's income tax expense would have been higher and impacted earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm as follows (in millions, except per share amounts):

	2017	2016	2015
Additional income tax expense	\$ 493	\$ 487	\$ 656
Reduction to diluted earnings per share	\$ 0.33	\$ 0.32	\$ 0.40

The Company considers the operating earnings of certain non-United States subsidiaries to be indefinitely reinvested outside the United States based on the Company's plans for use and/or investment outside the United States and the Company's belief that its sources of cash and liquidity in the United States will be sufficient to meet future domestic cash needs. The Company has not recorded a deferred tax liability of approximately \$13.7 billion related to the United States federal and state income taxes and foreign withholding taxes on approximately \$39.0 billion of undistributed earnings of certain non-United States subsidiaries indefinitely reinvested outside the United States. Should the Company decide to no longer indefinitely reinvest such earnings outside the United States, the Company would have to adjust the income tax provision in the period management makes such determination.

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The Company had deferred tax assets and deferred tax liabilities as follows (in millions):

	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
Unused tax credits	\$ 1,798	\$ 1,256
Accrued liabilities and reserves	888	409
Unearned revenues	886	920
Share-based compensation	241	277
Unused net operating losses	208	218
Unrealized losses on other investments and marketable securities	151	254
Other	21	55
Total gross deferred tax assets	4,193	3,389
Valuation allowance	(863)	(754)
Total net deferred tax assets	3,330	2,635
Intangible assets	(535)	(502)
Unrealized gains on other investments and marketable securities	(33)	(194)
Other	(95)	(78)
Total deferred tax liabilities	(663)	(774)
Net deferred tax assets	\$ 2,667	\$ 1,861
Reported as:		
Non-current deferred tax assets	2,900	2,030
Non-current deferred tax liabilities (1)	(233)	(169)
	\$ 2,667	\$ 1,861

(1) Non-current deferred tax liabilities were included in other liabilities in the consolidated balance sheets.

At September 24, 2017, the Company had unused federal net operating loss carryforwards of \$245 million expiring from 2021 through 2035, unused state net operating loss carryforwards of \$858 million expiring from 2018 through 2037 and unused foreign net operating loss carryforwards of \$215 million, of which substantially all may be carried forward indefinitely. At September 24, 2017, the Company had unused state tax credits of \$763 million, of which substantially all may be carried forward indefinitely, unused federal tax credits of \$1.0 billion expiring from 2025 through 2037 and unused tax credits of \$28 million in foreign jurisdictions expiring from 2033 through 2037. The Company does not expect its federal net operating loss carryforwards to expire unused.

At September 24, 2017, the Company has provided a valuation allowance on certain state tax credits, foreign deferred tax assets and state net operating losses of \$752 million, \$69 million and \$42 million, respectively. The valuation allowances reflect the uncertainties surrounding the Company's ability to generate sufficient future taxable income in certain foreign and state tax jurisdictions to utilize its net operating losses and the Company's ability to generate sufficient capital gains to utilize all capital losses. The Company believes, more likely than not, that it will have sufficient taxable income after deductions related to share-based awards to utilize its remaining deferred tax assets.

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A summary of the changes in the amount of unrecognized tax benefits for fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 follows (in millions):

	2017	2016	2015
Beginning balance of unrecognized tax benefits	\$ 271	\$ 40	\$ 87
Additions based on prior year tax positions	92	20	31
Reductions for prior year tax positions and lapse in statute of limitations	(11)	(6)	(70)
Additions for current year tax positions	23	218	5
Settlements with taxing authorities	(3)	(1)	(13)
Ending balance of unrecognized tax benefits	\$ 372	\$ 271	\$ 40

The Company believes that it is reasonably possible that certain unrecognized tax benefits recorded at September 24, 2017 may result in a significant cash payment in fiscal 2018 . Unrecognized tax benefits at September 24, 2017 included \$289 million for tax positions that, if recognized, would impact the effective tax rate. The unrecognized tax benefits differ from the amount that would affect the Company's effective tax rate primarily because the unrecognized tax benefits were included on a gross basis and did not reflect secondary impacts such as the federal deduction for state taxes, adjustments to deferred tax assets and the valuation allowance that might be required if the Company's tax positions are sustained. The increase in unrecognized tax benefits in fiscal 2017 was primarily due to tax positions related to transfer pricing. The increase in unrecognized tax benefits in fiscal 2016 was primarily due to tax positions related to classification of income. The Company believes that it is reasonably possible that the total amount of unrecognized tax benefits at September 24, 2017 may increase or decrease in fiscal 2018 .

The Company files income tax returns in the United States federal jurisdiction and various state and foreign jurisdictions. The Company is currently a participant in the IRS Compliance Assurance Process, whereby the IRS and the Company endeavor to agree on the treatment of all tax issues prior to the tax return being filed. The IRS completed its examination of the Company's tax return for fiscal 2015 and issued a no change letter in February 2017, resulting in no change to the income tax provision. The Company is no longer subject to United States federal income tax examinations for years prior to fiscal 2014. The Company is subject to examination by the California Franchise Tax Board for fiscal years after 2011. The Company is also subject to examination in other taxing jurisdictions in the United States and numerous foreign jurisdictions, most notably in countries where the Company earns a routine return and tax authorities believe substantial value-add activities are performed. These examinations are at various stages with respect to assessments, claims, deficiencies and refunds, many of which are open for periods after fiscal 2000. The Company continually assesses the likelihood and amount of potential adjustments and adjusts the income tax provision, income taxes payable and deferred taxes in the period in which the facts give rise to a revision become known. As of September 24, 2017, the Company believes that adequate amounts have been reserved for based on facts known. However, the final determination of tax audits and any related legal proceedings could materially differ from amounts reflected in the Company's income tax provision and the related accruals.

Cash amounts paid for income taxes, net of refunds received, were \$1.0 billion , \$1.3 billion and \$1.2 billion for fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 , respectively.

Note 4. Capital Stock

Stock Repurchase Program. On March 9, 2015 , the Company announced a stock repurchase program authorizing it to repurchase up to \$15 billion of the Company's common stock. The stock repurchase program has no expiration date. During fiscal 2015, the Company entered into two accelerated share repurchase agreements (ASR Agreements) with two financial institutions under which the Company paid an aggregate of \$5.0 billion to the financial institutions and received from them a total of 78,276,000 shares of the Company's common stock based on the average daily volume weighted-average stock price of the Company's common stock during the respective terms of the ASR Agreements, less a discount. The shares were retired and recorded as a reduction to stockholders' equity.

During fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 , the Company repurchased and retired an additional 22,792,000 , 73,782,000 and 94,159,000 shares of common stock, respectively, for \$1.3 billion , \$3.9 billion and \$6.2 billion , respectively, before commissions. To reflect share repurchases in the consolidated balance sheet, the Company (i) reduces common stock for the par value of the shares, (ii) reduces paid-in capital for the amount in excess of par to zero during the quarter in which the shares are repurchased and (iii) records the residual amount to retained earnings . At September 24, 2017 , \$1.6 billion remained authorized for repurchase under the Company's stock repurchase program.

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Dividends. On October 10, 2017, the Company announced a cash dividend of \$0.57 per share on the Company's common stock, payable on December 15, 2017 to stockholders of record as of the close of business on November 29, 2017. Dividends charged to retained earnings in fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 were as follows (in millions, except per share data):

	2017		2016		2015	
	Per Share	Total	Per Share	Total	Per Share	Total
First quarter	\$ 0.53	\$ 801	\$ 0.48	\$ 730	\$ 0.42	\$ 710
Second quarter	0.53	798	0.48	726	0.42	702
Third quarter	0.57	858	0.53	794	0.48	771
Fourth quarter	0.57	857	0.53	796	0.48	749
	<u>\$ 2.20</u>	<u>\$ 3,314</u>	<u>\$ 2.02</u>	<u>\$ 3,046</u>	<u>\$ 1.80</u>	<u>\$ 2,932</u>

Note 5. Employee Benefit Plans

Employee Savings and Retirement Plan. The Company has a 401(k) plan that allows eligible employees to contribute up to 85% of their eligible compensation, subject to annual limits. The Company matches a portion of the employee contributions and may, at its discretion, make additional contributions based upon earnings. The Company's contribution expense was \$76 million, \$74 million and \$81 million in fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, respectively.

Equity Compensation Plans. On March 8, 2016, the Company's stockholders approved the Qualcomm Incorporated 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan (the 2016 Plan), which replaced the Qualcomm Incorporated 2006 Long-Term Incentive Plan (the Prior Plan). Effective on and after that date, no new awards will be granted under the Prior Plan, although all outstanding awards under the Prior Plan will remain outstanding according to their terms and the terms of the Prior Plan. The 2016 Plan provides for the grant of incentive and nonstatutory stock options, stock appreciation rights, restricted stock, unrestricted stock, restricted stock units, performance units, performance shares, deferred compensation awards and other stock-based awards. The share reserve under the 2016 Plan is equal to 90,000,000 shares, plus approximately 20,120,000 shares that were available for future grant under the Prior Plan on March 8, 2016, for a total of approximately 110,120,000 shares available for grant under the 2016 Plan on that date. This share reserve is automatically increased as provided in the 2016 Plan by the number of shares subject to stock options granted under the Prior Plan and outstanding as of March 8, 2016, which after that date expire or for any reason are forfeited, canceled or terminated, and by two times the number of shares subject to any awards other than stock options granted under the Prior Plan and outstanding as of March 8, 2016, which after that date expire, are forfeited, canceled or terminated, fail to vest, are not earned due to any performance goal that is not met, are otherwise reacquired without having become vested, or are paid in cash, exchanged by a participant or withheld by the Company to satisfy any tax withholding or tax payment obligations related to such award. The Board of Directors of the Company may amend or terminate the 2016 Plan at any time. Certain amendments, including an increase in the share reserve, require stockholder approval. As of September 24, 2017, approximately 95,485,000 shares were available for future grant under the 2016 Plan.

RSUs are share awards that entitle the holder to receive shares of the Company's common stock upon vesting. The RSUs generally include dividend-equivalent rights and vest over periods of three years from the date of grant. A summary of RSU transactions for all equity compensation plans follows:

	Number of Shares	Weighted-Average Grant Date Fair Value	Aggregate Intrinsic Value
	(In thousands)		(In billions)
RSUs outstanding at September 25, 2016	26,078	\$ 61.42	
RSUs granted	12,525	66.54	
RSUs canceled/forfeited	(1,793)	63.17	
RSUs vested	(12,106)	64.34	
RSUs outstanding at September 24, 2017	<u>24,704</u>	<u>\$ 62.46</u>	<u>\$ 1.3</u>

At September 24, 2017, total unrecognized compensation expense related to non-vested RSUs granted prior to that date was \$911 million, which is expected to be recognized over a weighted-average period of 1.6 years. The total vest-date fair

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value of RSUs that vested during fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 was \$820 million , \$685 million and \$1.0 billion , respectively. The total shares withheld to satisfy statutory tax withholding requirements related to all share-based awards were approximately 4,247,000 , 4,300,000 and 5,043,000 in fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 , respectively, and were based on the value of the awards on their vesting dates as determined by the Company's closing stock price. Total payments for the employees' tax obligations to the taxing authorities were \$268 million , \$224 million and \$351 million in fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 , respectively, and were included as a reduction to net cash provided by operating activities in the consolidated statements of cash flows.

The Board of Directors may grant stock options to employees, directors and consultants to the Company to purchase shares of the Company's common stock at an exercise price not less than the fair market value of the stock at the date of grant. Stock options vest over periods not exceeding five years and are exercisable for up to ten years from the grant date. A summary of stock option transactions for all equity compensation plans follows:

	Number of Shares	Weighted- Average Exercise Price	Average Remaining Contractual Term	Aggregate Intrinsic Value
	(In thousands)		(Years)	(In millions)
Stock options outstanding at September 25, 2016	17,979	\$ 40.96		
Stock options canceled/forfeited/expired	(52)	27.33		
Stock options exercised	(5,542)	41.02		
Stock options outstanding at September 24, 2017	12,385	\$ 40.99	1.3	\$ 139
Exercisable at September 24, 2017	12,382	\$ 41.00	1.3	\$ 139

The total intrinsic value of stock options exercised during fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 was \$118 million , \$147 million and \$371 million , respectively, and the amount of cash received from the exercise of stock options was \$236 million , \$436 million and \$519 million , respectively. Upon option exercise, the Company issues new shares of stock.

The total tax benefits realized, including the excess tax benefits, related to share-based awards during fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 was \$301 million , \$253 million and \$437 million , respectively.

Employee Stock Purchase Plan. The Company has an employee stock purchase plan for eligible employees to purchase shares of common stock at 85% of the lower of the fair market value on the first or the last day of each offering period, which is generally six months. Employees may authorize the Company to withhold up to 15% of their compensation during any offering period, subject to certain limitations. The employee stock purchase plan includes a non-423(b) plan. The shares authorized under the employee stock purchase plan were approximately 71,709,000 at September 24, 2017 . The shares reserved for future issuance were approximately 14,648,000 at September 24, 2017 . During fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 , approximately 5,746,000 , 5,966,000 and 4,977,000 shares, respectively, were issued under the plan at an average price of \$45.29 , \$38.89 and \$53.92 per share, respectively. At September 24, 2017 , total unrecognized compensation expense related to non-vested purchase rights granted prior to that date was \$26 million . The Company recorded cash received from the exercise of purchase rights of \$260 million , \$232 million and \$268 million during fiscal 2017 , 2016 and 2015 , respectively.

Note 6. Debt

Revolving Credit Facility. In November 2016, the Company amended and restated its existing Revolving Credit Facility that provides for unsecured revolving facility loans, swing line loans and letters of credit (Amended and Restated Revolving Credit Facility) to increase the aggregate amount available to \$5.0 billion , of which \$530 million and \$4.47 billion will expire in February 2020 and November 2021 , respectively. The Company had not previously borrowed any funds under the existing Revolving Credit Facility. Proceeds from the Amended and Restated Revolving Credit Facility are expected to be used for general corporate purposes. Loans under the Amended and Restated Revolving Credit Facility will bear interest, at the option of the Company, at either the reserve-adjusted Eurocurrency Rate (determined in accordance with the Amended and Restated Revolving Credit Facility) or the Base Rate (determined in accordance with the Amended and Restated Revolving Credit Facility), in each case plus an applicable margin based on the Company's long-term unsecured senior, non-credit enhanced debt ratings. The initial margins over the reserve-adjusted Eurocurrency Rate and the Base Rate will be 0.70% and 0.00% per annum, respectively . The Amended and Restated Revolving Credit Facility has a facility fee, which initially accrues at a rate of 0.05% per annum. At September 24, 2017 , the Company had not borrowed any funds under the Amended and Restated Revolving Credit Facility .

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Commercial Paper Program. The Company has an unsecured commercial paper program, which provides for the issuance of up to \$5.0 billion of commercial paper. Net proceeds from this program are used for general corporate purposes. Maturities of commercial paper can range from 1 day to up to 397 days. At September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016, the Company had \$999 million and \$1.7 billion, respectively, of outstanding commercial paper recorded as short-term debt with a weighted-average interest rate of 1.19% and 0.52%, respectively, which included fees paid to the commercial paper dealers, and weighted-average remaining days to maturity of 45 days and 36 days, respectively. The carrying value of the outstanding commercial paper approximated its estimated fair value at September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016.

Bridge Loan Facility. In October 2016, the Company entered into commitment letters pursuant to which the Company received commitments for senior unsecured bridge facility loans in an aggregate principal amount up to \$13.6 billion (Bridge Loan Facility). Proceeds from the Bridge Loan Facility, if drawn, were intended to be used to finance, in part, the proposed acquisition of NXP Semiconductors N.V. (NXP) by Qualcomm River Holdings B.V., a wholly owned subsidiary of the Company (Qualcomm River Holdings) (Note 9). Subsequently, the commitments available under the Bridge Loan Facility were reduced to \$7.1 billion upon the Company entering into a \$4.0 billion Term Loan Facility, described below, and the sale of certain assets by NXP for estimated net cash proceeds of \$2.5 billion in February 2017. In May 2017, in connection with the Company's issuance of an aggregate principal amount of \$11.0 billion of unsecured floating-rate and fixed-rate notes, described below, the commitments available under the Bridge Loan Facility were reduced such that there were no remaining commitments available, and the Bridge Loan Facility was terminated. The Company had not previously borrowed any funds under the Bridge Loan Facility. The Bridge Loan Facility had a ticking fee, which accrued at a rate of 0.05% per annum commencing on December 26, 2016.

Term Loan Facility. In November 2016, the Company entered into a Credit Agreement that provides for senior unsecured delayed-draw term facility loans in an aggregate amount of \$4.0 billion (Term Loan Facility). Proceeds from the Term Loan Facility, if drawn, will be used to finance the proposed acquisition of NXP. Commitments under the Term Loan Facility will expire on the first to occur of (i) the consummation of the proposed acquisition of NXP without using loans under the Term Loan Facility, (ii) the termination of Qualcomm River Holdings's obligation to consummate the proposed acquisition of NXP and (iii) January 25, 2018 (which reflects the automatic extension of the original expiration date of October 27, 2017 in accordance with the NXP purchase agreement, and as such date may be further extended in accordance with the NXP purchase agreement). Loans under the Term Loan Facility will mature on the third anniversary of the date on which they are funded and will bear interest at either the reserve-adjusted Eurocurrency Rate (determined in accordance with the Term Loan Facility) or the Base Rate (determined in accordance with the Term Loan Facility), in each case plus an applicable margin based on the Company's long-term unsecured senior, non-credit enhanced debt ratings. The initial margins over the reserve-adjusted Eurocurrency Rate and the Base Rate will be 0.875% and 0.00% per annum, respectively. The Term Loan Facility has a ticking fee, which initially accrues at a rate of 0.05% per annum commencing on December 26, 2016. At September 24, 2017, the Company had not borrowed any funds under the Term Loan Facility.

Long-term Debt. In May 2015, the Company issued an aggregate principal amount of \$10.0 billion of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes (May 2015 Notes) with varying maturities. The proceeds from the May 2015 Notes of \$9.9 billion, net of underwriting discounts and offering expenses, were used to fund the ASR Agreements (Note 4) and also for other general corporate purposes. In May 2017, the Company issued an aggregate principal amount of \$11.0 billion of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes (May 2017 Notes) with varying maturities. The proceeds from the May 2017 Notes of \$10.95 billion, net of underwriting discounts and offering expenses, are intended to be used to finance, in part, the Company's proposed acquisition of NXP and other related transactions and for general corporate purposes. The following

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table provides a summary of the Company's long-term debt (in millions except percentages):

	September 24, 2017		September 25, 2016	
	Amount	Effective Rate	Amount	Effective Rate
May 2015 Notes				
Floating-rate three-month LIBOR plus 0.27% notes due May 18, 2018	\$ 250	1.65%	\$ 250	1.14%
Floating-rate three-month LIBOR plus 0.55% notes due May 20, 2020	250	1.92%	250	1.42%
Fixed-rate 1.40% notes due May 18, 2018	1,250	1.93%	1,250	0.93%
Fixed-rate 2.25% notes due May 20, 2020	1,750	2.20%	1,750	1.69%
Fixed-rate 3.00% notes due May 20, 2022	2,000	2.65%	2,000	2.04%
Fixed-rate 3.45% notes due May 20, 2025	2,000	3.46%	2,000	3.46%
Fixed-rate 4.65% notes due May 20, 2035	1,000	4.74%	1,000	4.74%
Fixed-rate 4.80% notes due May 20, 2045	1,500	4.71%	1,500	4.71%
May 2017 Notes				
Floating-rate three-month LIBOR plus 0.36% notes due May 20, 2019	750	1.80%	—	
Floating-rate three-month LIBOR plus 0.45% notes due May 20, 2020	500	1.86%	—	
Floating-rate three-month LIBOR plus 0.73% notes due January 30, 2023	500	2.11%	—	
Fixed-rate 1.85% notes due May 20, 2019	1,250	2.00%	—	
Fixed-rate 2.10% notes due May 20, 2020	1,500	2.19%	—	
Fixed-rate 2.60% notes due January 30, 2023	1,500	2.70%	—	
Fixed-rate 2.90% notes due May 20, 2024	1,500	3.01%	—	
Fixed-rate 3.25% notes due May 20, 2027	2,000	3.46%	—	
Fixed-rate 4.30% notes due May 20, 2047	1,500	4.47%	—	
Total principal	21,000		10,000	
Unamortized discount, including debt issuance costs	(106)		(57)	
Hedge accounting fair value adjustments	—		65	
Total long-term debt	\$ 20,894		\$ 10,008	
Reported as:				
Short-term debt	\$ 1,496		\$ —	
Long-term debt	19,398		10,008	
Total	\$ 20,894		\$ 10,008	

At September 24, 2017, future principal payments were \$1.5 billion in fiscal 2018, \$2.0 billion in fiscal 2019, \$4.0 billion in fiscal 2020, \$2.0 billion in fiscal 2022 and \$11.5 billion after fiscal 2022; no principal payments are due in fiscal 2021.

The Company's 2019 floating-rate notes, 2020 floating-rate notes, 2019 fixed-rate notes and 2020 fixed-rate notes issued in May 2017 for an aggregate principal amount of \$4.0 billion are subject to a special mandatory redemption at a price equal to 101% of the aggregate principal amount, plus accrued and unpaid interest to, but excluding, the date of such mandatory redemption. The redemption is required on the first to occur of (i) the termination of the NXP purchase agreement or (ii) January 25, 2018 (which reflects the automatic extension of the original expiration date of October 27, 2017 in accordance with the NXP purchase agreement, and as such date may be further extended in accordance with the NXP purchase agreement to a date on or prior to June 1, 2018).

The Company may redeem the fixed-rate notes at any time in whole, or from time to time in part, at specified make-whole premiums as defined in the applicable form of note. The Company may not redeem the floating-rate notes prior to maturity. The obligations under the notes rank equally in right of payment with all of the Company's other senior unsecured indebtedness and will effectively rank junior to all liabilities of the Company's subsidiaries. At September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016, the aggregate fair value of the notes, based on Level 2 inputs, was approximately \$21.5 billion and \$ 10.6 billion, respectively.

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In connection with issuance of the May 2015 Notes, the Company entered into interest rate swaps with an aggregate notional amount of \$3.0 billion, which effectively converted all of the fixed-rate notes due in 2018 and approximately 43% and 50% of the fixed-rate notes due in 2020 and 2022, respectively, into floating-rate notes. The net gains and losses on the interest rate swaps, as well as the offsetting gains or losses on the related fixed-rate notes attributable to the hedged risks, are recognized in earnings in interest expense in the current period. The Company did not enter into similar interest rate swaps in connection with issuance of the May 2017 Notes.

The effective interest rates for the notes include the interest on the notes, amortization of the discount, which includes debt issuance costs, and if applicable, adjustments related to hedging. Interest is payable in arrears quarterly for the floating-rate notes and semi-annually for the fixed-rate notes. Cash interest paid related to the Company's commercial paper program and long-term debt, net of cash received from the related interest rate swaps, was \$313 million, \$282 million and negligible during fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, respectively.

Debt Covenants. The Amended and Restated Revolving Credit Facility and the Term Loan Facility require, and the Bridge Loan Facility and prior Revolving Credit Facility required, that the Company comply with certain covenants, including one financial covenant to maintain a ratio of consolidated earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization to consolidated interest expense, as defined in each of the respective agreements, of not less than three to one at the end of each fiscal quarter. The Company is not subject to any financial covenants under the notes nor any covenants that would prohibit the Company from incurring additional indebtedness ranking equal to the notes, paying dividends, issuing securities or repurchasing securities issued by it or its subsidiaries. At September 24, 2017 and September 25, 2016, the Company was in compliance with the applicable covenants under each facility outstanding at such time.

Note 7. Commitments and Contingencies

Legal and Regulatory Proceedings.

ParkerVision, Inc. v. QUALCOMM Incorporated : On May 1, 2014, ParkerVision filed a complaint against the Company in the United States District Court for the Middle District of Florida alleging that certain of the Company's products infringe certain ParkerVision patents. On August 21, 2014, ParkerVision amended the complaint, now captioned ParkerVision, Inc. v. QUALCOMM Incorporated, Qualcomm Atheros, Inc., HTC Corporation, HTC America, Inc., Samsung Electronics Co., LTD., Samsung Electronics America, Inc. and Samsung Telecommunications America, LLC, broadening the allegations. ParkerVision alleged that the Company infringes 11 ParkerVision patents and seeks damages and injunctive and other relief. On December 3, 2015, ParkerVision dismissed six patents from the lawsuit and granted the Company and all other defendants a covenant not to assert those patents against any existing products. On February 2, 2016, after agreement among the parties, the District Court stayed the remainder of the case pending the resolution of the complaint filed by ParkerVision against the Company and other parties with the United States International Trade Commission (ITC) described below. Subsequently, ParkerVision announced that it had reached a settlement with Samsung which dismissed the Samsung entities from the District Court case. The Company had previously filed Inter-Partes Review petitions with the United States Patent and Trademark Office (USPTO) to invalidate all asserted claims of several of the remaining patents. On March 7, 2017, the USPTO decided in the Company's favor with respect to all asserted claims of one such patent. After the ITC action described below was closed, and upon agreement among the parties, on May 24, 2017, the District Court further stayed the District Court case pending ParkerVision's appeals of the USPTO's invalidation decisions.

On December 14, 2015, ParkerVision filed another complaint against the Company in the United States District Court for the Middle District of Florida alleging patent infringement. Apple Inc., Samsung Electronics Co., LTD., Samsung Electronics America, Inc., Samsung Telecommunications America, LLC, Samsung Semiconductor, Inc., LG Electronics, Inc., LG Electronics U.S.A., Inc. and LG Electronics MobileComm U.S.A., Inc. are also named defendants. The complaint asserts that certain of the Company's products infringe four additional ParkerVision patents and seeks damages and other relief. On December 15, 2015, ParkerVision filed a complaint with the ITC pursuant to Section 337 of the Tariff Act of 1930 against the same parties asserting the same four patents. The complaint seeks an exclusion order barring the importation of products that use either of two Company transceivers or one Samsung transceiver and a cease and desist order preventing the Company and the other defendants from carrying out commercial activities within the United States related to such products. On January 13, 2016, the Company served its answer to the District Court complaint. On January 15, 2016, the ITC instituted an investigation. On February 12, 2016, the District Court case was stayed pending completion of the ITC investigation. Subsequently, ParkerVision announced that it had reached a settlement with Samsung which dismissed the Samsung entities from the ITC investigation and related District Court case. On February 2, 2017, the ITC granted ParkerVision's motion to drop all but one patent and one accused product from the ITC investigation. On March 12, 2017, one day before the ITC hearing was scheduled to begin, ParkerVision moved to withdraw its ITC complaint in its entirety. The Company and the

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other defendants did not oppose the withdrawal of the complaint. On April 28, 2017, the ITC formally closed the investigation. On May 4, 2017, ParkerVision filed a motion to reopen the related District Court Case, and on May 26, 2017, the District Court granted the motion. On July 19, 2017, the District Court set an approximate date of mid-January 2018 for a claim construction hearing. A trial date has not been set.

Apple Inc. (Apple) v. QUALCOMM Incorporated: On January 20, 2017, Apple filed a complaint against the Company in the United States District Court for the Southern District of California seeking declarations with respect to several of the Company's patents and alleging that the Company breached certain agreements and violated federal antitrust and California state unfair competition laws. In its initial complaint, Apple sought declaratory judgments of non-infringement by Apple of nine of the Company's patents, or in the alternative, a declaration of royalties Apple must pay for the patents. Apple further sought a declaration that the Company's sale of baseband chipsets exhausts the Company's patent rights for patents embodied in those chipsets. Separately, Apple sought to enjoin the Company from seeking excessive royalties from Apple and to disgorge royalties paid by Apple's contract manufacturers that the court finds were not fair, reasonable and non-discriminatory (FRAND). Apple also claimed that the Company's refusal to make certain payments to Apple under a Business Cooperation and Patent Agreement (Cooperation Agreement) constitutes a breach of contract in violation of California law and sought damages in the amount of the unpaid payments, alleged to be approximately \$1 billion. In addition, Apple claimed that the Company has refused to deal with competitors in contravention of the Company's agreements with applicable standard setting organizations, has used its market position to impose contractual obligations on Apple that prevented Apple from challenging the Company's licensing practices, has tied the purchase of the Company's CDMA-enabled and "premium" LTE-enabled chipsets to licensing certain of the Company's patents and has required Apple to purchase baseband chipsets exclusively from the Company as a condition of the Company's payment to Apple of certain rebates, in violation of Section 2 of the Sherman Act and the California Unfair Competition Law. Apple sought injunctive relief with respect to these claims and a judgment awarding its expenses, costs and attorneys' fees.

On April 10, 2017, the Company filed its Answer and Counterclaims (amended on May 24, 2017) in response to Apple's complaint denying Apple's claims and asserting claims against Apple. The counterclaims against Apple include tortious interference with the Company's long-standing Subscriber Unit License Agreements (SULAs) with third-party contract manufacturers of Apple devices, causing those contract manufacturers to withhold certain royalty payments owed to the Company and violate their audit obligations; breach of contract and the implied covenant of good faith and fair dealing relating to the parties' Cooperation Agreement; unjust enrichment and declaratory relief relating to the Cooperation Agreement; breach of contract based on Apple's failure to pay amounts owed to the Company under a Statement of Work relating to a high-speed feature of the Company's chipsets; breach of the parties' software agreement; and violation of California Unfair Competition Law based on Apple's threatening the Company to prevent it from promoting the superior performance of the Company's own chipsets. The Company also seeks declaratory judgments that the Company has satisfied its FRAND commitments with respect to Apple, and that the Company's SULAs with the contract manufacturers do not violate either competition law or the Company's FRAND commitments. On June 19, 2017, Apple filed a Partial Motion to Dismiss the Company's counterclaim for violation of the California Unfair Competition Law. A hearing on that motion was held on October 13, 2017. The court has not yet ruled on the motion. On June 20, 2017, Apple filed an Answer and Affirmative Defenses to the rest of the Company's counterclaims, and also filed an Amended Complaint reiterating all of the original claims and adding claims for declaratory judgments of invalidity of the nine patents that are subject to declaratory judgment claims in the original complaint, adding new declaratory judgment claims for non-infringement, invalidity and a declaration of royalties for nine more patents. Apple also added claims for declaratory judgments that certain of the Company's agreements are unenforceable. On July 21, 2017, the Company filed an Answer to Apple's Amended Complaint as well as a motion to dismiss the new declaratory judgment claims for non-infringement, invalidity and a declaration of royalties for the nine additional patents. A hearing on that motion was also held on October 13, 2017. The court has not yet ruled on the motion. On July 18, 2017, Apple filed a motion to consolidate this action with *QUALCOMM Incorporated v. Compal Electronics, Inc., et al.*, discussed below, and on September 13, 2017, the court granted that motion.

On January 23, 2017, an Apple subsidiary in China filed two complaints against the Company in the Beijing Intellectual Property Court. On March 31, 2017, the court granted an application by Apple Inc. to join the actions as a plaintiff, and Apple amended the complaints. One of the complaints alleges a violation of China's Anti-Monopoly Law (AML complaint); the other complaint requests a determination of the terms of a patent license between the Company and Apple (FRAND complaint). The AML complaint alleges that (i) the Company has abused its dominant position in communication standard-essential patents licensing markets and certain global baseband chipset markets by charging and offering royalty terms that were excessively high; (ii) the Company refused to license certain implementers of standardized technologies, including Apple and baseband chipset manufacturers; (iii) the Company forced Apple to use only the Company's products and services; and (iv) the Company bundled licenses to standard-essential patents with licenses to non-standard-essential patents and

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imposed other unreasonable or discriminatory trading terms on Apple in violation of the AML. The AML complaint seeks a decree that the Company cease the alleged abuse of dominance, as well as damages in the amount of 1 billion Chinese Renminbi (approximately \$152 million based on the exchange rate on September 24, 2017). The FRAND complaint makes allegations similar to the AML complaint and further alleges that the Company refused to offer licensing terms for the Company's cellular standard-essential patents consistent with the Company's FRAND licensing commitments and failed to provide to Apple certain information about the Company's patents. The FRAND complaint seeks (i) a declaration that the license terms offered to Apple by the Company for its mobile communication standard essential patents are not compliant with FRAND; (ii) an order that the Company cease its actions that allegedly violate the Company's FRAND obligations, including pricing on unfair, unreasonable and excessive terms, refusing to deal, imposing unreasonable trade conditions and failing to provide information on the Company's patents; and (iii) a determination of FRAND-compliant license terms for the Company's Chinese standard-essential patents. Apple also seeks its expenses in each of the cases. On August 3, 2017, the Company received three additional complaints filed by an Apple subsidiary and Apple Inc. against the Company in the Beijing Intellectual Property Court. The complaints seek declaratory judgments of non-infringement of three Qualcomm patents.

On February 16, 2017, Apple and one of its Japanese subsidiaries filed four complaints against the Company in the Tokyo District Court. In three of the complaints, Apple seeks declaratory judgment of non-infringement by Apple of three of the Company's patents. Apple further seeks a declaration that the Company's patent rights with respect to those three patents are exhausted by the Company's SULAs with the contract manufacturers of Apple's devices as well as the Company's sale of baseband chipsets. Apple also seeks an award of fees. On May 15, 2017, the Company learned of the fourth complaint. In that complaint, Apple and one of its Japanese subsidiaries seek damages of 100 million Japanese Yen (approximately \$1 million based on the exchange rate on September 24, 2017) from the Company based on allegations that the Company violated the Japanese Antimonopoly Act and the Japanese Civil Code. In particular, the fourth complaint alleges that (i) the Company holds a monopoly position in the market for baseband processor chipsets that implement certain cellular standards; (ii) the Company collects double royalties through its license agreements and the sale of chipsets; (iii) the Company refused to grant Apple a license on FRAND terms and forced Apple to execute a rebate agreement under unreasonable conditions; (iv) the Company refused to grant Apple a direct license; and (v) the Company demanded a license fee based on the market value of the total device. The Company has filed answers to all four of the complaints.

On March 2, 2017, the Company learned that Apple and certain of its European subsidiaries issued a Claim Form against the Company in the UK High Court of Justice, Chancery Division, Patents Court on January 23, 2017. Apple subsequently filed an Amended Claim Form and Particulars of Claim. Both the Amended Claim Form and the Particulars of Claim allege several European competition law claims, including refusal to license competing chipmakers, failure to offer Apple a direct license to the Company's standard-essential patents on FRAND terms, demanding excessive royalties for the Company's standard-essential patents, and demanding excessive license fees for the use of the Company's standard-essential patents in connection with chipsets purchased from the Company. Apple also seeks declarations that the Company is obliged to offer a direct patent license to Apple in respect of standard-essential patents actually practiced on fair, reasonable and non-discriminatory terms and that using the Company's chipsets does not infringe any of the Company's patents because the Company exhausted its patent rights. Finally, Apple seeks declarations that five of the Company's European (UK) patents are invalid and not essential, and an order that each of those patents be revoked.

On April 20, 2017, the Company was informed that on April 18, 2017, Apple and one of its Taiwanese subsidiaries filed a complaint against the Company in the Taiwan Intellectual Property Court alleging that the Company has abused a dominant market position in licensing wireless standard-essential patents and selling baseband chipsets, including improper pricing, refusal to deal, exclusive dealing, tying, imposing unreasonable trade terms and discriminatory treatment. The complaint seeks rulings that the Company not use the sales price of the terminal device as the royalty base for standard-essential patents; not leverage its cellular standard-essential patents to obtain licenses of its non-standard-essential patents or demand cross-licenses without proper compensation; not refuse, reduce, delay or take any other action to limit the supply of its baseband chipsets to non-licensees; that the Company must license its standard-essential patents on FRAND terms; and that the Company shall not, based on standard-essential patents, seek injunctions. The complaint also seeks damages of 10 million Taiwan Dollars (less than \$1 million based on the exchange rate on September 24, 2017), among other relief.

On July 14, 2017, the Company filed a motion for anti-suit injunction in the United States District Court for the Southern District of California, asking the court to enjoin Apple from pursuing its foreign actions in the UK, China, Japan and Taiwan and from initiating other duplicative foreign actions, while the action in the Southern District of California is pending. On September 7, 2017, the court denied this motion.

The Company believes Apple's claims in the above matters are without merit.

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QUALCOMM Incorporated v. Compal Electronics, Inc. et al. : On May 17, 2017, the Company filed a complaint in the United States District Court for the Southern District of California against Compal Electronics, Inc. (Compal), FIH Mobile, Ltd., Hon Hai Precision Industry Co., Ltd. (together with FIH Mobile, Ltd., Foxconn), Pegatron Corporation (Pegatron) and Wistron Corporation (Wistron) asserting claims for injunctive relief, specific performance, declaratory relief and damages stemming from the defendants' breach of contracts by ceasing the payment of royalties for iPhones and other devices which they manufacture for Apple. On May 24, 2017, the Company filed a Motion for Preliminary Injunction seeking to enjoin each of the defendants from violating their license agreements during the pendency of the litigation. On July 17, 2017, Compal, Foxconn, Pegatron and Wistron each filed third-party complaints for contractual indemnity against Apple seeking to join Apple as a party to the action. On July 18, 2017, Apple filed an answer to these third party complaints acknowledging its indemnity agreements and consenting to be joined. On that same date, the defendants and Apple filed papers opposing the motion for preliminary injunction. On August 18, 2017, a hearing on the preliminary injunction motion was held, and on September 7, 2017, the court denied the motion. Also on July 18, 2017, the defendants filed an Answer and Counterclaims to the complaint, asserting defenses and counterclaims similar to allegations previously made by Apple in the *Apple Inc. v. QUALCOMM Incorporated* case in the Southern District of California discussed above. In addition, the defendants asserted certain new claims, including claims under Section 1 of the Sherman Act and California's Cartwright Act. The defendants seek damages, declaratory relief, injunctive relief, restitution of certain royalties and other relief. On July 18, 2017, Apple filed a motion to consolidate this action with the *Apple Inc. v. QUALCOMM Incorporated* case in the Southern District of California. On September 13, 2017, the court granted Apple's consolidation motion.

The Company believes Compal's, Foxconn's, Pegatron's and Wistron's claims in the above matter are without merit.

QUALCOMM Incorporated v. Apple Inc. : On July 6, 2017, the Company filed a complaint against Apple in the United States District Court for the Southern District of California asserting claims for damages and injunctive relief for infringement of six of the Company's patents directed to a variety of features found in iPhone models. On July 7, 2017, the Company filed a complaint against Apple in the United States International Trade Commission (ITC) requesting that the ITC institute an investigation pursuant to Section 337 of the Tariff Act of 1930 based on Apple's infringement of the same six patents. The Company is seeking a limited exclusion order and cease and desist order against importation of iPhone models that do not contain a Qualcomm brand baseband processor. The patents have not been declared as essential to any standards organization and are not subject to commitments to license on FRAND terms. Apple filed an Answer and Counterclaims in the District Court case on September 26, 2017, but no schedule has been set in that case. On August 8, 2017, the ITC issued a notice of institution of an investigation. On August 25, 2017, the Company withdrew allegations as to one patent in both the ITC investigation and the District Court case. A claim construction hearing is scheduled in the ITC investigation for January 22-23, 2018. The ITC investigation is scheduled for evidentiary hearing by the Administrative Law Judge (ALJ) from June 18-26, 2018. The ALJ's Initial Determination on the merits is due on September 14, 2018, and the target date for final determination by the ITC is set for January 14, 2019.

On July 17, 2017, the Company filed complaints against Apple and certain of its subsidiaries in the Federal Republic of Germany, asserting infringement of one patent in the Mannheim District Court and infringement of another patent in the Munich District Court. On October 2, 2017, the Company filed claim extensions in these actions against Apple and certain of its subsidiaries, asserting infringement of two additional patents in the Mannheim District Court and infringement of five additional patents in the Munich District Court. The complaints seek remedies including, among other relief, declaratory relief confirming liability on the merits for damages and injunctive relief. The patents have not been declared as essential to any standards organization and are not subject to commitments to license on FRAND terms.

On September 29, 2017, the Company filed three complaints against Apple and certain of its subsidiaries in the Beijing (China) Intellectual Property Court, asserting infringement of three patents. The complaints seek remedies including injunctive relief and costs. The patents have not been declared as essential to any standards organization and are not subject to commitments to license on FRAND terms.

On November 1, 2017, the Company filed a complaint against Apple in San Diego Superior Court for breach of the Master Software Agreement between the companies. The complaint recounts instances when Apple failed to protect the Company's software as required by the agreement and failed to provide sufficient information to which the Company is entitled under the agreement in order to understand whether other breaches have occurred. The complaint seeks specific performance of Apple's obligations to cooperate with an audit of its handling of the Company's software, damages and injunctive relief. No case schedule has yet been set.

3226701 Canada, Inc. v. QUALCOMM Incorporated et al: On November 30, 2015, plaintiffs filed a securities class action complaint against the Company and certain of its current and former officers in the United States District Court for the

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Southern District of California. On April 29, 2016, plaintiffs filed an amended complaint. On January 27, 2017, the court dismissed the amended complaint in its entirety, granting leave to amend. On March 17, 2017, plaintiffs filed a second amended complaint, alleging that the Company and certain of its current and former officers violated Sections 10(b) and 20(a) of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934, as amended, by making false and misleading statements regarding the Company's business outlook and product development between November 19, 2014 and July 22, 2015. The second amended complaint seeks unspecified damages, interest, attorneys' fees and other costs. On May 8, 2017, the Company filed a motion to dismiss the second amended complaint, and on October 20, 2017, the court entered an order granting in part and denying in part the Company's motion to dismiss. The court dismissed all claims as to all defendants other than the Company and Steve Mollenkopf with prejudice. The court also limited the case to two statements which it found, at least for pleading purposes, had stated a claim that could be explored in the discovery process. The Company believes the plaintiffs' claims are without merit.

Consolidated Securities Class Action Lawsuit: On January 23, 2017 and January 26, 2017, respectively, two securities class action complaints were filed by purported stockholders of the Company in the United States District Court for the Southern District of California against the Company and certain of its current and former officers and directors. The complaints alleged, among other things, that the defendants violated Sections 10(b) and 20(a) of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934, and Rule 10b-5 thereunder, by making false and misleading statements and omissions of material fact in connection with certain allegations that the Company is or was engaged in anticompetitive conduct. The complaints sought unspecified damages, interest, fees and costs. On May 4, 2017, the court consolidated the two actions and appointed lead plaintiffs. On July 3, 2017, the lead plaintiffs filed a consolidated amended complaint asserting the same basic theories of liability and requesting the same basic relief. On September 1, 2017, the defendants filed a motion to dismiss the consolidated amended complaint. The hearing on that motion is scheduled for December 4, 2017. The Company believes the plaintiffs' claims are without merit.

Consumer Class Action Lawsuit: Since January 18, 2017, a number of consumer class action complaints have been filed against the Company in the United States District Courts for the Southern and Northern Districts of California, each on behalf of a putative class of purchasers of cellular phones and other cellular devices. Twenty-four such cases remain outstanding. In April 2017, the Judicial Panel on Multidistrict Litigation transferred the cases that had been filed in the Southern District of California to the Northern District of California. On May 15, 2017, the court entered an order appointing the plaintiffs' co-lead counsel, and on May 25, 2017, set a trial date of April 29, 2019. On July 11, 2017, plaintiffs filed a consolidated amended complaint alleging that the Company violated California and federal antitrust and unfair competition laws by, among other things, refusing to license standard-essential patents to its competitors, conditioning the supply of certain of its baseband chipsets on the purchaser first agreeing to license the Company's entire patent portfolio, entering into exclusive deals with companies including Apple Inc., and charging unreasonably high royalties that do not comply with the Company's commitments to standard setting organizations. The complaint seeks unspecified damages and disgorgement and/or restitution, as well as an order that the Company be enjoined from further unlawful conduct. On August 11, 2017, the Company filed a motion to dismiss the consolidated amended complaint. The Company believes the plaintiffs' claims are without merit.

Japan Fair Trade Commission (JFTC) Complaint : The JFTC received unspecified complaints alleging that the Company's business practices are, in some way, a violation of Japanese law. On September 29, 2009, the JFTC issued a cease and desist order concluding that the Company's Japanese licensees were forced to cross-license patents to the Company on a royalty-free basis and were forced to accept a provision under which they agreed not to assert their essential patents against the Company's other licensees who made a similar commitment in their license agreements with the Company. The cease and desist order seeks to require the Company to modify its existing license agreements with Japanese companies to eliminate these provisions while preserving the license of the Company's patents to those companies. The Company disagrees with the conclusions that it forced its Japanese licensees to agree to any provision in the parties' agreements and that those provisions violate the Japanese Antimonopoly Act. The Company has invoked its right under Japanese law to an administrative hearing before the JFTC. In February 2010, the Tokyo High Court granted the Company's motion and issued a stay of the cease and desist order pending the administrative hearing before the JFTC. The JFTC has held hearings on 37 different dates. No further hearings are currently scheduled.

Korea Fair Trade Commission (KFTC) Complaint : On January 4, 2010, the KFTC issued a written decision finding that the Company had violated Korean law by offering certain discounts and rebates for purchases of its CDMA chipsets and for including in certain agreements language requiring the continued payment of royalties after all licensed patents have expired. The KFTC levied a fine, which the Company paid and recorded as an expense in fiscal 2010. The Company appealed to the Seoul High Court, and on June 19, 2013, the Seoul High Court affirmed the KFTC's decision. On July 4, 2013, the Company

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filed an appeal with the Korea Supreme Court. There have been no material developments since then with respect to this matter.

Korea Fair Trade Commission (KFTC) Investigation : On March 17, 2015, the KFTC notified the Company that it was conducting an investigation of the Company relating to the Korean Monopoly Regulation and Fair Trade Act (MRFTA). On December 27, 2016, the KFTC announced that it had reached a decision in the investigation, finding that the Company has violated provisions of the MRFTA. On January 22, 2017, the Company received the KFTC's formal written decision, which finds that the following conducts violate the MRFTA: (i) refusing to license, or imposing restrictions on licenses for, cellular communications standard-essential patents with competing modem chipset makers; (ii) conditioning the supply of modem chipsets to handset suppliers on their execution and performance of license agreements with the Company; and (iii) coercing agreement terms including portfolio license terms, royalty terms and free cross-grant terms in executing patent license agreements with handset makers. The KFTC's decision orders the Company to: (i) upon request by modem chipset companies, engage in good-faith negotiations for patent license agreements, without offering unjustifiable conditions, and if necessary submit to a determination of terms by an independent third party; (ii) not demand that handset companies execute and perform under patent license agreements as a precondition for purchasing modem chips; (iii) not demand unjustifiable conditions in the Company's license agreements with handset companies, and upon request renegotiate existing patent license agreements; and (iv) notify modem chipset companies and handset companies of the decision and order imposed on the Company and report to the KFTC new or amended agreements. According to the KFTC's decision, the foregoing will apply to transactions between the Company and the following enterprises: (i) handset manufacturers headquartered in Korea and their affiliate companies; (ii) enterprises that sell handsets in or to Korea and their affiliate companies; (iii) enterprises that supply handsets to companies referred in (ii) above and the affiliate companies of such enterprises; (iv) modem chipset manufacturers headquartered in Korea and their affiliate companies; and (v) enterprises that supply modem chipsets to companies referred in (i), (ii) or (iii) above and the affiliate companies of such enterprises. The KFTC's decision also imposed a fine of approximately 1.03 trillion Korean Won (approximately \$927 million), which was paid on March 30, 2017. The Company believes that its business practices do not violate the MRFTA, and on February 21, 2017 filed an action in the Seoul High Court to cancel the KFTC's decision. The Seoul High Court has not ruled on the Company's action to cancel the KFTC's decision. On the same day, the Company filed an application with the Seoul High Court to stay the decision's remedial order pending the Seoul High Court's final judgment on the Company's action to cancel the KFTC's decision. The Seoul High Court held hearings on the Company's application to stay the decision's remedial order on July 10, 2017 and July 14, 2017. On September 4, 2017, the Seoul High Court denied the Company's application to stay the remedial order. The Company has appealed the Seoul High Court's decision to the Korea Supreme Court. The Supreme Court has not ruled on the Company's appeal of the stay decision.

Icera Complaint to the European Commission (Commission) : On June 7, 2010, the Commission notified and provided the Company with a redacted copy of a complaint filed with the Commission by Icera, Inc. (subsequently acquired by Nvidia Corporation) alleging that the Company has engaged in anticompetitive activity. The Company was asked by the Commission to submit a preliminary response to the portions of the complaint disclosed to it, and the Company submitted its response in July 2010. Subsequently, the Company provided additional documents and information as requested by the Commission. On July 16, 2015, the Commission announced that it had initiated formal proceedings in this matter. On December 8, 2015, the Commission announced that it had issued a Statement of Objections expressing its preliminary view that between 2009 and 2011, the Company engaged in predatory pricing by selling certain baseband chipsets to two customers at prices below cost, with the intention of hindering competition. A Statement of Objections informs the subject of the investigation of the allegations against it and provides an opportunity to respond to such allegations. It is not a determination of the final outcome of the investigation. On August 15, 2016, the Company submitted its response to the Statement of Objections. If a violation is found, a broad range of remedies is potentially available to the Commission, including imposing a fine and/or injunctive relief prohibiting or restricting certain business practices. It is difficult to predict the outcome of this matter or what remedies, if any, may be imposed by the Commission. The Company believes that its business practices do not violate the EU competition rules.

European Commission (Commission) Investigation : On October 15, 2014, the Commission notified the Company that it is conducting an investigation of the Company relating to Articles 101 and/or 102 of the Treaty on the Functioning of the European Union (TFEU). On July 16, 2015, the Commission announced that it had initiated formal proceedings in this matter. On December 8, 2015, the Commission announced that it had issued a Statement of Objections expressing its preliminary view that since 2011 the Company has paid significant amounts to a customer on condition that it exclusively use the Company's baseband chipsets in its smartphones and tablets. This conduct has allegedly reduced the customer's incentives to source chipsets from the Company's competitors and harmed competition and innovation for certain baseband chipsets. A Statement of Objections informs the subject of the investigation of the allegations against it and provides an

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opportunity to respond to such allegations. It is not a determination of the final outcome of the investigation. On June 27, 2016, the Company submitted its response to the Statement of Objections. If a violation is found, a broad range of remedies is potentially available to the Commission, including imposing a fine and/or injunctive relief prohibiting or restricting certain business practices. It is difficult to predict the outcome of this matter or what remedies, if any, may be imposed by the Commission. The Company believes that its business practices do not violate the EU competition rules.

United States Federal Trade Commission (FTC) v. QUALCOMM Incorporated : On September 17, 2014, the FTC notified the Company that it is conducting an investigation of the Company relating to Section 5 of the Federal Trade Commission Act (FTCA). On January 17, 2017, the FTC filed a complaint against the Company in the United States District Court for the Northern District of California alleging that the Company engaged in anticompetitive conduct and unfair methods of competition in violation of Section 5 of the FTCA by conditioning the supply of baseband processors on the purchaser first agreeing to a license to the Company's standard-essential patents, paying incentives to purchasers of baseband processors to induce them to accept certain license terms, refusing to license its standard-essential patents to the Company's competitors and entering into alleged exclusive dealing arrangements with Apple Inc. The complaint seeks a permanent injunction against the Company's alleged violations of the FTCA and other unspecified ancillary equitable relief. The Company filed a motion to dismiss the FTC's complaint on April 3, 2017, which the court denied on June 26, 2017. On April 19, 2017, the court set a trial date for January 4, 2019. The Company believes the FTC's claims are without merit.

Taiwan Fair Trade Commission (TFTC) Investigation : On December 4, 2015, the TFTC notified the Company that it was conducting an investigation into whether the Company's patent licensing practices violate the Taiwan Fair Trade Act (TFTA). On April 27, 2016, the TFTC specified that the allegations under investigation include whether: (i) the Company jointly licensed its patents rather than separately licensing standard-essential patents and non-standard-essential patents; (ii) the Company's royalty charges are unreasonable; (iii) the Company unreasonably required licensees to grant it cross-licenses; (iv) the Company failed to provide lists of licensed patents to licensees; (v) the Company violated a FRAND licensing commitment by declining to grant licenses to chipset makers; (vi) the Company declined to sell chipsets to unlicensed potential customers; and (vii) the Company provided royalty rebates to certain companies in exchange for their exclusive use of the Company's chipsets. On October 11, 2017, the TFTC announced that it had reached a decision in the investigation, finding that the Company has violated the TFTA. On October 23, 2017, the Company received TFTC's formal written decision, which finds that the following conducts violate the TFTA: (i) refusing to license and demanding restrictive covenants from chip competitors; (ii) refusing to supply baseband processors to companies that do not have an executed license; and (iii) providing a royalty discount to Apple in exchange for its exclusive use of the Company's chipsets. The TFTC's decision orders the Company to: (1) cease the following conduct within 60 days of the day after receipt of the decision: (a) applying the clauses in an agreement entered into with a competing chip supplier requesting it to provide sensitive sales information such as chip prices, customers, sales volumes, product types and serial numbers; (b) applying clauses in component supply agreements entered into with handset manufacturers relating to the refusal to sell chips to unlicensed manufacturers; and (c) applying discount clauses in the exclusive agreement entered into with a relevant enterprise; (2) notify competing chip companies and handset manufacturers in writing within 30 days after receipt of the decision that those companies may request to amend or enter into patent license agreements and other relevant agreements within 60 days of the day following the day such notices are received, and upon receipt of such requests, the Company shall commence negotiation in good faith; (3) submit status reports to the TFTC on any such negotiations every six months beginning from the day after receipt of the decision, as well as to submit a report to the TFTC within 30 days after amendments to any license agreements or newly signed license agreements are executed. The TFTC's decision also imposed a fine of 23.4 billion Taiwan Dollars (approximately \$778 million based on the exchange rate at September 24, 2017), which is due on or before November 7, 2017. The Company believes that its business practices do not violate the TFTA and intends to seek a stay of, and to file an action to revoke, the TFTC's decision.

Contingent losses: The Company will continue to vigorously defend itself in the foregoing matters. However, litigation and investigations are inherently uncertain. Accordingly, the Company cannot predict the outcome of these matters. Other than with respect to the TFTC fine, the Company has not recorded any accrual at September 24, 2017 for contingent losses associated with these matters based on its belief that losses, while possible, are not probable. Further, any possible range of loss cannot be reasonably estimated at this time. The unfavorable resolution of one or more of these matters could have a material adverse effect on the Company's business, results of operations, financial condition or cash flows. The Company is engaged in numerous other legal actions not described above arising in the ordinary course of its business and, while there can be no assurance, believes that the ultimate outcome of these other legal actions will not have a material adverse effect on its business, results of operations, financial condition or cash flows.

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Indemnifications . The Company generally does not indemnify its customers and licensees for losses sustained from infringement of third-party intellectual property rights. However, the Company is contingently liable under certain product sales, services, license and other agreements to indemnify certain customers, chipset foundries and semiconductor assembly and test service providers against certain types of liability and/or damages arising from qualifying claims of patent, copyright, trademark or trade secret infringement by products or services sold or provided by the Company, or by intellectual property provided by the Company to chipset foundries and semiconductor assembly and test service providers. The Company's obligations under these agreements may be limited in terms of time and/or amount, and in some instances, the Company may have recourse against third parties for certain payments made by the Company.

Through September 24, 2017, the Company has received a number of claims from its direct and indirect customers and other third parties for indemnification under such agreements with respect to alleged infringement of third-party intellectual property rights by its products. Reimbursements under indemnification arrangements have not been material to the Company's consolidated financial statements. The Company has not recorded any accrual for contingent liabilities at September 24, 2017 associated with these indemnification arrangements based on the Company's belief that additional liabilities, while possible, are not probable. Further, any possible range of loss cannot be reasonably estimated at this time.

Purchase Obligations . The Company has agreements with suppliers and other parties to purchase inventory, other goods and services and long-lived assets. Obligations under these agreements at September 24, 2017 for each of the subsequent five years from fiscal 2018 through 2022 were \$4.3 billion, \$1.0 billion, \$376 million, \$120 million and \$27 million, respectively, and there were no obligations thereafter. Of these amounts, for each of the subsequent five years from fiscal 2018 through 2022, commitments to purchase integrated circuit product inventories comprised \$3.5 billion, \$846 million, \$286 million, \$72 million and \$27 million, respectively, and there were no purchase commitments thereafter. Integrated circuit product inventory obligations represent purchase commitments for raw materials, semiconductor die, finished goods and manufacturing services, such as wafer bump, probe, assembly and final test. Under the Company's manufacturing relationships with its foundry suppliers and assembly and test service providers, cancellation of outstanding purchase commitments is generally allowed but requires payment of costs incurred through the date of cancellation, and in some cases, incremental fees related to capacity underutilization.

Operating Leases . The Company leases certain of its land, facilities and equipment under noncancelable operating leases, with terms ranging from less than one year to 21 years and with provisions in certain leases for cost-of-living increases. Rental expense for fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015 was \$129 million, \$116 million and \$99 million, respectively. Future minimum lease payments at September 24, 2017 for each of the subsequent five years from fiscal 2018 through 2022 were \$98 million, \$102 million, \$82 million, \$66 million and \$42 million, respectively, and \$55 million thereafter.

Other Commitments . At September 24, 2017, the Company was committed to fund certain strategic investments up to \$514 million, of which \$69 million is expected to be funded in both fiscal 2018 and fiscal 2021. The remaining commitments do not have fixed funding dates and are subject to certain conditions. Commitments represent the maximum amounts to be funded under these arrangements; actual funding may be in lesser amounts or not at all.

Note 8. Segment Information

The Company is organized on the basis of products and services and has three reportable segments. The Company conducts business primarily through its QCT (Qualcomm CDMA Technologies) semiconductor business and its QTL (Qualcomm Technology Licensing) licensing business. QCT develops and supplies integrated circuits and system software based on CDMA, OFDMA and other technologies for use in mobile devices, wireless networks, devices used in the Internet of Things (IoT), broadband gateway equipment, consumer electronic devices and automotive telematics and infotainment systems. QTL grants licenses to use portions of its intellectual property portfolio, which includes certain patent rights essential to and/or useful in the manufacture and sale of certain wireless products. The Company's QSI (Qualcomm Strategic Initiatives) reportable segment makes strategic investments and includes revenues and related costs associated with development contracts with an equity method investee. The Company also has nonreportable segments, including its mobile health, data center, small cell and other wireless technology and service initiatives.

The Company evaluates the performance of its segments based on earnings (loss) before income taxes (EBT). Segment EBT includes the allocation of certain corporate expenses to the segments, including depreciation and amortization expense related to unallocated corporate assets. Certain income and charges are not allocated to segments in the Company's management reports because they are not considered in evaluating the segments' operating performance. Unallocated income and charges include certain interest expense; certain net investment income; certain share-based compensation; and certain research and development expenses, selling, general and administrative expenses and other expenses or income that were deemed to be not directly related to the businesses of the segments. Additionally, unallocated charges include recognition of

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the step-up of inventories to fair value, amortization of certain intangible assets and certain other acquisition-related charges, third-party acquisition and integration services costs and certain other items, which may include major restructuring and restructuring-related costs, goodwill and long-lived asset impairment charges and litigation settlements and/or damages. Additionally, starting with acquisitions in the second quarter of fiscal 2017, unallocated charges include recognition of the depreciation related to the step-up of property, plant and equipment to fair value. Such charges related to acquisitions that were completed prior to the second quarter of fiscal 2017 continue to be allocated to the respective segment, and such amounts are not material. All of the costs related to the initial research of 5G (fifth generation) technology are included in unallocated corporate research and development expenses, whereas initial costs related to the research of 3G (third generation) and 4G (fourth generation) technology were recorded in both the QCT segment and unallocated corporate research and development expenses based on the nature of the activity. Fiscal 2016 and 2015 results have not been revised as such costs were incurred prior to fiscal 2014.

The table below presents revenues, EBT and total assets for reportable segments (in millions):

	2017	2016	2015
Revenues			
QCT	\$ 16,479	\$ 15,409	\$ 17,154
QTL	6,445	7,664	7,947
QSI	113	47	4
Reconciling Items	(746)	434	176
Total	\$ 22,291	\$ 23,554	\$ 25,281
EBT			
QCT	\$ 2,747	\$ 1,812	\$ 2,465
QTL	5,175	6,528	6,882
QSI	65	386	(74)
Reconciling Items	(4,967)	(1,893)	(2,786)
Total	\$ 3,020	\$ 6,833	\$ 6,487
Assets			
QCT	\$ 3,830	\$ 2,995	\$ 2,923
QTL	1,735	644	438
QSI	1,037	910	812
Reconciling Items	58,884	47,810	46,623
Total	\$ 65,486	\$ 52,359	\$ 50,796

The Company reports revenues from external customers by country based on the location to which its products or services are delivered, which for QCT is generally the country in which its customers manufacture their products, or for licensing revenues, the invoiced addresses of its licensees. As a result, the revenues by country presented herein are not necessarily indicative of either the country in which the devices containing the Company's products and/or intellectual property are ultimately sold to consumers or the country in which the companies that sell the devices are headquartered. For example, China revenues could include revenues related to shipments of integrated circuits to a company that is headquartered in South Korea but that manufactures devices in China, which devices are then sold to consumers in Europe and/or the United States. Revenues by country were as follows (in millions):

	2017	2016	2015
China (including Hong Kong)	\$ 14,579	\$ 13,503	\$ 13,337
South Korea	3,538	3,918	4,107
United States	513	386	246
Other foreign	3,661	5,747	7,591
	\$ 22,291	\$ 23,554	\$ 25,281

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Segment assets are comprised of accounts receivable and inventories for all reportable segments other than QSI. QSI segment assets include certain non-marketable equity instruments and other investments and a receivable from the sale of wireless spectrum in fiscal 2016 (Note 2). QSI assets at September 24, 2017, September 25, 2016 and September 27, 2015 included \$254 million, \$162 million and \$163 million, respectively, related to investments in equity method investees. The increase in QCT segment assets resulted primarily from the Company's recently formed RF360 Holdings joint venture in the second quarter of fiscal 2017 (Note 9). The increase in QTL segment assets was due to an increase in accounts receivable (Note 2). Total segment assets differ from total assets on a consolidated basis as a result of unallocated corporate assets primarily comprised of certain cash, cash equivalents, marketable securities, property, plant and equipment, deferred tax assets, intangible assets and assets of nonreportable segments. The net book values of long-lived tangible assets located outside of the United States were \$1.4 billion, \$404 million and \$414 million at September 24, 2017, September 25, 2016 and September 27, 2015, respectively. The increase in fiscal 2017 was primarily from the RF360 Holdings joint venture, which has substantially all of its operations outside the United States. The net book values of long-lived tangible assets located in the United States were \$1.8 billion, \$1.9 billion and \$2.1 billion at September 24, 2017, September 25, 2016 and September 27, 2015, respectively.

Reconciling items in the previous table were as follows (in millions):

	2017	2016	2015
Revenues			
Nonreportable segments	\$ 311	\$ 438	\$ 181
BlackBerry arbitration	(962)	—	—
Unallocated other revenues	(95)	—	—
Intersegment eliminations	—	(4)	(5)
	<u>\$ (746)</u>	<u>\$ 434</u>	<u>\$ 176</u>
EBT			
BlackBerry arbitration	\$ (962)	\$ —	\$ —
Unallocated other revenues	(95)	—	—
Unallocated cost of revenues	(517)	(495)	(314)
Unallocated research and development expenses	(1,056)	(799)	(809)
Unallocated selling, general and administrative expenses	(647)	(478)	(497)
Unallocated other expense, net	(1,742)	(154)	(1,289)
Unallocated interest expense	(488)	(292)	(101)
Unallocated investment and other income, net	913	667	855
Nonreportable segments	(373)	(342)	(630)
Intersegment eliminations	—	—	(1)
	<u>\$ (4,967)</u>	<u>\$ (1,893)</u>	<u>\$ (2,786)</u>

In May 2017, in connection with the arbitration decision, BlackBerry Limited (BlackBerry) and the Company entered into a Joint Stipulation Regarding Final Award Agreement agreeing that the Company would pay BlackBerry \$940 million to cover the award amount, pre-judgment interest and attorneys' fees. This amount, which was paid in the third quarter of fiscal 2017, also reflected \$22 million that was owed to the Company by BlackBerry, which was recorded as revenues in the QTL segment. The remaining amount was recorded as an adjustment to revenues related to the arbitration decision, which was not allocated to QTL in the Company's management reports because it will not be considered in evaluating segment results. Unallocated other revenues is comprised of a reduction to revenues related to the portion of a business arrangement under negotiation that resolves a legal dispute. Unallocated other expense, net in fiscal 2017 was comprised of charges related to the fines imposed by the KFTC and the TFTC (Note 7), as well as restructuring and restructuring-related charges related to the Company's Strategic Realignment Plan, which was substantially implemented in fiscal 2016 (Note 10). Unallocated other expense, net for fiscal 2016 was comprised of net restructuring and restructuring-related charges related to the Company's Strategic Realignment Plan (Note 10). Unallocated other expense, net for fiscal 2015 was comprised of a charge related to the resolution reached with the NDRC, goodwill and intangible asset impairment charges related to three of the Company's nonreportable segments and restructuring and restructuring-related charges related to the Company's Strategic Realignment Plan, partially offset by a gain on the sale of certain property, plant and equipment (Note 2).

Unallocated acquisition-related expenses were comprised as follows (in millions):

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	2017	2016	2015
Cost of revenues	\$ 437	\$ 434	\$ 272
Research and development expenses	20	10	14
Selling, general and administrative expenses	272	99	72

Note 9. Acquisitions

Completed. On February 3, 2017 (the Closing Date), the Company and TDK Corporation (TDK) completed the formation of a joint venture, under the name RF360 Holdings, to enable delivery of radio frequency front-end (RFFE) modules and radio frequency (RF) filters into fully integrated products for mobile devices and Internet of Things (IoT) applications, among others. The joint venture is owned 51% by Qualcomm Global Trading Pte. Ltd. (Qualcomm Global Trading), a Singapore corporation and wholly-owned subsidiary of the Company, and 49% by EPCOS AG (EPCOS), a German wholly-owned subsidiary of TDK. RF360 Holdings is a Singapore corporation with research and development and manufacturing and/or sales locations in the United States, Europe and Asia and its headquarters in Munich, Germany. Certain intellectual property, patents and filter and module design and manufacturing assets were carved out of existing TDK businesses and are owned by the joint venture, and certain assets were acquired directly by affiliates of the Company. Qualcomm Global Trading has the option to acquire (and EPCOS has an option to sell) EPCOS's interest in the joint venture for \$1.15 billion (Settlement Amount) 30 months after the Closing Date (the Put and Call Option).

EPCOS is entitled to up to a total of \$200 million in payments based on sales of RF filter functions over the three-year period after the Closing Date, which is a substitute for and in lieu of the right of EPCOS to receive any profit sharing, distributions, dividends or other payments of any kind or nature. Such contingent consideration was recorded as a liability at fair value at close based on significant inputs that were not observable, with future changes in fair value recorded in earnings. Such fair value adjustments recorded in fiscal 2017 were negligible.

RF360 Holdings is a variable interest entity, and its results of operations and statement of financial position are included in the Company's consolidated financial statements (on a one-month reporting lag) as the governance structure of RF360 Holdings provides the Company with the power to direct the activities of the joint venture that most significantly impact its economic performance, such as operating decisions related to research and development, manufacturing and sales and marketing of its products. Since the Put and Call Option is considered a financing of the Company's purchase of EPCOS's interest in RF360 Holdings, noncontrolling interest is not recorded in the Company's consolidated financial statements. Therefore, the Put and Call Option was recorded as a liability at fair value at close and included in other noncurrent liabilities. The liability is being accreted to the Settlement Amount, with the offset recorded as interest expense. The carrying value of the Put and Call Option approximated its estimated fair value at September 24, 2017 .

The total purchase price consisted of the following (in millions):

Cash paid to TDK at close	\$ 1,463
Fair value of Put and Call Option	1,112
Fair value of contingent consideration and other deferred payments	496
Total purchase price	<u>\$ 3,071</u>

The Company has not finalized the accounting for this business acquisition related to certain tax matters, and therefore, such amounts are subject to change during the remainder of the one year measurement period. The allocation of the purchase price to the assets acquired and liabilities assumed based on their fair values was as follows (in millions):

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Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 306
Accounts receivable	303
Inventories	261
Intangible assets subject to amortization:	
Technology-based intangible assets	738
Customer-related intangible assets	87
Marketing-related intangible assets	8
In-process research and development (IPR&D)	75
Property, plant and equipment	821
Goodwill	829
Other assets	42
Total assets	3,470
Liabilities	(399)
	\$ 3,071

The Company recognized \$829 million in goodwill related to this transaction, of which \$386 million is expected to be deductible for tax purposes. The goodwill recognized was allocated to the QCT segment for annual impairment testing purposes. The goodwill is primarily attributable to the assembled workforce and synergies expected to arise after the acquisition. Each category of intangible assets acquired will be amortized on a straight-line basis over the weighted-average useful lives of seven years for technology-based intangible assets, nine years for customer-related intangible assets and one year for marketing-related intangible assets. At September 24, 2017, the remaining IPR&D of \$61 million consisted of two projects, which are expected to be completed over the next year. Upon completion, the IPR&D projects will be amortized over their useful lives, which are estimated to be six years. The estimated fair values of the intangible assets and the property, plant and equipment acquired were primarily determined using the income approach and cost approach, respectively, both of which were based on significant inputs that were not observable.

The Company's results of operations for fiscal 2017 included the operating results of RF360 Holdings on a one-month reporting lag since the date of acquisition, the amounts of which were not material. The following table presents the unaudited pro forma results for fiscal 2017 and fiscal 2016. The unaudited pro forma financial information combines the results of operations of Qualcomm and RF360 Holdings as though the companies had been combined as of the beginning of fiscal 2016. The pro forma information is presented for informational purposes only and is not indicative of the results of operations that would have been achieved if the acquisition had taken place at such time. The unaudited pro forma results presented below include adjustments for the step-up of inventories to fair value, amortization and depreciation of identified intangible assets and property, plant and equipment, adjustments for certain acquisition-related charges, interest expense related to the Put and Call Option and related tax effects (in millions):

	(Unaudited)	
	2017	2016
Pro forma revenues	\$ 22,806	\$ 24,731
Pro forma net income attributable to Qualcomm	2,614	5,791

During fiscal 2017, the Company acquired three other businesses for total cash consideration of \$35 million, net of cash acquired, and up to a total of \$94 million in certain contingent payments, which were recorded as a liability at fair value. The Company recognized \$47 million in goodwill related to these transactions, of which \$12 million is expected to be deductible for tax purposes. Goodwill of \$23 million, \$12 million and \$11 million was assigned to the Company's QTL, QCT and nonreportable segments, respectively.

During fiscal 2016, the Company acquired four businesses for total cash consideration of \$392 million, net of cash acquired. Technology-based intangible assets of \$257 million were recognized with a weighted-average useful life of four years. The Company recognized \$172 million in goodwill related to these transactions, all of which was assigned to the Company's QCT segment and of which \$24 million is expected to be deductible for tax purposes.

On August 13, 2015, the Company acquired CSR plc, which was renamed CSR Limited (CSR), for total cash consideration of \$2.3 billion (net of \$176 million of cash acquired). CSR is an innovator in the development of multifunction

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semiconductor platforms and technologies for the automotive, consumer and voice and music categories. The acquisition complemented the Company's current offerings by adding products, channels and customers in the growth categories of the IoT and automotive infotainment. CSR was integrated into the QCT segment. The \$2.4 billion total purchase price was allocated as follows: \$1.0 billion to amortizable intangible assets, \$969 million to goodwill, \$182 million to IPR&D and \$280 million to other net assets.

Goodwill recognized in this transaction is not deductible for tax purposes and was allocated to the QCT segment for annual impairment testing purposes. Goodwill is primarily attributable to synergies expected to arise after the acquisition. Each category of intangible assets acquired are being amortized on a straight-line basis over their weighted-average useful lives of five years for technology-based intangible assets and four years for customer-related and marketing-related intangible assets.

The Company's results of operations for fiscal 2015 included the operating results of CSR since the date of acquisition, the amounts of which were not material. Unaudited pro forma revenues and net income attributable to Qualcomm for fiscal 2015, presenting the results of operations of Qualcomm and CSR as though the companies had been combined as of the beginning of fiscal 2014, were \$25.9 billion and \$5.2 billion, respectively. This unaudited pro forma information is provided for informational purposes only and is not indicative of the results of operations that would have been achieved if the acquisition had taken place as of the beginning of fiscal 2014.

During fiscal 2015, the Company acquired four other businesses for total cash consideration of \$405 million, net of cash acquired. Technology-based intangible assets of \$84 million were recognized with a weighted-average useful life of eight years. The Company recognized \$289 million in goodwill related to these transactions, of which \$35 million is expected to be deductible for tax purposes. Goodwill of \$29 million, \$6 million and \$254 million was assigned to the Company's QCT, QTL and nonreportable segments, respectively.

Proposed. On October 27, 2016, the Company announced a definitive agreement under which Qualcomm River Holdings, B.V. (Qualcomm River Holdings), an indirect, wholly owned subsidiary of QUALCOMM Incorporated, will acquire NXP Semiconductors N.V. (NXP). Pursuant to the definitive agreement, Qualcomm River Holdings has commenced a tender offer to acquire all of the issued and outstanding common shares of NXP for \$110 per share in cash, for estimated total cash consideration to be paid to NXP's shareholders of \$38 billion. NXP is a leader in high-performance, mixed-signal semiconductor electronics in automotive, broad-based microcontrollers, secure identification, network processing and RF power products.

The transaction is subject to receipt of regulatory approvals in various jurisdictions and other closing conditions, including the tender of at least 80% of the issued and outstanding common shares of NXP in the offer (provided that the minimum tender threshold may be reduced to a percentage not less than 70% with the prior written consent of NXP). At an Extraordinary General Meeting of NXP's shareholders held on January 27, 2017, NXP's shareholders approved certain matters relating to the transaction, including the appointment of designees of Qualcomm River Holdings to NXP's board of directors (effective upon the closing of the transaction) and certain transactions that are intended to be consummated after the completion of the tender offer.

In May 2017, the Company issued an aggregate principal amount of \$11.0 billion of unsecured floating- and fixed-rate notes with varying maturities, of which a portion will be used to fund the purchase price and other related transactions. In addition, the Company has secured \$4.0 billion in committed financing through a Term Loan Facility, which is expected to be drawn on at the close of the NXP transaction (Note 6). The remaining amount will be funded with cash held by foreign entities.

Qualcomm River Holdings and NXP may terminate the definitive agreement under certain circumstances. If the definitive agreement is terminated by NXP in certain circumstances, NXP will be required to pay Qualcomm River Holdings a termination fee of \$1.25 billion. If the definitive agreement is terminated by Qualcomm River Holdings under certain circumstances involving the failure to obtain the required regulatory approvals or the failure of NXP to complete certain pre-closing reorganization steps in all material respects, Qualcomm River Holdings will be required to pay NXP a termination fee of \$2.0 billion. In November 2016, as required by the definitive agreement, Qualcomm River Holdings entered into four letters of credit for an aggregate amount of \$2.0 billion related to the potential termination fee payable to NXP. Pursuant to the terms of each letter of credit, NXP will have the right to draw amounts to fund certain termination compensation owed by Qualcomm River Holdings to NXP if the definitive agreement is terminated under certain circumstances. The letters of credit expire on June 30, 2018 or if drawn on by NXP or surrendered by Qualcomm River Holdings. Each letter of credit is required to be fully cash collateralized in an amount equal to 100% of its face value through deposits with the issuers of the letters of credit. Qualcomm River Holdings is restricted from using the funds deposited as collateral while the letters of credit are

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outstanding. At September 24, 2017, the letters of credit were fully collateralized through bank time deposits and money market funds, which were recorded as other noncurrent assets.

Note 10. Strategic Realignment Plan

On July 22, 2015, the Company announced a Strategic Realignment Plan designed to improve execution, enhance financial performance and drive profitable growth as the Company works to create sustainable long-term value for stockholders. As part of this, among other actions, the Company implemented a cost reduction plan, which included a series of targeted reductions across the Company's businesses, particularly in QCT, and a reduction to its annual share-based compensation grants. Restructuring activities were initiated in the fourth quarter of fiscal 2015, the cost reduction initiatives were achieved by the end of fiscal 2016 and other activities under the plan were completed by the end of fiscal 2017. During fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, the Company recorded restructuring and restructuring-related charges of \$37 million, \$202 million (which was partially offset by a \$48 million gain on the sale of the Company's business that provided augmented reality applications) and \$190 million, respectively.

Note 11. Fair Value Measurements

The following table presents the Company's fair value hierarchy for assets and liabilities measured at fair value on a recurring basis at September 24, 2017 (in millions):

	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Total
Assets				
Cash equivalents	\$ 21,016	\$ 12,933	\$ —	\$ 33,949
Marketable securities				
U.S. Treasury securities and government-related securities	969	13	—	982
Corporate bonds and notes	—	2,285	—	2,285
Mortgage- and asset-backed and auction rate securities	—	93	40	133
Equity and preferred securities and equity funds	36	—	—	36
Debt funds	—	109	—	109
Total marketable securities	1,005	2,500	40	3,545
Derivative instruments	—	14	—	14
Other investments	369	—	125	494
Total assets measured at fair value	\$ 22,390	\$ 15,447	\$ 165	\$ 38,002
Liabilities				
Derivative instruments	\$ —	\$ 27	\$ —	\$ 27
Other liabilities	369	—	196	565
Total liabilities measured at fair value	\$ 369	\$ 27	\$ 196	\$ 592

Activity between Levels of the Fair Value Hierarchy. There were no significant transfers between Level 1 and Level 2 during fiscal 2017 and 2016.

The following table includes the activity for marketable securities, other investments and other liabilities classified within Level 3 of the valuation hierarchy (in millions):

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	2017			2016	
	Marketable Securities	Other Investments	Other Liabilities	Marketable Securities	Other Investments
Beginning balance of Level 3	\$ 43	\$ 37	\$ —	\$ 224	\$ 13
Total realized and unrealized gains or losses:					
Included in selling, general and administrative expenses	—	—	(7)	—	—
Included in investment and other income, net	—	3	—	(4)	(23)
Included in other comprehensive income (loss)	—	8	—	(1)	15
Issuances	—	—	203	—	—
Purchases	—	111	—	2	40
Sales	—	—	—	(106)	—
Settlements	(3)	(34)	—	(45)	(8)
Transfers into Level 3	—	—	—	—	—
Transfers out of Level 3	—	—	—	(27)	—
Ending balance of Level 3	\$ 40	\$ 125	\$ 196	\$ 43	\$ 37

The Company recognizes transfers into and out of levels within the fair value hierarchy at the end of the fiscal month in which the actual event or change in circumstances that caused the transfer occurs. Transfers out of Level 3 during fiscal 2016 for marketable securities primarily consisted of debt securities with significant upgrades in credit ratings or for which there were observable inputs.

Nonrecurring Fair Value Measurements. The Company measures certain assets and liabilities at fair value on a nonrecurring basis. These assets and liabilities include cost and equity method investments when they are deemed to be other-than-temporarily impaired, assets acquired and liabilities assumed in an acquisition or in a nonmonetary exchange, and property, plant and equipment and intangible assets that are written down to fair value when they are held for sale or determined to be impaired. During fiscal 2015, the Company updated the business plans and related internal forecasts related to certain of the Company's businesses, resulting in impairment charges to write down certain property, plant and equipment, intangible assets and goodwill (Note 2). The Company determined the fair values using cost, income and market approaches. The estimation of fair value and cash flows used in the fair value measurements required the use of significant unobservable inputs, and as a result, the fair value measurements were classified as Level 3. During fiscal 2017, 2016 and 2015, the Company did not have any other significant assets or liabilities that were measured at fair value on a nonrecurring basis in periods subsequent to initial recognition.

Note 12. Marketable Securities

Marketable securities were comprised as follows (in millions):

	Current		Noncurrent	
	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016
Available-for-sale:				
U.S. Treasury securities and government-related securities	\$ 23	\$ 1,116	\$ 959	\$ 1,099
Corporate bonds and notes	2,014	10,159	271	8,584
Mortgage- and asset-backed and auction rate securities	93	1,363	40	534
Equity and preferred securities and equity funds	36	64	—	1,682
Debt funds	109	—	—	1,803
Total available-for-sale	2,275	12,702	1,270	13,702
Time deposits	4	—	—	—
Total marketable securities	\$ 2,279	\$ 12,702	\$ 1,270	\$ 13,702

During fiscal 2016, the Company exited an investment in a debt fund for which the Company elected the fair value option. The investment would have otherwise been recorded using the equity method. Changes in fair value associated with this investment were recognized in investment and other income, net. During fiscal 2016 and 2015, the net decrease in fair

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value associated with this investment was negligible and \$10 million, respectively. At September 24, 2017, marketable securities also included \$4 million of time deposits with original maturities that range from 94 to 285 days.

At September 24, 2017, the contractual maturities of available-for-sale debt securities were as follows (in millions):

	September 24, 2017
Years to Maturity:	
Less than one year	\$ 2,189
One to five years	1,079
Five to ten years	—
Greater than ten years	—
No single maturity date	241
Total	\$ 3,509

Debt securities with no single maturity date included debt funds, mortgage- and asset-backed securities and auction rate securities.

The Company recorded realized gains and losses on sales of available-for-sale securities as follows (in millions):

	Gross Realized Gains	Gross Realized Losses	Net Realized Gains
2017	\$ 553	\$ (127)	\$ 426
2016	277	(37)	240
2015	540	(52)	488

Available-for-sale securities were comprised as follows (in millions):

	Cost	Unrealized Gains	Unrealized Losses	Fair Value
September 24, 2017				
Equity securities	\$ 8	\$ 28	\$ —	\$ 36
Debt securities (including debt funds)	3,497	13	(1)	3,509
	\$ 3,505	\$ 41	\$ (1)	\$ 3,545
September 25, 2016				
Equity securities	\$ 1,554	\$ 204	\$ (12)	\$ 1,746
Debt securities (including debt funds)	24,363	388	(93)	24,658
	\$ 25,917	\$ 592	\$ (105)	\$ 26,404

The following table shows the gross unrealized losses and fair values of the Company's investments in individual securities that are classified as available-for-sale and have been in a continuous unrealized loss position deemed to be temporary for less than 12 months and for more than 12 months, aggregated by investment category (in millions):

	September 24, 2017			
	Less than 12 months		More than 12 months	
	Fair Value	Unrealized Losses	Fair Value	Unrealized Losses
Corporate bonds and notes	\$ 330	\$ (1)	\$ 21	\$ —

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	September 25, 2016			
	Less than 12 months		More than 12 months	
	Fair Value	Unrealized Losses	Fair Value	Unrealized Losses
U.S. Treasury securities and government-related securities	\$ 444	\$ (5)	\$ 16	\$ —
Corporate bonds and notes	2,775	(12)	1,033	(65)
Mortgage- and asset-backed and auction rate securities	337	(3)	211	(2)
Equity and preferred securities and equity funds	312	(4)	130	(8)
Debt funds	—	—	309	(6)
	<u>\$ 3,868</u>	<u>\$ (24)</u>	<u>\$ 1,699</u>	<u>\$ (81)</u>

In connection with the proposed NXP transaction (Note 9), the Company divested a substantial portion of its marketable securities portfolio in order to finance, in part, that transaction. Marketable securities that were expected to be used to finance the NXP transaction were classified as noncurrent at September 24, 2017 as they are not considered available for current operations. Given the change in the Company's intention to sell certain marketable securities, the Company recognized other-than-temporary impairment losses in fiscal 2017 for such marketable securities (Note 2) and may recognize additional losses prior to the sale of such marketable securities. For the available-for-sale securities that are not expected to be sold to finance the NXP transaction, the Company concluded that the unrealized losses were temporary at September 24, 2017. Further, for debt securities with unrealized losses, as of September 24, 2017, the Company did not have the intent to sell, nor was it more likely than not that the Company would be required to sell, such securities before recovery or maturity.

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Note 13. Summarized Quarterly Data (Unaudited)

The following financial information reflects all normal recurring adjustments that are, in the opinion of management, necessary for a fair statement of the results of the interim periods.

The table below presents quarterly data for fiscal 2017 and 2016 (in millions, except per share data):

	1st Quarter	2nd Quarter	3rd Quarter	4th Quarter
2017 (1)				
Revenues	\$ 5,999	\$ 5,016	\$ 5,371	\$ 5,905
Operating income (2)	778	729	773	333
Net income (2)	681	749	865	168
Net income attributable to Qualcomm	682	749	866	168
Basic earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm (3):	\$ 0.46	\$ 0.51	\$ 0.59	\$ 0.11
Diluted earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm (3):	0.46	0.50	0.58	0.11
2016 (1)				
Revenues	\$ 5,775	\$ 5,551	\$ 6,044	\$ 6,184
Operating income	1,685	1,415	1,592	1,804
Net income	1,496	1,164	1,443	1,599
Net income attributable to Qualcomm	1,498	1,164	1,444	1,599
Basic earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm (3):	\$ 1.00	\$ 0.78	\$ 0.98	\$ 1.08
Diluted earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm (3):	0.99	0.78	0.97	1.07

(1) Amounts, other than per share amounts, are rounded to millions each quarter. Therefore, the sum of the quarterly amounts may not equal the annual amounts reported.

(2) Operating income and net income in the fourth quarter of fiscal 2017 were negatively impacted by a \$778 million charge related to the TFTP fine.

(3) Earnings per share attributable to Qualcomm are computed independently for each quarter and the full year based upon respective average shares outstanding. Therefore, the sum of the quarterly earnings per share amounts may not equal the annual amounts reported.

SCHEDULE II
QUALCOMM INCORPORATED
VALUATION AND QUALIFYING ACCOUNTS
(In millions)

	Balance at Beginning of Period	Charged (Credited) to Costs and Expenses	Deductions	Other	Balance at End of Period
Year ended September 24, 2017					
Allowances:					
— trade receivables	\$ 1	\$ 10	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 11
Valuation allowance on deferred tax assets	754	109	—	—	863
	<u>\$ 755</u>	<u>\$ 119</u>	<u>\$ —</u>	<u>\$ —</u>	<u>\$ 874</u>
Year ended September 25, 2016					
Allowances:					
— trade receivables	\$ 6	\$ (5)	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 1
Valuation allowance on deferred tax assets	635	118	—	1 (a)	754
	<u>\$ 641</u>	<u>\$ 113</u>	<u>\$ —</u>	<u>\$ 1</u>	<u>\$ 755</u>
Year ended September 27, 2015					
Allowances:					
— trade receivables	\$ 5	\$ 1	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 6
— notes receivable	4	—	(3)	(1) (b)	—
Valuation allowance on deferred tax assets	414	130	—	91 (a)	635
	<u>\$ 423</u>	<u>\$ 131</u>	<u>\$ (3)</u>	<u>\$ 90</u>	<u>\$ 641</u>

(a) This amount was recorded to goodwill in connection with a business acquisition.

(b) This amount relates to notes receivable on strategic investments that were converted to cost method equity investments.

QUALCOMM INCORPORATED

2018 DIRECTOR COMPENSATION PLAN

ARTICLE 1

ADOPTION

1.1 **Adoption**. The Compensation Committee (the "Compensation Committee") of the Board of Directors of Qualcomm Incorporated (the "Company") adopted and approved this 2018 Director Compensation Plan (the "Plan") by resolutions adopted on September 21, 2017. The Plan was adopted to establish the compensation to be paid to the Company's nonemployee directors ("Directors"), based on the Compensation Committee's annual review of nonemployee director compensation, including an analysis prepared by independent compensation analyst Frederic W. Cook & Co., Inc., of reported nonemployee director compensation practices at the same peer companies used in the Compensation Committee's evaluation of compensation for the Company's named executive officers. This Plan is effective on January 1, 2018.

1.2 **Issuance of Deferred Stock Units**. The Plan constitutes a sub-plan under Section 3.5(j) of the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan, as amended (the "2016 LTIP"), with respect to the grant of Deferred Stock Units as set forth herein. By approval of this Plan, the Compensation Committee has authorized and approved the grant, issuance and settlement of the Deferred Stock Units pursuant to the 2016 LTIP as provided herein and subject to the terms and conditions of the forms of award agreements for such Deferred Stock Units which have been authorized and approved by the Compensation Committee as provided in the 2016 LTIP.

ARTICLE 2

DIRECTOR COMPENSATION

2.1 **Annual Retainer**. Directors who are U.S. residents receive an Annual Retainer of \$100,000 per calendar year. In consideration of the increased travel time, Directors who are non-U.S. residents receive an Annual Retainer of \$120,000 per calendar year. The Annual Retainer is earned and paid quarterly in arrears, in equal one-fourth installments as soon as practicable after the end of each calendar quarter.

2.2 **Board Committee Chair Retainers**. The chairs of the following Board Committees receive annual Board Committee Chair Retainers as follows:

- (a) **Audit Committee Chair Retainer**: \$25,000 per calendar year;
- (b) **Compensation Chair Retainer**: \$25,000 per calendar year; and
- (c) **Governance Chair Retainer**: \$15,000 per calendar year.

The Board may appoint special committees from time-to-time and the Board Committee Chair Retainer, if any, for the chairs of such committees are determined by the Compensation Committee in its discretion. Board Committee Chair Retainers are earned and paid quarterly in arrears, in equal one-fourth installments as soon as practicable after the end of each calendar quarter.

2.3 **Presiding Director Retainer**. The Presiding Director will receive an annual Presiding Director Retainer of \$35,000, which is earned and paid quarterly in arrears, in equal one-fourth installments as soon as practicable after the end of each calendar quarter.

2.4 **Meeting Fees**. Each Director will receive \$1,500 for each standing committee meeting attended in person or by telephone. No fees are paid for attending Board meetings. Directors Emeriti receive \$2,000 for each Board meeting attended in person and \$1,000 for each telephonic Board meeting attended. The Board may appoint special committees from time-to-time and the Meeting Fees, if any, for such special committees are determined by the Compensation Committee in its discretion. Meeting Fees will be paid on a quarterly basis as soon as practicable after the end of each calendar quarter.

2.5 **Annual Deferred Stock Units**. On the date of the annual meeting of stockholders of the Company, each Director will receive an automatic grant of a number of Annual Deferred Stock Units ("Annual DSUs") determined by dividing (1) \$200,000, by (2) the fair value of each such unit on such date, as determined by Aon (or another third-party designated by the Company) in accordance with FASB ASC Topic 718, with the result rounded up to the next whole unit. Annual DSUs are fully vested on the grant date and paid on the third anniversary of the grant date (subject to an election made pursuant to Section 3.1(b) of this Plan), or earlier upon death, Disability or a Change in Control, as set forth in the Annual DSU agreements approved by the Compensation Committee.

2.6 **Proration of Retainers and Annual Deferred Stock Units**. An individual who becomes or ceases to be a Director other than on the first day of any calendar quarter will receive prorated Retainers for that quarter based on the number of days in such calendar quarter in which he or she served as a Director. An individual commencing service as a Director between annual meetings of the stockholders, will receive an automatic grant on the date services commence of a number of Annual DSUs equal to the product (rounded up to the nearest whole number) of (1) the number of Annual DSUs granted to each Director pursuant to Section 2.5 at the most recent annual meeting of stockholders of the Company, multiplied by (2) a fraction, (a) the numerator of which shall be the number of complete or partial calendar months from and including the month he or she commences service as a Director through the end of the calendar month immediately preceding the month in which the next annual meeting is scheduled to be held (or, if the next annual meeting has not been scheduled as of the grant date, it will be assumed to be scheduled for the next-following March for this purpose), and (b) the denominator of which shall be 12.

ARTICLE 3

ELECTIONS TO DEFER PAYMENT OF COMPENSATION

3.1 **Allowable Deferrals**

(a) **Elective Deferred Stock Units**. Directors may elect to convert all or a portion (in 25% increments) of their Retainers into Elective Deferred Stock Units ("Elective DSUs"), which are fully vested on the grant date and payable upon the earliest of (1) a date elected by the Director that is at least three years following the grant date, (2) separation from service, (3) death, (4) Disability, or (5) a Change in Control, as set forth in the Elective DSU agreements approved by the Compensation Committee. A Director who has made such an election shall, on the last day of the calendar quarter for which the Retainer would be paid but for such election, automatically receive a grant pursuant to this Plan of a number of Elective DSUs equal to (i) the amount of the Retainer to which such election applies, divided by (ii) the Fair Market Value (as defined in the 2016 LTIP) of a share of the Company's Common Stock on the last date of that quarter (or the next trading date following the close of the quarter with respect to any quarter that does not end on a trading date), with the result rounded up to the next whole unit.

(b) **Deferral of Payment Date for Annual Deferred Stock Units**. A Director may elect to defer the payment of the Annual DSUs to a date that is later than three years from the grant date.

(c) **Deferrals into the Nonqualified Deferred Compensation Plan**. Directors may elect to defer all or a portion (in whole percentages) of their Retainers and/or Meeting Fees into the Company's Nonqualified Deferred

Compensation Plan ("NQDCP"), which gives Directors several investment options and allows them to select the timing and form of distributions.

3.2 Timing and Manner of Elections

(a) Annual Elections. Generally, any election referenced in Section 3.1 must be made by a Director in writing on the form provided by the Company before the beginning of the calendar year in which the Retainer or Meeting Fees are earned or the Annual DSU is granted.

(b) First Year Elections for New Directors. Directors who join the Board between annual meetings may make an election referenced in Section 3.1 (a) or (c) no later than thirty (30) days following the date he or she joins the Board, although that election will apply only to Retainers or Meeting Fees earned after the end of the calendar quarter in which such election is made.

(c) Effect of Elections. Elections are intended to comply with Section 409A of the Internal Revenue Code and are irrevocable and continue from year to year unless changed or terminated effective as of the beginning of a subsequent calendar year.

ARTICLE 4

AMENDMENT AND TERMINATION

4.1 Amendment and Termination. The Committee may at any time amend, suspend, discontinue or terminate this Plan; provided, however, that no such amendment, suspension, discontinuance or termination shall materially and adversely affect the rights of any Director with respect to amounts earned or Deferred Stock Units granted prior to the amendment, suspension, discontinuance or termination.

QUALCOMM INCORPORATED
2016 LONG-TERM INCENTIVE PLAN
EXECUTIVE RESTRICTED STOCK UNIT GRANT NOTICE

Qualcomm Incorporated (the “*Company*”), pursuant to its 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan (the “*Plan*”) hereby grants to you, the Participant named below, the number of Restricted Stock Units set forth below, each of which represents the right to receive one (1) share of the Company’s common stock, subject to all of the terms and conditions as set forth in this Executive Restricted Stock Unit Grant Notice (the “*Grant Notice*”) and the Executive Restricted Stock Unit Agreement (attached hereto) and the Plan which are incorporated herein in their entirety. Capitalized terms not otherwise defined in this Grant Notice or the Executive Restricted Stock Unit Agreement shall have the meaning set forth in the Plan. A copy of the Plan can be obtained from the Stock Administration website, located on the Company’s internal webpage, or you may request a hard copy from the Stock Administration Department.

Participant : «Employee» **Grant No.** : «Number»

Emp # : «ID»

Number of Restricted Stock Units : «Shares_Granted»

Date of Grant : «Grant_Date»

Performance Period : September 25, 2017 – March 25, 2018

Performance Measure : Adjusted GAAP Operating Income defined as the Company’s operating income, determined in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles in the United States (GAAP), but determined excluding

- (1) the Qualcomm Strategic Initiative segment as defined in the Company’s fiscal 2016 Form 10-K;
- (2) all share-based compensation other than amounts settleable in cash;
- (3) acquisition-related items, which consist of:
 - (a) acquired in-process research and development,
 - (b) recognition of the step-up of inventories to fair value,
 - (c) purchase accounting effects on property, plant and equipment for acquisitions completed in or after the second quarter of fiscal 2017,
 - (d) amortization of intangible assets for acquisitions completed in or after the third quarter of fiscal 2011,
 - (e) expenses related to the termination of contracts that limit the use of the acquired intellectual property, and
 - (f) third-party acquisition and integration services costs.

The above adjustments shall apply only with respect to applicable items acquired in transactions that qualify as business combinations pursuant to GAAP;

- (4) the following items for which each event individually equals or exceeds \$25 million on a pre-tax basis:
 - (a) restructuring and restructuring-related costs (in the aggregate by restructuring event), which consist of the following costs:
 - i. severance and benefits (including COBRA and outplacement expenses);
 - ii. consulting costs;
 - iii. increased security costs;
 - iv. acceleration of depreciation and/or amortization expense;
 - v. facilities and lease termination or abandonment charges;
 - vi. asset impairment charges and/or contract terminations;
 - vii. third-party business separation costs; and
 - viii. relocation costs as a result of an office or facility closure.
 - (b) goodwill and indefinite- and long-lived asset impairments;
 - (c) gain/losses on divestitures or non-revenue generating asset sales; and
 - (d) impact of litigation settlement, arbitration and/or judgment.
-

- (5) the impact of unresolved contract disputes on revenues recorded during the Performance Period (including but not limited to disputes resulting in litigation or arbitration) to the extent a licensee withholds or fails to make royalty payments or disputes the royalty payment paid, provided that, to the extent that the licensee fails to report information sufficient to determine the actual impact on revenues of the withholding or failure to make royalty payments or dispute of paid amounts, the average royalty revenues over the four fiscal quarters preceding the dispute (or such shorter period for which information is available) shall be used to determine the impact on royalty revenues due to the contract dispute for purposes of this award, and such amount shall be prorated as appropriate to reflect the period during the Performance Period in which such withholding, dispute or failure to pay impacts revenues.

Performance Target : «\$ _Amount» in Adjusted GAAP Operating Income for the Performance Period

Vesting Dates :

<u>Restricted Stock Units Vested</u>	<u>Vesting Date</u>
«1/3 Shares»	«1st Vesting Date»
«1/3 Shares»	«2nd Vesting Date»
«1/3 Shares»	«3rd Vesting Date»

Additional Terms/Acknowledgments : You must acknowledge, in the form determined by the Company, receipt of, and represent that you have read, understand, accept and agree to the terms and conditions of, this Grant Notice, the Agreement including the Exclusive Consulting Agreement attached to the Agreement and the Plan (including, but not limited to, the binding arbitration provision in Section 3.7 of the Plan).

Qualcomm Incorporated:

By: /s/ Steven M. Mollenkopf
Steven M. Mollenkopf
Chief Executive Officer
Dated: «Grant_Date»

Attachment: Executive Restricted Stock Unit Agreement (RSU-EX-A12)

QUALCOMM INCORPORATED
2016 LONG-TERM INCENTIVE PLAN
EXECUTIVE RESTRICTED STOCK UNIT AGREEMENT

Qualcomm Incorporated (the “*Company*”) has granted a number of Restricted Stock Units (this “*Award*”) with respect to the number of shares of the Company’s common stock (“*Stock*”) specified in the Executive Restricted Stock Unit Grant Notice (the “*Grant Notice*”) to you, the Participant named in the Grant Notice pursuant to the terms and conditions set forth in the Grant Notice, this Executive Restricted Stock Unit Agreement and the attachments hereto (together with the Grant Notice, the “*Agreement*”) and the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan (the “*Plan*”). Capitalized terms that are not explicitly defined in the Grant Notice or this Agreement but are defined in the Plan shall have the same definitions as in the Plan.

The terms and conditions of this Award are as follows:

1. VESTING.

1.1 VESTING CONTINGENT ON ACHIEVING PERFORMANCE TARGET. Your Restricted Stock Units will become vested as provided in Sections 1.2 through 1.6 and be paid as provided in Section 2 only if the Performance Measure equals or exceeds the Performance Target for the Performance Period (as each capitalized term is defined in the Grant Notice). Any determination that the Performance Measure equals or exceeds the Performance Target for the Performance Period shall be made by written certification of the Committee no later than the November 30th that next follows the end of the Performance Period. If the Performance Measure does not equal or exceed the Performance Target, this Award shall terminate and no Restricted Stock Units will vest or be paid.

1.2 SERVICE VESTING. Except to the extent that your Restricted Stock Units may vest earlier as provided in Sections 1.3 through 1.6, below, your Restricted Stock Units will vest to the extent you are in Service on the applicable Vesting Date(s) specified in the Grant Notice.

1.3 ATTAINMENT OF NORMAL RETIREMENT AGE. Your Restricted Stock Units will be fully vested on the later of (a) the date which is six (6) months after the Grant Date or (b) the date on which you have attained age fifty-five (55) and completed at least ten (10) years of consecutive Service.

1.4 DEATH. If your Service terminates because of your death, the vesting of your Restricted Stock Units shall be accelerated in full effective upon your death.

1.5 DISABILITY. If your Service terminates because of your Disability, the vesting of your Restricted Stock Units shall be accelerated in full effective as of the date on which your Service terminates due to your Disability.

1.6 TERMINATION AFTER CHANGE IN CONTROL. If your Service terminates as a result of Termination After Change in Control (as defined below), then the vesting of your Restricted Stock Units shall be accelerated in full effective as of the date on which your Service terminates. For this purpose, “*Termination After Change in Control*” shall mean either of the following events occurring within twenty-four (24) months after a Change in Control (as defined in the Plan):

(a) termination by the Participating Company Group of your Service with the Participating Company Group for any reason other than for Cause (as defined below); or

(b) your resignation for Good Reason (as defined below) from all capacities in which you are then rendering Service to the Participating Company Group within a reasonable period of time following the event constituting Good Reason.

Notwithstanding any provision herein to the contrary, Termination After Change in Control shall not include any termination of your Service with the Participating Company Group which (A) is for Cause; (B) is a result of your

death or Disability; (C) is a result of your voluntary termination of Service other than for Good Reason; or (D) occurs prior to the effectiveness of a Change in Control.

For purposes of this Section 1:

“ **Cause** ” shall mean any of the following: (i) your theft, dishonesty, or falsification of any Participating Company documents or records; (ii) your improper use or disclosure of a Participating Company’s confidential or proprietary information; (iii) any action by you which has a detrimental effect on a Participating Company’s reputation or business; (iv) your failure or inability to perform any reasonable assigned duties after written notice from a Participating Company of, and a reasonable opportunity to cure, such failure or inability; (v) any material breach by you of any employment or service agreement between you and a Participating Company, which breach is not cured pursuant to the terms of such agreement; (vi) your conviction (including any plea of guilty or *nolo contendere*) of any criminal act which impairs your ability to perform your duties with a Participating Company; or (vii) violation of a material Company or Participating Company policy.

“ **Good Reason** ” shall mean any one or more of the following:

(i) without your express written consent, the assignment to you of any duties, or any limitation of your responsibilities, substantially inconsistent with your positions, duties, responsibilities and status with the Participating Company Group immediately prior to the date of a Change in Control;

(ii) without your express written consent, the relocation of the principal place of your employment or service to a location that is more than fifty (50) miles from your principal place of employment or service immediately prior to the date of a Change in Control, or the imposition of travel requirements substantially more demanding of you than such travel requirements existing immediately prior to the date of the Change in Control;

(iii) any failure by the Participating Company Group to pay, or any material reduction by the Participating Company Group of, (A) your base salary in effect immediately prior to the date of the Change in Control (unless reductions comparable in amount and duration are concurrently made for all other employees of the Participating Company Group with responsibilities, organizational level and title comparable to yours), or (B) your bonus compensation, if any, in effect immediately prior to the date of a Change in Control (subject to applicable performance requirements with respect to the actual amount of bonus compensation earned by you);

(iv) any failure by the Participating Company Group to (A) continue to provide you with the opportunity to participate, on terms no less favorable than those in effect for the benefit of any employee or service provider group which customarily includes a person holding the employment or service provider position or a comparable position with the Participating Company Group then held by you, in any benefit or compensation plans and programs, including, but not limited to, the Participating Company Group’s life, disability, health, dental, medical, savings, profit sharing, stock purchase and retirement plans, if any, in which you were participating immediately prior to the date of the Change in Control, or their equivalent, or (B) provide you with all other fringe benefits (or their equivalent) from time to time in effect for the benefit of any employee group which customarily includes a person holding the employment or service provider position or a comparable position with the Participating Company Group then held by you;

(v) any breach by the Participating Company Group of any material agreement between you and a Participating Company concerning your employment; or

(vi) any failure by the Company to obtain the assumption of any material agreement between you and the Company concerning your employment by a successor or assign of the Company.

2. PAYMENT OF YOUR RESTRICTED STOCK UNITS.

2.1 TIMING OF PAYMENT.

(a) Subject to the other terms of the Plan and this Agreement, any Restricted Stock Units that vest in accordance with Section 1.2 will be paid to you as follows: (i) the first installment shall be paid to you no later than 30 days after the later of (1) the earliest Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice or (2) the date on which the Committee certifies in writing that the Performance Measure equals or exceeds the Performance Target for the Performance Period; and (ii) any subsequent installments shall be paid to you no later than 30 days after the applicable Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice.

(b) Subject to the other terms of the Plan and this Agreement, any Restricted Stock Units that vest and become nonforfeitable in accordance with Section 1.3 will be paid to you as follows: (i) the first installment shall be paid to you no later than 30 days after the later of (1) the earliest Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice or (2) the date on which the Committee certifies in writing that the Performance Measure equals or exceeds the Performance Target for the Performance Period; and (ii) any subsequent installments shall be paid to you no later than 30 days after the applicable Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice; provided, however, that payments shall be made pursuant to this Section 2.1(b) following termination of your employment with the Participating Company only if such termination was not for Cause and you (A) execute a general release of claims in a form satisfactory to the Company and that general release becomes irrevocable before the 60th day following your termination of employment, and (B) comply with the requirements contained in the Exclusive Consulting Agreement attached hereto as Attachment 1 (the “**Consulting Agreement**”). Notwithstanding the foregoing, in the event you violate any of the provisions contained in the Consulting Agreement, any Restricted Stock Units that became vested pursuant to Section 1.3 shall be immediately forfeited without consideration. In the event that your employment is terminated for Cause, you shall immediately forfeit your right to payment of any Restricted Stock Units following the date of such termination under this Section 2.1(b).

(c) Subject to the other terms of the Plan and this Agreement, any Restricted Stock Units that vest and become nonforfeitable in accordance with Sections 1.4, 1.5 or 1.6 will be paid to you no later than 30 days after the later of the date your Service terminates or the date on which the Committee certifies in writing that the Performance Measure equals or exceeds the Performance Target.

2.2 FORM OF PAYMENT. Your vested Restricted Stock Units shall be paid in whole shares of Stock except as otherwise provided in Section 10.3 of the Plan regarding fractional shares attributable to Dividend Equivalents.

2.3 TAX WITHHOLDING. You acknowledge that the Company and/or the Participating Company that employs you (the “**Employer**”) may be subject to withholding tax obligations arising by reason of the vesting and/or payment of this Award. You authorize your Employer to satisfy the withholding tax obligations by one or a combination of the following methods, as selected by the Company in its sole discretion: (a) withholding from your pay and any other amounts payable to you; (b) withholding of Stock and/or cash from the payment of this Award; (c) arranging for the sale of shares of Stock payable in connection with this Award (on your behalf and at your direction which you authorize by accepting this Award); or (d) any other method allowed by the Plan or applicable law. Notwithstanding the foregoing, you may elect in the manner specified by the Company to make a cash payment to the Company or your Employer to satisfy the withholding tax obligations with respect to this Award, provided such election is made during an open trading window under the Qualcomm Insider Trading Policy and you are not in possession of any material nonpublic information at the time of such election. If your Employer satisfies the withholding obligations by withholding a number of whole shares of Stock as described in subsection (b) herein, you will be deemed to have been issued the full number of shares of Stock subject to this Award, notwithstanding that a number of shares is held back in order to satisfy the withholding obligations. The “**Fair Market Value**” of any Stock withheld pursuant to this Section 2.3 shall be equal to the closing price of a share of Stock as quoted on any national or regional securities exchange or market system constituting the primary market for the Stock on the date of determination (or, if there is no closing price on that day, the last trading day prior to that day) or, if the Stock is not listed on a national or regional securities exchange or market system, the value of a share of Stock as determined by the Committee in good faith without regard to any restriction other than a restriction

which, by its terms, will never lapse. The Company shall not be required to issue any shares of Stock pursuant to this Agreement unless and until the withholding obligations are satisfied.

3. TAX ADVICE. You represent, warrant and acknowledge that the Company and, if different, your Employer, has made no warranties or representations to you with respect to the income tax consequences of the transactions contemplated by this Award, and you are in no manner relying on the Company, your Employer or their representatives for an assessment of such tax consequences. YOU UNDERSTAND THAT THE TAX LAWS AND REGULATIONS ARE SUBJECT TO CHANGE. YOU SHOULD CONSULT YOUR OWN TAX ADVISOR REGARDING THE TAX TREATMENT OF THIS OR ANY OTHER AWARD. NOTHING STATED HEREIN IS INTENDED OR WRITTEN TO BE USED, AND CANNOT BE USED, FOR THE PURPOSE OF AVOIDING TAXPAYER PENALTIES.

4. DIVIDEND EQUIVALENTS. If the Board declares a cash dividend on the Company's Stock, you will be entitled to Dividend Equivalents in the form, payable on the terms and at such times as provided in Section 10.3 of the Plan.

5. SECURITIES LAW COMPLIANCE. Notwithstanding anything to the contrary contained herein, no shares of Stock will be issued to you upon vesting or payment of this Award unless the Stock is then registered under the Securities Act or, if such Stock is not then so registered, the Company has determined that such vesting and issuance would be exempt from the registration requirements of the Securities Act. By accepting this Award, you agree not to sell any of the shares of Stock received under this Award at a time when applicable laws or Company policies prohibit a sale.

6. TRANSFERABILITY. Prior to the issuance of shares of Stock in payment of all Restricted Stock Units, your Restricted Stock Units shall not be subject in any manner to anticipation, alienation, sale, exchange, transfer, assignment, pledge, encumbrance, or garnishment by your creditors or by your beneficiary, except (a) transfer by will or by the laws of descent and distribution or (b) transfer by written designation of a beneficiary, in a form acceptable to the Company, with such designation taking effect upon your death. All rights with respect to your Restricted Stock Units shall be exercisable during your lifetime only by you or your guardian or legal representative. Prior to actual payment of any Restricted Stock Units, such Restricted Stock Units will represent an unsecured obligation of the Company, payable (if at all) only from the general assets of the Company.

7. AWARD NOT A SERVICE CONTRACT. This Award is not an employment or service contract and nothing in this Agreement, the Grant Notice or the Plan shall be deemed to create in any way whatsoever any obligation on your part to continue in the Service of a Participating Company, or of a Participating Company to continue your Service with the Participating Company. In addition, nothing in this Award shall obligate the Company, its stockholders, Board, Officers or Employees to continue any relationship which you might have as a Director or Consultant for the Company.

8. RESTRICTIVE LEGEND. Stock issued pursuant to the vesting and payment this Award may be subject to such restrictions upon the sale, pledge or other transfer of the Stock as the Company and the Company's counsel deem necessary under applicable law or pursuant to this Agreement.

9. REPRESENTATIONS, WARRANTIES, COVENANTS, AND ACKNOWLEDGMENTS. You hereby agree that in the event the Company and the Company's counsel deem it necessary or advisable in the exercise of their discretion, the transfer or issuance of the shares of Stock issued pursuant to this Award may be conditioned upon you making certain representations, warranties, and acknowledgments relating to compliance with applicable securities laws.

10. VOTING AND OTHER RIGHTS. Subject to the terms of this Agreement, you shall not have any voting rights or any other rights and privileges of a shareholder of the Company unless and until shares of Stock are issued upon payment of this Award.

11. CODE SECTION 409A. It is the intent that the terms relating to the vesting and payment of the Award as set forth in this Agreement shall qualify for exemption from or comply with the requirements of Section 409A of the Code, and any ambiguities herein will be interpreted to so qualify or comply. Notwithstanding the

foregoing or anything herein to the contrary, if it is determined that this Award fails to satisfy the requirements of the “short-term deferral” exemption and is otherwise deferred compensation subject to Section 409A of the Code, and if you are a “specified employee” (as defined under Section 409A(a)(2)(B)(i) of the Code) as of the date of your “separation from service” (as defined under Treasury Regulation Section 1.409A-1(h)), then the issuance of any shares of Stock that would otherwise be made upon the date of the separation from service or within the first six (6) months thereafter will not be made on the originally scheduled date and will instead be issued in a lump sum on the date that is six (6) months and one day after the date of the separation from service, but only if such delay in the issuance of the shares is necessary to avoid the imposition of additional taxation on you in respect of the shares under Section 409A of the Code. The Company reserves the right, to the extent the Company deems necessary or advisable in its sole discretion, to unilaterally amend or modify this Agreement as may be necessary to ensure that all payments provided for under this Agreement are made in a manner that qualifies for exemption from or complies with Section 409A of the Code; provided, however, that the Company makes no representation that the vesting or payments pursuant to this Award provided for under this Agreement will be exempt from or comply with Section 409A of the Code and makes no undertaking to preclude Section 409A of the Code from applying to the vesting or payments pursuant to this Award or require that any vesting or payments pursuant to this Award comply with the require Section of 409A of the Code. The Company will have no liability to you or any other party if the Award, the delivery of shares of Stock upon payment of the Award or other payment hereunder that is intended to be exempt from, or compliant with, Code Section 409A, is not so exempt or compliant or for any action taken by the Company with respect thereto.

12. NOTICES. Any notices provided for in this Agreement, the Grant Notice or the Plan shall be given in writing and shall be deemed effectively given upon receipt or, in the case of notices delivered by the Company to you, five (5) days after deposit in the United States mail, postage prepaid, addressed to you at the last address you provided to the Company.

13. NATURE OF GRANT. In accepting the Award, you acknowledge and agree that:

(a) the Plan is established voluntarily by the Company, it is discretionary in nature and it may be modified, amended, suspended or terminated by the Company at any time, (subject to any limitations set forth in the Plan);

(b) the Award is voluntary and occasional and does not create any contractual or other right to receive future awards, or benefits in lieu of awards, even if other awards have been awarded repeatedly in the past;

(c) all decisions with respect to future Awards, if any, will be at the sole discretion of the Company;

(d) your participation in the Plan is voluntary;

(e) the Award and the shares of Stock subject to the Award are not intended to replace any pension rights or compensation;

(f) the Award and the shares of Stock subject to the Award are not part of normal or expected compensation or salary for any purposes, including, but not limited to, calculating any severance, resignation, termination, redundancy, dismissal, end of service payments, bonuses, long-service awards, pension or retirement or welfare benefits or similar payments and in no event should be considered as compensation for, or relating in any way to, past services for the Company, the Employer or any Participating Company;

(g) the future value of the underlying shares of Stock is unknown and cannot be predicted with any certainty;

(h) no claim or entitlement to compensation or damages shall arise from forfeiture of your Award resulting from termination of your employment or Service or your breach of any terms hereof (for any reason whatsoever and whether or not in breach of local labor laws or later found invalid), and in consideration of the grant of the Award to which you are otherwise not entitled, you irrevocably agree never to institute any claim against the

Company, waive your ability, if any, to bring any such claim, and release the Company from any such claim; if, notwithstanding the foregoing, any such claim is allowed by a court of competent jurisdiction, then, by participating in the Plan, you shall be deemed irrevocably to have agreed not to pursue such claim and agree to execute any and all documents necessary to request dismissal or withdrawal of such claim;

(i) the Award and the benefits evidenced by this Agreement do not create any entitlement, not otherwise specifically provided for in the Plan or provided by the Company in its discretion, to have the Award or any such benefits transferred to, or assumed by, another company, nor to be exchanged, cashed out or substituted for, in connection with any corporate transaction affecting the Company's Stock;

(j) the Award is subject to vesting based on satisfaction of Performance Goals as provided in Section 10.2 of the Plan, as provided herein. The Award shall be interpreted and administered to satisfy the requirements of Section 162(m)(4)(C) of the Code and the regulations thereunder; and

(k) the Company is not providing any tax, legal or financial advice, nor is the Company making any recommendations regarding your participation in the Plan, or your acquisition or sale of the underlying shares of Stock; you are hereby advised to consult with your own personal tax, legal and financial advisors regarding your participation in the Plan before taking any action related to the Plan.

14. APPLICABLE LAW. This Agreement shall be governed by the laws of the State of California as if the Agreement were between California residents and as if it were entered into and to be performed entirely within the State of California.

15. ARBITRATION. Any dispute or claim concerning any Restricted Stock Units granted (or not granted) pursuant to the Plan and any other disputes or claims relating to or arising out of this Agreement or the Plan shall be fully, finally and exclusively resolved by binding arbitration conducted by the American Arbitration Association pursuant to the commercial arbitration rules in San Diego, California. By accepting this Award, you and the Company waive your respective rights to have any such disputes or claims tried by a judge or jury.

16. AMENDMENT. Your Award may be amended as provided in the Plan at any time, provided no such amendment may adversely affect this Award without your consent unless such amendment is necessary to comply with any applicable law or government regulation, or is contemplated in Section 11 hereof. No amendment or addition to this Agreement shall be effective unless in writing or in such electronic form as may be designated by the Company.

17. GOVERNING PLAN DOCUMENT. This Award is subject to this Agreement, the Grant Notice and all the provisions of the Plan, the provisions of which are hereby made a part of this Agreement, and is further subject to all interpretations, amendments, rules and regulations which may from time to time be promulgated and adopted pursuant to the Plan. In the event of any conflict between the provisions of this Agreement, the Grant Notice and those of the Plan, the provisions of the Plan shall control.

18. SEVERABILITY. If any provision of this Agreement is held to be unenforceable for any reason, it shall be adjusted rather than voided, if possible, in order to achieve the intent of the parties to the extent possible. In any event, all other provisions of this Agreement shall be deemed valid and enforceable to the full extent possible.

19. DESCRIPTION OF ELECTRONIC DELIVERY . The Plan documents, which may include but do not necessarily include: the Plan, the Grant Notice, this Agreement, and any reports of the Company provided generally to the Company's stockholders, may be delivered to you electronically. In addition, if permitted by the Company, you may electronically accept and acknowledge the Grant Notice and/or this Agreement and/or deliver such documents to the Company or to such third party involved in administering the Plan as the Company may designate from time to time. Such means of electronic acknowledgement, acceptance and/or delivery may include but do not necessarily include use of a link to a Company intranet or the internet site of a third party involved in administering the Plan, the delivery of the document via electronic mail ("e-mail") or such other means specified by the Company. You hereby consent to receive the above-listed documents by electronic delivery and, if permitted by the Company, agree to participate in the Plan through an on-line or electronic system established and maintained by the Company or a third party designated by the Company, as set forth herein.

20. WAIVER. The waiver by the Company with respect to your (or any other Participant's) compliance of any provision of this Agreement shall not operate or be construed as a waiver of any other provision of this Agreement, or of any subsequent breach of such party of a provision of this Agreement.

21. REPAYMENT/FORFEITURE. Any benefits you may receive hereunder shall be subject to repayment or forfeiture as may be required to comply with (a) any applicable listing standards of a national securities exchange adopted in accordance with Section 954 of the Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act (regarding recovery of erroneously awarded compensation) and any implementing rules and regulations of the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission adopted thereunder, (b) similar rules under the laws of any other jurisdiction and (c) any policies adopted by the Company to implement such requirements, all to the extent determined by the Company in its discretion to be applicable to you.

Attachment 1

QUALCOMM INCORPORATED EXCLUSIVE CONSULTING AGREEMENT

1. Consulting Services Following Normal Retirement Age. In the event you terminate your employment with the Participating Companies and receive or are entitled to receive additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits under the Award to which this Exclusive Consulting Agreement is attached as a result of having previously attained Normal Retirement Age, you will provide the Company consulting services related to the subject matter of that employment as provided in this Exclusive Consulting Agreement. Such consulting services will not exceed five (5) hours per month, and there will be no separate compensation for such services beyond that provided in the Award. Should the Company request services in excess of five (5) hours per month, you and Company will negotiate appropriate compensation for such additional services before they are undertaken. You represent, warrant and covenant that you will perform any services under this Exclusive Consulting Agreement in a timely, professional and workmanlike manner and that all services, materials, information and deliverables provided by you hereunder will comply with (i) the requirements communicated by Company, (ii) the Company's policies and procedures; and (iii) any other agreements between you and the Company, including but not limited to any severance, confidentiality or proprietary agreements. All capitalized terms in this Exclusive Consulting Agreement not otherwise defined herein shall have the meaning prescribed by the Qualcomm Incorporated 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan (the "**Plan**") or the Award thereunder to which this Exclusive Consulting Agreement is attached.

2. The Award. You are a former high-level executive with at least 10 years' service with the Company and as such you are entitled to additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits under the Award as a result of having reached Normal Retirement Age. Your agreement to the terms and conditions of this Exclusive Consulting Agreement is an express condition of the Award and the additional provisions of the Award applicable to you following attainment of Normal Retirement Age.

3. Independent Contractor Relationship. Your relationship with Company under this Exclusive Consulting Agreement is that of an independent contractor, and nothing herein is intended to, or shall be construed to, create a partnership, agency, joint venture, employment, or similar relationship. You will not be entitled to any of the benefits that Company may make available to its employees, including, but not limited to, group health or life insurance, profit-sharing benefits, or retirement benefits, or awards under the Plan unless expressly provided in writing otherwise. You agree that providing services under this Exclusive Consulting Agreement shall not be treated as Service for purposes of the Plan or the Award. You are not authorized to make any representation, contract, or commitment on behalf of Company unless specifically requested or authorized in writing to do so by a Company officer. You are solely responsible for, and will file, on a timely basis, all tax returns and payments required to be filed with, or made to, any federal, state, or local tax authority. You will indemnify and hold harmless Company from and against any and all tax liability related to this Exclusive Consulting Agreement as well as any claims, actions, or charges arising out of or caused by your classification as an independent contractor.

4. Exclusivity.

4.1 The consultancy arrangement contemplated by this Exclusive Consulting Agreement shall be on an exclusive basis. You shall not, during the Term, without the prior written consent of the Compensation Committee, engage in any work, services, or other activities for any person or entity which directly or indirectly competes with Company in any way. This includes, but is not limited to acting as an employee, officer, director, contractor, owner, consultant, or agent of any such person or entity. The determination of whether a person or entity is competitive with Company shall be subject to the sole and exclusive discretion of the Compensation Committee. You shall act in the best interest of Company while providing the Exclusive Consulting Services to Company.

5. Term and Termination.

5.1 Term. This Exclusive Consulting Agreement is effective as of the date of your termination of employment with Company following Normal Retirement Age and will terminate on the two year anniversary thereof unless terminated earlier as set forth below (the "**Term**").

5.2 Termination by Company. Company may terminate this Exclusive Consulting Agreement before the end of the Term for any breach of Section 4 hereof by you or any material breach by you of any other provision hereof. Should Company believe that you breached this Exclusive Consulting Agreement in a manner that allows a termination pursuant to this Section 5.2, Company will notify you in writing and allow you to cure any breach (if such breach is curable) within ten (10) days after the date of Company's written notice of breach. You understand that if Company terminates this Exclusive Consulting Agreement pursuant to this Section 5.2, you will forfeit all additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits under the Award as a result of having attained Normal Retirement Age and you will be subject to the Equity Clawback provisions of Section 6, below.

5.3 Termination by You. You may not terminate this Exclusive Consulting Agreement during the Term except or unless Company materially breaches this Consulting Agreement. Should you believe that Company materially breached this Exclusive Consulting Agreement, you will notify the Company in writing and allow Company to cure any breach (if such breach is curable) within ten (10) days after the date of your written notice of breach.

6. Equity Clawback. In the event of any breach by you of Section 4 hereof or any material breach by you of any other provision hereof, then any additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits you may have as a result of having attained Normal Retirement Age shall automatically and immediately terminate and be forfeited. In addition, you shall, within 30 days following notice from Company, pay to the Company an amount equal to the aggregate benefit, value or gain you realized or obtained as a result of any additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits you received under the Award as a result of having attained Normal Retirement Age.

Attachment: Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Agreement (U.S. PSU-EX-A11)

QUALCOMM INCORPORATED
2016 LONG-TERM INCENTIVE PLAN
EXECUTIVE PERFORMANCE STOCK UNIT AWARD
AGREEMENT

Qualcomm Incorporated (the “*Company*”) has granted this Performance Stock Unit Award (this “*Award*”) to you, the Participant named in the Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Grant Notice (the “*Grant Notice*”) pursuant to the terms and conditions set forth in the Grant Notice, this Executive Performance Stock Unit Award Agreement and the attachments hereto (together with the Grant Notice, the “*Agreement*”) and the 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan (the “*Plan*”). Capitalized terms that are not explicitly defined in the Grant Notice or this Agreement but are defined in the Plan shall have the same definitions as in the Plan.

The details of this Award are as follows:

1. VESTING.

1.1 SERVICE VESTING. Except to the extent provided in Section 1.2 and Section 6, you will be fully vested in this Award on the Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice if and to the extent that you continue in Service through that Vesting Date. If your Service terminates before the Vesting Date for any reason other than as specified in Section 1.2, this Award shall be forfeited.

1.2 VESTING UPON TERMINATION OF SERVICE DUE TO DEATH, DISABILITY OR TERMINATION AFTER CHANGE IN CONTROL, OR UPON ATTAINMENT OF NORMAL RETIREMENT AGE. You will be vested in this Award if your Service terminates before the Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice due to death, Disability or Termination After Change in Control (as defined below) or upon the date you have attained Normal Retirement Age (as defined below), if and to the extent that you continue in Service through the date of such termination of Service or the date you have attained Normal Retirement Age. If your Service terminates for any reason other than due to death, Disability or Termination After Change in Control (as defined below), or prior to the date on which you have attained Normal Retirement Age, this Award shall be forfeited.

(a) Certain Definitions.

(i) “*Cause*” shall mean any of the following: (1) your theft of, dishonesty with respect to, or falsification of any Participating Company documents or records; (2) your improper use or disclosure of a Participating Company’s confidential or proprietary information; (3) any action by you which has a detrimental effect on a Participating Company’s reputation or business; (4) your failure or inability to perform any reasonable assigned duties after written notice from a Participating Company of, and a reasonable opportunity to cure, such failure or inability; (5) any material breach by you of any employment or service agreement between you and a Participating Company, which breach is not cured pursuant to the terms of such agreement; (6) your conviction (including any plea of guilty or *nolo contendere*) of any criminal act which impairs your ability to perform your duties with a Participating Company; or (7) violation of a material Company or Participating Company policy.

(ii) “*Good Reason*” shall mean any one or more of the following:

a) without your express written consent, the assignment to you of any duties, or any limitation of your responsibilities, substantially inconsistent with your positions, duties, responsibilities and status with the Participating Company Group immediately prior to the date of a Change in Control;

b) without your express written consent, the relocation of the principal place of your employment or service to a location that is more than fifty (50) miles from your principal place of employment or service immediately prior to the date of a Change

in Control, or the imposition of travel requirements substantially more demanding of you than such travel requirements existing immediately prior to the date of the Change in Control;

c) any failure by the Participating Company Group to pay, or any material reduction by the Participating Company Group of, (A) your base salary in effect immediately prior to the date of a Change in Control (unless reductions comparable in amount and duration are concurrently made for all other employees of the Participating Company Group with responsibilities, organizational level and title comparable to yours), or (B) your bonus compensation, if any, in effect immediately prior to the date of a Change in Control (subject to applicable performance requirements with respect to the actual amount of bonus compensation earned by you);

d) any failure by the Participating Company Group to (A) continue to provide you with the opportunity to participate, on terms no less favorable than those in effect for the benefit of any employee or service provider group which customarily includes a person holding the employment or service provider position or a comparable position with the Participating Company Group then held by you, in any benefit or compensation plans and programs, including, but not limited to, the Participating Company Group's life, disability, health, dental, medical, savings, profit sharing, stock purchase and retirement plans, if any, in which you were participating immediately prior to the date of the Change in Control, or their equivalent, or (B) provide you with all other fringe benefits (or their equivalent) from time to time in effect for the benefit of any employee group which customarily includes a person holding the employment or service provider position or a comparable position with the Participating Company Group then held by you;

e) any breach by the Participating Company Group of any material agreement between you and a Participating Company concerning your employment; or

f) any failure by the Company to obtain the assumption of any material agreement between you and the Company concerning your employment by a successor or assignee of the Company.

(iii) “**Normal Retirement Age**” shall be the later of (1) the date which is six (6) months after the Grant Date or (2) the date on which you have attained age fifty-five (55) and completed at least ten (10) years of consecutive Service.

(iv) “**Termination After Change in Control**” shall mean either of the following events occurring within twenty-four (24) months after a Change in Control:

a) termination by the Participating Company Group of your Service with the Participating Company Group for any reason other than for Cause; or

b) your resignation for Good Reason from all capacities in which you are then rendering Service to the Participating Company Group within a reasonable period of time following the event constituting Good Reason.

Notwithstanding any provision herein to the contrary, Termination After Change in Control shall not include any termination of your Service with the Participating Company Group which (1) is for Cause; (2) is a result of your death or Disability; (3) is a result of your voluntary termination of Service other than for Good Reason; or (4) occurs prior to the effectiveness of a Change in Control.

1.3 SUSPENSION OF VESTING. Notwithstanding any other provision of the Plan or this Agreement, the Company reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to suspend vesting of this Award in the event of any leave of absence or part-time Service.

2. SETTLEMENT OF THE AWARD.

2.1 AMOUNT, FORM AND TIMING OF PAYMENT OF AWARD THAT VESTS ON VESTING DATE SPECIFIED IN THE GRANT NOTICE. If your Award vests on the Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice, you shall be paid in a number of shares of Stock equal to the total number of Shares Earned (if any) determined pursuant to Attachment 1, which is attached hereto and made a part hereof. Such shares of Stock shall be paid within the 30 days after the later of (a) the Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice or (b) the date on which the Compensation Committee (the “*Committee*”) determines and certifies in writing the number of shares (if any) that are payable, which determination and certification shall be made by the Committee no later than the November 30th that next follows the end of the Performance Period.

2.2 AMOUNT, FORM AND TIMING OF PAYMENT OF AWARD THAT VESTS UPON ATTAINMENT OF NORMAL RETIREMENT AGE. If your Award vests upon your attainment of Normal Retirement Age, you shall be paid in a number of shares of Stock equal to the total number of Shares Earned (if any) determined pursuant to Attachment 1, which is attached hereto and made a part hereof. Such shares of Stock shall be paid within the 30 days after the later of (a) the Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice or (b) the date on which the Committee determines and certifies in writing the number of shares (if any) that are payable, which determination and certification shall be made by the Committee no later than the November 30th that next follows the end of the Performance Period; provided, however, that payment shall be made pursuant to this Section 2.2 following your termination of employment with the Participating Company only if such termination was not for Cause and you (A) execute a general release of claims in a form satisfactory to the Company and that general release become irrevocable before the 60th day following your termination of employment, and (B) comply with the requirements of the Exclusive Consulting Agreement attached hereto as Attachment 2 (the “*Consulting Agreement*”). Notwithstanding the foregoing, in the event you violate any of the provisions contained in the Consulting Agreement, all rights to payment under this Section 2.2. shall be immediately forfeited without consideration. In the event your employment is terminated for Cause, you will immediately forfeit your right to payment under this Section 2.2.

2.3 AMOUNT, FORM AND TIMING OF PAYMENT OF AWARD THAT VESTS UPON TERMINATION OF SERVICE BEFORE THE VESTING DATE SPECIFIED IN THE GRANT NOTICE DUE TO DEATH, DISABILITY OR TERMINATION AFTER CHANGE IN CONTROL. If your Service terminates before the Vesting Date specified in the Grant Notice due to death, Disability or Termination After a Change in Control, you (or in the event of death, your estate, personal representative, or beneficiary to whom this Award may be transferred by will or by the laws of descent and distribution), will be paid a number of shares of Stock equal to the product of (1) the sum of (a) the RTSR Shares Earned and (b) the ROIC Shares Earned determined pursuant to this Attachment 1 except that the Performance Period for this determination will be the period beginning on the date specified in the Grant Notice, and ending on the last day of the Company’s fiscal year in which your Service terminates, multiplied by (2) a fraction the numerator of which is the number of whole and partial months (rounded up to the next whole month) from the beginning of the Performance Period until the date your Service terminates, and the denominator of which is 36. Shares of Stock payable pursuant to this Section 2.3 shall be paid within the 30 days after the date on which the Committee determines and certifies in writing the number of shares of Stock (if any) that are payable pursuant to this Section 2.3, which determination and certification shall be made by the Committee no later than the November 30th that next follows the end of the Company’s fiscal year in which such termination of Service occurred.

2.4 AMOUNT, FORM AND TIMING OF PAYMENT UPON DEATH DURING THE PERFORMANCE PERIOD FOLLOWING TERMINATION OF SERVICE DUE TO DISABILITY. If your Service with the Employer terminates because of your Disability and you are entitled to receive or have received a payment of Stock pursuant to Section 2.3, and you later die during the Performance Period specified in the Grant Agreement, your estate, personal representative, or beneficiary to whom this Award may be transferred by will or by the laws of descent and distribution will be paid an additional number of shares of Stock equal to the difference (if any) between (1) the shares of Stock you would have received under Section 2.3 had you remained in Service until the date of your death, reduced by (2) any shares of Stock you are entitled to receive or have received pursuant to Section 2.3 as a result of termination of your Service due to your Disability. Shares of Stock payable pursuant to this Section 2.4 shall be paid within the 30 days after the date on which the Committee determines and certifies in writing the number of shares of Stock (if any) that are payable pursuant to this Section 2.4, which determination and

certification shall be made by the Committee no later than the November 30th that next follows the end of the Company's fiscal year in which such termination of Service occurred.

2.5 TAX WITHHOLDING. You acknowledge that the Company and/or the Participating Company that employs you (the "**Employer**") may be subject to withholding tax obligations arising by reason of the vesting and/or payment of this Award. You authorize your Employer to satisfy the withholding tax obligations by one or a combination of the following methods, as selected by the Company in its sole discretion: (a) withholding from your pay and any other amounts payable to you; (b) withholding of Stock and/or cash from the payment of this Award; (c) arranging for the sale of shares of Stock payable in connection with this Award (on your behalf and at your direction which you authorize by accepting this Award); or (d) any other method allowed by the Plan or applicable law. Notwithstanding the foregoing, you may elect in the manner specified by the Company to make a cash payment to the Company or your Employer to satisfy the withholding tax obligations with respect to this Award, provided such election is made during an open trading window under the Qualcomm Insider Trading Policy and you are not in possession of any material nonpublic information at the time of such election. If your Employer satisfies the withholding obligations by withholding a number of whole shares of Stock as described in subsection (b) herein, you will be deemed to have been issued the full number of shares of Stock subject to this Award, notwithstanding that a number of shares is held back in order to satisfy the withholding obligations. The "**Fair Market Value**" of any Stock withheld pursuant to this Section 2.5 shall be equal to the closing price of a share of Stock as quoted on any national or regional securities exchange or market system constituting the primary market for the Stock on the date of determination (or, if there is no closing price on that day, the last trading day prior to that day) or, if the Stock is not listed on a national or regional securities exchange or market system, the value of a share of Stock as determined by the Committee in good faith without regard to any restriction other than a restriction which, by its terms, will never lapse. The Company shall not be required to issue any shares of Stock pursuant to this Agreement unless and until the withholding obligations are satisfied.

3. TAX ADVICE. You represent, warrant and acknowledge that the Company and, if different, your Employer, has made no warranties or representations to you with respect to the income tax consequences of the transactions contemplated by this Award, and you are in no manner relying on the Company, your Employer or their representatives for an assessment of such tax consequences. YOU UNDERSTAND THAT THE TAX LAWS AND REGULATIONS ARE SUBJECT TO CHANGE. YOU SHOULD CONSULT YOUR OWN TAX ADVISOR REGARDING THE TAX TREATMENT OF THIS OR ANY OTHER AWARD. NOTHING STATED HEREIN IS INTENDED OR WRITTEN TO BE USED, AND CANNOT BE USED, FOR THE PURPOSE OF AVOIDING TAXPAYER PENALTIES.

4. DIVIDEND EQUIVALENTS. If the Board declares a cash dividend on the Company's Stock, you will be entitled to Dividend Equivalents in the form, payable on the terms and at such times as provided in Section 10.3 of the Plan.

5. SECURITIES LAW COMPLIANCE. Notwithstanding anything to the contrary contained herein, no shares of Stock will be issued to you upon vesting of this Award unless the Stock is then registered under the Securities Act or, if such Stock is not then so registered, the Company has determined that such vesting and issuance would be exempt from the registration requirements of the Securities Act. By accepting this Award, you agree not to sell any of the shares of Stock received under this Award at a time when applicable laws or Company policies prohibit a sale.

6. CHANGE IN CONTROL. In the event of a Change in Control, the surviving, continuing, successor, or purchasing corporation or other business entity or parent thereof, as the case may be (the "**Acquiring Corporation**"), may, without your consent, either assume the Company's rights and obligations under this Award or substitute for this Award a substantially equivalent award for the Acquiring Corporation's stock.

6.1 Payout Pursuant to a Change in Control. In the event the Acquiring Corporation elects not to assume or substitute for this Award in connection with a Change in Control, the vesting of this Award, so long as your Service has not terminated prior to the date of the Change in Control, shall be accelerated, effective as of the date ten (10) days prior to the date of the Change in Control, and immediately prior to the closing of the Change in Control, you will be paid a number of shares of Stock equal to the sum of (a) the RTSR Shares Earned determined

pursuant to Attachment 1 based on a Performance Period ending ten (10) days before the Change in Control, plus (b) the Target ROIC Shares specified in the Grant Notice.

6.2 Vesting Contingent Upon Consummation. The vesting of this Award and payment of any shares of Stock by reason of this Section 6 shall be conditioned upon the consummation of the Change in Control.

6.3 Applicability of Agreement. Notwithstanding the foregoing, shares of Stock acquired upon settlement of this Award prior to the Change in Control and any consideration received pursuant to the Change in Control with respect to such shares shall continue to be subject to all applicable provisions of this Agreement except as otherwise provided in this Agreement.

6.4 Continuation of Award. Notwithstanding the foregoing, if the corporation the stock of which is subject to this Award immediately prior to an Ownership Change Event constituting a Change in Control is the surviving or continuing corporation and immediately after such Ownership Change Event, less than fifty percent (50%) of the total combined voting power of its voting stock is held by another corporation or by other corporations that are members of an affiliated group within the meaning of Section 1504(a) of the Code, without regard to the provisions of Section 1504(b) of the Code, this Award shall not terminate unless the Committee otherwise provides in its discretion.

7. TRANSFERABILITY. Prior to the issuance of shares of Stock in settlement of this Award, the Award shall not be subject in any manner to anticipation, alienation, sale, exchange, transfer, assignment, pledge, encumbrance, or garnishment by your creditors or by your beneficiary (if any), except (i) transfer by will or by the laws of descent and distribution or (ii) to the extent permitted by the Company, transfer by written designation of a beneficiary, in a form acceptable to the Company, with such designation taking effect upon your death. All rights with respect to the Performance Stock Units shall be exercisable during your lifetime only by you or your guardian or legal representative. Prior to actual payment of any shares of Stock pursuant to this Award, this Award will represent an unsecured obligation of the Company, payable (if at all) only from the general assets of the Company.

8. AWARD NOT A SERVICE CONTRACT. This Award is not an employment or service contract and nothing in this Agreement, the Grant Notice or the Plan shall be deemed to create in any way whatsoever any obligation on your part to continue in the Service of a Participating Company, or of a Participating Company to continue your Service with the Participating Company. In addition, nothing in your Award shall obligate the Company, its stockholders, Board, Officers or Employees to continue any relationship which you might have as a Director or Consultant for the Company.

9. RESTRICTIVE LEGEND. Stock issued pursuant to the vesting and payment of this Award may be subject to such restrictions upon the sale, pledge or other transfer of the Stock as the Company and the Company's counsel deem necessary under applicable law or pursuant to this Agreement.

10. REPRESENTATIONS, WARRANTIES, COVENANTS, AND ACKNOWLEDGMENTS. You hereby agree that in the event the Company and the Company's counsel deem it necessary or advisable in the exercise of their discretion, the transfer or issuance of the shares of Stock issued pursuant to the vesting and payment of this Award may be conditioned upon you making certain representations, warranties, and acknowledgments relating to compliance with applicable securities laws.

11. VOTING AND OTHER RIGHTS. Subject to the terms of this Agreement, you shall not have any voting rights or any other rights and privileges of a shareholder of the Company unless and until shares of Stock are issued upon payment of this Award.

12. CODE SECTION 409A. It is the intent that the terms relating to the vesting and the payment of the Award as set forth in this Agreement shall qualify for exemption from or comply with the requirements of Section 409A of the Code, and any ambiguities herein will be interpreted to so qualify or comply. Notwithstanding the foregoing or anything herein to the contrary, if it is determined that this Award fails to satisfy the requirements of the "short-term deferral" exemption and is otherwise deferred compensation subject to Section 409A of the Code, and if you are a "specified employee" (as defined under Section 409A(a)(2)(B)(i) of the Code) as of the date of your "separation from service" (as defined under Treasury Regulation Section 1.409A-1(h)), then the issuance of any

shares of Stock that would otherwise be made upon the date of the separation from service or within the first six (6) months thereafter will not be made on the originally scheduled date and will instead be issued in a lump sum on the date that is six (6) months and one day after the date of the separation from service, but only if such delay in the issuance of the shares is necessary to avoid the imposition of additional taxation on you in respect of the shares under Section 409A of the Code. The Company reserves the right, to the extent the Company deems appropriate or advisable in its sole discretion, to unilaterally amend or modify this Agreement as may be necessary to ensure that all vesting or payments provided for under this Agreement are made in a manner that qualifies for exemption from or complies with the requirements of Section 409A of the Code; provided, however, that the Company makes no representation that the vesting or payments pursuant to this Award will be exempt from or comply with the requirements of Section 409A of the Code and makes no undertaking to preclude Section 409A of the Code from applying to the vesting or payments of this Award or require that any vesting or payments pursuant to this Award comply with the requirements of Section 409A of the Code. The Company will have no liability to you or any other party if the Award, the delivery of shares of Stock upon payment of the Award or other payment hereunder that is intended to be exempt from, or compliant with, Section 409A of the Code, is not so exempt or compliant or for any action taken by the Company with respect thereto.

13. NOTICES. Any notices provided for in this Agreement, the Grant Notice or the Plan shall be given in writing and shall be deemed effectively given upon receipt or, in the case of notices delivered by the Company to you, five (5) days after deposit in the United States mail, postage prepaid, addressed to you at the last address you provided to the Company.

14. NATURE OF GRANT. In accepting the Award, you acknowledge and agree that:

(a) the Plan is established voluntarily by the Company, it is discretionary in nature and it may be modified, amended, suspended or terminated by the Company at any time, (subject to any limitations set forth in the Plan);

(b) the Award is voluntary and occasional and does not create any contractual or other right to receive future awards or benefits in lieu of awards, even if other awards have been awarded repeatedly in the past;

(c) all decisions with respect to future awards, if any, will be at the sole discretion of the Company;

(d) your participation in the Plan is voluntary;

(e) the Award and the shares of Stock subject to the Award are extraordinary items that do not constitute compensation of any kind for Services of any kind rendered to the Company or the Employer, and which are outside the scope of your employment or service contract, if any;

(f) the Award and the shares of Stock subject to the Award are not intended to replace any pension rights or compensation;

(g) the Award and the shares of Stock subject to the Award are not part of normal or expected compensation or salary for any purposes, including, but not limited to, calculating any severance, resignation, termination, redundancy, dismissal, end of service payments, bonuses, long-service awards, pension or retirement or welfare benefits or similar payments and in no event should be considered as compensation for, or relating in any way to, past services for the Company, the Employer or any Participating Company;

(h) the future value of the underlying shares of Stock is unknown and cannot be predicted with any certainty;

(i) no claim or entitlement to compensation or damages shall arise from forfeiture of your Award resulting from termination of your employment or Service or your breach of any terms hereof (for any reason whatsoever and whether or not in breach of local labor laws or later found invalid), and in consideration of the grant of the Award to which you are otherwise not entitled, you irrevocably agree never to institute any claim against the Company, waive your ability, if any, to bring any such claim, and release the Company from any such claim; if,

notwithstanding the foregoing, any such claim is allowed by a court of competent jurisdiction, then, by participating in the Plan, you shall be deemed irrevocably to have agreed not to pursue such claim and agree to execute any and all documents necessary to request dismissal or withdrawal of such claim;

(j) the Award and the benefits evidenced by this Agreement do not create any entitlement, not otherwise specifically provided for in the Plan or provided by the Company in its discretion, to have the Award or any such benefits transferred to, or assumed by, another company, nor to be exchanged, cashed out or substituted for, in connection with any corporate transaction affecting the Company's Stock;

(k) the Award is a Performance Award granted pursuant to the Plan providing for a number of Performance Units equal to the Target RTSR Shares and Target ROIC Shares specified in the Grant Agreement, which shall be payable in a number of shares of Stock (if any) based on the RTSR and ROIC for the Performance Period, as provided herein. This Performance Award shall be interpreted and administered to satisfy the requirements of section 162(m)(4)(C) of the Code and the regulations thereunder; and

(l) the Company is not providing any tax, legal or financial advice, nor is the Company making any recommendations regarding your participation in the Plan, or your acquisition or sale of the underlying shares of Stock; you are hereby advised to consult with your own personal tax, legal and financial advisors regarding your participation in the Plan before taking any action related to the Plan.

15. APPLICABLE LAW. This Agreement shall be governed by the laws of the State of California as if the Agreement were between California residents and as if it were entered into and to be performed entirely within the State of California.

16. ARBITRATION. Any dispute or claim concerning any Performance Stock Units granted (or not granted) pursuant to the Plan and any other disputes or claims relating to or arising out of this Agreement or the Plan shall be fully, finally and exclusively resolved by binding arbitration conducted by the American Arbitration Association pursuant to the commercial arbitration rules in San Diego, California. By accepting this Award, you and the Company waive your respective rights to have any such disputes or claims tried by a judge or jury.

17. AMENDMENT. Your Award may be amended as provided in the Plan at any time, provided no such amendment may adversely affect this Award without your consent unless such amendment is necessary to comply with any applicable law or government regulation, or is contemplated in Section 12 hereof. No amendment or addition to this Agreement shall be effective unless in writing or in such electronic form as may be designated by the Company.

18. GOVERNING PLAN DOCUMENT. Your Award is subject to this Agreement, the Grant Notice and all the provisions of the Plan, the provisions of which are hereby made a part of this Agreement, and is further subject to all interpretations, amendments, rules and regulations which may from time to time be promulgated and adopted pursuant to the Plan. In the event of any conflict between the provisions of this Agreement, the Grant Notice and those of the Plan, the provisions of the Plan shall control.

19. SEVERABILITY. If any provision of this Agreement is held to be unenforceable for any reason, it shall be adjusted rather than voided, if possible, in order to achieve the intent of the parties to the extent possible. In any event, all other provisions of this Agreement shall be deemed valid and enforceable to the full extent possible.

20. DESCRIPTION OF ELECTRONIC DELIVERY . The Plan documents, which may include but do not necessarily include: the Plan, the Grant Notice, this Agreement, and any reports of the Company provided generally to the Company's stockholders, may be delivered to you electronically. In addition, if permitted by the Company, you may electronically accept and acknowledge the Grant Notice and/or this Agreement and/or deliver such documents to the Company or to such third party involved in administering the Plan as the Company may designate from time to time. Such means of electronic acknowledgement, acceptance and/or delivery may include but do not necessarily include use of a link to a Company intranet or the internet site of a third party involved in administering the Plan, the delivery of the document via electronic mail ("e-mail") or such other means specified by the Company. You hereby consent to receive the above-listed documents by electronic delivery and, if permitted by

the Company, agree to participate in the Plan through an on-line or electronic system established and maintained by the Company or a third party designated by the Company, as set forth herein.

21. WAIVER. The waiver by the Company with respect to your (or any other Participant's) compliance of any provision of this Agreement shall not operate or be construed as a waiver of any other provision of this Agreement, or of any subsequent breach of such party of a provision of this Agreement.

22. REPAYMENT/FORFEITURE. Any benefits you may receive hereunder shall be subject to repayment or forfeiture as may be required to comply with (a) any applicable listing standards of a national securities exchange adopted in accordance with Section 954 of the Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act (regarding recovery of erroneously awarded compensation) and any implementing rules and regulations of the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission adopted thereunder, (b) similar rules under the laws of any other jurisdiction and (c) any policies adopted by the Company, including but not limited to any policies that may be adopted to implement the foregoing standards or rules, all to the extent determined by the Company in its discretion.

ATTACHMENT 1

For purposes of Section 2.1 of this Agreement, “Shares Earned” means the sum of (1) the RTSR Shares Earned and (2) the ROIC Shares Earned, as determined pursuant to this Attachment 1.

“***RTSR Shares Earned***” means the number of Shares determined by multiplying the Target RTSR Shares specified in the Grant Notice by the TSR Payout Percentage, rounding up to the nearest whole share. For purposes of determining the RTSR Shares Earned:

“***Beginning Period Average Price***” means the average official closing price per share of the issuer over the 20-consecutive-trading days ending with and including the first day of the Performance Period (if the applicable day is not a trading day, the immediately preceding trading day).

“***Ending Period Average Price***” means the average official closing price per share of the issuer over the 20-consecutive-trading days ending with and including the last day of the Performance Period (if the applicable day is not a trading day, the immediately preceding trading day).

“***Nasdaq-100 Companies***” means the companies that are included in the NASDAQ-100 Index (published by The NASDAQ Stock Market, or its successor) continuously from the beginning through the end of the Performance Period. The Committee shall have the authority to make appropriate adjustments to the extent necessary to account for extraordinary, unusual and infrequently occurring events and transactions involving that company to the extent such adjustments would not preclude the payment of TSR Shares Earned from satisfying the requirements of Section 162(m)(4)(C) of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986, as amended (the “***Code***”) and the regulations thereunder.

“***Performance Period***” means the period specified in the Grant Notice.

“***TSR***” means total shareholder return as determined by dividing (i) the sum of (A) the Ending Period Average Price minus the Beginning Period Average Price plus (B) all dividends and other distributions paid on the issuer’s shares during the Performance Period by (ii) the Beginning Period Average Price. In calculating TSR, all dividends are assumed to have been reinvested in shares when paid. The Committee shall have the authority to make appropriate equitable adjustments to account for extraordinary items affecting a company’s TSR for the Performance Period to the extent such adjustments would not preclude the payment of TSR Shares Earned from satisfying the requirements of Section 162(m)(4)(C) of the Code and the regulations thereunder.

“***TSR Payout Percentage***” means the percentage that corresponds to the TSR Percentile Rank specified below:

TSR Percentile Rank	Payout Percentage
90 th percentile and above	200%
75 th percentile	150%
60 th percentile	100% (Target)
50 th percentile	75%
33 rd percentile	33%
Below 33 rd percentile	0%

Between the levels specified above, the Payout Percentage is interpolated linearly at a ratio of three-and-one-third (3-1/3) percentage points for each percentile that the TSR Percentile Rank is greater than the 60th percentile, and two-and-one-half (2-1/2) percentage points for each percentile that the TSR Percentile Rank is less than the 60th percentile, in each case rounded up to the nearest decimal point.

“ **TSR Percentile Rank** ” means the Company’s percentile ranking relative to the Nasdaq-100 Companies, based on TSR. TSR Percentile Rank is determined by ordering the Nasdaq-100 Companies (plus the Company if the Company is not one of the Nasdaq-100 Companies) from highest to lowest based on TSR for the Performance Period and counting down from the company with the highest TSR (ranked first) to the Company’s position on the list. If two companies are ranked equally, the ranking of the next company shall account for the tie, so that if one company is ranked first, and two companies are tied for second, the next company is ranked fourth. After this ranking, the TSR Percentile Rank will be calculated using the following formula, rounded to the nearest whole percentile by application of regular rounding:

$$\text{TSR Percentile Rank} = \frac{(N - R)}{N} * 100$$

“ *N* ” represents the number of Nasdaq-100 Companies for the Performance Period (plus the Company if the Company is not one of the Nasdaq-100 Companies for the Performance Period).

“ *R* ” represents the Company’s ranking among the Nasdaq-100 Companies (plus the Company if the Company is not one of the Nasdaq-100 Companies for the Performance Period).

For example, if there are 100 Nasdaq-100 Companies (including the Company), and the Company ranked 40th, the TSR Percentile Rank would be at the 60th percentile:

$$60 = (100 - 40)/100 * 100.$$

LIMITATION ON AMOUNT OF PAYMENT. Notwithstanding anything in this Agreement to the contrary, if the Company’s TSR is negative for the Performance Period, then the RTSR Shares Earned will be equal to the lesser of (a) the number of RTSR Shares (if any) determined without regard to this Limitation on Amount of Payment, or (b) the Target RTSR Shares specified in the Grant Notice.

“ ROIC Shares Earned ” means the number of shares determined by multiplying the Target ROIC Shares specified in the Grant Notice by the ROIC Payout Percentage, rounding up to the nearest whole share. For purposes of determining the ROIC Shares Earned:

“ Average ” means the sum of the balance at the beginning of the Company’s fiscal year plus the balance at the end of that fiscal year divided by two (2).

“ Adjusted Debt ” means debt issued or assumed by Qualcomm Incorporated or any of its consolidated subsidiaries, provided that in the event of an acquisition with a purchase price that is greater than \$5 billion, the impact of debt incurred or assumed in connection with or related to such acquisition shall be excluded for the fiscal year in which such acquisition closes and, if such debt is incurred in the fiscal year prior to the year in which such acquisition closes, for such prior fiscal year and the year in which the acquisition closes (but for no other years).

“ Adjusted GAAP Equity ” means the total stockholders’ equity attributable to Qualcomm as reported in the consolidated balance sheet prepared in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States (“GAAP”) and shall be adjusted to exclude the following items:

- (1) Provided that in the event of an acquisition with a purchase price that is greater than \$5 billion, solely for purposes of calculating Adjusted GAAP Equity for the fiscal year in which such acquisition closes (but for no other year), the impact of equity issued by Qualcomm Incorporated to fund such acquisition;
- (2) Provided that in the event of an acquisition with a purchase price that is greater than \$5 billion, the after-tax impact of expense (e.g. interest expense) or amortization of premiums or discounts related to debt issued or assumed by Qualcomm Incorporated or any of its subsidiaries in connection with or related to such acquisition shall be excluded for the fiscal year in which the acquisition closes, and if such debt is incurred in the fiscal year prior to the year in which such acquisitions closes, for such prior fiscal year and the year in which the acquisition closes (but for no other years);
- (3) The effect of adjustments to retained earnings for changes in U.S. GAAP (including the adoption of new accounting standards); and
- (4) Tax items, including the effects of changes to tax laws, individually exceeding \$10 million that are unrelated to the fiscal year in which they are recorded, but only with respect to tax items relating to one or more tax years ending before the beginning of the Performance Period.

To the extent that adjustments are made to Adjusted GAAP Operating Income pursuant to items (3) and (4) as described below, corresponding adjustments shall be made to Adjusted GAAP Equity.

“ Adjusted GAAP Operating Income ” is determined in accordance with GAAP and shall be adjusted to exclude the after tax impact of the following items:

- (1) The Qualcomm Strategic Initiative (“QSI”) segment as defined in the Company’s fiscal 2016 Form 10-K;
- (2) Acquisition-related items, which consist of:
 - (a) Acquired in-process research and development,
 - (b) Recognition of the step-up of inventories to fair value,
 - (c) Purchase accounting effects on property, plant and equipment for acquisitions completed in or after the second quarter of fiscal 2017,

- (d) Amortization of intangible assets for acquisitions completed in or after the third quarter of fiscal 2011,
- (e) Expenses related to the termination of contracts that limit the use of the acquired intellectual property, and
- (f) Third-party acquisition and integration services costs.

The above adjustments shall apply only with respect to applicable items acquired in transactions that qualify as business combinations pursuant to GAAP;

(3) The following items for which each event individually equals or exceeds \$25 million on a pre-tax basis:

(a) Restructuring and restructuring-related costs (in the aggregate by restructuring event), which consist of the following costs:

- severance and benefits (including COBRA and outplacement expenses);
- consulting costs;
- increased security costs;
- acceleration of depreciation and/or amortization expense;
- facilities and lease termination or abandonment charges;
- asset impairment charges and/or contract terminations;
- third-party business separation costs; and
- relocation costs as a result of an office or facility closure.

GAAP operating income shall not be adjusted for any item that cannot specifically be tied to the restructuring event;

(b) Goodwill and indefinite- and long-lived asset impairments, but only with respect to goodwill and assets acquired before the first day of the Performance Period;

(c) Gain/losses on divestitures or non-revenue generating asset sales;

(d) Impact of litigation settlement, arbitration and/or judgment, but only to the extent the profit or loss arising from the settlement or judgment is clearly attributable to one or more fiscal years ending before the beginning of the Performance Period; and

(e) The impact of unresolved contract disputes on revenues recorded during the Performance Period (including but not limited to disputes resulting in litigation or arbitration) to the extent a licensee withholds or fails to make royalty payments or disputes the royalty payment paid, provided that, to the extent that the licensee fails to report information sufficient to determine the actual impact on revenues of the withholding or failure to make royalty payments or dispute of paid amounts, the average royalty revenues over the four fiscal quarters preceding the dispute (or such shorter period for which information is available) shall be used to determine the impact on royalty revenues due to the contract dispute, and such amount shall be prorated as appropriate to reflect the period during the Performance Period in which such withholding, dispute or failure to pay impacts revenue.

(4) In the event of an acquisition with a purchase price that is greater than \$5 billion, solely for purposes of calculating Adjusted GAAP Operating Income for the fiscal year in which such acquisition closes (but for no other year), operating results from such acquisition shall be excluded.

“ **Adjusted GAAP Tax Rate** ” means the applicable tax rates determined in accordance with GAAP, adjusted for earnings and the related tax expense associated with the adjustments specified in the definition of Adjusted GAAP Operating Income.

“ **Performance Period** ” means the period specified in the Grant Notice.

“ **Return on Invested Capital** ” or “ **ROIC** ” means the percentage determined by dividing

(1) the sum of the following amounts calculated separately for each of the Company fiscal years in the Performance Period: the product of (A) the Adjusted GAAP Operating Income for the fiscal year multiplied by (B) the difference between one (1) and the Adjusted GAAP Tax Rate for such fiscal year; by

(2) the sum of the following amounts calculated separately for each of the Company’s fiscal years in the Performance Period: the sum of (A) Average Adjusted GAAP Equity for the fiscal year and (B) Average Adjusted Debt for the fiscal year.

“ **ROIC Payout Percentage** ” means the percentage that corresponds to the specified below:

ROIC Ratio	ROIC Payout Percentage
120%	200%
100%	100%
80%	33%
Below 80%	0% Payout

Between the levels specified above, the ROIC Payout Percentage is interpolated linearly at a ratio of 3.35 percentage points for each one percent improvement in the ROIC Ratio from 80% to 100% and five (5) percentage points for each one percent improvement in the ROIC Ratio from 100% up to 120%, in each case rounded up to the nearest decimal point.

“ **ROIC Ratio** ” means the ROIC for the Performance Period divided by the ROIC Target.

“ **ROIC Target** ” means 12.0% percent.

LIMITATION ON ADJUSTMENTS. No adjustments shall be made in the calculation of Adjusted Debt, Adjusted GAAP Equity, Adjusted GAAP Operating Income or Adjusted GAAP Tax Rate which would preclude the payment of ROIC Shares Earned from satisfying the requirements of Code Section 162(m)(4)(C) and the regulations thereunder.

ATTACHMENT 2

QUALCOMM INCORPORATED EXCLUSIVE CONSULTING AGREEMENT

1. Consulting Services Following Normal Retirement Age. In the event you terminate your employment with the Participating Companies and receive or are entitled to receive additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits under the Award to which this Exclusive Consulting Agreement is attached as a result of having previously attained Normal Retirement Age, you will provide the Company consulting services related to the subject matter of that employment as provided in this Exclusive Consulting Agreement. Such consulting services will not exceed five (5) hours per month, and there will be no separate compensation for such services beyond that provided in the Award. Should the Company request services in excess of five (5) hours per month, you and Company will negotiate appropriate compensation for such additional services before they are undertaken. You represent, warrant and covenant that you will perform any services under this Exclusive Consulting Agreement in a timely, professional and workmanlike manner and that all services, materials, information and deliverables provided by you hereunder will comply with (i) the requirements communicated by Company, (ii) the Company's policies and procedures; and (iii) any other agreements between you and the Company, including but not limited to any severance, confidentiality or proprietary agreements. All capitalized terms in this Exclusive Consulting Agreement not otherwise defined herein shall have the meaning prescribed by the Qualcomm Incorporated 2016 Long-Term Incentive Plan (the "**Plan**") or the Award thereunder to which this Exclusive Consulting Agreement is attached.
2. The Award. You are a former high-level executive with at least 10 years' service with the Company and as such you are entitled to additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits under the Award as a result of having reached Normal Retirement Age. Your agreement to the terms and conditions of this Exclusive Consulting Agreement is an express condition of the Award and the additional provisions of the Award applicable to you following attainment of Normal Retirement Age.
3. Independent Contractor Relationship. Your relationship with Company under this Exclusive Consulting Agreement is that of an independent contractor, and nothing herein is intended to, or shall be construed to, create a partnership, agency, joint venture, employment, or similar relationship. You will not be entitled to any of the benefits that Company may make available to its employees, including, but not limited to, group health or life insurance, profit-sharing benefits, or retirement benefits, or awards under the Plan unless expressly provided in writing otherwise. You agree that providing services under this Exclusive Consulting Agreement shall not be treated as Service for purposes of the Plan or the Award. You are not authorized to make any representation, contract, or commitment on behalf of Company unless specifically requested or authorized in writing to do so by a Company officer. You are solely responsible for, and will file, on a timely basis, all tax returns and payments required to be filed with, or made to, any federal, state, or local tax authority. You will indemnify and hold harmless Company from and against any and all tax liability related to this Exclusive Consulting Agreement as well as any claims, actions, or charges arising out of or caused by your classification as an independent contractor.
4. Exclusivity.
 - 4.1 The consultancy arrangement contemplated by this Exclusive Consulting Agreement shall be on an exclusive basis. You shall not, during the Term, without the prior written consent of the Committee, engage in any work, services, or other activities for any person or entity which directly or indirectly competes with Company in any way. This includes, but is not limited to acting as an employee, officer, director, contractor, owner, consultant, or agent of any such person or entity. The determination of whether a person or entity is competitive with Company shall be subject to the sole and exclusive discretion of the Committee. You shall act in the best interest of Company while providing the Exclusive Consulting Services to Company.

5. Term and Termination.

5.1 Term. This Exclusive Consulting Agreement is effective as of the date of your termination of employment with Company following Normal Retirement Age and will terminate on the two year anniversary thereof unless terminated earlier as set forth below (the “**Term**”).

5.2 Termination by Company. Company may terminate this Exclusive Consulting Agreement before the end of the Term for any breach of Section 4 hereof by you or any material breach by you of any other provision hereof. Should Company believe that you breached this Exclusive Consulting Agreement in a manner that allows a termination pursuant to this Section 5.2, Company will notify you in writing and allow you to cure any breach (if such breach is curable) within ten (10) days after the date of Company’s written notice of breach. You understand that if Company terminates this Exclusive Consulting Agreement pursuant to this Section 5.2, you will forfeit all additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits under the Award as a result of having attained Normal Retirement Age and you will be subject to the Equity Clawback provisions of Section 6, below.

5.3 Termination by You. You may not terminate this Exclusive Consulting Agreement during the Term except or unless Company materially breaches this Consulting Agreement. Should you believe that Company materially breached this Exclusive Consulting Agreement, you will notify the Company in writing and allow Company to cure any breach (if such breach is curable) within ten (10) days after the date of your written notice of breach.

6. Equity Clawback. In the event of any breach by you of Section 4 hereof or any material breach by you of any other provision hereof, then any additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits you may have as a result of having attained Normal Retirement Age shall automatically and immediately terminate and be forfeited. In addition, you shall, within 30 days following notice from Company, pay to the Company an amount equal to the aggregate benefit, value or gain you realized or obtained as a result of any additional vesting, payments or other rights or benefits you received under the Award as a result of having attained Normal Retirement Age.

QUALCOMM Incorporated
COMPUTATION OF RATIO OF EARNINGS TO FIXED CHARGES
(In millions, except ratio data)

	Year Ended				
	September 24, 2017	September 25, 2016	September 27, 2015	September 28, 2014	September 29, 2013
Earnings:					
Income from continuing operations before income taxes and income (losses) from equity method investments	\$ 3,094	\$ 6,917	\$ 6,519	\$ 8,788	\$ 8,200
Fixed charges (1)	537	336	137	35	118
Cash distributions from equity method investments	—	—	6	—	1
Less: Capitalized interest	—	—	—	—	(65)
Total earnings	<u>\$ 3,631</u>	<u>\$ 7,253</u>	<u>\$ 6,662</u>	<u>\$ 8,823</u>	<u>\$ 8,254</u>
Fixed charges: (1)					
Interest	\$ 494	\$ 297	\$ 104	\$ 5	\$ 88
Interest component of rental expense	43	39	33	30	30
Total fixed charges	<u>\$ 537</u>	<u>\$ 336</u>	<u>\$ 137</u>	<u>\$ 35</u>	<u>\$ 118</u>
Ratio of earnings to fixed charges	<u>7 x</u>	<u>22 x</u>	<u>49 x</u>	<u>252 x</u>	<u>70 x</u>

- (1) Fixed charges include interest expense (which includes amortization of debt issuance costs), whether expensed or capitalized, and the portion of operating rental expense that management believes is representative of the interest component of rent expense, which is estimated to be one-third of rental expense.

SUBSIDIARIES OF REGISTRANT

Subsidiaries of Qualcomm Incorporated	State or Other Jurisdiction of Incorporation
Qualcomm Technologies, Inc.	Delaware
Qualcomm Global Trading Pte. Ltd.	Singapore
Qualcomm Asia Pacific Pte. Ltd.	Singapore
Qualcomm Technologies International, Ltd.	United Kingdom

The names of other subsidiaries are omitted. Such subsidiaries would not, if considered in the aggregate as a single subsidiary, constitute a significant subsidiary within the meaning of Item 601(b)(21)(ii) of Regulation S-K.

CONSENT OF INDEPENDENT REGISTERED PUBLIC ACCOUNTING FIRM

We hereby consent to the incorporation by reference in the Registration Statements on Form S-3 (No. 333-203935) and Form S-8 (No. 333-137692, No. 333-148177, No. 333-148556, No. 333-150423, No. 333-166246, No. 333-173184, No. 333-174649, No. 333-188104, No. 333-197445, No. 333-203575 and No. 333-210048) of QUALCOMM Incorporated of our report dated November 1, 2017 relating to the consolidated financial statements, the financial statement schedule and the effectiveness of internal control over financial reporting, which appears in this Form 10-K.

/s/ PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP

San Diego, California
November 1, 2017

EXHIBIT 31.1

CERTIFICATION PURSUANT TO SECTION 302 OF THE SARBANES-OXLEY ACT OF 2002

I, Steve Mollenkopf, certify that:

1. I have reviewed this Annual Report on Form 10-K of QUALCOMM Incorporated;
2. Based on my knowledge, this report does not contain any untrue statement of a material fact or omit to state a material fact necessary to make the statements made, in light of the circumstances under which such statements were made, not misleading with respect to the period covered by this report;
3. Based on my knowledge, the financial statements, and other financial information included in this report, fairly present in all material respects the financial condition, results of operations and cash flows of the registrant as of, and for, the periods presented in this report;
4. The registrant's other certifying officer and I are responsible for establishing and maintaining disclosure controls and procedures (as defined in Exchange Act Rules 13a-15(e) and 15d-15(e)) and internal control over financial reporting (as defined in Exchange Act Rules 13a-15(f) and 15d-15(f)) for the registrant and have:
 - a) Designed such disclosure controls and procedures, or caused such disclosure controls and procedures to be designed under our supervision, to ensure that material information relating to the registrant, including its consolidated subsidiaries, is made known to us by others within those entities, particularly during the period in which this report is being prepared;
 - b) Designed such internal control over financial reporting, or caused such internal control over financial reporting to be designed under our supervision, to provide reasonable assurance regarding the reliability of financial reporting and the preparation of financial statements for external purposes in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles;
 - c) Evaluated the effectiveness of the registrant's disclosure controls and procedures and presented in this report our conclusions about the effectiveness of the disclosure controls and procedures, as of the end of the period covered by this report based on such evaluation; and
 - d) Disclosed in this report any change in the registrant's internal control over financial reporting that occurred during the registrant's most recent fiscal quarter (the registrant's fourth fiscal quarter in the case of an annual report) that has materially affected, or is reasonably likely to materially affect, the registrant's internal control over financial reporting; and
5. The registrant's other certifying officer and I have disclosed, based on our most recent evaluation of internal control over financial reporting, to the registrant's auditors and the audit committee of the registrant's board of directors (or persons performing the equivalent functions):
 - a) All significant deficiencies and material weaknesses in the design or operation of internal control over financial reporting which are reasonably likely to adversely affect the registrant's ability to record, process, summarize and report financial information; and
 - b) Any fraud, whether or not material, that involves management or other employees who have a significant role in the registrant's internal control over financial reporting.

Dated: November 1, 2017

/s/ Steve Mollenkopf

Steve Mollenkopf

Chief Executive Officer

EXHIBIT 31.2

CERTIFICATION PURSUANT TO SECTION 302 OF THE SARBANES-OXLEY ACT OF 2002

I, George S. Davis, certify that:

1. I have reviewed this Annual Report on Form 10-K of QUALCOMM Incorporated;
2. Based on my knowledge, this report does not contain any untrue statement of a material fact or omit to state a material fact necessary to make the statements made, in light of the circumstances under which such statements were made, not misleading with respect to the period covered by this report;
3. Based on my knowledge, the financial statements, and other financial information included in this report, fairly present in all material respects the financial condition, results of operations and cash flows of the registrant as of, and for, the periods presented in this report;
4. The registrant's other certifying officer and I are responsible for establishing and maintaining disclosure controls and procedures (as defined in Exchange Act Rules 13a-15(e) and 15d-15(e)) and internal control over financial reporting (as defined in Exchange Act Rules 13a-15(f) and 15d-15(f)) for the registrant and have:
 - a) Designed such disclosure controls and procedures, or caused such disclosure controls and procedures to be designed under our supervision, to ensure that material information relating to the registrant, including its consolidated subsidiaries, is made known to us by others within those entities, particularly during the period in which this report is being prepared;
 - b) Designed such internal control over financial reporting, or caused such internal control over financial reporting to be designed under our supervision, to provide reasonable assurance regarding the reliability of financial reporting and the preparation of financial statements for external purposes in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles;
 - c) Evaluated the effectiveness of the registrant's disclosure controls and procedures and presented in this report our conclusions about the effectiveness of the disclosure controls and procedures, as of the end of the period covered by this report based on such evaluation; and
 - d) Disclosed in this report any change in the registrant's internal control over financial reporting that occurred during the registrant's most recent fiscal quarter (the registrant's fourth fiscal quarter in the case of an annual report) that has materially affected, or is reasonably likely to materially affect, the registrant's internal control over financial reporting; and
5. The registrant's other certifying officer and I have disclosed, based on our most recent evaluation of internal control over financial reporting, to the registrant's auditors and the audit committee of the registrant's board of directors (or persons performing the equivalent functions):
 - a) All significant deficiencies and material weaknesses in the design or operation of internal control over financial reporting which are reasonably likely to adversely affect the registrant's ability to record, process, summarize and report financial information; and
 - b) Any fraud, whether or not material, that involves management or other employees who have a significant role in the registrant's internal control over financial reporting.

Dated: November 1, 2017

/s/ George S. Davis

George S. Davis

Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer

EXHIBIT 32.1

CERTIFICATION PURSUANT TO SECTION 906 OF THE SARBANES-OXLEY ACT OF 2002

(18 U.S.C. SECTION 1350)

In connection with the accompanying Annual Report of QUALCOMM Incorporated (the “Company”) on Form 10-K for the fiscal year ended September 24, 2017 (the “Report”), I, Steve Mollenkopf, Chief Executive Officer of the Company, certify, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. §1350, as adopted pursuant to §906 of the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002, that:

1. The Report fully complies with the requirements of Section 13(a) of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934; and
2. The information contained in the Report fairly presents, in all material respects, the financial condition and results of operations of the Company.

Dated: November 1, 2017

/s/ Steve Mollenkopf

Steve Mollenkopf

Chief Executive Officer

EXHIBIT 32.2

CERTIFICATION PURSUANT TO SECTION 906 OF THE SARBANES-OXLEY ACT OF 2002

(18 U.S.C. SECTION 1350)

In connection with the accompanying Annual Report of QUALCOMM Incorporated (the “Company”) on Form 10-K for the fiscal year ended September 24, 2017 (the “Report”), I, George S. Davis, Chief Financial Officer of the Company, certify, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. §1350, as adopted pursuant to §906 of the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002, that:

1. The Report fully complies with the requirements of Section 13(a) of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934; and
2. The information contained in the Report fairly presents, in all material respects, the financial condition and results of operations of the Company.

Dated: November 1, 2017

/s/ George S. Davis

George S. Davis

Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer